

Independent Medicare & ACA Agents — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *Health-Insurance-Agents-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/health-insurance-agents/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

Not making enough to stay in the business · 39 documents · 20 voices

"If it's low stress and you're making that level of money, please stay. I'm a director of a commercial lines division making a little more than that and when I tell you that it is exhausting and a nonstop grind."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rft8td/13_years_in_140kyr_need_advice/o7mlq53/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... that's because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they can't just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"Online leads Hello, been an agent for 8 years never had a good experience with online lead companies. I see most people here are active with online leads. Any life lead companies worth suggesting to try out? Appreciate all the suggestions. Not afraid of the competition I believe it's enough money to go around for all of us that put in the work. These are the companies that were pretty much trash and disappointments for me, I wouldn't suggest any of you wasting time and money with them. A plus leads, Hometown quote, Everq, QuoteWizard, Smart financial."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dfe69c/online_leads/

"Making too little for Marketplace Insurance?? I am a college student live in FL. I enrolled health insurance through Marketplace and received premium tax credit in year 2025. Now when I'm trying to enroll for 2026, my estimated income for 2026 is lower due to job change. The Marketplace shows I have \$0 premium tax credit. I called them, they say I make too little to qualify the premium tax credit. Although they mentioned I make too much to qualify for Medicaid, I don't qualify Medicaid anyway. My question is: - My income dropped tremendously in 2025 due to job change. Is it possible that I have to pay back the Tax Credit if I made less than 2025 100%FPL? I am worried now that when I file taxes, I might owe crazy amount of money for the insurance. - how do I get cheap insurance coverage (just for serious emergency like accidents or unforeseeable disease. I normally don't go to the hospital to get checked up or for some small things like cold cuz I literally can't afford it right now) P.S.: My school don't have anything. It's a very small private school & they don't care. I'm waitressing and they do not offer insurance. I can't get on my parent's plan either."

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out there test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umxt4AaABAg

↳ @TheDIGAgency (2): "We have that for agents in my Medicare agency. Also, consider looking for an agency that will actually support and train you. Agencies have to earn their overrides if they want to survive."

↳ @reoman8179 (2): "@TheDIGAgency any recommendations on IMO/FHO's?"

"My tips: 1) Networking: I'm an introvert that comes across as an extrovert. Great for sales but I dread going to events and force myself to go. Staying connected and going to Insurance Events, opens up connections, some you may not realize for years later. Perfect example is while I'm young, I got into insurance and owning my agency at 21ish. Many of the contacts at brokerages I've made, jump ship to other brokerages. The friendship will get you an appointment where normally you couldn't have. 2) Agency Software: This one is a big one. Many of the softwares are expensive and slow. Sometimes agents, when opening their own agencies, use the software from their previous agency, with outdated tech, solely because of familiarity. I learned this lesson the hard way. Thousands a year on crappy agency software. 3) Turning 1 New Business Insured and the policy they chose to have you quote, into multiple policies and new leads. This one is big. 4) This is personal to my niche (small/medium accounts are \$100k+), and builds on 3. Offer several smaller quotes for lines of insurance applicable to your line of business the insured may not have/have been offered previously, even if you don't think the insured will be interested. "If Any" Workers Comp would be applicable for my lines of business. 5) create partnerships with other independent agencies and agents. Self explanatory I would think. 6) SOP's, and building the agency with Franchising in mind. 7) Calendar: setting up reminders to touch base on insured's. If you are coming around only at renewal time, you easily become an agent that is replaceable. 8) As an agency owner, not only having SOP's, but understanding how every moving part of your agency works. From accounting, to customer service, to certificates of insurance, and on and on. Excuse any typos (at the barber shop), but this is what I could think of off the top of my head, and while some sections are more important than others, I didn't number them in any particular order."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over/oodxkae/

"PDP's barely paid much to begin with, it's honestly not that big of a deal. Also, MOST of the non commissioned MAPD's are made that way because carriers are either about to sunset them anyway or they actively don't want you to sell that plan. Until a carrier makes their premier plan non commissioned, I wouldn't worry. My book is doing just fine"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msu3ukc/

"Thank you. After dealing with MLM's for years (mixture of insurance and product sales), I don't want to deal with the structure anymore. "No More Recruiting". I moved into the medical field for a change in pace but now I need to make more money. Looking into life insurance and I'm getting told to recruit. I'm glad I ran across this video. I support you in this. I just want to sell policies with great leads with no charge backs. On your application you ask for prior sales proof. I been out of the game for years and don't have anything to show proof of past successes. Can I still join your team?"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgzJaldo-PZu7wQUnsB4AaABAg>

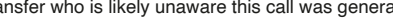
↳ @parissinclair1809 (0): "Been there too. No company will come with no charge backs even when you leave you are on the hook."

"Is there another LOB as lucrative as Medicare? I've been licensed in A, L, & H for 8 years now and after spending my first year with Aflac I switched to focus on Medicare. I really loved it for a while and was quite good at it, but doing Medicare in rural GA in 2020 made me never want to speak to an old person ever again. I took a huge step back and got into vet medicine, but maintained my current book and took referrals. With the current COL, I'm considering what to do with my license. As in, I'm debating whether I should focus more on insurance again and build my book more or just let it ride like I've been doing. I'm also wondering if there's another LOB or 1099 position within the industry that could be as lucrative but wouldn't require listening to old people talk about starting a civil war. I'm painfully aware that this year is an election year again so I hesitate to get right back in the same position. This is NOT meant to be a political post, but it's relevant as to why I took a break from Medicare, and why I'm hesitant to go back this year. I'm single and live alone, so I pay for all my expenses and am solely responsible for retirement and savings. I will stay in vet medicine long term to some capacity as I truly love it, but I'd like to also have other streams of income as a financial safety net. I originally focused on Medicare because it has such a high retention rate and such a large eligibility pool, but I also know that neither one of those things will be true forever. I'm open to any and all reasonable suggestions."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/191enzf/is_there_another_lob_as_lucrative_as_medicare/

"Nice. Best thing to do is have a great sales process to follow with each customer, like a lead-me-this-way type of script. Doesn't matter what they call in for, you will revolve all inquiries around extra Medicare benefits, as that is how they get all that stuff. I usually say sure I can help regardless of what question, read the legal disclosures for telephonic sales, then briefly explain in plain English how they get the benefits (by getting a new plan) and explain that YOU can make the transition super easy so they aren't afraid to do so. Get familiar with all the plans in the zip codes you serve so you can know what to look at when random questions come up. Don't waste time, or leave open air, or put on hold for too long. You should get to a point in your ability where no matter what they ask for, your brain knows already what to look at for that specific item. Always ask a final close at the end of the benefit presentation. Don't say how does that sound then sign them up. You need to ask something like "now that we reviewed XYZ plan and I showed you how you get XYZ benefit, would you like to sign up for a start date of (first of next month). And if they say YES, do enrollment. I have about 2500 enrollments under my belt and this is my process."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1idj71g/i_sold_my_first_medicare_policy/mhfhaps/

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady overseas call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not.  >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygvfc/

"⚠️ American Income Life = Scam ⚠️ I spent 6 months inside American Income Life, and if you're even thinking about working here, please hear me out: it's a trap. They lure you in with promises of six-figure income, freedom, luxury trips, and "helping families." What actually happens? You're bled dry from day one. You pay for your license, exam fees, Zoom account, computer—money, money, money out of your pocket. By the time you realize what's going on, you've already invested too much to walk away easily. The first week, they make you feel like you've accomplished something huge: passing the exam, starting your "career." But then you're thrown into terrible training and endless busywork—basically just making calls for your upline. When you finally get your own "opportunity," they hand you garbage leads that have been recycled a thousand times. People scream at you to stop calling, and you're forced to keep going. It's harassment, plain and simple. The schedule is insane: 12-hour days, almost no breaks, constant check-ins and micromanagement. When you finally catch someone, you drag them onto a Zoom call and read a script full of lies that you've been drilled on. Without even realizing it, you're tricking people into buying one of the worst insurance products out there. Meanwhile, you're broke, stressed, and exhausted. They parade "success stories" in front of you—agents claiming they were once in your shoes but now they're making six figures. Fake trips, fake recognition, fake promises. It's all smoke and mirrors. 🏹 If you're considering joining, or if you're already inside and thinking "I've put too much time and money in to quit now" — wake up. That's exactly how they keep you trapped. You're not building a business. You're being used. They're scamming new agents and clients alike. This place wrecks people's finances, mental health, and self-worth. It operates like a Ponzi scheme disguised as a career opportunity. To anyone on the fence: don't fall for it. Get out while you can. To the authorities: How is this still allowed to exist?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nggbda7/

"The problem with Globe life is that it can be really good or really bad depending on your branch and manager. Im working with them for about a month and is ok, the leads are from unions so the people that I call they requested so is not that invasive as a cold call. the thing about push people products is kinda a sale thing no matter the field, one thing that works for me is focus on the no cost benefits and just works as I'm hooking people up, be honest to them, if they say they don't want anything do a good deed and give them whatever free benefit you have, as long as they have your contact if one day they need something they gonna call that dude that hooked them up. Also I don't think is a good type of job if you are desperate for money since in the beginning it sucks, they give you old leads since they don't want you to burn bridges with new clients but as soon as you start to book appointments the leads get better, but it take time and lots of calls. I'm not a native english speaker and although I was scared about calling people, as long as you are nice and respectful they will be nice to you. I even make sure to let the ones that dont want to be bothered to know that I will make sure to exclude them from the leads so they wont get calls again, they really appreciate. So before you look for a new company, no matter which one you go, you gotta found a good branch and team, that's gonna make a huge difference, in the end of the day they are all the same. Also, the ones that offers some salary usually sucks in the commission, at least in my case the commission from the get go is already 50% so is not that bad. try to get a normal job, save some money to be good for a couple months and then try again... not having the pressure to have to make money ASAP can makes things easier on you. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/mra1242/

"My own company. I don't work for no one, but myself. I just have contracts with several carriers and just focus on selling and generating my own leads. If I need a pep talk, I give it to myself. Need motivation, I tell myself men are supposed to be providers and if I can't provide for myself then it is impossible to do so for another. Took me years to figure it out, but depression, wasted money on leads, women leaving me because I was broke, all brought me to this point, and now it feels good not having to worry about the check when I go out to dinner."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/nodm9ma/

"I would contract direct with Midland National and then call Premier or Ritter and see who will give you better contracts for whatever else you need. I will say there are good reasons to work with a decent IMO. But if you don't want marketing or sales assistance that is the way to go especially if you want to continue to work mid market. Penn Mutual does decent direct contracts too."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hmdw46/failed_mlm_insurance_agent/m3tx2fq/

"Beware of unethical FMO. Integrity Marketing Group (based out of TX) has been on an FMO buying spree, trying to gobble up as many FMO's across the country as they can, simply in order to reduce market competition. FMO's, such as Agent Pipeline, Holland, NAA (Superior Performers), AGA, Premier Marketing, Western Marketing, and many others are included in their portfolio (this list can be verified/expanded via the Integrity website). Integrity hasn't been able to grow organically (i.e. gaining more Agents via better support), and so acquisitions have been their key to growth. As per another post elsewhere: "Welcome to the world of insurance full of empty promises and recruit anybody with a pulse." And Integrity owned FMO's are no different, even perhaps amongst the worst offenders. Burn & churn is the Integrity way. Integrity has adopted a quantity over quality approach in regards to Agents. They would rather have 100 low-producing Agents (often via lack of support) that each write only 1 app than 10 better-producing Agents that each write 10 apps. The net dollar gain is the same for them (100 apps written is 100 apps - regardless of the sources). Integrity only cares about Integrity. Again, burn & churn is the m.o. for Integrity (in regards to both Agents & employees). Perhaps worse, many Medicare carriers could care less about Integrity, and so offer little-to-no dedicated support and/or training, meaning Agents are often left completely in the dark. Most Integrity employees themselves don't even know the process for onboarding new Agents, and so cannot offer any real help. Even worse, Integrity has in-house CRM's & databases that are outdated by some 30+ years, but continue to pump out propaganda claiming they are "leaders" in "AI" (ha!). Let's not ignore the massive data breach that recently occurred at some Integrity companies (a class action suit is pending with NAA/Superior Performers in particular). Plus, many of those Integrity owned FMO's all operate on different systems than each other, so any one of their FMO's is largely unaware of what the other(s) are doing, and there is virtually no cohesion amongst those similarly owned FMO's (imagine the nightmare caused when several subsidiaries of the same parent company each have different policies, procedures, processes, computer systems, forms, etc.). Worse still, many of those Integrity similarly owned FMO's simply don't get along with each other (given the lack of cohesion/cooperation between each other), and so don't even offer support for each other. I have frequently seen employees from one Integrity owned FMO simply refuse to return calls/emails from employees of another Integrity owned FMO. And I have never seen as many data processing errors as I have w/Integrity owned FMO's (Integrity hasn't even initiated training programs for their employees, thus many don't even know how to properly submit Agent info to conform with NIPR/licensing info, creating unnecessary delays and/or rejection when trying to onboard. Integrity has completely ignored sustainable operations and infrastructure, meaning lack of knowledge, low efficiency, low productivity, and low effectiveness. One of the main reasons why their Agent support is so bad. And many Integrity Managers are amongst the least knowledgeable of products, carrier processes, etc. I once had to speak to four different Marketing Managers at an Integrity FMO, and was given four very different answers, each of which was completely wrong (which I discovered after finally speaking to carriers and getting the correct answers). Integrity is easily one of the worst run companies I have ever seen. My best recommendation, is stay far away from any Integrity owned FMO."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/m36p0b0/

"THIS! I joined maybe two weeks ago, and they are pretty good salespeople because I was definitely sold into it at first. Purchased my own training, licensing and bought my own leads which they did tell me I had to buy the lower level leads to "get a feel for it" as well. Was pressured into going to their national conference, which was VERY cultish and a lot of toxic positivity like you said and almost nobody would even speak to me because I hadn't made them any money yet. Or even look at me, not kidding they would look at me I would smile at them and they would just turn their head and walk away. First person I called when I bought the leads, the person who answered the phone told me they died 2 years ago and I was told to try to call the widow back after 6 months to see if she wants insurance for herself. what the actual fuck. Goes to show how OLD these leads are and how you're basically cold calling these people and being pushed to try to force them to buy something from you even if they don't want it. Currently trying to get out of it but I just feel so bad for my upline who is very nice but very immersed in this company, and I can tell she so badly wants the approval of these people and I was the first person she recruited who stuck around and she was just so excited and seems like she really wants me to succeed. I just feel like I didn't sign up for most of this, and was told one thing and am now being told a different thing. Like in my interview, they said I will not have to call my friends and family and are now asking me to call my friends and family. I don't want to and will not go broke doing this, or forfeit my integrity. I just feel so stupid lol"

— r/Insurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/1klwvqp/do_not_join_symmetry_financial_group_heres_the/n98m1gl/

Money spent on leads that don't pay back · 23 documents · 20 voices

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps 😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

"This is one of the best videos you've put out Peter. The truth people need to hear even though they don't want to hear (clearly from the comments) There is no "lead vendor" that's going to give you the types of leads he described (multiple times) - I know it's crazy and an unimaginable thing to think of but guess what....are you ready for it?.....wait....IN BUSINESS YOU HAVE TO ACTUALLY MARKET!!!!!! Why would you assume the product you sell is any different than anything else? Marketing is 90% of any business. If you're not getting your brand out there and marketing then you have no business. Learn how to market and sales become a lot easier. Learn how to market and you'll never run out of people to talk to. There's no way around it."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=Ugz1fJk41aKk9iSog94AaABAq>

↳ @davidmooney4112 (0): "Self gen is a lead source. I think what people were hoping to hear is how his business goes about self generating leads (how he runs his marketing)."

↳ @legacyfirst (0): "@davidmooney4112 he's already got videos on that"

↳ @Eternalsuav (0): "@davidmooney4112well that's what the title says"

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"I am physically disabled working from home. I would not be able to work 20-hours a week without bed rest intermediately. As a 1099 for life and health insurance, I'll be doing mock interviews with my family and friends. I plan on doing a lot of research on all of my products and the industry. I'm not worried about leads, because my previous job is resourceful. For someone in my situation, do you have any additional training advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5ges4r/

"This isn't financial advice btw. I've only been in the life and health insurance industry not p&c. I started off selling mortgage protecting which is a term life product. It's lucrative but does take work. I succeeded early on because I wasn't afraid to doorknock leads that wouldn't answer the phone. Knowing what you're selling and getting in front of the client while focusing on being likable will get you to 6 figures a year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ey16zq/how_much_was_your_first_check/ljbuJ7g/

"In regards to the recycled leads - they end up that way because everyone is too afraid to "resolve" them. Well when I knew I was on my way out, I was begging for more leads. They let me log into the accounts of agents that were no longer there, so what I did before I left was resolve around 350 leads on multiple impact accounts"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fx4zhe/i_hate_american_income_life_all_so_bad/lqrl6m6/

"The problem with Globe life is that it can be really good or really bad depending on your branch and manager. Im working with them for about a month and is ok, the leads are from unions so the people that I call they requested so is not that invasive as a cold call. the thing about push people products is kinda a sale thing no matter the field, one thing that works for me is focus on the no cost benefits and just works as I'm hooking people up, be honest to them, if they say they don't want anything do a good deed and give them whatever free benefit you have, as long as they have your contact if one day they need something they gonna call that dude that hooked them up. Also I don't think is a good type of job if you a desperate for money since in the beginning it sucks, they give you old leads since they don't want you to burn bridges with new clients but as soon as you start to book appointments the leads get better, but it take time and lots of calls. I'm not a native english speaker and although I was scared about calling people, as long as you are nice and respectful they will be nice to you. I even make sure to let the ones that dont want to be bothered to know that I will make sure to exclude them from the leads so they wont get calls again, they really appreciate. So before you look for a new company, no matter which one you go, you gotta found a good branch and team, that's gonna make a huge difference, in the end of the day they are all the same. Also, the ones that offers some salary usually sucks in the commission, at least in my case the commission from the get go is already 50% so is not that bad. try to get a normal job, save some money to be good for a couple months and then try again... not having the pressure to have to make money ASAP can makes things easier on you. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/mra1242/

"My own company. I don't work for no one, but myself. I just have contracts with several carriers and just focus on selling and generating my own leads. If I need a pep talk, I give it to myself. Need motivation, I tell myself men are supposed to be providers and if I can't provide for myself then it is impossible to do so for another. Took me years to figure it out, but depression, wasted money on leads, women leaving me because I was broke, all brought me to this point, and now it feels good not having to worry about the check when I go out to dinner."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/nodm9ma/

"I do life insurance too, but I do it for worksite versus individual and it's such a game changer. The company I work with actually doesn't make you pay for leads, which was the thing I was worried about the most when I started. We have a few different teams in our office and a lot of people from my team came from individual and they said it's so different so maybe that would be something to consider"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lb713fm/

"THIS! I joined maybe two weeks ago, and they are pretty good salespeople because I was definitely sold into it at first. Purchased my own training, licensing and bought my own leads which they did tell me I had to buy the lower level leads to "get a feel for it" as well. Was pressured into going to their national conference, which was VERY cultish and a lot of toxic positivity like you said and almost nobody would even speak to me because I hadn't made them any money yet. Or even look at me, not kidding they would look at me I would smile at them and they would just turn their head and walk away. First person I called when I bought the leads, the person who answered the phone told me they died 2 years ago and I was told to try to call the widow back after 6 months to see if she wants insurance for herself. what the actual fuck. Goes to show how OLD these leads are and how you're basically cold calling these people and being pushed to try to force them to buy something from you even if they don't want it. Currently trying to get out of it but I just feel so bad for my upline who is very nice but very immersed in this company, and I can tell she so badly wants the approval of these people and I was the first person she recruited who stuck around and she was just so excited and seems like she really wants me to succeed. I just feel like I didn't sign up for most of this, and was told one thing and am now being told a different thing. Like in my interview, they said I will not have to call my friends and family and are now asking me to call my friends and family. I don't want to and will not go broke doing this, or forfeit my integrity. I just feel so stupid lol"

— r/Insurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/1klwvqp/do_not_join_symmetry_financial_group_heres_the/n98m1gl/

"I can completely relate to your struggles. I joined 2 agencies that provided free leads and promised they were fresh in exvhnage for a cut of commissions. I thought I finally had the answer to my problems. The first place didnt work out and I was making 500 dials a day and getting nowhere. The leads were old and tired of getting calls. The 2nd place- the lead quality was almost just as bad as the first. I learned that free leads is not the path to success but it helped me get over the fear of being on the phones. Now, Im at a place that I pay for my own inbound leads but the close rate has been insane. They have figured things out and have a great system in place for people that are willing to pay for leads and work hard. If you want to know more.or to come hang out with us for a day in zoom, let me know and I will set it up so you can see what we are doing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1su3zm9/i_am_stuck_frustrated_and_ready_to_give_up_on_my/oithfeh/

"I don't want to sound harsh but the key to this business is having a lead budget. \$50/day equates to \$250/wk. I wouldn't recommend anyone get in this business if they don't have at least \$500/wk to work with. \$5/day wouldn't even buy one lead. How many people can you sell if you only have half of a lead? This industry is full of MLM companies that recruit vulnerable people and sell them on these grand ideas of making tons of money working from home. Because of this they recruit people with little to no money. You should not come in to this industry without a way to fund your business while you are getting your feet."

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTTo3FiUCM&lc=Ugywlm5_i5HvirQshol4AaABAg_9opRFs4nUfr9xcb2V1gLIb

"Thanks for your insight! My main concern with going independent is that I don't have the capital to buy leads. I know that you have to buy leads at a lot of other companies too, but in my mind it seems easier to start off with a recognizable company, have a handful of leads provided to you, and not have to worry about being in the red before I've even finished learning. What's your lead process being independent?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/jy8ymyi/

"We get inbound leads so no I'm not worried about AI. To make a good amount make sure you know what you're selling, figure out the clients needs and always assume the sale in other words be confident."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ey16zg/how_much_was_your_first_check/nbpsz84/

"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtgo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/

"I would almost think that is too pushy(I'm very new to sales. Take it with a grain of salt.) 3 calls a day? I'm ignoring that, or it better be something extremely important, like someone in the hospital. I text or email, then a day or two later I call, then follow up with a text or email letting them know I'm sorry I missed them. I usually include a quote or number if I have enough information for a relatively accurate quote. I may try it your way, but I could also recommend you trying it my way. I get about that many policies, but with much less stress and less leads. It may also be my location/personality difference too though. I do want to focus on networking though. Internet leads stink in general."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hdr5qh/i_sold_two_policies_myself_today_lets_go/m66224l/

"Seems we are getting off topic? I thought this was about EFES? EMG...the old EMG...was as every says. But...they are now ran under the EFES higher ups. The problem now? Agents don't want to pay \$35 for NEW leads? OK? Maybe EMG should go back to cheaper recycled leads? Damn if you do...you know the rest. But EMG is running just like EFES on a much smaller scale but it is running successfully. Def not anything like the old EMG which is now Unique Underwriters. same guys over there. Same idea as the old EMG. take that last statement for what it's worth if you're looking at them? Smoke and mirrors boys. Smoke and mirrors. The only downside to the EFES program is because they really do generate brand new leads for the agent, there is some downtime before those leads roll in which can be frustrating. But it's worth the wait."

— Insurance-Forums.com · EFES, Equita Company · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/efes-equita-company.30922/#post-386968>

"I would be interested to see some of your internet lead scripts/processes. I normally close internet leads in about 2-3 calls. I use GatherPlace and Norvax and it works fairly well.. For every \$100 I spend I'm making about \$350-\$450. I know some guys on here a much higher ROI (i.e. \$100 to make \$800+). Internet leads are not my "bread and butter" but I would love to hear some feedback from some of the pros. I don't want to hear Leadpod as an alternative... I'm trying to increase my ROI..."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Internet Lead Process/Script · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/internet-lead-process-script.5987/#post-78579>

Being tied to an agency, upline or contract · 16 documents · 16 voices

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... thats because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they cant just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

"Thank you. After dealing with MLM's for years (mixture of insurance and product sales), I don't want to deal with the structure anymore. "No More Recruiting". I moved into the medical field for a change in pace but now I need to make more money. Looking into life insurance and I'm getting told to recruit. I'm glad I ran across this video. I support you in this. I just want to sell policies with great leads with no charge backs. On you application you ask for prior sales proof. I been out of the game for years and don't have anything to show proof of past successes. Can I still join your team?"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgzJaldo-PZu7wQUnsB4AaABAq>

↳ @parissinclair1809 (0): "Been there too. No company will come with no charge backs even when you leave you are on the hook."

"Beware of unethical FMO. Integrity Marketing Group (based out of TX) has been on an FMO buying spree, trying to gobble up as many FMO's across the country as they can, simply in order to reduce market competition. FMO's, such as Agent Pipeline, Holland, NAA (Superior Performers), AGA, Premier Marketing, Western Marketing, and many others are included in their portfolio (this list can be verified/expanded via the Integrity website). Integrity hasn't been able to grow organically (i.e. gaining more Agents via better support), and so acquisitions have been their key to growth. As per another post elsewhere: "Welcome to the world of insurance full of empty promises and recruit anybody with a pulse." And Integrity owned FMO's are no different, even perhaps amongst the worst offenders. Burn & churn is the Integrity way. Integrity has adopted a quantity over quality approach in regards to Agents. They would rather have 100 low-producing Agents (often via lack of support) that each write only 1 app than 10 better-producing Agents that each write 10 apps. The net dollar gain is the same for them (100 apps written is 100 apps - regardless of the sources). Integrity only cares about Integrity. Again, burn & churn is the m.o. for Integrity (in regards to both Agents & employees). Perhaps worse, many Medicare carriers could care less about Integrity, and so offer little-to-no dedicated support and/or training, meaning Agents are often left completely in the dark. Most Integrity employees themselves don't even know the process for onboarding new Agents, and so cannot offer any real help. Even worse, Integrity has in-house CRM's & databases that are outdated by some 30+ years, but continue to pump out propaganda claiming they are "leaders" in "AI" (ha!). Let's not ignore the massive data breach that recently occurred at some Integrity companies (a class action suit is pending with NAA/Superior Performers in particular). Plus, many of those Integrity owned FMO's all operate on different systems than each other, so any one of their FMO's is largely unaware of what the other(s) are doing, and there is virtually no cohesion amongst those similarly owned FMO's (imagine the nightmare caused when several subsidiaries of the same parent company each have different policies, procedures, processes, computer systems, forms, etc.). Worse still, many of those Integrity similarly owned FMO's simply don't get along with each other (given the lack of cohesion/cooperation between each other), and so don't even offer support for each other. I have frequently seen employees from one Integrity owned FMO simply refuse to return calls/emails from employees of another Integrity owned FMO. And I have never seen as many data processing errors as I have w/Integrity owned FMO's (Integrity hasn't even initiated training programs for their employees, thus many don't even know how to properly submit Agent info to conform with NIPR/licensing info, creating unnecessary delays and/or rejection when trying to onboard. Integrity has completely ignored sustainable operations and infrastructure, meaning lack of knowledge, low efficiency, low productivity, and low effectiveness. One of the main reasons why their Agent support is so bad. And many Integrity Managers are amongst the least knowledgeable of products, carrier processes, etc. I once had to speak to four different Marketing Managers at an Integrity FMO, and was given four very different answers, each of which was completely wrong (which I discovered after finally speaking to carriers and getting the correct answers). Integrity is easily one of the worst run companies I have ever seen. My best recommendation, is stay far away from any Integrity owned FMO."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/m36p0b0/

"As a personal lines guy I answer a lot of questions for agents starting out and you never know if it was appreciated or absorbed. I want you to know that this is fantastic information, it was recieved and appreciated for the time you took to respond. I actually like everything you said! My biggest hang up is leads. I don't know what I am looking for and who to trust when it comes to leads. Then I read where people say they spend \$1400 a WEEK on leads on forums I visit....what world am I living in? Thats \$70k on leads!!! Even if they are lying and its half that...\$700 a week?!! I just can't pay that much and feel good about it. I just don't believe their ROI is good with those numbers. So actually networking is EXACTLY what I like to hear because I can do that no problem! I am treating it like a side business to my P&C agency, in the sense that I don't want to feel pressured to do a huge number right now, I am learning the product so again my goal is 4 a month which now I am seeing may not be very realistic. But I can afford to not really rush and build networks and brand. Like you I would rather just be the local Medicare guy, theres a pretty large retirement city near me where its all golf courses and golf carts. I know it can provide a lot of opportunity. So I will take my time and build the brand and try to do it organically. When you did approach Financial advisors how did you explain what you wanted to do? Did you offer a referral payment? Did you send a letter or call first? I don't want them to feel annoyed that I am reaching out. I can't thank you enough for this great comment. You gave me more in this one comment than 6 months of Googling has done for me. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 2 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/jvb73ad/>

"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/

"My worst client's renewal is next week. His stuff is all on surplus lines, so he need w short apps for updating exposures etc completed annually. I actually prefill as much as I can (usually the insurance side+ limits etc) and I start sending it to him January. I send every other week until one month out, then it's weekly with a phone call too. I get his receptionist (wife) on maybe half of my calls and he's always busy and she'll take a message. She is literally always confused who I am. Typically the carrier breaks down and offers quotes based off expiring with our the apps which only reinforces his shitty behavior. This year they didn't. I was able to convince them to quite, but they are going to do an audit and inspection after renewal or cancel his ass. They also raised rates. All good imo, we kind of want this guy to go because he's such a PITA. I sent it all and with invoices Friday afternoon. We'll see how it goes lol hopefully he non complies and cancels and we can rod ourselves of it. I don't understand all of the thinking behind it, but my agency owner is worried about an E&O claim if we dont at least get renewal quotes for him, bit of he cancels for non pay or non compliance,we are good and can just tell him to go find a other broker."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sefo1v/if_insureds_could_just_open_their_mail_and_return/ofju8mq/

"I might encourage you to study the dental products you have access to and how they treat out-of-network... For example, with clients who don't want to switch dentists but that dentist doesn't contract with any carrier, I position Cigna's DVH policy since it pays the same amount for each service whether in network or out. This means more money towards those out of network services. Contrary to Ameritas and many others who pay out of network based on "the least contracted fee amount"..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/n3tjikg/

"DHurd said: Well I'm new also, but from what I've gathered is it would only conflict if you were trying to get multiple appointments with the same insurance company through different imos. But where as you're talking completely different field theres really no problem. You could even get another imo to get appointed with other insurers offering what you're already selling too Oh wow I had no idea, it just feels weird for me to ask here, there's a strong sense of camaraderie at this brokerage, so I don't want to be like "hey, if I want to sell medicare through another IMO is that cool?" lol. I mean, I may be able to sell medicare here? But if that's the case they're not informing me. I get the feeling that the people above me don't get a cut when I sell medicare? So that could be a factor (not even sure if that's true, still learning about medicare)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can I sell Medicare if I'm already with a brokerage? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-i-sell-medicare-if-im-already-with-a-brokerage.104522/#post-1379884>

"Most of the insurance companies have direct enrollment. You can see plans and prices at [healthcare.gov/see-plans/](https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/) (unless its a state exchange which I'm not familiar with) to pick a plan and then go to insurance companys' website for the direct enrollment. Some companies you can even make the first payment. I don't understand why anyone pays for a platform to do enrollments. And if you need a platform because the company doesn't have direct enrollment and you don't want to use [healthcare.gov](https://www.healthcare.gov/) or state exchange then join a National FMO that has a platform-it's free. The reason I think that Health Sherpa is working again is because CMS just opened the direct enrollment capability again, on the 12th I think, for SEPS. In the past it was only available during the open enrollment."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Sherpa 2016 Open Enrollment · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-sherpa-2016-open-enrollment.76187/#post-1015329>

"Dumbledood said: Oh wow I had no idea, it just feels weird for me to ask here, there's a strong sense of camaraderie at this brokerage, so I don't want to be like "hey, if I want to sell medicare through another IMO is that cool?" lol. I mean, I may be able to sell medicare here? But if that's the case they're not informing me. I get the feeling that the people above me don't get a cut when I sell medicare? So that could be a factor (not even sure if that's true, still learning about medicare). I think the general advice on the forum for such thing is to basically master what you're doing and then you can expand into another thing one at a time. Just some tidbit I've gathered from reading alot here"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can I sell Medicare if I'm already with a brokerage? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-i-sell-medicare-if-im-already-with-a-brokerage.104522/#post-1379885>

"May I ask, what are your thoughts regarding Allstate? Are they what you call a captive agency? I'm just starting in the field. I want to gain knowledge & experience, but I don't want to be contractually tied to an agency if it doesn't work and they don't deliver on their promises. I've come across a few stories where folks said that the company refused to release them Others stated they had to sign a 2-year non-compete form (unsure if this is the proper term). Can you please give an example of an Umbrella company? Any insight that you can provide would be greatly appreciated. 😊"

— YouTube · How Do Medicare Brokers Get Paid? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DBwUb_QfaB0&lc=UgzCQ1OOgvafafZPDGN4AaABA9_9UaXkUc6WkFA--uSBCC3lo

"What if I am contracted with every available MAPD plan in my area? I don't sell every one, but I can. As long as there is an exclusion for F2F, I'm golden."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Suprised nobody's talking about the huge MAPD marketing rules handed down by CMS · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/suprised-nobody%E2%80%99s-talking-about-the-huge-mapd-marketing-rules-handed-down-by-cms.108507/#post-1422055>

Carriers cutting commissions or pulling out · 9 documents · 9 voices

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

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"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

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"PDP's barely paid much to begin with, it's honestly not that big of a deal. Also, MOST of the non commissioned MAPD's are made that way because carriers are either about to sunset them anyway or they actively don't want you to sell that plan. Until a carrier makes their premier plan non commissioned, I wouldnt worry. My book is doing just fine"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msu3ukc/

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygvf/

"Just a back story on my thought process....Market factors and the price offered was hard to pass up. I am in an area of the country where insurance carriers are trying to decrease capacity and they do not want our business. I also had 40 percent of our revenue with one carrier and that carrier is also pulling back in our area. I had three carriers pull out of my agency as well 12 months leading to the sell. After the sell Helene destroyed my area so the market has gotten even worse. Once I sold to PE I realized the leverage they have that I didn't have. My agency was a nice size (2.5 million in rev) but a 1 million book with a carrier isn't what it used to be in an unprofitable area. I have a commitment to my family and this allowed me to achieve my dream as well. If I am an idiot I could run through all my money but at the moment I am comfortable with no debt and a lot of zeros in my account. I did agree to a three year contract known as a work out to get even more money on top of the initial offer. So far I have gotten 1/3 of the additional money. I am hoping to get the remaining 2/3 and then evaluate what I want to do next. If they treat me fairly I may continue but time will tell. Also...If another hurricane hits my area this year or even next I suspect we are heading towards a Florida scenario. I am too old and too burned out to have to tackle that type of marketplace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kr7bqt/pc_agency_owners/mtgh4s0/

"Makes you wonder if we are getting close to agents getting out of Medicare. When other industries are more profitable and less headaches there's no reason to sell for them. I think it's ridiculous that carriers are dropping HRA commissions while at the same time requiring them for the plan to effectuate. Like you're not jumping through a million hoops already, now do more work for less money. If they don't want to compensate for HRA's then the carrier should be in charge of completing HRA's. Time is money, get them signed and move on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fu74gk/question_for_other_medicare_agents_about_rx_plans/lq1fj3p/

"I might encourage you to study the dental products you have access to and how they treat out-of-network... For example, with clients who don't want to switch dentists but that dentist doesn't contract with any carrier, I position Cigna's DVH policy since it pays the same amount for each service whether in network or out. This means more money towards those out of network services. Contrary to Ameritas and many others who pay out of network based on "the least contracted fee amount"..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/n3tjkg/

"AllenChicago said: I've had 3 terminated this year for not sending in documents 6 - 10 months ago. When these clients received notice from the carrier that they're plan was cancelled by the Marketplace, they called me in a panic. I directed them to the people who walk on water at HC.gov. Within a few days, each one of them showed up as In-Force once again...and with a new policy date, but same policy number. No back premium due. ac Click to expand... I'm sure I'll be able to get it worked out: these people are out of the country now until the end of the month, though. I've called once for them. I am authorized on their account. I'll try again. (They have a 3-month grace period, too.)"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971705>

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— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971704>

Compliance, consent and losing contracts · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

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"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

"Stay in Health or move to P&C and Life I've been doing Medicare for about a year and some change. (2 OEP 1 AEP). I enjoy the working from home and commission checks. It's okay stressful, my job keep changing hours so work-life isn't there anymore. My license is about to expire and I'm considering either renewing or go join P&C and Life for less stress (let me know your experience in P&C and switching between, pros cons) thank you"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jz5x42/stay_in_health_or_move_to_pc_and_life/

"I'm at 120%. Medicare is a diff animal. i got scared away from it when I hear the compliance horror stories has the regulators keep changing everything constantly so the agent is constantly doing more training and more paperwork and more things that make their job harder. Is that right? do you run your own ads for leads then?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/nfchvdi/

"My worst client's renewal is next week. His stuff is all on surplus lines, so he need w short apps for updating exposures etc completed annually. I actually prefill as much as I can (usually the insurance side+ limits etc) and I start sending it to him January. I send every other week until one month out, then it's weekly with a phone call too. I get his receptionist (wife) on maybe half of my calls and he's always busy and she'll take a message. She is literally always confused who I am. Typically the carrier breaks down and offers quotes based off expiring with our the apps which only reinforces his shitty behavior. This year they didn't. I was able to convince them to quite, but they are going to do an audit and inspection after renewal or cancel his ass. They also raised rates. All good imo, we kind of want this guy to go because he's such a PITA. I sent it all and with invoices Friday afternoon. We'll see how it goes lol hopefully he non complies and cancels and we can rod ourselves of it. I don't understand all of the thinking behind it, but my agency owner is worried about an E&O claim if we dont at least get renewal quotes for him, bit of he cancels for non pay or non compliance, we are good and can just tell him to go find a other broker."

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Chargebacks after the enrollment season · 5 documents · 5 voices

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— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sefo1v/if_insureds_could_just_open_their_mail_and_return/ofju8mq/

"I completely understand your point and I think agents should definitely put more energy towards not being too over leveraged in one market or the other like only ACA or only Medicare. I'm a pretty new agent so I don't have the experience of being a part of the first OEP but what draws me to ACA is honestly just a few key things. I don't want to deal with chargebacks, I want to target a bigger client pool, and honestly I think the quality of agents in my area is pretty low and by focusing on being the best agent I can be I'll naturally rise to the top. I understand that all ACA agents are one major regulatory change away from being in a really bad place and honestly I have no real argument against. I definitely plan on expanding into Medicare eventually but for now, as I am a pretty new to the industry, I want to focus primarily on ACA until I'm more comfortable and confident in my role as an agent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n423dik/

"I wrote 84 apps but it was my first AEP I am worried about charge backs and how much it all equals out to be come Jan 1st. How many did you do in renewals?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nszamaq/

"AllenChicago said: I've had 3 terminated this year for not sending in documents 6 - 10 months ago. When these clients received notice from the carrier that they're plan was cancelled by the Marketplace, they called me in a panic. I directed them to the people who walk on water at HC.gov. Within a few days, each one of them showed up as In-Force once again...and with a new policy date, but same policy number. No back premium due. ac Click to expand... I'm sure I'll be able to get it worked out: these people are out of the country now until the end of the month, though. I've called once for them. I am authorized on their account. I'll try again. (They have a 3-month grace period, too.)"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971705>

"I've had 3 terminated this year for not sending in documents 6 - 10 months ago. When these clients received notice from the carrier that they're plan was cancelled by the Marketplace, they called me in a panic. I directed them to the people who walk on water at HC.gov. Within a few days, each one of them showed up as In-Force once again...and with a new policy date, but same policy number. No back premium due. ac"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971704>

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Leads that answer and a phone that rings · 68 documents · 20 voices

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will make me feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my ass off on the phone and my spleen KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~ \$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

"Thank you. After dealing with MLM's for years (mixture of insurance and product sales), I don't want to deal with the structure anymore. "No More Recruiting". I moved into the medical field for a change in pace but now I need to make more money. Looking into life insurance and I'm getting told to recruit. I'm glad I ran across this video. I support you in this. I just want to sell policies with great leads with no charge backs. On you application you ask for prior sales proof. I been out of the game for years and don't have anything to show proof of past successes. Can I still join your team?"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgzJaldo-PZu7wQUnsB4AaABAq>

↳ @parissinclair1809 (0): "Been there too. No company will come with no charge backs even when you leave you are on the hook."

"I want leads of medicare's Patients whos should be med b with good SNS regarding back braces"

— YouTube · Calling Medicare Leads! [FREE Medicare Script] · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VNXHul228Ts&lc=UgxcTCu7ggXchns7nEl4AaABAq>

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8ygyvfc/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"New Medicare Insurance agent with questions My name is Robert and I am a licensed insurance agent contracted through Cigna as my only carrier. I am interested in learning more about your leads and how I can partner with you to sell Cigna Medicare plans. I understand that Medicare can be confusing, and I want to make sure that I am providing my clients with the best possible service. I have a few questions that I would like to ask you: Can I walk a client through the [Medicare.gov](https://www.Medicare.gov) website and refer them to an agent who is licensed to sell the product that is the best deal for them? Can I make sure that a client does not have a group health plan, has Medicare, and that their doctor and prescriptions are covered? Can I explain plan benefits and costs, and compare Cigna plans to other plans that might cost less? Can I mention that another plan might be a better fit for a client, or try to compare Cigna plans to other plans that might be better for them? Can I offer them a referral to see someone who is licensed to sell the plan that may be better for them? Can I invite them to talk to me about Medicare 101 through email, then get an SOA to talk to them about Cigna? Should I just sell them the plan that is the best fit for them out of the products that I'm licensed to sell? I'm trying to imagine what my plan is, but I can't find any good scripts or guidance for selling Cigna. I want to gain clients through an email list that isn't specifically targeting Medicare and through Next Gen Leads. I understand that Medicare has a lot of rules, and I am not here to challenge them. I am here to ask questions to help me better understand how I can work with you to provide my clients with the best possible service. Thank you for your time and consideration. "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17j8bis/new_medicare_insurance_agent_with_questions/

"The problem with Globe life is that it can be really good or really bad depending on your branch and manager. Im working with them for about a month and is ok, the leads are from unions so the people that I call they requested so is not that invasive as a cold call. the thing about push people products is kinda a sale thing no matter the field, one thing that works for me is focus on the no cost benefits and just works as I'm hooking people up, be honest to them, if they say they don't want anything do a good deed and give them whatever free benefit you have, as long as they have your contact if one day they need something they gonna call that dude that hooked them up. Also I don't think is a good type of job if you are desperate for money since in the beginning it sucks, they give you old leads since they don't want you to burn bridges with new clients but as soon as you start to book appointments the leads get better, but it take time and lots of calls. I'm not a native english speaker and although I was scared about calling people, as long as you are nice and respectful they will be nice to you. I even make sure to let the ones that dont want to be bothered to know that I will make sure to exclude them from the leads so they wont get calls again, they really appreciate. So before you look for a new company, no matter which one you go, you gotta found a good branch and team, that's gonna make a huge difference, in the end of the day they are all the same. Also, the ones that offers some salary usually sucks in the commission, at least in my case the commission from the get go is already 50% so is not that bad. try to get a normal job, save some money to be good for a couple months and then try again... not having the pressure to have to make money ASAP can makes things easier on you. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and/mra1242/

"Yes hoping to hear some good advice soon. I'll tell you from my experience, I wish I would have created a referral network early on. I sat around for 2 years waiting for phone calls from Google searches, maybe had 2-3 realtor friends sent me 1 lead a month. I didn't realize how much work it took to get the referrals it takes to be successful. I'm going balls to the wall now with making relationships with realtors/mortgage brokers/lenders/title agents/etc. — knocking on doors and pitching myself as a go-getter, building my book from scratch, and aspiring to become a recognizable name and face in the area. There were about two offices (out of 6) that thought I was "the cutest thing ever" last week and I have a feeling they can relate to my hustle/want to see me grow. I'm not sure yet, but I think the biggest part of pitching yourself to these people is to be honest with them and tell them you want to grow. I know they always tell you to say "I'll help you get clear to close!", but there are 100's of insurance agents that they could choose over me, why not try to strike a chord emotionally and get them on my side? I want them to WANT to see me grow. That's my two cents anyway."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over/from/oodyhfe/

"I just left that place. I was putting in so much work just for my mentor to rail into everyone about how there wasn't enough effort put in. He had his team logging everything in a master sheet, down to time logged in and out (even though it's 1099) - I was in desperate need of work, late on all my major bills and was barely keeping food on the table with help from community. I disclosed this and his response was "just keep going". He one day went and pulled all my leads after I didn't log on for a few days (that I planned in advance). It was horrible and I'm currently looking on how to utilize my licensing in two states. (I had to get a second state because after telling me they had leads in my current state to get me in, they notified me that they actually didn't.) It's so unethical. And I thought I was genuinely helping people. I'd like to put in some hours on weekends but I've been wary of where to go from here so your post is very enlightening."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fx4zhe/i_hate_american_income_life_aill_so_bad/lqu5p8t/

"Randomly saw a listing on Indeed late at night and applied. Wish it was more of an amazing story but that's basically it. It caught my eye due to personally going through family law issues so I figured why not. I was brought on as their first sales guy. Before they were having the attorneys do the consults to try and sign clients but I took it over. For me it comes far more naturally than selling insurance because I personally relate to people I'm speaking with. I have a talk with them, explain the process and then sign them. It's a good job, bit boring at times but pays really well."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mhbz8u3/

"Started working for a company called selectquote and I was only connecting customers with Medicare part A and B with an licensed agent. I did truly enjoy bonding with the clients but I didn't like the repetitive script every phone call and decided I would love to be the licensed Medicare agent and also get my life insurance license. I've watched a few of your videos and see that this is a great line of business but before stepping in it I need to make sure it's for me. I am a peoples person and great at connecting with others. I guess my question to you would be does it get boring?"

— YouTube · Day in the Life of a Medicare Agent | Lead Generation + some helpful tips · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n06FUKfXV0M&lc=UgzCrndqI38QJ95GBH94AaABAq>

↳ @KinkyStyles1980 (4): "Boring, no. I love helping people. Each day is different. You answer different questions and meet different people. Not boring at all."

↳ @jadaliddell8812 (1): "Thank you I'm excited about finding a class and investing in health and life insurance!!"

↳ @jadaliddell8812 (1): "What book do you recommend for life and health insurance that is great to study if I'm not in a class or anything? What book should I study to completely prepare me for the exam? All the seminars I see available are online and far away from where I stay. How should I go about getting my life and health insurances without getting them free through a company?"

"New medicare sales agent for independent broker, 5 carriers adding more soon. My office is small in upstate NY, they don't give me any leads I do legwork for everything. I would like to buy leads but still feel completely in the dark about what my options are for buying leads, they seem to act like you can't/ should only buy during AEP. Any advice on a winning leads generation formula would be much appreciated."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b6ebes/i_work_for_an_nmo_ask_me_anything/ktdmytc/

"The sales tactics make me laugh 😂 I get them daily via text and email. Also just ignore them. Right to Block and spam they go. No lead is the best or exclusive, it's simply just a request for information. It's expensive data, but also the life blood of building a book. Nor do I desire to be sold on your agency, nor do I desire to recruit people, nor do I want to buy your limited addition leads 🙄"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmtn2/life_insurance_recruiters_are_liars/lodc4di/

"I'm an agent (won't say company) and it's always just a call, voicemail, text and MAYBE an email if I don't get a follow up response. I know that no one REALLY wants to talk to their insurance person/agent. If I don't get a response within the day, I just call the next lead and move on. 9 calls in one day is very weird unless it is something very important for an existing customer"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1skjb3s/insurance_agents_spamming_my_phone/og187eu/

"So, you are saying this won't impact your business? MedicareMillionair said: I want to address our ACA No Call Leads system and the confusion it has created. As a leader in this market we've drawn a lot of attention and we've taken a lot of heat. There have been untruths posted about this system, even on this forum. The funny part of that is these same people have contracted agents that previously worked with us to help create their systems. They change a couple things and then say we don't know what we are doing. Below are a couple points to make regarding NoCall Leads and our system. Our competitors state we are not compliant, this is their ignorance to the rules. We are 100% compliant and this has been proven with our interactions with CMS. We write thousands of deals every week. We've received several inquiries from CMS regarding our business practices. We have addressed these inquiries and been given their blessing. The individuals insinuating we are not compliant are simply ignorant to the rules or, as I suspect, simply working a marketing angle. (these guys don't know what they are doing, so do business with us) Things will change, but we don't know what the changes will be. Recent HHS proposals have been focused more so on DACA Recipients, Transgender Reassignment, Hormone Therapy, Gender Discrimination, but very little in the way of changing the enrollment rules. Having said this, there are items under consideration that will affect what we do. Regarding potential changes, the biggest changes that will affect this system are elimination of electronic consent to enroll, the requirement of all documentation with submission of application. Regarding documentation needed to submit applications; Healthcare.gov does not require all information to be submitted with the application. They want Americans to get access to health insurance immediately. Many of the people insured on zero premium plans don't have the very basics of their information available. That's why they are given time to produce this information. That's why it's compliant to submit applications without this information. What's the biggest issue? AGENTS are the biggest problem regarding this system. The only complaints we've received have been from agents and these go away immediately. The only people complaining about our system on the internet are agents. Agents will create the issues for other agents, not the consumer. This is reminiscent of the foolish agents/gurus, that for many years, said "Don't sell Medicare Advantage or you might lose your license". That was a big lie and only hurt agents. By the way, most of those agents now market or sell MAPD. They certainly provide it to their downline. We are insuring tens of thousands of people. Many of these people would not be insured without us. Our agents are earning tens of thousands of dollars every month. We are quite content to push forward. Click to expand..."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA - NoCall Leads Compliance · 2 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-nocall-leads-compliance.110703/#post-1455769>

"It's not a pipe dream but I definitely understand where you're coming from, at my old agency I was a top writer in the country for health, and I was netting maybe \$3K a month tops after my lead spend and CRM usage. I started looking elsewhere and was lucky enough to find a new agency writing life with free leads and a free CRM, commissions were a bit lower than before, but not having to pay for anything more than made up for it. My first week I managed to make \$4200, pure profit, and working FT it's possible to do \$10K a week, not spending a dime. If I hadn't found this agency I was gonna give up, I was putting out applications to warehouses and coffee shops thinking I was gonna go right back to square one. There are places out there that can provide more support and resources, you sound like you're a good salesman, you just aren't being given the environment to thrive. We've got agents working 20 hours and making 6 figures, it's not the industry, it's just the BS a lot of these FMOs force on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbggg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a_hfcdph/

"I'm interested in seeing what responses you get, as in my experience, nobody is really compensating agents fairly right now. Additionally there's legislation in the pipeline that will more than likely have a lot of FMO's and IMO's closing up for Medicare sales as they won't be able to charge administrative fees (from my understanding) on top of taking a cut of your commissions. I've also been encountering a lot of MLM sounding "agencies." They become easier to spot once you recognize their goal is to recruit lol. The one thing I can't stand is these agencies refusing to release your appointments for months. For that I will definitely recommended staying far away from Assurance IQ who recruits agents by outright lying about the commissions you'll be looking forward to and then now looking to hold appointments for 120 days! Anyhow, good luck! Hoping we get some more optimistic answers in here lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/ksvk3d/

"I've been hearing mixed things on inbound, and would love to try but unfortunately given the financial situation I'm in now I can't buy any more leads even if they are inbound. I would feel better about it but the vast majority of the people I spoke to that are tenured have told me it takes between 6-12 months just to become profitable. I don't have that kind of runway. But I pray it goes well for you! Please check back in and let me know how things are going I'm genuinely interested to hear how you do by sticking it out!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourbvaq/

A book of business and renewals that pay every year · 24 documents · 20 voices

"Having done Medicare, I'd do ACA. Your odds are high that you will write the entire family versus Medicare where it's mostly one person. While you can sometimes do husband and wife enrollments it's very rare. Your goal is to build residual income. Plus, no longer dealing with pain the butt elderly people with a 2 minute attention span wanting \$5k/month in food cards who change policies multiple times per year is a bonus. I'm thankful for the experience in Medicare because it really does teach you to overcome objections and pivot pitch. Beyond that, I would never want to sell it again."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kmjoeg/whats_better_aca_or_medicare_sales/msbxwrl/

"For me it's, \$611 up front for MAPD and \$306 renewals in January. Med Supp Im about \$550 when you factor in PDP. My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare. Add in annuities, FE, CHAS, etc. Being rich depends on the person."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 5 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991>

"Picking apart this story, I have a few things I want to point out: 1) Do as much research as possible into whoever you're going to interview with. Glassdoor, customer reviews, news articles that may or may not feature the company, etc. If you have to pay for your own leads, but only from company approved sources, stay away. Either they let you build your book your way or they provide you leads to work. 2) Never. Ever. Trust the "can make up to \$x/mo" line. What some of these companies do is hire anyone who comes in, milk the bottom tier until they leave, and promote up people who either pull deals out of thin air OR are really good at recruiting. The recruiter can probably make \$10k/mo by bringing in people to buy leads, like they did you. If some policies get written in the process, all the better. 3) If you know it's a Pyramid scheme, why even take the job? 4) Ask important questions during the interview, such as if the job is 1099 or W2. Where do the leads come from? What am I financially responsible for? Do you have any affiliations with major carriers? If it's 1099 and you're responsible for purchasing leads, do you have the freedom to purchase from where you'd like or are you restricted to those same old "approved provider" sources? My personal favorite thing to do is whenever I'm asked about a previous work story of any kind, I try to use something shady I've witnessed to get their reaction. My go to is a guy who took \$6k from an old woman who was still receiving notices from her recently passed son's tax debts. One phone call and a faxed death certificate fixed the whole problem, and this dude was proud of fleecing the old lady. If they get excited about that sort of mentality, don't go with them. Pursue agencies that balances sales volume with professional integrity, rather than closing as many deals as possible and hoping at least 50% make it to a yearly renewal, if that. 5) You will not find one industry that doesn't have cockroaches giving a bad name to the rest. My parents don't trust flooring installers they don't know personally, because they last time they hired someone to re-floor their kitchen and dining room, \$500 of jewelry mysteriously disappeared. 6) From my own experience, if you apply and get invited to an "informational meeting where we break down what we do and how before you decide to go to the next phase of the hiring process", view it as a massive red flag. Having a "short meeting to get to know each other and see if we can do business together" is fine, if not unconventional, but informational lectures as the first stage of hiring just screams "sketchy". Best of luck in whatever direction you'd go in, but I'd recommend maintaining your license and fulfilling your state requirements to keep it. Can always come in handy, no matter what you do. I let mine lapse after a rough gig and it's been a headache to get back now that I'm my current employer."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/lc9vldd/

"Looking for advice on starting an independent brokerage Hey everybody, Captive producer going on two years in production at SF. Licensed in P&C and L&H. Goal was always to start an agency (captive or independent) after gaining some good experience; however, due to circumstances out of my control, it looks like I'll need to make that jump sooner rather than later. I'm located in Colorado. I've averaged \$45k in premium a month with 5-7 life policies working 32 hours a week solely on internet leads (Everquote and Quote wizard, plus my captives leads that come in). Due to some personal things I've been dealing with in the past 2 years, I'd say my prospecting and overall activity has been half-assed at best. Prior to this, I worked as a finance director/Sales manager in dealerships for 13 years, so hiring, firing, training, placing loans with banks, working long hours etc. are all very familiar to me. I assume this experience should translate well to the independent world. I'm working through a business plan now and have hit a few bumps on the road. I'm planning on primarily personal lines, though I'll sell life and health incidentally and hopefully land some large commercial accounts as well 1) I'm looking at Agentero Elite and First Connect as aggregators. Does anyone know if they can be enrolled in simultaneously? Agentero has some non-standard carriers I'd like access to, but First Connect seems to be the standard as far as commissions, fees and payment. 2) I'll lean heavily on Facebook Ads for marketing, but of course plan on building a referral pipeline and supplement with paid leads to keep me busy dialing the phone. Can this be done initially around \$1500/month? Or is that spend too low? 3) Outside of setting up a commission account, PFA, obtaining my LLC, and purchasing E&O, am I missing any major components? I'm looking at different AMS platforms (First Connect provides a discount on EZlynx), but might wait 6 months or so before enrolling unless I absolutely need it immediately. 4) Goal is to end the first year with \$500,000 in premium with an average 12% commission. Hoping to average 8% on renewals and shooting for a retention around 85% before scaling and employing a CSR and an additional 1099 producer. Is this realistic? Too high or low? Hiring too fast? Thanks in advance for any answers and advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/

"I'm gonna say this again... There are better internet leads out there if you know where to find them. It's not gonna be a mega corp like Smart Financial... 3-5% close shows that they are recycled non exclusive bullshit. I asked a rep and she basically told me so herself. Very pushy sales tactics like your expected to just say yes... anyways. I digress. I have a lead vendor once that ran adds through radio and online click for quote, the ones that responded (75%~), my close ratio was 80%. Unfortunately, these are highly exclusive and hard to come by BUT, my point is... fuck smart financial and if you use your wits a bit and think outside the box, you can have the business come to you. I've seen it happen in a VERY beautiful way. Wish I was still at that company sometimes since I lost my book (I was pretty green about laws regarding that). But I know the blueprint 🙌"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfr/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/ot6ab8m/

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 00000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at AIL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"Best strategy to start selling health insurance (Medicare + ACA) Hi everyone, I recently earned my accident & health license and I am excited to begin my journey as a health insurance agent. I am still in the early stages of learning how the sales process and industry work, so I would appreciate any advice or insights from experienced colleagues. My goal is to build residual income by focusing on health insurance (either ACA or Medicare). For ACA, I am considering using HealthSherpa for their platform and training resources. For Medicare, I am thinking of starting with 1 or 2 carriers as a captive to access knowledge. I look at this as a short-term plan (about 6 months) to build a solid foundation to then transition to a broker or agency to access multiple carriers to provide best plan and maybe better commissions. Does this sound like a good plan? Are there downsides of going captive with more than 1 carrier? I see some offer AHIP certification discount, should I take it? I would love to hear your thoughts and any suggestions you might have. Thank you so much!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i3ms00/best_strategy_to_start_selling_health_insurance/

"Sounds like you've been there because you are spot on! I've been there and seen it first hand. Not all of them do the leads buy, but absolutely use friends and family to expand network reach to tap into a new market. There is always a pay to play aspect and very minimal trainings on sales / products because your growth isn't based on sales (some will argue this and they do but they're wrong). Literally, to increase your commission level, you must recruit. You can be the most knowledgeable sales rep and a product guru and if you don't recruit, you are considered a failure. It's all about getting you in in some emotional vulnerability and then keep moving the goal post. I swear I am going to write a book about this one day, I just feel it. It's very predatory. Psychological manipulation all in all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nps4lyw/

"in California (at least) - a Medicare Agent with 150 Clients on their books is \$5400 a month or \$64,800 a year in residuals. It's very doable as "part time" if you grind to get that 150 on your book and service. for what it's worth, I started Medicare Summer of 2024 - so about 2 years doing it full time now. I currently have about 160 on my book of business. but it is a looooooong process in terms of grinding everyday. I am looking forward to Jan 2027 for the 160 book renewals. prior to that I had about 300 ACA . but have since slowed down on the ACA. Still service them - but use it more to transition my under 65 to medicare once they reach 65."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/p686xku/

"Beautiful, good for them, I'd love to reach that range or even a fraction of it one day. Even if they got a killer deal at \$1 per lead that's 700-900 per day. OMG that's a well funded mega agency that's grown well. Hope they pay you well and you get your hand in the renewals eventually. I'd be out of business if I had to pay for leads before now so it was all organic marketing and outreach."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/nixjsfb/

"HELP - P&C I'm currently working toward my P&C license in South Carolina and plan to start my own independent agency once I pass. I currently have a successful career in app design, and my wife already runs a very successful Medicare business. We're now looking to partner and build an agency together, with me focusing primarily on the P&C side. My goal is to own the book from day one and build something long term under our own name. I've been researching direct carrier appointments versus joining an agency network or aggregator. I've looked into First Connect, Smart Choice SC, Firefly and SIAA, but I'm seeing mixed opinions everywhere. For those who have actually started an independent agency from scratch, what route did you take? Would you recommend trying for direct appointments immediately, joining a network first, or using a combination of both? Any help is appreciated"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wnhsew/help_pc/

"No, i am employed by a company so my residue and commission are no good because of my salary. However, once I get my book of business, which my goal is 200, then i go 1099. The company provides all the leads at no cost."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1h0xwsw/which_insurance_sales_is_known_for_the_best/lzecvug/

"This is a very good question. I'll speak from the life and health industry being a daily grind agent for roughly ten years and more of an agency builder/operator for another ten. I've been in a zoom room with several dozen of the largest FMO's for L&H in the US. We were all asked to quickly share our biggest pain point. What happened has stuck with me for the last couple years since. Every single one of the FMO's said the exact same thing. They all had 80% turn over of their agent force per year. I'd always known the 8% number generally for the agency, which I believe is partly that bad because of some of the life insurance MLMs, but it was still amazing to hear from the horses mouth like that. These FMOs represent tens of thousands of agents. There were a few agencies in that group. We didn't have the same answer. I don't remember what each of us said, but, other than I think one agency, it wasn't retention. My father did very well as an agent and then an agency builder for Prudential, Met Life, BMA, in the 80's and 90's when the primary model was brick and mortar agencies with local management and mentorship owned by upline carriers. Retention has ALWAYS been a challenge in the insurance industry largely because it has such promise but such a low initial barrier to entry. That is the #1 reason. Too many people under-estimate the work they will have to do in return for the financial upside. In the last 25 years, though, technology has allow brokers to flourish in comparison to the 80's and 90's. Tech has helped overcome much of the administrative complexity of accessing a wide range of carriers. But the cost has been the erosion of mentorship. This was further exacerbated by some of the big companies becoming poorly managed, either with sick cultures (Bankers after Conseco buy out), bad CEOs (Beneficial Life), a lack of vision to adapt (imo Prudential, NYL, NWM, and many, many old school captives), or even economic tidal waves (Met Life after 2008). All of those companies are shadows of what they used to be. In their place now are FMO/IMOs as the most influential model today. I refer to most of them as 'contract collectors'. They are very, very much in the business of gobbling up as many agent contracts as possible to add to their books and hope they sell something. They focus on scale. This is not bad by itself, but I believe the people running these organizations don't know how to train and support agents at the most human level. By and large, they never (successfully) got in a car over and over and over again with agents to drive to customer houses to sell insurance - successfully. The art and science of developing individual human agents from the ground up and providing effective support has become elusive to a very large portion of the industry. About 5-10% of the people entering the industry will be successful almost no matter the model they land with. They might tumble with some of the worst, but they're made of something special and find success no matter what. 20-30% of people entering will not be successful no matter what. They simply cannot show up to work without the threat of being fired or they may not have or be able to develop the communication skills. Great teachers, trainers, and mentors are determined by what they do with the remaining 75-60% of new agents. The problem is that there's not a lot of those people. Some of them are also now behind screens talking to large audiences and the scale simply dilutes the impact they can have with any individual. There are a number of pieces I think the ideal career model should be made up of, but german to this question is the healthy, talented, and experienced mentor who is there day to day - and that is probably the most valuable piece regardless of the rest of the model."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wq22lv/are_retention_issues_really_one_of_the_biggest/pc0pmby/

"You're honestly in a better spot than most people making this jump, you already know how to sell and you've got real production behind it, so this isn't theoretical for you. On the aggregator side, you can usually sit with both Agentero and First Connect at the same time, just be mindful of overlapping carrier access and how you're submitting business so you don't create conflicts. One thing people don't tell you early is that if you build a big book through First Connect, it can be tough to peel those relationships off later and go direct with carriers. You're basically renting access, which is fine early on, just know that's the tradeoff if you scale hard inside their system. The \$1,500 a month on Facebook ads will work to get the phone ringing, especially with your background, but it won't carry the whole operation long term. It's a good way to stay busy dialing, but the real money comes from building something that feeds itself, referrals, organic presence, and just being visible where your clients already hang out. Paid leads keep you afloat, organic builds the business. You've got most of the setup handled, the only thing I'd really stress is having a consistent process from day one. Not fancy, just repeatable. How you quote, how you follow up, how you close, and how you check back in later. That's what turns your 85 percent retention goal into something real instead of something you hope happens. The \$500k first year goal is doable based on what you're already producing, the bigger risk isn't hitting the number, it's what that book looks like on the back end. If you stay disciplined on follow up and don't let stuff fall through the cracks, you'll be fine there. I wouldn't rush into hiring. Most people bring on a CSR too early and end up paying for service work they could've handled themselves while they're still trying to stabilize revenue. Once service actually starts slowing down your ability to write new business, that's when it makes sense. At the end of the day you're not trying to prove you can sell, you've already done that. You're trying to build something that works the same way every time so you're not starting from scratch on every deal. That's the difference between being busy and actually building something that scales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/ohf1e06/

"Solo until book hits \$500k is the goal. With a \$900 policy average and 2.5 policies per household, I expect anything beyond that will require a dedicated CSR so I can focus on generating new business. Once that CSR is beginning to get overwhelmed, the plan would be to find a hybrid CSR/producer, and transition them into a full time producer after hiring another CSR. I think I might be overly optimistic, but I'd love to quote 250 households in 90 days. I average 4.87 quotes a day in my current role but only working 4 days a week (and realistically, only engaged 3-4 hours out of 8). I think 3 a day, 6 days a week is a bit optimistic depending on lead and referral flow, but ultimately manageable if I can get the leads. Closing 25% at a \$900 average with 2.5 policies per would put me at \$526k year 1 before any lapse. I would hope compounding referrals and the renewal premium would be enough to support a CSR, although doing the math, I may need to start them part time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/odz3hvr/

"Because of the set up costs / cost of lead gen is so high now, that they make up the thin margins with volume. The higher volume agencies / FMO's that use these systems have better pricing than what's advertised. You're better off going grass roots - boots on the ground. List your website everywhere you can (use citations - Whitespark offers that service to boost your Google Business Profile), list your name on all the [free Medicare broker directories](<https://mymedicarebroker.com/why-join>), make sure you inner link your website pages (use overall good SEO tactics), dominate your local town / city as much as possible. The "I just want warm, inbound calls" era is over, unless you have VERY DEEP pockets and can weather low ROI until residuals kick in."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/p6u43y0/

"Hi Luis, Brandy Cameron. I have subscribed to your channel and love your videos, I also signed up for Shaun's course so I have your work flows. You have great content, I'm planning to get agent CRM soon but wondered if you have a slide show presentation you use with a client, or is it your smart book you use, I'm wondering how to use a presentation to help cross sell more, any thought about buying your books but wanted your opinion, if you have a presentation I would love to see it and your intake form as well. This video was so helpful and sending out that intake form may help me to. Thank you, keep up the good work. 😊"

— YouTube · 📌 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 📌 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cLRWdaqypkc&lc=UgzAEaxYtDigwh7Ox94AaABA>

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Here is the link to to get the ACA and/or Smartbooks: <https://simplyhealthinsurance.thinkific.com/>";

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "thank you for watching and commenting"

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "I am going make a video this week on cross selling. Stay tuned!! I assume this for cross selling ancillaries to ACA book?"

"I can not express how much I appreciate your time in that response and wish I got more insight like this (also would love to know what books you suggest). I want to learn as much and be able to offer as much as possible so I can lead with value and not push just one type of product to make money which is why I want 6, 63, 7, maybe tax professional, 65, ect. Now I need to look more into this and also anything for the paid-up adds because I would like to have my world rocked also. Anything specific you or anyone else can share about that or where to look? Thank you so much!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wo7uzv/new_career_agent_what_should_i_be_learning_to/pc0hh98/

"Hi, Thanks Luis for your the help! can you please mention what other cities or states are good to get licensed to do Obamacare! im stay-at-home mom and i would like to increased my book of bussines. Thaks a lot!"

— YouTube · FREE LEADS!! How to get free leads for ACA "Obamacare" · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sBopPuhBx74&lc=Ugzm0Sc_AMwj6k-fqnB4AaABA

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Here is map with carriers in each state. I would focus on the dark blue states which are FFM states and you only need 1 certification. You can also use Healthsherpa for all these states <https://messengerfinancial.com/our-products/under-65-aca>";

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Are you already contracted? We can help you with contracts if you need them. Email me: luis@360insurancegroup.com"

"This is a completely unsolicited review of ACA Express and solely my opinion: I went through the demo video last night and am enrolling in the standard package today (no set up, no monthly, \$20 per app)-this is truly a no brainer for a single producer. I give ACA Express enormous credit on this because they have figured out a great business model-they built in a supplemental benefits option (called Out of Pocket Protector) that, if only added on 10% of the apps, will more than pay the application fees in full for using the system for the first year and provide an on-going stream of income in future years (renewal commissions on the lowest level package are 20% or \$200 per year). For them, of course, as an upline, they get the overrides on all of these sales and I'm sure this will be a significant revenue stream. Just a quickie on the Out of Pocket Protector-it is a typical gap plan, the base premium for an individual is \$69 per month (\$89 for a couple) and includes about \$300 a year in 'routine benefits' for office visits and lab tests-so the actual cost is about \$45 per month Individual and \$39 per month (couple) for all of the other stuff (figure an Accident indemnity plan plus benefits for hospital stays, outpatient surgery, and \$250 for an ER visit) and not a bad deal-I wish there was a critical illness rider that could be added, that would make it even better. In addition to the Standard package they do have a Pro package that is more for call centers and agencies with multiple agents with a monthly fee and lower fee per app. On a scale of 1-10, I give ACA Express an initial 9.2 (if they could eliminate carriers on the agent facing website it would be a 9.9-nothing is a '10' except Bo Derek about 35 years ago)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACAexpress.com · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/acaexpress-com.69122/#post-910567>

Six figures and the freedom that comes with it · 14 documents · 14 voices

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

"I need a realistic understanding of what I can make as salary. So to break it down, I work for an agency I make \$40k salary full benefits plus a cruddy bonus structure, I'll probably end up hitting \$65k maybe \$70k with overtime and bonus during OEP I sell ACA plans thru the market place and state exchanges in 16 different states along with gap coverage and STP's. I really hate the 9-5 hours and I have an hour drive to the office. I want to go 1099 very badly but I don't have any understanding on how I would get paid or what the pay would be since my company takes care of that for me and I came into the insurance business thru them. I want to be able to profit at least \$65k, what would this take? I have about 100 clients in my book of business here, what would that translate to if I was independent? What are some numbers people are bringing in just selling ACA plans? Whats the average commission? Tips tricks? Anything would help. My company is crunching numbers and basically asking everyone to either step up and match the top 2% of agents at the company or they're getting the boot... I need a plan"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k042ke/i_need_a_realistic_understanding_of_what_i_can/

"Going independent...suggestions? Hello! I currently sell Medicare advantage and looking to go independent for more opportunity and flexibility (less administrative work thrown on me that has absolutely nothing to do with Medicare). For those of you that sell Medicare from home: what services and software platforms do you use? Which up line do you use? Should I invest in a CRM right away or wait? It's \$75/month for AgencyBloc. Should I get the commissions processing module for an additional \$125/month? Phone system.... RingCentral is like \$30 a month and has calling and texting so I think I might go this route. Other suggestions? Any ideas for marketing to get started? I know my up line can spend some. I would like to work entirely remote if possible. Most people just turning 65 are decent enough with technology. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17mm0vw/going_independentsuggestions/

"I actually see this sort of soulless behavior with very large commercial producers. Not all of them, not by any stretch. But I have ran commercial divisions where producers who bring in a lot of revenue are allowed to behave however they want. Practice quoting, dumping huge amounts of work on senior staff last minute in the name of hoping to get a \$500k revenue account, no screening at all, just looking at the dollars. Putting business with surplus lines simply for a shifting cost, etc. This happens quite a bit in southern CA. These brokers like to refer to themselves as cowboys, making the market work for them, etc. Don't think for a second it's not happening at the large PE backed firms. 100% is. And I'm talking about people who are millionaires at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rek2rd/be_honest_how_many_of_you_lost_your_soul_in_this/o7d7aza/

"a company is offering me a 1099 position at \$200 per sale flat, selling medicare supplements following a script. he said most of his agents do 1-2 per day and some doing 3-4 per day, my goal is just to make at least \$80k per year. is this a decent enough sounding gig?"

— YouTube · How To Make \$500k A Year As A Medicare Agent In 2023! (Medicare Sales Training) · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmppgLPuqeQ&lc=UgyD78lmLKnoYjUPmUp4AaABag>

↳ @deerlow1851 (1): "@oddjhi I made \$3000 my first week closing and i now make on average anywhere from 1200 to 4500 every week. during OE it's on the higher side of that more often."

↳ @deerlow1851 (1): "@oddjhi Although I am apparently exceptional as I have been top of the boards every week since I started"

↳ @oddjhi (0): "How did it go. Just curious?"

"For me it's, \$611 up front for MAPD and \$306 renewals in January. Med Supp Im about \$550 when you factor in PDP. My goal each year is \$100k FYC plus my renewals in Medicare. Add in annuities, FE, CHAS, etc. Being rich depends on the person."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Does anyone really get "rich" selling Medicare · 5 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/does-anyone-really-get-rich-selling-medicare.113372/#post-1494991>

"My goal is to reach 10k a month. I know it takes some time to get there and I'm in it for the long haul. I have some side gigs I can do on the side while I grow my business. Are you referring to ACA and Medicare? I'm still learning the products, plans and enrollment periods. Hoping I can get the hang of this soon."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j31y96/how_much_money_can_you_expect_to_make_first_year/mfx13wi/

"You're honestly in a better spot than most people making this jump, you already know how to sell and you've got real production behind it, so this isn't theoretical for you. On the aggregator side, you can usually sit with both Agentero and First Connect at the same time, just be mindful of overlapping carrier access and how you're submitting business so you don't create conflicts. One thing people don't tell you early is that if you build a big book through First Connect, it can be tough to peel those relationships off later and go direct with carriers. You're basically renting access, which is fine early on, just know that's the tradeoff if you scale hard inside their system. The \$1,500 a month on Facebook ads will work to get the phone ringing, especially with your background, but it won't carry the whole operation long term. It's a good way to stay busy dialing, but the real money comes from building something that feeds itself, referrals, organic presence, and just being visible where your clients already hang out. Paid leads keep you afloat, organic builds the business. You've got most of the setup handled, the only thing I'd really stress is having a consistent process from day one. Not fancy, just repeatable. How you quote, how you follow up, how you close, and how you check back in later. That's what turns your 85 percent retention goal into something real instead of something you hope happens. The \$500k first year goal is doable based on what you're already producing, the bigger risk isn't hitting the number, it's what that book looks like on the back end. If you stay disciplined on follow up and don't let stuff fall through the cracks, you'll be fine there. I wouldn't rush into hiring. Most people bring on a CSR too early and end up paying for service work they could've handled themselves while they're still trying to stabilize revenue. Once service actually starts slowing down your ability to write new business, that's when it makes sense. At the end of the day you're not trying to prove you can sell, you've already done that. You're trying to build something that works the same way every time so you're not starting from scratch on every deal. That's the difference between being busy and actually building something that scales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/ohf1e06/

"Worked for them about 3 months... When I was first starting they said it was a hybrid role which I was looking forward to, 2 days in office and the other 3 were remote and that hours were flexible. Working on getting licensed they were constantly texting me asking how studying was going, I need to schedule my exam etc. Once I passed I started immediately got handed all kinds of their training videos and scripts. Then I was paired with a "trainer" was taught how look for prospects and to call using the scripts. If there was no appointments set, they would ask why and force you to put your next calls on speaker so they knew what was being said or use you as an example for the next training. On non-office days I was expected to be door knocking or continue calling while my trainer drove to appointments, or they door knocked which I told them I was planning on calling or running any app over the phone or zoom since it was a hybrid remote role. Fast forward, they are constantly on you even though you're 1099 and the "flexible schedule" does not exist. After leaving, a couple life policies I was split in were canceled and completely re-written, so my trainer could have the full commission. I tried to return some fact finders, but seems like most people there have blocked me, texted and called the secretary sent me to VM and left me on read. Texted the director but completely deleted me the response "who is this" after saying who it was, I got left on read, tried reaching out again but seems like I got blocked."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/pbpkn7i/

"Love the math breakdown. I've done this in my head recently and that helped me get a clearer picture of what it takes for my production levels to look the way I need.

Example: If I want to write \$40k a month in premium, I need to quote \$100k a month and have a 40% conversion ratio. My plan is to find, quote, and touch 2 new leads a day. If each lead averages \$3,000 in premium, multiply by two for each day, multiply for 31 days in a month, that's \$186,000 in quoted premium. Problem is, all the leads I have right now are old leads that didn't buy. Eventually that will run dry. Hopefully going balls to the walls with referrals pays off soon."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over/ooega4z/

"Chris Donnelly said: Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think! Click to expand... They both post here so maybe you'll get some direct responses."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · 4 reactions · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444479>

"Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444478>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Friends and family pressure (the warm market) · 46 documents · 20 voices

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I *me*, the *salesperson* am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"I'm a captive Medicare agent, formerly a life/health broker and I have zero interest in going back to the 1099 life. I get PTO, I work from home, I just sit here and take calls all day and I get to truly clock out and spend time with my family instead of always feeling like I should be dialing leads. I'm a carrier rep and made \$130k last year, on pace to break \$150k this year. So yea, the broker path has a higher ceiling but w-2 isn't poverty."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1v1wdq6/why_would_anybody_want_to_be_a_captive_agent/oyqslzd/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

"A joining fee of 200 dollars not for licensing just to recruit you.... you have to pay 250 per month to use there software because its there rules. You have to pay for there leads only that they sell to you. (Not bad but varies, use google) They tell you we will start you at 25% commision then you have to recruit family or friends or people then we will raise your commision to 50%. Sell to family and only sell to family (not a bad thing but please be human about it) but they keep urging you to only sell to friends over and over like a broken record to the point you pitch to family and friends and they leave you because you're being annoying. Hearing key words as lifetime income being stretched and always going crazy on hura hura meetings and not actually teaching you how to sell. No one teaches you how a needs analysis works or what it is. Them always saying you will be a millionaire and showing so much money to glorify the idea. Granted yes agents can make this bank but lets think about this logically why are they showing these expensive things to us? Kind of suspicious? Sorry if i have disrespected any agency in any sort of way but this is my unbiased point of view on the industry as a whole."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest_nprizd4/

"I remember those days. I was trained by big mega life and the thought was just write and see what happens. When I went indie I set my agency up as a traditional life, health and p and c shop. I did a fair amount of health prior to the aca but it was so hard telling people that hey would not get coverage if any pre existing condition. I tried explaining that if you take anything other than Tylenol you were screwed. My wife had a preexisting condition and my state did not allow one man group so I was stuck stay in with golden rule until the aca came out. All the negative talk from family and friends regarding "Obamacare " would infuriate me. You could not explain to people just how bad the lack of a system was. I ended up going to the state exchange for myself so I stopped selling health completely (p and c renewals are my comp) and just started to send clients there. I'm semi retired now and my office does no health at all. But thankfully the aca has not been terminated."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1byrtj/

"The lack of financial knowledge is on purpose. If they can sell you that you need to work yourself to death so you can afford basic human needs, they can certainly sell you that you shouldn't want healthcare even if you're going broke paying for life saving medication. If ACA had existed in the early 2000's, my grandmother would've been able to afford her cancer screenings and treatments, and my family wouldn't have lost their house because they had to take a predatory mortgage loan to try to afford her treatment; and she probably wouldn't have died, either."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lr23yx/the_big_beautiful_bill_passed_here_are_the/n1b7yb1/

"I think people don't understand what was considered pre-existing. It's not just chronic health conditions. Did you ever buy health insurance on the open market? I did. My family had body parts excluded. Had an ovarian cyst once, my ovaries were not covered. Etc. ACA is not perfect, but it's better than what it was. Universal healthcare is probably the better system, but too many people get rich off of sick people for that to ever happen."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lr23yx/the_big_beautiful_bill_passed_here_are_the/n1b563e/

"Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out." Get out of here with that nonsense. DVH is an easy add on and you should be able to close 30% no problem. As for the MAPD's, the carrier doesn't want those plans sold, so find the next best thing that pays and make it happen. Regarding PDP's, it's a courtesy, and you shouldn't expect to get paid on them, you'll get paid by referral business if you do it right, and that is worth so much more than what you get paid. The money is in the grind my man. Just continue to do right by your clients and they will send friends and family to you. That's where you will find success. Don't get caught up selling the cheapest (Ace, Allstate) for obvious reasons, sell the quality product, attach a STC, DVH, HIP. There's plenty of ancillary products complement the health products. Just my two cents."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msspech/

"I am physically disabled working from home. I would not be able to work 20-hours a week without bed rest intermediately. As a 1099 for life and health insurance, I'll be doing mock interviews with my family and friends. I plan on doing a lot of research on all of my products and the industry. I'm not worried about leads, because my previous job is resourceful. For someone in my situation, do you have any additional training advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5ges4r/

"You dont have to buy leads. You can hit up your warm market, you can get call lists (cheap) and go door knock, etc. Yes leads are great but you don't "need" leads to sell a policy. I began calling lists and setting appointments, and then door knocking those neighbors. Now I operate on referrals and generate all my own leads from various sources. Do you have any capital to spend?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/jy8zoyl/

"Have a team of few hundred agents , the goal we set for agents is to write at least one policy a day if you are new. If you have been here for more than 90 days 2 policies a day. If you have been here for 6 months 3 policies a day. If you are a veteran agent the goal is 5-10 policies a day. The average policy is to 1000AP. So the question you need to solve first is do you have more time or do you have more money right now? Most agents have a lot more time than money. The next problem is that you need to know how to develop your skillset before you burn all of your marketing capital. You can take the slow route of forming referral partners, warm market, bingo nights etc. unless you are a boring 60yr old who started 20 years ago this isn't the move. Embrace the times, it's all about internet leads, a lead driven business, there is an endless amount of people to talk to and pitch insurance. It has never been easier. When we started it was suits and kitchen tables, now any Gen Z with a laptop and a Stiiizy pen can sit in sweatpants with a Stanley and crush \$500-\$1000 a day in deposits like clockwork. It was hard to watch at first considering what use to have to be done, but we have to embrace the times. Tip: start with final expense leads that are less than \$1 , preferably something that is about 15 cents a lead. Yes, it's going to require a ton of dials. You will have to put a bunch of sweat work in before you get paid. I tell my kids , in order for you to start selling 2-3 policies a week in your first month, you need to spend 15 hours a day on the phone for a good 7-10 days in a row to develop some grit. Then someone can start working with you. The next most important thing is who you marry? It's not the IMO , it's not the carrier, it's not the comp plan , you need a solid mentor who can work with you daily and give you feedback. This will cut down the learning curve by 50%, having someone who sells at a high level giving you feedback is priceless. Accept that you can work your tail off and still not make 10k in your first month. That is ok, you are nothing less. Understand that when you have put enough time and reps in the 10k will come easy. Then you will start chasing the 20k, 30k and 40k of Deposits ; it's not that hard to write 10,000-20,000 AP a week. The hardest thing is going from 0-10,000 consistently. Once you have your skill set somewhat polished then you just scale up the marketing. Wish you the best , get after it !"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/nof72gg/

"That's the way they lie to tell you you not making cold calls, cuz someone has texted them from their family! The agency doesn't give you leads they pay for. They take yours! They asked me for 10 or more of my friends, and family. Shouldn't I be using my own contacts for me, and my possible success? THIS IS A SCHEME! I did this for over a month making thousands of calls to their horrible lead list, that if you delete them all too fast for not answering, you are stuck with no list til they rotate the lists and give you someone else's exhausted list! Money days are ONLY if you write policies! There is no advance as they call it, or bonus! Your manager ain't giving you anything! 9 times out of 10 they wrote 1 or 2 good policies, and were elevated to manager, not having any experience how to manage a team! I am still trying to dig myself out of the whole that they put me in financially! And I quit June of 2024! You are going to get thrown out there to do your first demo, with NO prior practice, and your manager sitting there on the call, basically telling people, she don't know what she doing, which straps the potential customer of all their confidence in you, and they are less like to buy a policy, or share any of their family and friends' information! They, knowing there were no policies to write in MO, hired me, made me pay for the exam, only to tell me they gave nothing in MO! I was furious! Now they wanted me to pay for a Texas license. When I refused they paid for it, but I still never made a dime. DONT WASTE YOUR TIME!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/mhwzr5v/

"I started with Globe & left after 6 months with 2 state licenses. Learned lots but not enough to go solo -- that's not part of the program. Landed at Symmetry as an independent. Now, 8 states and multiple carriers later, I'm learning TONS about all kinds of aspects: Products, sales & genuinely helping people, Customer Service - referrals, warm market and servicing, leads - evaluating vendors, purchasing, engaging & closing, in-depth use of insurance products for retirement & financial security...and the list goes on. Is there a grind? Absolutely, there always is. Am I alone in it? Not even close. I understand your anger...I've been there. My best recommendation is to evaluate what YOU want from this industry and let them go. They couldn't help you then and they won't be helping you now so just drop the extra head trash & move forward to where you want to be. You were fired up enough to write this post. You are fired up enough to find your tribe and run at this business with everything you've got! Wishing you well my friend!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/mducvjo/

"Sounds like you've been there because you are spot on! I've been there and seen it first hand. Not all of them do the leads buy, but absolutely use friends and family to expand network reach to tap into a new market. There is always a pay to play aspect and very minimal trainings on sales / products because your growth isn't based on sales (some will argue this and they do but they're wrong). Literally, to increase your commission level, you must recruit. You can be the most knowledgeable sales rep and a product guru and if you don't recruit, you are considered a failure. It's all about getting you in in some emotional vulnerability and then keep moving the goal post. I swear I am going to write a book about this one day, I just feel it. It's very predatory. Psychological manipulation all in all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p1o3ii/if_youre_an_insurance_agent_whats_the_biggest/nps4lyw/

"New agent at New York Life Hello I am a 22 year old new agent at New York life. I passed all my tests and want to make money. They want me to sell to my natural market but I have gone through everyone and none are future clients. What are the best ways to get more clients as I start. I do not have a great market because most of my friends and past coworkers are in their 20s. I am leaning towards buying a subscription on a website to get warm leads if anyone can add advice if that will work or the best vendors! Thank you"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgfnvq/new_agent_at_new_york_life/

Clients who get angry when they are called · 22 documents · 20 voices

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** — How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** — How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** — How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmhbp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAq

↳ @thomasmorris2245 (6): "Congratulations on your first sale"

↳ @15pluna (4): "hey quick question do you mean the leads are 5-10 yrs old???? impressiiveeee!"

↳ @oExlucive (0): "@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

"I've never bought leads and not made a profit on them. If you are consistently losing money on leads or breaking even, there's something seriously wrong in your process."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/odheug7/

"Ex globe life agent here, and everything you said was correct. Fortunately for me, my lead was a woman who didn't do the gloaty car thing or flashy shenanigans. But everything else yeah. We even got a book for a "book club" which was a self help book written by the ex trainer of Kobe Bryant's (wasn't bad but still). The pitching script of elderly people was a big factor in me leaving, among many other things. You were "coached" to be pushy on people that were blue collar workers, because they made the big bucks. Meanwhile, the not so fortunate retirees of those companies were on a fixed income, yet you were still trying to sell them high premium, shitty contract, whole life policies. Elderly folks were the ones you were told to push the hardest, because they were simply more expensive premiums. Everything that company does is disgusting and they never once taught about the other benefits of life insurance or the financial/tax aspects of life insurance that a client could utilize. Since then, I've gone independent and have done... "decent"... but also had to pick up a full time job to supplement that lost income from being 1099. It's really hard not having your leads provided, and I didn't have the capital to invest in them (or find a reputable company NOT using old/recycled leads). Life insurance is sorta on the back burner while I work, that and I've signed up for information technology/cybersecurity classes that focuses on AI and computer programming. If anything, I hope to bring businesses better systems and structure. And my first market would be the people like me who couldn't figure it out and needed a better program/structure for their business. Anyways, always good to hear badmouthing of shitty insurance companies and the practices they preach. Keep fighting the good fight 🍷"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/omzw0l8/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually "get" the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcm82b/

"My first agency was horrible. They kept telling me dont learn the numbers or the business but just keep recruiting and running old leads. They forbid me from buying new leads even when I had the money and had 6 months experience. Im with a good agency now, but watching that first place scam desperate people was almost enough for me to quit entirely. I still feel bad for recruiting a few people into that when I hadnt made a dime. I ended up blocking my upline because he kept trying to get me to buy the ceo's motivational material. Whole place was like a cult."

— YouTube · 102 Former Insurance Agents Explain Why They Quit [No BS] · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xv8pQ6cZ7oU&lc=UgwnbxaP7SOajk2jFuV4AaABAq>

↳ @TheDIGAgency (1): "Good job sticking it out. Lots of people share a similar story."

↳ @danbushnell8043 (0): "Lemme guess, A to the I to the L"

"I don't know a single person that has ever had success with purchased leads. The exception to that might be the Dave Ramsey leads, but I believe they run 10k/year. Also, you have to subscribe to his mindset, which unless you are talking about debt, is a hard "pass" for most professionals. The exception to the lead situation would be a company like Prudential or one of the mutuals perhaps where you the leads that are generated come from an existing relationship with the company. In a sense, they are "warm" leads. Purchased leads are usually frigid cold. The person has no relationship with you or the company you represent. Maybe they offered the info up willingly, but in a lot of those generations, the quality of intent is low to outright unintentional. Sorry that you're having a rough go with this. Hope you can find somewhere to land and build a career!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/p3xgu6d/

"I have been contracted with about seven carriers for life insurance and I'm slowly getting the rest of them but yes I just got licensed left my 16 year career in the dental field and I have not yet sold one policy but I am officially two weeks and after getting carriers And I'm currently working still at a dental office helping a dentist for three days while I transfer out completely but I own my own small business seeing clients and also now trying to sit behind a desk and dial all day it's a lot, but I know I can do it. Glad I found this videos for more information on how a life insurance agent career is pass my exam the first time and have bought leads, but haven't had much success so I've made flyers."

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWq4TY&lc=Ugzr4N3sCTVahCgXMbd4AaABAq>

"Yes, they are a crappy company to work for, I worked for them for a year and a half. I was working for AIL (Globe life) before that and they prey on people with a AD&D policy, so I left to go to Bankers life. The upline starts to train you and then they cut you off, training is given in the office and basically let you run your own appointments, and if you fail, you fail. They give you a lead list that you call to try to set up an appointment to get their information on the fact finder for new to Medicare, then look at their life, critical illness policy, long term care policies and if there is any 401K in the home for the financial advisor to make the commissions for himself and your upline and yourself. If they are low income homes, (Medicaid) they tell you not to waste your time, but they actually need help, why walk away when your supposed to help people? They get you in the door for their training, and office days (normally 2 days a week). When you get someone on the phone you book appointments or door knock 3 days out of the week. Not to mention when you get someone new to Medicare they pay you \$325 to \$375 per person and a so called bonus APC (\$200 until that runs out). Cant forget about your SNA and RPA, which are contests against new agents and senior agents. They give you 6 months to hit these goals, with promises to give you more money, but don't mention that they stop later, or if you don't get your license, they let you go. So basically, if you have no license the person with the license (already working there) to run the appointment gets the commission and you get nothing. The push for you to get your license (you pay for and Xcel training) and contract with all the carriers, because the only commission you will receive is a life insurance commission when you get your license, yes, until then you have no money but are charged weekly to use the office space and their materials for appointments. They are vultures and prey on the elderly, want you to push, and push to meet goals, pairing you with someone who is supposed to know how to run things, only to give you false information. The offices will give awards (placard) showing the commissions you made and the APC, but when you leave, they keep the Medicare that you wrote and you will not get the business back unless you write the client to another carrier. When your running appointments by yourself, it's basically a contest especially during AEP or OEP for Medicare. I wrote 20 in Oct and 18 in Nov, only to fall short of the goals. I learned that (outside) a new to Medicare will pay \$694 the first during few months of the year and gradually reduces as the months goes by (Sept new to Medicare \$230), when you look for another company ask if they are captive or non captive, find out if there is an office fee, ask how much Medicare will pay, if it is to the company or directly to you from the carrier. Ask about commissions from the life insurance carriers, Bankers only has Washington mutual and Colonial Penn. Even their Medicare supplements are just thru Washington Mutual. Their life insurance is pricy but once you enroll someone, you don't want to remove them from that business especially if they are in poor health. Their underwriting department is harsh and had several applications that would not process on the back end, eventually to get cancelled. They do have a nice app called BSPN, that you upload on your tablet and phone and will allow you to drive to someone's home to visit them for new to Medicare (Turning 65 and you can actually filter some older prospects as well, but once your gone, all the notes that you made on that app stay there for other to utilize while in the area you liked to work. Know that if your working Medicare, you can actually pay for an app called T65. You can use that list to get your Medicare customers. I started working with another company to add to the things that I could offer to a family. So naturally I left, knowing that I could work for another company and the business was actually mine. I enjoy the company that I work for now, and I work what I want, when I want. The life insurance business can be good, you have to work for what you want. Know that last year during AEP I wrote 15 Medicare and Humana paid me \$3900. Business was much better on my own. Small commissions, large commissions, see what the company offers for other things such as leads, how much they cost, do your homework, and good luck to your new endeavor."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/bpbp7pg/

"You blame Medicare marketing compliance rules for this.. You CANNOT say Medicare is ANYTHING like ACA. ACA will become like Medicare with *compliance and disclosures*. AND with our new admin(👉👉). We might not have ACA anymore. Just STM. Some of those short term medical plans are only for 3 months in some states even after the recent changes. And there are rules where you can't reinstate with some carrier in same year. Health insurance is a circus right now. Medicare(MAPD) and ACA are typically uneducated people getting harassed all day during AEP/Open Enrollment. The chronic flips thinking they're getting something *more everytime added*. If you want to talk about *deceitful* then look at limited med with multiplan without major medical carrier with it. Which is way less compliant than ACA. And they're discount plans not real insurance for 2-300\$+ Yes people click once or couple times. And those leads are sold and sold again every month(.20 cents - 50\$). And 90% of that business you could get from those cheap leads will be flipped by end of the year or within 3 months clawback time. Vs your 30% you're suppose to lose on avg every year. Call Amazon or some other large company right now and watch you get redirected from Customer Service to Medicare agency. Sometimes the smaller newer agencies do spoof the numbers or emails to look like local food business even Amazon. Everyone wants a piece of the pie"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npm451h/

"See, I think we need to keep in mind most people - the *average* 'most people' - do not understand much about insurance *at all.* I have been reflecting lately on when I was in my 20s and even 30s, I really had no clue. That lady - \$100 says she thinks you decide the rates. When I was 20s, I wouldn't have known any better. I do remember getting auto insurance probably the first time and the agent said "ok so you want comp and collision" and I was like - "ok sure... if that's what I'm supposed to have. Is that what I'm supposed to have?" lol. I literally had no idea what that even meant. I never really thought much else about it until I needed to use it. Same with health insurance. So yeah - I think she probably believe that you absolutely do have a say in what the rates are that you're giving her. Maybe she just needed to hear the words "I really wish I could get you a lower rate. I would if I could to anything about it at all." Maybe it's also just cuz I've worked retail and I'm used to people yelling at me for stuff that has nothing to do with me, lol. It's just the way people are, sorry to say"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r99hmi/is_it_just_me_or_are_we_all_changing/o6d73ag/

"Keep it real. A lot of people give these speeches who have been in it for many years. Hi, they make it seem like you are able to put full time into it immediately when actually, somebody like me who doesn't have a base salary has to work another job while doing this. Then there is the idea of getting before seniors which was painted as an easy picture by sales people that I know and then you go out and try to do what they say and realize that the senior centers are already overwhelming people and you don't have seed money to buy leads from mail. I'm doing it and I like it, but to paint the picture that you're going to do 300 enrollments a year is a little bit unrealistic for some new people. They need to know that going in. That's why I think only one out of five continues after a year. Don't paint an unrealistic picture for those starting out because they could get discouraged. I'm going to continue because I see the value in it, but it has not as easy as people have made it sound."

— YouTube · How Much Money Can Medicare Sales Agents Make? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vs4gz6CkKLk&lc=UgyDfP8i14HIQ5Gav9h4AaABAq>

"I hate that the US food industries sells lead in food and processed foods have made our citizens obese. Or how junk food companies added ingredients to make food more addictive... I think most big business is awful at this point with lack of morality. Pick your poisons... someone said let's blame insurance because they are used to it and it will distract from everything else."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kv7r4x/what_good_hands/muf2o5g/

"My Blue Cross clients in Cook County are very angry! If they're subsidized, the presence of the dirt cheap Celtic-Ambetter HMO plans is causing their ATPC-subsidy \$\$\$ amount to actually DECREASE on 1/1/2016. I just spoke with a 62 year old Cook County client (60611). Her Blue Choice PPO plan is increasing by 45% and the subsidy decreasing by 11%. Net result is that her actual out-of-pocket increase in premium is a huge 56%! If they're not subsidized, they have to endure the entire 45% premium increase that will kick in on 1/1/2016. Or, change to Ambetter-Celtic and pray for the best of health in 2016. I'm pretty sure that Celtic-Ambetter is violating HHS-CMS rules by not having enough physicians and hospitals in Cook county. The problem is the Federal Government will not take any action until enough people are severely hurt with huge medical bills..and start filing official complaints. It would be nice if HHS-CMS would take proactive action, by telling Celtic-Ambetter to de-list itself from the Illinois Marketplace, but that's not going to happen. But, I will send a note to the Illinois Department of Insurance and the Governor's office. Almost zero chance of any response or action, but at least they'll have a record (and so will I) that at least one health insurance professional attempted to warn them of the problems that Celtic-Ambetter's presence will bring to lots of Illinois residents starting on 1/1/2016. ac"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Ambetter Insured by Celtic? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/ambetter-insured-by-celtic.78353/#post-1049179>

"No single agent is calling 20 times in a row. 3 calls is the standard. Usually, the client has gone and submitted their information to multiple sites for quotes and therefore gets reached out to by multiple agents from different agencies. As an agent you really have no way of knowing this is happening before you call and hear that the client is angry."

— YouTube · Insurance Agent Calls An Angry Lead - Rate This Call! #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsu · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yc0XJA-IF5I&lc=Ugz-HFskLOI_FKsOXeN4AaABAg_A024EDglj1A0ngGPK3LGM

"Thank you David. I've been in contact with Need A Lead and Lead Concepts, the recommendation you made from your video(s). From your experience and your agents, how accurate is their data for direct mail? What age and income do you recommend for FEX?"

— YouTube · Best Life Insurance Leads For 2020 [Vendor & Lead Review] · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=faFKfYtPADk&lc=Ugytz3DzwRNyQlwd3PR4AaABAg_9Q0zLTAvdfk9Q8uUFslcWo

"Insurance Broker (Advice Needed) Hey guys, I'm a 29 year-old insurance professional who's been working in the industry for about the last eight years. I started out my career with State Farm around 2018 only making a \$30K salary+ minimal commissions. When I started I didn't even know what a premium was buy after a few months of training, I developed into a 15K to 25K a month producer. After staying at State Farm for a year I left and went to Allstate for about 6 years and that 25K became a minimum for me. I started writing anywhere from 25K-50K in until they changed their commission structure. Things eventually worked their way down to me and that's where things started going wrong. My commission was cut in half and I was devastated. Thankfully in my last year I knew things were going downhill and I actually started my own independent agency on the side. I have a book of about 100K which is small but I'm really interested in growing, it as I know that can be the thing that creates semi passive income and build a significant amount of wealth in my life. However, I'm faced with a few challenges. The first challenge is the cost of writing business. I've only worked for high performing agencies and for all of my years of insurance experience the way that I've wrote business has been with leads. When I was with State Farm The agent purchased leads for us, we dialed and made the closes. I started off the same way with Allstate, but we noticed that internet lead quality was lacking so I was switched to exclusively working live transfers. As you can imagine this was a much more pleasurable experience, however when I applied the same strategy to my own business, although I was able to write business, I very soon discovered that Live transfers are very expensive lol. Currently I pay about \$55 per live transfer which is unsustainable for someone in my financial predicament. At this point in time I'm unable to live off my renewals, so I work for a large insurance brokerage and even though I sell more or just as much as I did as a captive, my commission is not what it used to be. I know that my ultimate goal is to run my own insurance brokerage and hire out, but I'm trying to determine the best path to get there. I've considered keeping my full-time job (which I need to pay my bills) in addition to picking up a second job, selling life insurance (Horrible experiences with purchases lead quality), picking up another job, (considering part time just to pay for leads), but I wanted to check and get the opinion of others before I proceeded. I definitely enjoy receiving my renewal checks when they come and I really would like to build on this, but I'm having trouble developing a strategy that will not only sustain me and my family in the short term, but also allow me to grow my business for long term wealth. I'm not opposed to financing but student loans and job instability has caused me to take on more debt than I normally would which for the time being limits my financing opportunities. I've considered pivoting from personally selling insurance as a whole and going into an industry that will provide me a higher commission, then taking that higher commission and using it to grow my insurance brokerage by hiring for Sales. I'm dedicated to growing my agency by any means necessary but at this point I'd like to get some input on what you guys think. Thanks"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w0agml/insurance_broker_advice_needed/

"I notice you are a bit more slower in speech and personable with the aged leads which I like because with the fresh leads you were fast and made me feel like "doesn't it sound like you're just a telemarketer?". This is more like how I speak with my prospects."

— YouTube · Calling Aged Final Expense Leads & Booking Appointments! · 5 likes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6xb8wEsnIPY&lc=UgwRGJeT_dvyw2jC4tZ4AaABAg

↳ @CodyAskins (5): "@KevsGuide no lol. Sometimes part of Cody's marketing team responds to his comments to make sure everyone is getting the answers they need."

↳ @KevsGuide (4): "@CodyAskins are you talking about yourself in the 3rd person lol"

↳ @CodyAskins (1): "Yeah that's a good point. Cody's speed usually comes from him being an excitable individual :)"

A spouse and household riding on commission income · 21 documents · 20 voices

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course there are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

"This is what sets us (DigitalBGA) apart from other telesales FE Agencies: - Our contracts are direct with the carriers and have earned custom telesales signature options to make transacting final expense over the phone easier for seniors. - We produce and run our own TV commercials, web call ins and internet leads. We see the sales results in real time and cut the losers and scale the winners. - We've built our own technology agents leverage to simplify receiving calls/working leads and having your KPI's at your fingertips to see where you need the most improvement. - We have a team of "A" players supporting and coaching agents every day. Our agent partners support each other daily as well. - We've been committed to telesales and nothing else since our inception in 2016. If you want to meet and ask a bunch of DigitalBGA agents questions, join this Facebook group as 99% of our agent partners don't frequent this forum and there's many in there."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444491>

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 000000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at AIL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"The individuals who have been there for years only are making money on recruiting or renewals. Basically the people that make it, had a ton of disposable income in order to get to the point where the few sales they did make are carrying them financially due to the renewals. The rest of the money they make comes in the form of the bonuses received on recruiting new people. These new people are "trained" on doing grunt work for these individuals who have "made it." So you are calling the trainers leads and making them money while you are in "training." Long story short. if you've got 20-30k in disposable income OR are married and able to live off your partners income, you've got a chance. otherwise I wouldn't do it because it is all commission based."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/n6x9sgz/

"That's a great question. I did not spend a dollar as I was part of a partnership where I was able to keep 40% of the commission and the other 60% went to my partner who was able to work a deal with our IMO where they paid for the marketing. I netted over 500k after the 40% cut. I called it lightning in a bottle that really dried up in 2023. Fun af while it lasted. Biggest check was \$79k, about 9 months after getting my license."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ey16zq/how_much_was_your_first_check/ljdhlg/

"No joke... Just start looking at various civic events and stuff like community fairs. I table in lots of different places. I used to be only one profession to focus. But it turns out there are some really great opportunities out there in the general public that genuinely wants to be educated. I might actually develop a workshop based on my "Learn to Drive, as slowly as possible," concept for families to have the conversation around driving and responsibility and get the kids noses out of their phones when they are in the car as a habit. Looking around at other cars and drivers to predict what may happen at the next movement. Which lights are turning next? Where will the pedestrians come from? Are any turns unprotected or are they all protected. Can you turn right on red here? Is there a bike box that needs to be minded? It's all driving with your brain before you drive with your body. Inviting parents to talk to their kids about their own driving, making the kids navigate them to school and home or the nearest whatever. That needs to become the kids job at 10 or even earlier. Which turn and when you take it. Let them tell you when to get into the correct lane and which lane that is. If there is anyone there, they should tell you that too. Obvi don't hit anyone, but let them tell you as you tell yourself in your head. See one. Teach one. Do one. A different model, to be sure, but it gets their brains used to the amount of information they must take in to be a good driver making seasoned calls, before they ever have their hands on the wheel. It addresses a lot of the anxiety I see from the kids I do talk to. And you know who makes a great family for premium when you bring them on? Families with teenage drivers. Boy are they great for premium it you can control the loss ratio. That's simply a good relationship with the insureds so they make good decisions. I also work the room at every event. I show up as early as I can and make a point to connect with other community orgs that might want to have us table. I love doing diverse community events because people who are gender and orientation diverse have a ton of questions about insurance, gender, family composition, driving, etc. When folks feel safe, they will relax tremendously and lean into everything you offer. Connecting with the community orgs that are there is how you get more invites to more community events. But don't just be collecting leads with a giveaway. You need to have a real value proposition beyond the insurance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vyv0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zer0_sales/p61f1se/

"I know this post is 4 months old but very glad I came across it. I went into an Aflac office today and they offered my a job (of course). After they explained how everything works, it sounded too good to be true. I can't lie, I was excited when I left but quickly came down to reality. I'm a single family income and 100% commission is not realistic to me. I would have to get a full time night job in order to do it and I have no passion for insurance sales. I don't have any leads personally but they didn't ask me for any (yet) but when I mentioned my father works in the dairy industry in San Diego (I'm in LA), she told me I should ask my dad for his customers names and offer them Aflac ! [gif](emotelfree_emotes_pack|facepalm) I'm not driving all the way to SD to sell Aflac. Needless to say after second guessing myself tonight and reading this, I've decided to definitely pass. Plus, they make you pay to get licensed and fingerprinted too?? Nope. I have 3 interviews lined up next week and will keep applying until I find the right job for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ceu431/my_honest_review_of_aflac/lidajl2/

"I don't pay for my leads at all my company pays for my leads I get paid \$250-500 per policy some days I make \$1000 a day just depends on the day it's the best move I've ever made my husband does the same job for a diff company so it's awesome"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=Ugw3WNVLbTBX-yv00Ad4AaABAg>

↳ @shoalingalarza3529 (2): "what company are you with may I ask?"

↳ @adampuentes4009 (0): "Please let me know what company you are with. That's exactly what I'm looking for"

"Health and Life is getting harder too. Tons of carriers not paying even a referral on prescription drug plans anymore. They're cherry picking which plans get which commission and of course renewals have become so time consuming because last year people were going in and snagging customers the day or two before end of open enrollment and however they did it if their name was last AOR then they got commission. I had signed consent but they wouldn't accept it. Huge issue last year soooo this year so far every renewal I've had to call 📞 in 3 way and getting customers to actually answer the phone is like nailing jello to a wall. Not like ACA pays us a fortune in first place. 🙄🙄 this is my 2nd year and I'm not sure if this is my "dream job" or leaving a legacy for my kids n grand kids kind of job anymore."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gvbrhr/allstae_just_made_all_their_agents_jobs_harder/ly7q9v1/

"I was in the same position as you months ago. The issue is you're probably applying for jobs on job boards, which is where all the "sell your friends and family" types recruit. If you want an agency that's not going to pressure you to recruit your friends and family and actually sell insurance, you'll need to AVOID job boards and look up local independent life and health insurance companies. Reach out to them directly and inquire about joining as an agent. That being said, it's still going to be commission-only most likely (you may be provided leads which is nice). You can make great money, but finding salary in life insurance is tough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1whddwv/life_and_health_licensed_but_cant_find_a_nonmlm/pa51i8o/

"Anyone have Humana take their book of business when they switched from Individual to a new Upline? Humana calls it a strategic partner move, so therefore they've moved my commissions to a house account." I just received another communication, that they say I owe them money, too."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/mxc3knm/

"Well, while some of it may be close to hitting the point it fails in an overall sense of proper marketing 101. James's No #1 Rule, stay in front of the client, one way or another you have to stay in front of them so when they are ready you are there! So exactly how does one do that? Okay if you take the above advice, which is a tad short sighted you won't be in front of them unless you so happen to walk in or call at the very time they are ready. Which is the underlying reason that makes the response rate, basically if you get a 3% response rate what you have done is actually have good timing 3 out of 100 times you make contact. Now depending upon what you are selling and what you are making will have direct effect on what you can pay out to market. Yet though I can't imagine on picking one thing and sticking with it alone. So one does multiple systems to increase business, while B2B and Telemarketing is aggressive I can't imagine not including more passive systems to support your aggressive marketing. Such as, 1. Yellow Pages 2. Letters to leads that didn't buy and then the re-call. 3. Post Cards to prospects that didn't make initial appointment. 4. Ad's or submit articles to Trade Magazines and local papers. As always activity is the key. Warm markets, don't let that go by. Call it what you want but the fact is it is quite effective. Make the list of family and friends, now I don't support the idea of selling to family and friends but the contacts they can provide you is crucial. Take my wife, a Case Manager at UTMC, a highly awarded at that. Now how many contacts do you think I can work through her? There is not a Medical Durable Equipment or Home Care base in Knoxville that won't give me their ear. Of course sometimes you have to be real careful how you handle the communications. Have a friend that is a well known employee of a County Courthouse. Now I'm close in getting a contract for a voluntary LTC, he got me in to meet with the HR person and I simply presented a voluntary group JH to them. Looks good so far. First thing they told me is that they already have service, yet I ask how many of their employees know anything about it? The response was classic, no idea! Quite correct I said because I ask a few of your people and they had the same answer, no idea of the plan. Obviously their agent or agency is failing in their job and that is to promote their plan. Why bother having a benefit that isn't promoted, it isn't your job and they are failing. Just lets slide this over here and we'll take care of it for you!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Individual Health Insurance Marketing · [https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/individual-health-insurance-marketing.34/#post-](https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/individual-health-insurance-marketing.34/#post-441)

441

"Re: How Are Most Affording Health Care These Days? Any Suggestio In what state do you live? Some states have special plans designed just for kids for those with modest incomes. For example, in Georgia we have PeachCare. A family of 4 can have an income of close to \$52k and still qualify. If your state has this type of program you could put the kids on that plan since they are the primary users of health care right now. dorlow said: I'm just trying to figure out how to get cheaper healthcare. I make about \$40,000 a year. We are a single income family. With our current healthcare from our employer, it's \$80 bi-weekly for our healthcare that has a \$10,000 deductible. So everything we go to the doctor for, we have to think twice about it. My daughter had to go to ER a few months ago and the bill for a 1 day stay was about \$2,000. We have to pay everything out of pocket until we reach the \$10,000. It is killing us. I keep on calling around and trying to get quotes for healthcare on my own. Everytime I tell insurance sales people what we're paying, they tell me "You're getting an awesome deal!!!" I don't think it's an awesome deal. Seems with having two kids under 2, every other day, I have med bills in the mail and it's killing me to pay them all and still feed the family. There has to be other people in this world that are in the same boat. I don't think I get paid that crappy, but I know it's not great. We shouldn't be living so bad if we have, what everyone keeps telling me, awesome insurance. What would be great is if someone could tell me some loophole so we could get Medicaid or Medicare or something government sponsored. We do get a little bit of government assistance but I think that's ending after this month. I asked or rep and he said we don't apply for anything government related. Click to expand..."

— Insurance-Forums.com · How Are Most Affording Health Care These Days? Any Suggestions? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/how-are-most-affording-health-care-these-days-any-suggestions.22939/#post-286716>

"I'm just trying to figure out how to get cheaper healthcare. I make about \$40,000 a year. We are a single income family. With our current healthcare from our employer, it's \$80 bi-weekly for our healthcare that has a \$10,000 deductible. So everything we go to the doctor for, we have to think twice about it. My daughter had to go to ER a few months ago and the bill for a 1 day stay was about \$2,000. We have to pay everything out of pocket until we reach the \$10,000. It is killing us. I keep on calling around and trying to get quotes for healthcare on my own. Everytime I tell insurance sales people what we're paying, they tell me "You're getting an awesome deal!!!" I don't think it's an awesome deal. Seems with having two kids under 2, every other day, I have med bills in the mail and it's killing me to pay them all and still feed the family. There has to be other people in this world that are in the same boat. I don't think I get paid that crappy, but I know it's not great. We shouldn't be living so bad if we have, what everyone keeps telling me, awesome insurance. What would be great is if someone could tell me some loophole so we could get Medicaid or Medicare or something government sponsored. We do get a little bit of government assistance but I think that's ending after this month. I asked or rep and he said we don't apply for anything government related."

— Insurance-Forums.com · How Are Most Affording Health Care These Days? Any Suggestions? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/how-are-most-affording-health-care-these-days-any-suggestions.22939/#post-286677>

"healthagent said: This board can definitely derail so let me lay out the truth for everyone: Most agents are going to continue only writing for carriers that advance. Most agents make their living off internet leads - not local marketing, SEO, social media or anything else The only agents who are truly pissed and depressed about this were the "6 app a month-ers" who surfed porn all day and sucked off their wife's paycheck. The truth - sorry. Click to expand... Thank You John-

— Insurance-Forums.com · Don't Panic! · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/dont-panic.26484/#post-329732>

"This board can definitely derail so let me lay out the truth for everyone: Most agents are going to continue only writing for carriers that advance. Most agents make their living off internet leads - not local marketing, SEO, social media or anything else The only agents who are truly pissed and depressed about this were the "6 app a month-ers" who surfed porn all day and sucked off their wife's paycheck. The truth - sorry."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Don't Panic! · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/dont-panic.26484/#post-329731>

"Chris Donnelly said: Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think! Click to expand... They both post here so maybe you'll get some direct responses."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · 4 reactions · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444479>

"Hi all. My name is Chris and I am a brand new agent looking to enter the business of final expense telesales. I am coming into this business from the academic world of political science (decided I was tired of going from visiting gig to visiting gig but never nailing down a tenure track job, and so I now want something radically different for myself and have decided on entering this new (for me) field. I consider myself someone who tries to do a lot of research and due diligence, however, before making any big decisions, and so I am asking for some help from you all. So in terms of where I want to call home for my first job in final expense telesales, after doing a lot of shopping around, I have narrowed my search down to what seem to me to be two excellent choices: Duford Insurance Group and Digital BGA As such, as I was wondering if any more experienced agents here could lend some insight as to the pros and cons of joining one or the other of these two companies. Just to preemptively answer some basic questions about my own plans and background that people might have: -I am 37 years old and do not have a significant other or children, and live alone -I plan to work from my apartment in the Boston area -As above suggests, I am looking to do exclusively do telesales, NOT F2F -I am fortunate enough to have accumulated some money from family, past work, and passive income and so can afford to spend a good bit of money on buying leads -I have not yet gotten licensed but hope to pass the MA state exam in a few weeks tops and to purchase transferances so that I can sell in some other states, too -I am planning on doing this full time, not part time -I'd hope to be able to earn six figures in income after a couple of years of doing this (realistic?) -Getting high quality training and mentoring is of utmost importance to me, as I do not have a background in sales or insurance Anyhow, I hope this info is helpful. I look forward to reading what people think!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Duford Insurance Group vs. Digital BGA for Final Expense Telesales · new or aspiring agent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/duford-insurance-group-vs-digital-bga-for-final-expense-telesales.110049/#post-1444478>

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

Uplines, managers and recruiters · 16 documents · 16 voices

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to atflack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenevolent to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"I watched the FX vid that was posted here and he talked about a rogue agent writing 40k of bad business and fleeing the country. My Assurant regional manager told me a better one. Assurant came out with a feature where if an app was instantly approved - meaning the second you submitted the app it was approved without any UW, you got 12 months advanced commission. What could go wrong? A new agent signed up his entire network of friends. They chose the most expensive plans, listed zero health conditions and all were auto-approved, earning him \$48,000 in commissions. His friends all then cancelled the policies during the 10 day free look. His MGA apparently didn't think it was a flag that a new agent wrote that much in two weeks. Every dime was charged back to the MGA who had to file BK over it and the agent went off to Mexico."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1b228y/

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about ALL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, ALL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"I'm not talking about earning potential/possibilities. But math like: \$10 cost per lead, 50% contact ratio, 20% closing ratio, \$780 avg AP, 75% comp with standard 75% advance = \$338.75 net/\$438.75 gross per \$100 spent on ads. Clearly numbers are taken out of thin air as an example and will differ on number of factors. But if one comes into this industry and operates (and is familiar with) with those metrics, as opposed to intangible "great leads" and "amazing income opportunity", he'll be much better off. Here's an example: one IMO heavily pushes that anyone who's able to simply read their script will close 50% of the appointments. And their leads have 25/40/80% booking ratio depending on the tier (age). Free money printer, ain't it? Put anyone who can't even spell the word "deductible" and he should be mansion-shopping in no time. Even if you discount those numbers by half to account for lack of experience. But they conveniently don't mention that leads have ~25% contact ratio. When agents struggle? Buy more leads! You may be a couple dials away from your big break! So new agent, who doesn't know any better and operates with the zero-to-hero story in his mind, will keep on going till he's broke without knowing that numbers wouldn't work out for him to begin with. Point being, I'm talking about basic/general point of reference and means to put the numbers together. So one can make better decisions based on factual information and have the means to understand that if 1/150 dials end up in a quote, it's very likely that there's nothing wrong with them, but leads just aren't as great as the recruiter promised."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/mlvyds3/

"I'm interested in seeing what responses you get, as in my experience, nobody is really compensating agents fairly right now. Additionally there's legislation in the pipeline that will more than likely have a lot of FMO's and IMO's closing up for Medicare sales as they won't be able to charge administrative fees (from my understanding) on top of taking a cut of your commissions. I've also been encountering a lot of MLM sounding "agencies." They become easier to spot once you recognize their goal is to recruit lol. The one thing I can't stand is these agencies refusing to release your appointments for months. For that I will definitely recommended staying far away from Assurance IQ who recruits agents by outright lying about the commissions you'll be looking forward to and then now looking to hold appointments for 120 days! Anyhow, good luck! Hoping we get some more optimistic answers in here lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/ksvk3d/

"Appreciate this response, and yes I'm in the US. I'm stilling digging into the FMO landscape, but are you saying when I start reaching out to FMOs be prepared that I won't be able to access their full network of carriers?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/mib7543/

"So here's a funny twist in my insurance journey. I've been grinding, trying to build my agency, and for months I've been researching CRMs and dialers. I finally pulled the trigger and bought Ringy because everyone kept recommending it. Fast forward to this week... and I randomly discover I actually had access to Integrity's CRM, dialer, and lead marketplace the whole time for free through one of the agencies I'm contracted with. No one ever mentioned it. I literally stumbled into the dashboard by accident while looking for something else. Wild. I paid for a CRM meanwhile I already had access to one but my upline never brought it up. Smh Not mad about it though, just sharing in case any newer agents don't realize some FMOs/IMOs automatically give you tools like CRMs, dialers, quoting platforms, or lead systems that they never bother to highlight. Definitely worth double-checking what's included with your contracts before you go spending on extra software. If anyone else has had this happen or knows hidden features inside Integrity's system, drop some tips. I'm already finding stuff I didn't even know existed. However, I am going to keep the ringy platform. I really like the drip system they have for text and email and other features"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1odlyvq/solo_insurance_agent_looking_for_a_crm_dialer/no7I9a4/

"I only been the office a few times. I was referred by a buddy of mine. The branch manager told me about a training class at one location and then another 2 hours away from home when I missed the first initial one due to failing my L&H the first time. All my onboarding training is done and I'm just..waiting on an email regarding actually starting. I know starting out is very difficult bc you're basically starting your own book of business with their provided leads/training. I already been offered two contracts from different statefarm agencies so I may just have to start off captive to gain experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/mdehm9h/

"crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Selling for Multiple IMO/FMO'S · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929096>

"jdeasy said: Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. Click to expand... Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Selling for Multiple IMO/FMO'S · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929350>

"heffhawk said: Thanks again for the input. I haven't sold much health insurance and this forum is a tremendous help. They continue to call me(pitch me) to get contracted, even though they won't tell me specific products, lead system, etc.. The recruiter basically told me to get contracted and then he'll talk specifics. You'll get a lot of highly enthusiastic pitches. Step One: Be very skeptical, step two, run it by the BBB and search for the scam. Step three: repeat step one!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Anyone Heard of USHealth Advisors? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/anyone-heard-of-ushealth-advisors.33531/#post-454456>

"Thanks again for the input. I haven't sold much health insurance and this forum is a tremendous help. They continue to call me(pitch me) to get contracted, even though they won't tell me specific products, lead system, etc.. The recruiter basically told me to get contracted and then he'll talk specifics."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Anyone Heard of USHealth Advisors? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/anyone-heard-of-ushealth-advisors.33531/#post-421238>

"heffhawk said: They continue to call me(pitch me) to get contracted, even though they won't tell me specific products, lead system, etc.. The recruiter basically told me to get contracted and then he'll talk specifics. Haha, no red flag there."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Anyone Heard of USHealth Advisors? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/anyone-heard-of-ushealth-advisors.33531/#post-421241>

"Why i left the life insurance industry Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— r/LifeInsurance · 83 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1eqogok/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"Why I left the life insurance industry I posted this in r/insurance but i'm going to post it here too. Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 46 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

'Don't buy leads, generate your own' · 15 documents · 15 voices

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . Id say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgZvaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

↳ @MyPowerfulClips (4): "Where are you working where you don't pay for leads ?!"

↳ @patinamia (4): "how do you find clients without buying leads"

↳ @Lovebeyondfear1111 (0): "This is awesomeness !! Where do you see your career in the long run?"

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"This is what they don't tell you is that you have to learn to generate your own leads. Don't waste your time I'm with the competitor of Aflac which is colonial life. I do Facebook ads, Tik Tok etc.. to generate my own leads it works. The old methods don't"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5v01x4/

"It's just me, a solo agent now for 30 years. All health insurance, mostly Medicare. I work nothing but referrals, I don't buy leads at all. I work hard for 2 months and then cruise the rest of the year any taking a few appointments a week most on the phone anymore. I make about \$200k a year. I feel that's not bad at all considering how much time off I have. I'm always available for calls, so I go around the house doing projects most of the year with my Bluetooth headset on and when someone calls, I head into the office and work. I'm not out there to get rich or chest anyone. I have \$0 debt and my retirement is very well set. I figure I'm not going to burn myself out doing this job but work whenever I'm needed. It's a good life, but open enrollment is not easy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq9pmvd/

"We don't cold call and we don't buy leads. We get steady clients but we aren't a huge agency at all. We're comfortable so we never really wrote like \$500k a year in new premium like some say here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n7fvj7h/

"We do virtual. We are set up on first connect, Bolt, and smart choice. We don't buy leads. We work on referrals from people we know, existing customers, and relationships built with car dealerships and realtors or mortgage brokers. Would I have found that works best is to create a schedule that would set aside specific office hours for service work. Have certain times you do follow up for quotes. And have specific time to use to reach out to drum up new business. It's all about organizing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wkdbcb/anyone_in_here_doing_solo_independent_from_home/pagr2rq/

"Don't buy leads from overseas!? Next you'll tell me not to send apple gift cards to the county sheriff with an Indian accent looking for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjvobq2/

"So far, so good. Obviously, we all want more more more but given that I don't pay for leads or advertising, it's not a bad start at all."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lyho3b/i_started_my_own_agency_in_mid_may_been_in_the/n2u4dbj/

"To answer your question of how to get better leads - don't pay for leads. Find out where the prospects you want to have as clients are and hang out there. Networking works when you have something in common. Not that buying leads won't work it's just inefficient and expensive. I've never bought something from a telemarketer or door knocker, would you? I'm glad you didn't sell to your friends and family though. Your book of business is captive there if you ever decide to leave. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgfngv/new_agent_at_new_york_life/paa3pz0/

"This happened to me too when I first started! When you do this with good intention you will do well. Insurance is not a get rich quick scheme no matter what anyone says. I left insurance sales and focused on ACA which aligns with my purpose which is to HELP people. Look into that and most importantly STOP paying for leads. Anytime a company is trying to sell you leads regardless of who they are, they are trying to scam you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujisuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ouqr9cz/

"I mean, telling people to stop buying leads is an interesting way to put it then. Maybe stop buying shitty leads or scam websites who sell you old and worn out info. There's certainly lead sites that are custom to the individual agent, which can bring in more business. There's other agencies that do create ads for agents yes, but they don't give out information like numbers, emails, nor does it guarantee any interest."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466vj/stop_buying_leads/moachej/

"I don't pay for my leads at all my company pays for my leads I get paid \$250-500 per policy some days I make \$1000 a day just depends on the day it's the best move I've ever made my husband does the same job for a diff company so it's awesome"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=Ugw3WNVLbTBX-yv0OAd4AaABAg>

↳ @shoalingalarza3529 (2): "what company are you with may I ask?"

↳ @adampuentes4009 (0): "Please let me know what company you are with. That's exactly what I'm looking for"

"I dont buy leads either. Network. Write only quality business ask for referrals each time you do something great for your client. Book builds itself."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4kj8c9/

"Are you talking about ACA as in Affordable Care Act? Open enrollment for government health insurance is in November. No body is actively looking for health insurance unless they lost coverage. Don't buy aged leads. Waste of time and money."

— Facebook group comment · Insurance Agent Opportunities (USA) · 1 likes · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/2501016683509797/posts/4085419205069529/>

'The money is in the renewals / your book' · 15 documents · 15 voices

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoRQzLpt1BvWDah4AaABAg>

↳ @davidcampo2902 (13): "Everything you said is spot on! I I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

↳ @roberthoeller5516 (5): "I too sell both and agree with you 110%."

↳ @rodbutler4054 (4): "Spoken like a true insurance salesman!"

"Possible complaint being filed against me. I am an independent life and health Insurance agent who may be having a complaint filed against me from a former client of mine. I have hundreds of clients enrolled in ACA plans (marketplace, Obamacare) and this person was one of them. He was enrolled in a plan and opted into automatic renewal. The plan was renewed and he called me back saying he was never aware his plan was renewed, because he was requiring a 1095 form to file his taxes. He called the marketplace and they told him to "file a complaint" against the agent. I have a recently recorded call where I told him he opted in for the automatic renewal and he didn't negate against it. I do have E&O insurance as well. I would never enroll a customer without their consent, I am just worried about what will happen next. He is losing \$1800 on his tax return due to him being enrolled in this plan, but it's not my fault. Any advice would be greatly appreciated, thank you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1c7go61/possible_complaint_being_filed_against_me/

"Yes, but years 1 & 2 are solid working years (build a base for renewals) in health expect about 40-60k in new business, (money to you). This is health insurance, my niche is Medicare and I love it. By year 5 you should be somewhere near 200k annually (gross) with renewals and new clients. Oh, and I don't really work that hard, if I did my numbers would be double..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc6m3ct/

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 000000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at AIL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"I'm yet to find a decent lead vendor in many years in health. Best way is to build your book with referrals - like really be a good person to your clients, then when OEP/AEP get closer, you gotta ask those clients for referrals. Every once in a while, I'll try a new lead company and sometimes it works out but typically, the leads get worse and worse over time (that's their business model in many cases), so it becomes not worth the time or money."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npo7fdj/

"Hey I'm curious about your thoughts, on how you should approach clients with older term policies that aren't up for renewal yet, but could have the potential for new insurance plans to be placed?"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=UgyvyhH5w4ifrYX9anR4AaABAg>

↳ @dylanlafollette7804 (2): "Term Policies typically pay out 2% of the time since people out live that policy. I would just explain that life insurance should be there when something happens. Then you can offer to write whole life, or a longer new term policy. And I ask the client if they believe that as you get older, the more likely you'll have an illness or anything that would stop them from getting insurance. If they can agree to either of those, they're likely to move forward. Hope this helps.."

↳ @aicejermiah4885 (2): "Let them know they are basically giving money to charity for the insurance, and show them the rate increase w their policy or call in to the company and ask them the questions so they can hear it, try to set them up w an IUL or whole depending on age. And let them know you may pay more but this will never end and it has living benefits."

↳ @rick73020 (1): "This is exactly why I offer a free "policy review" for anybody that already has a policy. Review their current policy and offer them something that's better than what they currently have in place. Make it a no-brained for them to go with you."

"To be fair a few things turned me off. A lot of it was commission structure. I used Agentero for small GL and although I do like them I don't like that I have no access to my larger policies and get as earned commissions. I'm used to managing my own accounts and getting up front payment. Also I need the full commissions paid for budget reasons. That is what I am used to. I don't want to write a \$6000 policy and get \$60 a month for a year. So that was a big portion of me backing off. I thought I'd see more commission growth. I would absolutely suggest them to anyone starting out but if you have a decent book already it's tough to get as earned. I know there were months and months I didn't get Life Insurance commissions from them and had to bug them to pay me. They did a little at a time then stopped again. It seemed to be off and on. I finally gave up. So that was a big part of my turn off as well, I just shouldn't have to bug you to pay me, they should have come to me about it first. I do wish now I would have just done direct appointments. I think had I done that I would find more reason to have stayed with it. I had a great mentor who was very helpful and I need to actually get in touch with him, but a lot of my issues stemmed from the size of my own book. I have a decent book and a staff. I am dealing with rate increases on personal lines which has taken a chunk of time. Being on social media stalking comments was proving to be very difficult. Add in the admin work, moving, new schools, new jobs, etc. I just didn't have room. Personal and business just kept me too busy. When I did it I realized it was on the weekends and taking time from my family and friends. I need that break for my own mental health. That was another part of it as well. You have to make the time and for me that was usually weekends. I say that to say if you have the time, are a smaller agency or building from scratch, you are 100% correct in your assessment, and I encourage anyone reading this that is getting a book going that this is a great avenue AND I can get you with a great mentor to help you. I just felt like for my size I was chasing small \$60 commissions being paid at \$6 a month, when I could devote the time to chase \$2000 commissions paid up front. I did not mean to question or push your methods, again I had someone helping me to do the same thing and I absolutely saw some good results! I just realized I was chasing smaller fish when I had bigger ones I could eat. However I think for me as well... I am ready to pull back and would rather pay someone else to do commercial. I've been in this for 30 years. I started at 19 and I just don't care to be in the agent seat anymore, I'd rather be behind the scenes. I'd also like to move on to overseeing other businesses ventures as well to diversify income. Using the social media method takes A LOT of time and you have to be ready to jump fast on a lead. I just realized for me I was going a different direction than I needed to. I have an overwhelming feeling the older I get the more I want my time back. For ME being on social media chasing leads was causing me to give more of it up. I'd rather at this point just have a remote commercial agent that works their own way but has access to my companies. I have 20 commercial companies as well as several huge broker network. All of them pay 10-25% up front of which we'd have a very fair split in their favor. It's a great opportunity for someone to build up a decent income even if it were part time. In other words I think I personally took on the project when after 30 years I just wasn't ready to give up that much time working it. Good luck to you as you go forward!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/nlr0kp/

"@WitsEndFL Thanks. I'll now pay special attention to max out of pocket when comparing plans. Some sources say you should start learning about Medicare 6 months before you are eligible, and as much as I hate it, it's true. It's scary to be near the enrollment deadline (whatever it is in relation to when you need your effective date to be, which I'm still not sure, due to unknown processing time after you apply), and you haven't learned enough about a very complicated topic. Just today, I'm learning from a BOOK on Medicare, that I have to produce a birth certificate which I don't even have, before I can sign up. So I have no clue how an agent even signs me up for a plan if I can't yet enroll with the government. One agent I know said Florida was a hugely expensive state for Medicare costs, so I don't know why you're calling their plans good. What prospecting methods did you use? Which ones work? Did you buy people free dinners? Do all the meals pay for themselves in commissions as a result? Did you use powerpoint in restaurant meeting rooms? You hated it, but I would enjoy it as long as the money was there. I've done 100% commission sales before, and only came to hate prospecting it when it didn't pay off after the real estate market tanked. I'm used to speaking in public and enjoy giving presentations. But I'm not paying for 25 dinners at \$20/pop if everybody just eats and leaves. I suspect good agents are eventually making thousands of dollars over time as a result of their meal investments. Some presentations are titled "Medicare Made Simple in 1 hour" which of course is a crock. Medicare is complicated, and you have to memorize a whole book to be able to answer anyone's odd questions. What they mean is, "I can give you a broad overview in 1 hour that barely scratches the surface." It allows prospects a chance to get to know the agent in a group setting, but that's about it. No one walks away remembering all that stuff. If anything, they walk away in a fog. I can already tell it will be much more costly in time, and possibly gas (if you can't get them to drive across town to come into your office) to sell to even half the room, as compared to a canned presentation to 15+ people at once, which is the easy part. The work comes later. But I'm surprised there aren't more people doing the free meal shotgun approach to maximize the hourly income. People I've met at meetings say they get 15-20 telemarketing calls per day, which I've read is against the law. I haven't gotten any. I mainly get junk in the mail, and there's no way to differentiate one agent from the next. Assuming a new agent did well and wanted to keep doing it, what's the minimum numbers of year you'd recommend it takes for the overall process of getting licensed and building up referrals and residuals for the whole thing to be worth it? I'm thinking that if you start young, it's more likely worth it, making more each year. But if you're looking for part-time income after retiring from your main career, it may be too late if you're going to quit in less than 5 years and retire for good. (or die)"

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgwznXpDAJG44WTG054AaABAg.9lUZZMzAxJm9loBO8nfeFK>

"I currently work for Globe Life American Income and started about 2 months ago. Some of these comments are valid, especially about paying for licensing/training, but that's pretty standard for getting licensed in insurance anywhere. My experience personally has been very different from a lot of these comments. During training I called on my trainer's leads so he could teach me the system and help on appointments, but I was still getting paid on my own sales. It's definitely not easy money. You have to be willing to grind, make calls, book appointments, and handle rejection. Some people love that environment and some people hate it. I'm not here saying it's perfect, but I also don't think every office/agency experience is the same. Just wanted to share my honest experience so far."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlyhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/ol36w7y/

"How effective is the old lead hunting? Are you mostly personal lines? Most buyers in insurance are doing so ahead of a renewal, so your prospecting should be lined up accordingly. In personal lines and micro commercial, it's a very commoditized product where price is a majority buying driver. That space is really a numbers and efficiency game. I spend my time on commercial accounts in the \$50k-\$250k space, with a few accounts north of that. As far as reverse engineering numbers, you need to base them off your current book and then work towards going up market."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/coersjo/

"Because agents who provide renewals typically don't pay as high on first term, and also don't typically provide leads. If someone wants/needs to make more money in the short term, a captive paying 8% of first time and funneling the person quote opportunities is a much easier path. I've also seen so many producer arrangements where the person only gets renewals as long as they remain employed at the agency. If you don't actually own the book and can just be let go and lose it on a whim, that's really not something I'd put a lot of stock in."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmfyg/no_commission_on_renewals/pbaro4m/

"Our agency pays a base salary and drives every lead across the agents desk. We don't pay agents renewal commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmfyg/no_commission_on_renewals/pbexnnt/

"Tom Highway said: You should change your flag from Alabama to Colorado then! EFES is a cash flow business. If you don't manage what you spend on leads in the front end and balance the cost of leads with commission, you can quickly find yourself either in a lot of debt, or very much in the red, which is what happened to me. Yes, at a higher commission rate even, 130% of 0 sales is still 0, but the thing to factor in with EFES is that you are required to take a certain number of leads per week, at \$24 per lead, and there's around a \$300 startup cost just to get going. I think the recommended number of leads to receive per week is 20, and it doesn't take a rocket scientist to see that, at \$24 a lead, you'll be spending \$480 per week on leads received. Plus, that startup cost, which is actually little higher than \$300, but let's just call it \$300. So, from the very start, you're in for around \$780 for your startup cost (which may get you some old B leads) and your first batch of leads. If you keep receiving leads, which you have to, keep adding \$480 per week for leads received, and it'll take you less than 2 more weeks to burn through that initial \$1,500 you have set aside for leads. You can realistically spend that entire \$1,500 in a month, easily. So be aware that this is what can happen. To counter the cash flow going out, you have to get policies on the books and paid out FAST. It's not that hard to do, but if your first batch of leads are duds or something goes wrong, you'll keep digging yourself a hole that you can't get out of. On the bright side, even at an 85% contract, you'll only need about 4 sales to break even, or about \$2,000 in Annualized Premium. If you can start out with a bang and get in the black quickly, EFES is a very, very good place to be. Jdeasy is the perfect example of that, and he has been very successful there. But don't look at what he's done and expect to do that. For every Jdeasy, there are 5 people like me who got out to a slow start, maybe were not supported with the infrastructure that he had, and got burned. Am I bitter on EFES? No way. I think that, especially for someone new in the industry, having a group like this is a great way to make it. They are a class act, they are honest, and they don't hide any expectations. Some people on this board may try to shun them, but if you dig a little deeper, you may find that they're trying to recruit you for their own methods. And those methods work too; they have their own merits. EFES is a great business model, if you can make it starting out. Just understand going in that EFES is primarily in the business of selling you X number of leads per week at Y cost to you, it is in their best interest to keep the leads coming and keep the billing coming. This is not necessarily a bad thing. You definitely CAN do very well with EFES. Jdeasy certainly does, and he puts his pants on one leg at a time just like the rest of us. No reason why you can't replicate his success. OTOH, doing the mailings yourself will cost you about \$375 or so per 1,000, give or take a little bit, and it's typical to get 10-15 leads per 1,000, at best. You work the leads as you want to, and control mailouts, and, essentially, the number of leads you receive. You can get a higher commission contract, but you typically won't get any support or training. Final expense sales is not brain surgery, but it does take some solid training and there is a learning curve. If you can handle things starting out, the initial cost will be less this way, but your ability to start earning money right away may be less if you don't get as many leads. Hope this helps! And here's my question to you, jdeasy. Do you keep E&O insurance? When I first started with EFES, I was advised that it was not necessary to get E&O insurance. And Billy, if you do, you can add another \$460 or so to that startup cost, which may or may not be able to be broken down into quarterly payments, depending on the E&O carrier. Click to expand... In Ky, it is the law to have E&O or a \$20,000 bond. I chose to go with E&O from the start. Many FE agents just tdo the bond. I think the bond costs about \$200/yr. E&O costs me about \$500/yr. I believe I would have E&O even if it wasn't required. Also, with EFES, that \$24/lead is for a new agent and you can work your way to lower lead costs with production. I pay \$11/lead. Yes, 15 is the minimum they require you to buy. You can pause your leads, though. There were 5 or 6 weeks last year where I told them to not send me any leads."

— Insurance-Forums.com · EFES Vs Independent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/efes-vs-independent.17926/#post-225456>

"billy said: Denver, Colorado - - - - - I think I am being realistic in budgeting for business costs. I have a few thousand to put into leads, though I would expect to only need about 1,500 before it all becomes self funding. Click to expand... You should change your flag from Alabama to Colorado then! EFES is a cash flow business. If you don't manage what you spend on leads in the front end and balance the cost of leads with commission, you can quickly find yourself either in a lot of debt, or very much in the red, which is what happened to me. Yes, at a higher commission rate even, 130% of 0 sales is still 0, but the thing to factor in with EFES is that you are required to take a certain number of leads per week, at \$24 per lead, and there's around a \$300 startup cost just to get going. I think the recommended number of leads to receive per week is 20, and it doesn't take a rocket scientist to see that, at \$24 a lead, you'll be spending \$480 per week on leads received. Plus, that startup cost, which is actually little higher than \$300, but let's just call it \$300. So, from the very start, you're in for around \$780 for your startup cost (which may get you some old B leads) and your first batch of leads. If you keep receiving leads, which you have to, keep adding \$480 per week for leads received, and it'll take you less than 2 more weeks to burn through that initial \$1,500 you have set aside for leads. You can realistically spend that entire \$1,500 in a month, easily. So be aware that this is what can happen. To counter the cash flow going out, you have to get policies on the books and paid out FAST. It's not that hard to do, but if your first batch of leads are duds or something goes wrong, you'll keep digging yourself a hole that you can't get out of. On the bright side, even at an 85% contract, you'll only need about 4 sales to break even, or about \$2,000 in Annualized Premium. If you can start out with a bang and get in the black quickly, EFES is a very, very good place to be. Jdeasy is the perfect example of that, and he has been very successful there. But don't look at what he's done and expect to do that. For every Jdeasy, there are 5 people like me who got out to a slow start, maybe were not supported with the infrastructure that he had, and got burned. Am I bitter on EFES? No way. I think that, especially for someone new in the industry, having a group like this is a great way to make it. They are a class act, they are honest, and they don't hide any expectations. Some people on this board may try to shun them, but if you dig a little deeper, you may find that they're trying to recruit you for their own methods. And those methods work too; they have their own merits. EFES is a great business model, if you can make it starting out. Just understand going in that EFES is primarily in the business of selling you X number of leads per week at Y cost to you, it is in their best interest to keep the leads coming and keep the billing coming. This is not necessarily a bad thing. You definitely CAN do very well with EFES. Jdeasy certainly does, and he puts his pants on one leg at a time just like the rest of us. No reason why you can't replicate his success. OTOH, doing the mailings yourself will cost you about \$375 or so per 1,000, give or take a little bit, and it's typical to get 10-15 leads per 1,000, at best. You work the leads as you want to, and control mailouts, and, essentially, the number of leads you receive. You can get a higher commission contract, but you typically won't get any support or training. Final expense sales is not brain surgery, but it does take some solid training and there is a learning curve. If you can handle things starting out, the initial cost will be less this way, but your ability to start earning money right away may be less if you don't get as many leads. Hope this helps! And here's my question to you, jdeasy. Do you keep E&O insurance? When I first started with EFES, I was advised that it was not necessary to get E&O insurance. And Billy, if you do, you can add another \$460 or so to that startup cost, which may or may not be able to be broken down into quarterly payments, depending on the E&O carrier."

— Insurance-Forums.com · EFES Vs Independent · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/efes-vs-independent.17926/#post-225426>

"Real_AMG said: Nobody said you needed to write D-SNP to sell 12 months a year. I'm suggesting that you felt the need to undermine this thread with that T-65 comment because you are insecure that your book is small. So just to clarify: - Yes, not all agents sell D-SNP. - No, the fact that you don't sell D-SNP doesn't mean you have a small book. - Yes, the fact that you feel the need to undermine anybody talking about the D-SNP market positively suggests the fact that you are insecure about having a small BoB. Click to expand... Again, you should check your assumptions at the door. I don't undermine anyone talking positively about marketing DSNP. Maybe if you'd use more than a second grade reading comprehension, you'd be able to read where I actually say God love people that work DSNP their go to product, because I don't want to.... Meaning I'm glad others serve this niche, because I don't. That's not "undermining" DSNP, or anyone that markets them. It's saying you don't have to sell it to work year round. Whipping out the BoB line shows some pretty significant immaturity on your end. On my end, I turn business away that I don't want to deal with. If I was truly insecure about my book, I'd write every piece of garbage that came across my desk. Just because I understand your reading comprehension is poor, I'm not saying DSNP is garbage... I'm saying that I don't have to write everyone that CALLS ME (because I don't chase for work) which invalidates your very misinformed assumption that I'm insecure about my book."

— Insurance-Forums.com · 3 Reasons To Focus On DSNP · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/3-reasons-to-focus-on-dsnp.107363/#post-1407311>

Tab 5 — Frustrations

MLMs and captive agencies that recruit on promises · 156 documents · 20 voices

"Recently accepted a job with Globe Life Hi, I'm working on getting my life/health License. I just got accepted to sell insurance for American Income Life, a subsidiary of Globe Life. Has anyone done this and can let me know if this is the right move to start my insurance journey? I'll be selling life insurance to union workers and they said all my leads are from the workers filling out their info so they should be waiting for a call so seems like an easy sell. I'd love some insight to anyone that knows what I'm getting into or has first hand experience working with this company. Update: I accepted the job but next day I called and cancelled. Never spent a day working for Globe Life."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 114 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Warning: Globe Life Zuzick I was "hired" by these people after watching a prerecorded video and waiting for 45 minutes in an empty breakout room. Red flags from the beginning. I went through with getting my license that week and scheduled for a group training call. Towards the end of the call, the leader was explaining how we must respect the CEOs time and must have the contracts signed BEFORE he talks to us and welcomes us to the team. She then gives us a 7 page contract and less than 5 minutes to sign. Everyone signs without reading. I tried to read thru it before he joined, but didn't make it. She called me out on the call saying they're still waiting on me. I just turned my cam off and kept reading. Pressuring kids into signing a contract is super unethical and should be illegal. I knew I would find nuggets of garbage after this pressure. Sure enough, I did. The only reason why I was going to let them take 70% of my commission was because they said they provided leads for free. Funny, the contract says: we do not guarantee that you will receive any leads. I also was wondering how no one has ever written poorly of this branch online. There was a clause in there that says you may not say anything negative about our company once signed. Is that even allowed? I ghosted them and have been getting spammed with emails and texts as if I am still with them. Sad to see, taking advantage of people in desperate times."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mnj1p8/warning_globe_life_zuzick/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a lack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. Anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group — Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilty like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtq3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"This is absolutely ridiculous that he's pushing for the end of it with no replacement. People are going to be left high and dry having to try to figure this out, and insurance agents trying to figure out something to patch their clients into. I think he's going to try to give everybody money and then promote some type of scammy health sharing something that he has a stake in."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pfvb1f/looks_like_aca_wont_be_extended_and_were_moving/nsmnfkp/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gat2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] (https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircjl/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"Is this against AIL or Globe Life in general because I worked for the Liberty National division and if it's a class action lawsuit against globe, I would love to become a part of it."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m75jzrt/

"Ahh I see what you mean. Is the agent sure that this "lead generator" isn't working hand in hand with the litigant? I mean, talk about top notch scam. Having one of those companies over seas and being the litigant here in the US then splitting the wins."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjususk/

"Overall there's just less chatter about Medicare here. I feel like majority of users in this sub are P&C agents, followed closely by the MLM Life Insurance folk. Could just be a demographic thing. Reddit users tend to be of the younger generations and maybe the majority of Medicare reps are all chatting in those cesspool Facebook groups."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n565vur/

Leads that are old, fake, shared or never answer · 125 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C%266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: I Industry I Description I I --- I --- I Tech I You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. I Med I You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. I Finance/Insurance I You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. I Hardware/Construction I Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. I Cars I You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. I Door to Door I Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. I JOB TITLE I PAY RANGE (Salary) I PAY RANGE (OTE) I DESCRIPTION** I I --- I --- I --- I SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) I £25,000 - £40,000 I £50,000 - £80,000 I Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. I SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive I £30,000 - £60,000 I £50,000 - £140,000 I Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. I MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive I £40,000 - £75,000 I £60,000 - £150,000 I Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. I ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive I £50,000 - £100,000 I £70,000 - £250,000 I Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. I SALES MANAGER I £60,000 - £120,000 I £80,000 - £200,000 I Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. I MD: Managing Director I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. I HEAD OF SALES I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. I Terminology I Description I I --- I --- I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. I Lead I This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. I Account I This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. I Contact I This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. I Example of a lead, a contact and an account. I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1tqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if i had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgwyw8/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Journaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use journaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"I sell 50 to 60 per month during SEP over the phone. Buy good leads, know your product knowledge, and hold a strong frame. It's not that difficult."

— YouTube · How To Sell 1 Medicare Policy Daily! [The Complete Blueprint] · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TVurscsjKY&lc=UgxANMbmPTXjNqAhxx4AaABAq>

↳ @scotpederson5932 (2): "what is your out of pocket costs per month for the leads?"

↳ @lidianaredeemed9848 (0): "I am taking Ahlp exam Monday. My challenge is finding the right agency or do it independently FMO. I just need someone to guide me"

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"I would love to have a sit down with John about this. This is such amazing advice. I'm an agent through a captive agency in NY and I have been having such a tough time, with what I thought was leads. My problem isn't that I can't get people to answer, my problem continues to be no shows and I feel like I'm stuck in that "hamster wheel" where I've called the leads to oblivion and have a tough time booking those. Mind you, some of the leads I'm given are 6 or 7 years old where we're told to, "throw them against the wall and see what sticks." I'm going to implement this more aggressive calling method and see how it helps. Thank you so much."

— YouTube · How To Work Insurance Leads Like A Pro! (Cody Askins & John Wetmore) · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nf_TnViVIs&lc=Ugy_-op6VjG4LLmRuwN4AaABAq

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"Turning 65 leads Medicare New agent need a few leads to get the hopper working. Tried data brokers old and tired lists. Just need like 4-10 sales a month. Passed the tests. With 12 carriers. Need to get the phone ringing. Independent. Who do I pay to get real leads. Can't be a secret."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only recieve direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leas, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤨"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj4uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"I work with Symmetry. I like it as an independent IMO. I buy only new leads generated in real time so that doesn't line with my experience. Value leads range from weeks to years. I've never seen a value lead over 3 years old. Culture does depend what agency you're with, sounds like you were in a bad one. I've owned my business for 3.5 years so not sure what happened wherever you were at. Conferences are optional but beneficial. Again sounds like your experience is much different than mine and I'm going on year four. How long were you there? National has descent training and good agencies have their own too, we have for over a year. Sorry your experience stunk. Did you reach out to corporate and use their mediation team? Even if that door is closed reach out because corporate may be able to help train your former up-lines. Alignment is key. Glad you found a better solution for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/mrtbkig/

CMS rules, commission caps and carrier cuts · 74 documents · 20 voices

"Let's remember what selling health was like pre-ACA Before 2010, I was running a rather large individual health insurance agency. Jan 2010 literally put me out of business overnight as commissions evaporated. I looked at my wife and said "well, this all needed to change." Commission rocked. 25% average on the front, 5% renewals on average. \$400/mo premium = \$1,200. Market was everyone that didn't have group. We could even pull people off group. Although highly unethical, it happened all the time. 1. Declines for all major health conditions. Diabetes? Decline. Heart? Decline. 2. Ratings or waivers/riders for every other health condition you can imagine. HBP, Asthma, etc...rated 25% to 50% or the condition was excluded from coverage. Some more mild conditions might have only resulted in a drug waiver. 3. Post claims underwriting. No carrier pulled medical records or MIB reports. Instead, they waited until they filed a claim. Any misrepresentation on the app resulted in either a denial of that claim or a policy rescission. For auto, imagine no one checked anything; no DMV report, didn't run their license and only did that when they went to file a claim, then cancelled the policy. 4. Fraud was everywhere. Agents knew they wouldn't get paid for putting conditions/meds on the app, so they excluded them. I was trained by Mega Life to never list health conditions. Tough conversations with newly self-employed people. Many simply could not get covered. People who had direct control over their health, like smokers I had little sympathy for. People with conditions out of their control? Horrible phone calls."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are *a ton* of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill".** From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects "yet"? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"ACA Shit-Show I am recently getting leads and I am using Health Sherpa for enrollments. I just came across a few clients who had 70 + writing agents ! Like WTF. Is this a data bresch , scam or what. In some cases I would actually call the person and they seem clueless about it when I would tell them you marketplace profile looks like a brothel with agents cocking each other. Secondly how does this effect their tax returns, since most of them are somehow enrolled in two three market place plans, all with premium subsidy applied, which as far as I know doesn't work like that. My question is should I presume such leads? Should I tell them to call CMS and report ? Or just ignore such customers. I feel like my inner conscious doesn't let it go I feel like I should help these people, because is most cases they are unaware."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/

"Medicare Agent Commissions I have a question for fellow Medicare agents. With carriers pulling commissions what are your plans to pivot to keep business alive? My clients and new individuals turning 65 still are in such need for help navigating through the weeds of the whole system along with their plan choices but working for free just can't go on. We have a higher MS clientele rate but now with those rates skyrocketing I'm concerned there will be a shift towards MAPD which a lot are going non-commissionable. Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out. What are you all doing to stay alive?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/

"I was briefly on cms webinar discussing rollout of new MC plan finder systems starting oct 1st, and its complete overhaul. For PDP specifically, you will no longer have access to your clients old drug list I'd #s and password dates to bring up their list of past medications. It is part of legacy system and will NOT transfer over. If wanted, all clients will have to register a MC.gov account and list the medications inside their MC portal. What a disaster coming"

— Insurance-Forums.com · New medicare.gov plan finder 2020 · 7 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/new-medicare-gov-plan-finder-2020-99130/#post-1312254>

"PDP's barely paid much to begin with, it's honestly not that big of a deal. Also, MOST of the non commissioned MAPD's are made that way because carriers are either about to sunset them anyway or they actively don't want you to sell that plan. Until a carrier makes their premier plan non commissioned, I wouldnt worry. My book is doing just fine"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msu3ukc/

"I'd personally look into medical sales. I have several friends in the industry and they're all killing it. Medicare It's very competitive and saturated at this point. Turning 65's are bombarded with hundreds of mailers, phone calls, emails, etc. Every AEP, same exact thing. 90% of the call centers arent CMS compliant. It's just a shit show honestly. On top of that...with the new CMS legislation, call centers will be basically nonexistent same with many IMO/FMO's due to the money being taken away, so there is no incentive for IMO/FMO to hire anyone since they can't make overrides."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b3t4hx/been_out_of_the_medicare_sales_game_for_2_years/ksvi9cr/

"You are touching on a really hot topic. I hope my answers help: CMS is basically about to say in simple terms: **"No sharing the overrides, those are strictly for marketing expenses and actual MARKETING resources"**. The issue has been most FMO's have been utilizing this override as part of their compensation agreements with their downline agencies. **"THUS FAR, FMO's who are utilizing their overrides as a critical component to the comp, their downline agents and agencies are at risk. Those who are not doing this, remain safe"**. Had a talk with a major insurance carrier about 3 weeks ago on the topic, they personally attended the CMS talks and did not see any indicators that FMO's were going to be "abolished" in any way. Agents ***will*** be impacted by the budget structure changes of their uplines ***if their uplines were not utilizing these funds how they were intended in the first place***. _____ MAPD overrides will be dependent on the deal with the carrier, some as much as \$200-300/policy approval (Which has a renewal amount that is lower as well). They organize this based on how much production and the rapport the upline has built with the carrier. This does not include our share in the actual commission itself, we personally keep our commission share as small as possible because our philosophy is to guide agents to independence and give them the best contracts as opposed to spoon feeding them leads \[or God-forbid SELLING them leads\], we stay out of that, and rather train agents to develop their own leads and their own business and give the comp that demands that level of input. Our big agencies, maybe we make like 2-3% on what they sell, our brand new agents, as much as 20% and move them up from there based on production. (Again, that \$200-300 should be being spent on administrative support and marketing in support of FMO function, and not as a spiff to agents. We spiff using the commission difference, NOT the override.) _____ Terms like MGA and GA are designed purposely to be arbitrary so that by you saying that, I won't be able to tell you what kind of deal you have unless you disclosed the carrier. That being said, it would be beyond my ability to disclose those kinds of specifics as it would mean breaking some non-disclosure agreements we have with Carriers. What I can say is that I've seen GA be the lowest contract possible, and I've also seen it be one of the highest contracts possible. Same with MGA. Your upline is most likely making anywhere from 3-20% on your commission + the override they receive. This is why your FMO should be business critical, they need to be providing the value of anyone in the office who is sharing in that commission, from administrative to marketing to educational resources, to keeping their finger on the pulse of the market to your benefit. Hold them accountable to those services!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b6ebes/i_work_for_an_nmo_ask_me_anything/ktcmhjh/

"You can actually call CMS directly (email is better) and they actually can give real answers that are detailed. Its how i learned the ACA part so much, and also how i do so well. Rather than assume, its better to ask. CMS is cracking down on ACA a lot, with some new things like the whole recording needing to be sent and no longer the snippet for compliance (a LOT of agencies were doing this)."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1b6ebes/i_work_for_an_nmo_ask_me_anything/ktew87g/

"Most likely Universal and Whole Life downsell to Final Expense, which I think is pretty standard. We will be launching Annuities pretty quickly though. Great to know about 110%+ uncapped. I am so bullish on providing free leads to Agents, but only if they show up to training sessions and maintaining a certain close rate. Month 1 is going to be about onboarding, building local presence/credibility, SEO and branding. This will both help create quick wins and filter out unreliable Agents before our real investment begins. Agents are also required to attend every training session (twice per week). Month 2, onward: Access to the inbound call platform. In order to maintain access, Agents will need to either close 4 policies per month or attend 4 training sessions per month. If Agents aren't closing deals, we need to know they are at least motivated to by showing up for training. Thanks for your advice. It's much appreciated."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p7ouj4/starting_my_own_life_insurance_agency_i_have/nr2ydud/

"I am partnered with a tax office, and we have been running into people getting penalties for not having proper coverage. Most of these clients have been getting switched out each month by their telesales agents. I plan to sit with the clients on calls with Healthcare.gov and CMS and report every single one of these assholes that are doing this. The most recent one owes over \$1,500 in penalties. I am all for heavier ethics standards and stronger disciplinary action to stop agents from taking advantage of unsuspecting clients. The first step I would want to see is abolishing the tele sales agent. I feel like most telesales agents care for the clients' needs as good as they should because they don't have good symbiotic relationships with their book of business."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/kuo7i2d/

"Appreciate the context! That helps me understand it better. Sounds like you're saying this is might be more of a market correction or rough patch than a permanent decline for agents. I've heard some of the chatter around UHC's situation but didn't realize it was that bad. Curious, do you think the carriers pulling commissions now might bring them back "if" the plans become profitable again? Or is that just wishful thinking and the trend toward no commissions is here to stay? And yeah, I agree...it feels like ACA/Medicaid are way more vulnerable, but hard to predict where this all ends up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n563vtn/

"I think the liability issue isn't talked about enough! It's ridiculous that CMS doesn't want "incentive-based steering" on MA plans, so they put a cap on broker commissions. All that does is create more incentive-based steering in the opposite direction. CMS should enforce a minimum commission on MA plans as a back stop. That could still create incentive-based steering, so the best answer would just be flat commissions for any MA plan across the board."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1woc7yr/for_mapd_brokers_who_is_still_writing_uhc_and/pbmk9jh/

"Learning Medicare sales and compliance is the most headache inducing part of it. More experienced agents tell me getting complaints from CMS are the most frustrating. You are dealing with old people that typically don't remember what you say or totally misinterpret plans. They can also have bad hearing. These agents always win."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mwee78/besides_compliance_what_is_the_most_tedious_part/n9wtgpi/

"So, you are saying this won't impact your business? MedicareMillionair said: I want to address our ACA No Call Leads system and the confusion it has created. As a leader in this market we've drawn a lot of attention and we've taken a lot of heat. There have been untruths posted about this system, even on this forum. The funny part of that is these same people have contracted agents that previously worked with us to help create their systems. They change a couple things and then say we don't know what we are doing. Below are a couple points to make regarding NoCall Leads and our system. Our competitors state we are not compliant, this is their ignorance to the rules. We are 100% compliant and this has been proven with our interactions with CMS. We write thousands of deals every week. We've received several inquiries from CMS regarding our business practices. We have addressed these inquiries and been given their blessing. The individuals insinuating we are not compliant are simply ignorant to the rules or, as I suspect, simply working a marketing angle. (these guys don't know what they are doing, so do business with us) Things will change, but we don't know what the changes will be. Recent HHS proposals have been focused more so on DACA Recipients, Transgender Reassignment, Hormone Therapy, Gender Discrimination, but very little in the way of changing the enrollment rules. Having said this, there are items under consideration that will affect what we do. Regarding potential changes, the biggest changes that will affect this system are elimination of electronic consent to enroll, the requirement of all documentation with submission of application. Regarding documentation needed to submit applications; Healthcare.gov does not require all information to be submitted with the application. They want Americans to get access to health insurance immediately. Many of the people insured on zero premium plans don't have the very basics of their information available. That's why they are given time to produce this information. That's why it's compliant to submit applications without this information. What's the biggest issue? AGENTS are the biggest problem regarding this system. The only complaints we've received have been from agents and these go away immediately. The only people complaining about our system on the internet are agents. Agents will create the issues for other agents, not the consumer. This is reminiscent of the foolish agents/gurus, that for many years, said "Don't sell Medicare Advantage or you might lose your license". That was a big lie and only hurt agents. By the way, most of those agents now market or sell MAPD. They certainly provide it to their downline. We are insuring tens of thousands of people. Many of these people would not be insured without us. Our agents are earning tens of thousands of dollars every month. We are quite content to push forward. Click to expand..."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA - NoCall Leads Compliance · 2 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-nocall-leads-compliance.110703/#post-1455769>

"That's not a lead vendor, That's a criminal accomplice! marketing companies are not allowed to take personal client information give quotes etc... What you just described is **not** Lead generation. Its marketed as "pre sold policies by shady dudes in facebook groups" and its illegal.. If an agent doesn't know that they deserve to lose their license. There is no way this was surprising to him. he knew what was happening.. he paid more for this "service" specifically because he is Lazy..... There are in fact marketing companies that want to sell legitimate CMS/ carrier compliant leads and inbound calls. They do exist. You never interact with them because you are a professional litigator on the DNC list . Legitimate companies pay money for subscriptions like this <https://www.dnc.com/dncscrub/> and make api calls to stay DNC compliant. Those same API calls check Professional Litigator lists, which you are likely on..Any one who can afford \$300 per month and knows how to call an API will make sure they never call you. The only marketing companies you ever interact with are the Bad ones... here is the medicare manuals <https://www.cms.gov/medicare/health-drug-plans/managed-care-marketing/medicare-guidelines> As you can see this is COMPLICATED. Many Insurance brokers choose to outsource marketing because there is a lot of rules to follow here. Some companies Aka "third party" marketing companies offer a legitimate service to insurance brokers , allowing them to legally outsource marketing.. just like very other industry. Some agents do get deceived by shady companies. many don't even think to ask marketers , "how do you check DNC /TCPA? how do you generate leads or data? "what qualifications do you use to turn data into a lead? how many people are you selling this data to? What liability do you have regarding DNC/TCPA violations? These are all legitimate questions any legitimate marketer will have no problem answering.. Keep up being a professional litigator. get the Bad apples out of the industry. you should put up a you tube channel like Coffeezilla. I bet it would be more entertaining than the most insurance industry content.. i think it would be helpful for a lot of agents if you posted content of this stuff. Its the dark underbelly that many agents never see.. they get pitched an offer that's too good to be true.. and well it is..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nl7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nf78cv7/

"Thank you for all the comments! I understand this isn't necessarily "fun" work, but after spending 50+ hours per week at car dealerships for most of the last 20 years, having the ability to make a living while traveling and spending time with loved ones is my primary goal now that my kids are self-sufficient. I also appreciate the ability to earn money through helping people as corny as that may sound, but the older I get and more corruption I see, the more morality shapes my motivations. Does anyone have experience with TAIA? They have 2 roles, fully independent or telesales broker where they pay 50% CMS commission and give you free call transfers. I don't know if they pay renewals on free call transfer leads, but pretty sure they aren't vested to you. But this seems somewhat fair overall. I realize partnering with a small independent FMO (or a few if possible) is probably the way to go long term, but to gain initial experience, learn the landscape, and start making decent money right away, this sounded like it might be a decent option to start. I do have digital marketing/lead gen experience from my time managing dealerships, but I also know how expensive it can be as they require constant testing. Spending thousands of dollars to target a landscape I'm not 100% familiar with, isn't a smart investment. So to start, I'm looking to partner with a FMO that has a successful system in place that provides ample opportunity. I'm considering speaking with TAIA to see if I could sign up as a telesales broker but still keep the renewals (and a higher %) on any self generated business. Any other comments or ideas would be appreciated! As far as transitioning to P&C, focus on Life or other lines, sure, maybe I will try that if this doesn't workout, but I have too much time, money and effort invested at this point not to give this a shot. I have 17 state licenses, E&O, AHIP & CMS FFM, so yeah..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofcscz0/

"Just a back story on my thought process....Market factors and the price offered was hard to pass up. I am in an area of the country where insurance carriers are trying to decrease capacity and they do not want our business. I also had 40 percent of our revenue with one carrier and that carrier is also pulling back in our area. I had three carriers pull out of my agency as well 12 months leading to the sell. After the sell Helene destroyed my area so the market has gotten even worse. Once I sold to PE I realized the leverage they have that I didn't have. My agency was a nice size (2.5 million in rev) but a 1 million book with a carrier isn't what it used to be in an unprofitable area. I have a commitment to my family and this allowed me to achieve my dream as well. If I am an idiot I could run through all my money but at the moment I am comfortable with no debt and a lot of zeros in my account. I did agree to a three year contract known as a work out to get even more money on top of the initial offer. So far I have gotten 1/3 of the additional money. I am hoping to get the remaining 2/3 and then evaluate what I want to do next. If they treat me fairly I may continue but time will tell. Also...If another hurricane hits my area this year or even next I suspect we are heading towards a Florida scenario. I am too old and too burned out to have to tackle that type of marketplace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kr7bqt/pc_agency_owners/mtgh4s0/

"> If an unsolicited caller calls you to ask you if you have Medicare Part A & Part B, they are marketing Medicare Advantage 10 times out of 10, I guarantee it. I would agree. My landline number is 40+ years old, attached to my dad's name who would be 77 this year. >Interesting thing about those calls is that in addition to the other rules they're violating, they're also uncompliant per CMS guidelines. What is CMS? >Unsolicited contacts to Medicare beneficiaries are strictly prohibited and a document called a "Scope of Appointment" must be signed prior to having a sales call with a Medicare beneficiary. So if I have a video of this, who should I be reporting this to? Which regulatory body? >Medicare numbers are 11 digits, a combination of letters and number. The letter "O" never appears in them, only the number "zero". Feigning as if you have a disability and a Medicare number might get you transferred to the live agent in the states, and that would be the party responsible for the violation. I feign that I have my dad's power of attorney and they NEVER connect. I put on a 3 pack a day gravelly sam elliot voice and it connects every time."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n90qwcw/

Bait-and-switch marketing ('free' benefits, 'free' policies) · 32 documents · 20 voices

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

"Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7vk9p/

"What in the actual fuck is happening in this industry. (ACA) Overused milked leads, marketplace looking like a brothel, people being promised subsidy cards, free grocery cards, nothing short than being promised a free Mercedes-Benz which I'm sure someone has been already promised. That being said, a great company I'm with, but holy cow man, what an actual cess-pool of agents just circle jerking each other with ol miss Emmy Lou in Lagrange, Mississippi's market-place profile. Luckily I have a 80% closing ratio on getting them to lock me down as their agent for 365. I love it"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j5cd0q/what_in_the_actual_fuck_is_happening_in_this/

"I often wonder if homeowners vehemently complain so much that their home valuations went up so much in recent years. *Surely* not..... And the prices of vehicles haven't gone up dramatically since the turn of the century so insurance should be the same as a quarter century ago! Never mind a new or used car price off the lot. Let's pretend it is not much more likely total out a vehicle due to the engineering, complexity and expensive replacement parts have remained the same too. Health insurance is going up??? It's not like anyone is reporting how much healthcare costs have been outpacing inflation for decades... I am a cheap SOB personally. My wife is constantly telling me to shush when I gripe at prices while grocery shopping since Covid. But it actually is reality. Everything has gone up noticeably. Insurance is no different."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qqrxtx/but_i_havent_had_any_claims/o2li6s6/

"I agree. Im an agent that handles every Medicare plan thats offered. MAPD, Supplements, and PDP. MAPD plans can work great for some people. Every single person is different and this video is misleading."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyZgiHmgfpQS0R9PLJ4AaABA9.9Z9YeUZ.eQye9ZCdRG0fPuf>

"Why I think you are a crummy agent: 1) Supplement plans in my state go for \$220 per month, plus the drug card at \$35 per month. That's over \$3,000 per year paid in premium WITHOUT FAIL! 2) Most Advantage plans have a \$0 premium with reasonable co-pays and no deductibles. 3) Although extremely unlikely, the maximum out of pocket could be as low as \$4,500. This compares favorably to the fixed out of pocket cost for a supplement of \$3,060. 4) Catch up with the times! Many Advantage plans are PPOs, which allow the enrollee to see any provider who takes Medicare. 5) You have to carry around only one card....only one party to call when there is an issue. With the supplement, you have to handle your Medicare card, the supplement card, and the drug card. Good luck getting to the right people. 6) Advantage plans offer extra stuff that isn't covered by Medicare nor its supplement. Dental, eye care, hearing aids, fitness memberships, Over the Counter items, flex cards to augment the Dental/Vision/Hearing, etc. 7) Even some HMOs, like Aetna, do not require a referral to an "in network" provider. BTW, I have been a Medicare agent for 10 years and have NEVER received a call from one of my clients complaining about a lack of a qualified specialist in the area. So, Mr. Expert, be careful the next time you say the word "NEVER". In the vast majority of situations, an Advantage plan is a much better deal to the consumer. About the only time a supplement is preferred is when the enrollee is on a Part B medication.....very rare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzJjwcvLoaOA_tfivB4AaABA9

↳ @3121813 (1): "Many high end hospitals in California will not take advantage plans C supplemental coverage plans anymore they only accept A@B with D prescription coverage and G supplemental. Never get supplemental C advantage plans you will be denied medical care at many hospitals."

"Really depends on what kind man but I wish I knew how disgustingly vile the industry was and how disgustingly stupid medicare advantage clients are. I tried to be a knight. I really really did and got shit on over and over. Im still fully compliant but if Agnus wants the worst medical coverage I have ever seen in order to get a grocery card im sighning her up Had plenty of people turn down the beat coverage in their area because it didnt have a giveback or card and even one where EVERYTHING was better but he would lose just 20 bucks on his giveback, thats it. Save 100's on his meds and seeing doctors and great out of pocket too Still said nah over the 20. If theres a really good policy I see but it'd be humana hmo to humana hmo so I wont get paid I aint talking about it. The very very very few times when I ask about medical needs or coverage and they actually tell me something im more than happy to find best i can offer but that NEVER happens. Its always oh idk oh you tell me.which obviously I cant tell you. Maybe 2 of 300 conversations are about actual medical needs or concerns. I also see TONS that dont even know they were switched recently or pending a switch or any of that and when they say they didn't know I fully beleive them because the checked out ones or no medical decision ones I bang on anyway"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62oxd3/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps 😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

"You can still sell medicare this AEP. You'll need to approach it as a field agent. You can set up an educational kiosk anywhere you can get permission where there's consistent senior foot traffic, like grocery stores. You can go visit a local networking group like a BNI and share how you can help folks and ask for referrals. You can introduce yourself to 64 year olds who aren't on Medicare yet but who likely have questions about the process - keeping the conversation education for compliance - by using the T65 Locator app in the App Store. Cold calling seniors during AEP was always and is always a plague in our society, fucking leeches. Go do the best you can and after AEP you can change your contracts to another FMO who supports healthy field agent marketing activities."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ofi9mo/i_was_a_1099_agent_and_got_terminated_today/nlat6zf/

"My advice with these people, before you do anything see if they have an SEP. I know you're in open enrollment but for future reference. If they don't, go immediately to your SEP questions. If you don't have anything end the call. If they want an increase to their food card or giveback, filter them in Sunfire and find whatever has that specific thing that's higher than what they have. Pitch the increased benefits, if they bite great, if they don't move to the next thing that's better. Most of these people have no intentions of signing so get them off the phone fast. It's a numbers game."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1idj71g/i_sold_my_first_medicare_policy/ma31xog/

"Having to explain that disclaimers don't apply to 100% of beneficiaries (for example Part D IRMAA). Having to explain that not every beneficiary will have plans in their area that offer benefits/be eligible for benefits like the Part B giveback or a grocery card, even though they may see it advertised. On the flip side, I love being able to educate beneficiaries on resources like Extra Help, or the Medicare Savings Program so that they can get additional help."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mwee78/besides_compliance_what_is_the_most_tedious_part/na0iqqz/

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 000000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at AIL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"The problem with Globe life is that it can be really good or really bad depending on your branch and manager. Im working with them for about a month and is ok, the leads are from unions so the people that I call they requested so is not that invasive as a cold call. the thing about push people products is kinda a sale thing no matter the field, one thing that works for me is focus on the no cost benefits and just works as I'm hooking people up, be honest to them, if they say they don't want anything do a good deed and give them whatever free benefit you have, as long as they have your contact if one day they need something they gonna call that dude that hooked them up. Also I don't think is a good type of job if you a desperate for money since in the beginning it sucks, they give you old leads since they don't want you to burn bridges with new clients but as soon as you start to book appointments the leads get better, but it take time and lots of calls. I'm not a native english speaker and although I was scared about calling people, as long as you are nice and respectful they will be nice to you. I even make sure to let the ones that dont want to be bothered to know that I will make sure to exclude them from the leads so they wont get calls again, they really appreciate. So before you look for a new company, no matter which one you go, you gotta found a good branch and team, that's gonna make a huge difference, in the end of the day they are all the same. Also, the ones that offers some salary usually sucks in the commission, at least in my case the commission from the get go is already 50% so is not that bad. try to get a normal job, save some money to be good for a couple months and then try again... not having the pressure to have to make money ASAP can makes things easier on you. Good luck."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/mra1242/

"FYI I'm a health insurance broker and he or she is misleading you on your application with the state. The issue is this: "Married" but file "Seperately". The IRS will pick up that you are receiving a subsidy and could audit you to pay back the subsidy through either your own will or through your paycheck. Take your pick. Here's the issue per the application the Feds or Marketplace want to know if someone else is living under the same roof and that income is now implemented into the "household" income. I do not know your tax situation but if you are both W2 it would be harder to get the subsidy but if both self-employed that could be a game changer."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/pbo7nn1/

"im not gonna say nothing to those claims. i don't work with those so i can't offer an opinion on how that works. i have no experience. but just as you've already said- there's gonna be a crap ton of bad reviews online, don't pay no mind you havta figure out what works for you. i work with globe, my particular agency doesn't "switch bait" as we don't handle child safety kits. we work a specialized lead that mentions burial, life insurance etc. cant mislead when it's right there in black and white print."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/jy8xirm/

"There were a few really well thought out responses to your BS so I don't try to 1up those. I'll be the typical social media response to tell you that YOU'RE the problem with America and directly contributing to hurting small businesses. You're not hurting the carrier because they aren't putting their actual money on the line. They pay commissions to tiny little mom and pop insurance agents just trying to feed their kids working 60 hour weeks then they had to deal with sharky lawyers and evil people like you to wreck their lives potentially. I can guarantee all of those 100 calls you claim to get from insurance agents were not just random spam calls. You absolutely at some point put your number in a list to get quotes on a website, credit karma, playing a game, etc just to bait them via the lead companies. You think you're doing some sort of social justice when in reality you're the actual scammer on the other line. I pray you find Jesus because there will be lots of people like you in hell."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n907j5r/

"I agree with you wholeheartedly! I went into thinking about helping older people and making sure they were getting everything they needed. The real job was pushing food cards and flex cards. I felt gross after a while quit. Hard sales to the elderly that don't understand their own needs and knowing someone was likely to poach my hard work. No thanks."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gz0ref/medicare_enrollment_tools/lytogna/

"wow, i am feeling almost everything you wrote, just have not been doing it as long. The leads that come in feel a bit unethical to me. Medicare needs you to call ASAP! Get \$2000 in grocery money! And all the affiliate leads. This is not at all what I thought it would be."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1ewgfvz/i_need_some_advice_or_something_im_struggling_im/lmdahg/v/

"Honestly this is the case for all Inbound leads. I've tried them and got tired of the bait and switch marketing that would cause callers to assume the policies were "free". Not worth the hassle and chargebacks."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u9pr90/ringba_leads_through_integrity_connect_are_a_scam/osij5z6/

Inbound calls and transfers from offshore call centers · 17 documents · 17 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Have you ever considered, you know, actually generating your own leads with community engagement in a niche market? Seriously... It works. I have done it for nine years. Wouldn't even know where to get a lead that was purchased if I tried. Also, thank God this is happening. The number of spam calls I get per day is undodly and they interrupt my actual calls from call waiting. I hope all the overseas scammers shrivel up and go back to the holes they came from. I am tired of trying to tell my mom that I did not go to mexico and will never be kidnapped there, she does not have a tax debt, and her Amazon order doesn't exist. Most of the time she is fine, and sends me an 'lol you are not in Mexico getting robbed are you?' text. But I know the day is coming when that fails and I will be very grateful if it comes after this happens."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/mx7qg7x/

"Don't buy leads from overseas!? Next you'll tell me not to send apple gift cards to the county sheriff with an Indian accent looking for me."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjvobq2/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"I did a lot of outbound when I was younger, but I eventually went to inbound. I never made close to 100k until I started working inbound. Being self aware is key. I know what my strengths are and I know my weaknesses are I could pay someone 2 to 3 dollars an hour in the Philippines or somewhere to dial for me if I had to why wasting my time calling there are so many more effective ways. I know it works, but I think it's just going to get more more difficult. I realized I'm much stronger at closing and consulting than I am at prospecting. Even when I owned my own business I used inbound marketing. It took a long time but it was way more effective. I utilize my website and I was able to get to the first page of Google. SEO and constant content. It did take over a year and a half in the meantime I had to buy Leads unfortunately Covid hit and I had to close my business, but it wasn't an insurance or financial services which is way more difficult because of compliance."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmt560/reluctance_to_dial/pba8wsg/

"I am a Medicare Insurance Agent and Broker in Indiana - Your explanation of MA vs Supp is wonderful and aligns with my style. Good luck next month fellow Agents - ITS ALMOST TIME!!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzLUmaX4u-bhjVLC54AaABAq_A2XS12mgJJA8V3J36v9kP

"UKTX said: Am I right in thinking that the quarterly DSNP/LIS SEP will now be gone, thereby limiting call centers ability to switch DSNPS on demand? If true that's a big blow to the call centers? Yes lis/ partial Medicaid will have same seps as regular people . Oep/ aep etc . How I also read is unless a dsnp enrolls in a " integrated " dsnp which they can do monthly they also have the regular seps . But a fair warning what's taking place . Cms wants all dsnps to eventually be " integrated " . This means the dsnp will have Medicaid / mapd with same carrier for total integration. It's happening in Indiana next yr . What this means if you run into an Anthem dsnp they will have anthem Medicaid and mapd . It means unless you live there Medicaid first ti let's say United you can't move there dsnp . It affectively ends writing dsnps . But if you have a big dsnp book it's good as retention will be much higher . Also a person who has Medicaid and gets Medicare will be auto enrolled in a " integrated " plan . So no more running into that given nugget were somebody just has Medicare /medicaid . Games getting tougher"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Is the New 2025 CMS Rule for Agent compensation actually GREAT news for AGENTS and FMOs? · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/is-the-new-2025-cms-rule-for-agent-compensation-actually-great-news-for-agents-and-fmos.112929/#post-1487897>

"Midlevel said: I got a call today from a non clients daughter who said they already got their UH PDP ANOC and it's going from 140 to like 210/month and he takes 4 generic drugs. I said he needs a new agent first of all. Never been this late in the game and not known all the PDP information. I had a call like that in Indiana today too. But the UHC plan was the correct plan for her due to meds. But the rate which was already the highest of all is going to double for next year."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Humana is taking suppression to a new level · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/humana-is-taking-suppression-to-a-new-level.118143/#post-1594028>

"I would love for you to explain more about the ins and outs of Tricare and MA When I first went indy in 2011 from various FMO's and when I was trained in call center in 2008 I was always taught with VA its simple, Go to VA than VA pays, Go out in public then MA pays But don't mess with Tricare as Tricare acts a Medicare supplement and MA would interfere on how that works"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Know it All Veterans · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/know-it-all-veterans.108924/#post-1427894>

"Cody i have seen some of your videos but i've a question i really love this field cause i've worked one year on solar lead gen that was awkward but good and now i wanna start something new i've worked in office here and i'm from pakistan so what's your opinion? What should i do what you say?"

— YouTube · Calling Aged Final Expense Leads & Booking Appointments! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6xb8wEsnlPY&lc=UgwBWv6h0KsDVCBZ4N54AaABAq>

↳ @CodyAskins (2): "I really enjoy the insurance field. If you're great on the phone, can handle objections, and have the drive to train every week, I believe you will have success."

"DonP said: I think they want to exclude face to face agents Everyone that's not associated with a call center in any way is considered f2f. Furthermore, if this is a real issue, the agent can just send the app link and the client fills it out."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Suprised nobody's talking about the huge MAPD marketing rules handed down by CMS · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/suprised-nobody%E2%80%99s-talking-about-the-huge-mapd-marketing-rules-handed-down-by-cms.108507/#post-1422053>

"Our back ground- Mortgage Marketing as well as Real Estate. We have been in business for over 4.5 years and in that time we earned one of the best reputations in the mortgage field for all forms of marketing. Our options include TM leads (24 man American call center), targeted lists, mailers and post cards, hosted dialer service, and call center set ups and consulting. Our capabilities- We have a 24 man call center in our corporate office in Las Vegas, NV. Currently we are going to dedicate this to Insurance lead generation only from 10 EST to 300 EST. With 24 reps we can generate just over 80 leads per day after our verifiers make sure the lead is valid. Very limited! In addition we do have printing capabilities with our presses to do any type of post cards or letter printing. BRR offers some of the best client retention packages in the country that not only retain your client but they also generate referrals for you as well. In addition to all of this we are also data brokers of the new business, as well as the consumer national database. We can filter just about anything! Our Goals- To provide a very high quality lead to a few companies or individual agents until our capacity is filled. We are not here to take over the field or put anyone out of business. Fact is that we can handle no more than 10-12 accounts in total for our TM leads. WE pride ourselves on customer service and making sure that each account has the best chance of making money. We literally want to retain every client that buys from us. As you all know residual income is the best! We will also offer a fair return policy as well as nothing but EXCLUSIVE LEADS, dialer services, and print and mail options, and New business database! Our Research- For the last 7 months or so we have been inquiring about and researching the insurance (primarily health) industry. I have learned a ton on this forum as well as others and by talking with many agents in the field. We even ran some beta testing for a few accounts that paid for their leads at cost while we were working the kinks out. During this time we got wonderful feedback from many agents that helped us mold what is now our final product. A lot of hours were spent on this project and we now have our marketing quality where we want them. You can view much of this on this forum on this thread.... Im seeking advice from health agents!! PROOF- before I take one order I will be giving a couple leads per day away for FREE on this thread starting next week. I'm going to pull 500 records from about 10 different states of new businesses set up in the last 12 months and under 8 employees. Then I will load this list into my dialer and pound away until we get the few leads needed per day. This is where I have had the most success. All these free leads will be given away on this thread in hopes that the recipients will report their feedback to the board. I will post the free lead and the first person that post that can do insurance in that state gets the lead! I will post the first leads 8-6-08! If you have any questions please post away! Let's let the FUN begin! STAY TUNED!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Leads! Telemarketed! · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-insurance-leads-telemarketed.6703/#post-85556>

"I'm sorry you're going through this. The first step is to confirm which state your Ambetter plan is based in, since the appeal process can vary by state. As an agent, when a prior authorization is denied, I immediately submit an expedited appeal so the member can get a final resolution quickly. If that appeal is denied, I help them file an Independent Review Organization (IRO) request right away. The full process usually takes about 14 days. Most denials happen because the medical criteria simply aren't met — for example, when the provider prescribes something off-label, experimental, or fails to submit the required documentation. If the denial is due to a health plan error, the IRO often overturns it at no cost to the member. Sometimes appeals succeed because the Medical Director contacts the provider's office for more information. However, since Medical Directors handle dozens of cases per shift, if they can't connect with the provider promptly, the denial is usually upheld. The IRO process is more thorough because it requests documentation directly from the provider and reviews everything comprehensively. In certain states, like Florida, Centene Pharmacy Services handles appeals directly, leaving agents with little influence. Also, the so-called "Member Escalation Team" is essentially experienced customer service representatives — they don't escalate issues beyond standard procedures. True escalation happens through appeals or grievances, where the health plan must act according to your Evidence of Coverage and applicable law. Corporate staff may get involved, but unless your contract or policy language allows exceptions, their role is limited. Recommended Steps Call Ambetter and request to file an appeal as the patient for the denied prior authorization. Note the complaint number if your state allows appeals by phone, or complete the appeal form and send it to your state's designated address. Wait for the letter of determination. If denial is upheld, submit an IRO request. If the IRO also upholds the denial, you can file a complaint with your state's Department of Insurance. You can also skip directly to the Department of Insurance, but they'll usually redirect you back into the same process I described — only with corporate agents involved. That may be preferable if you'd rather speak with someone based in the U.S., since most contact center agents are overseas. Good luck — persistence is key in these cases, and following the proper steps gives you the best chance of success"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tx9333/ambetter_admitting_to_missing_three_p2ps_and/opubd5s/

"JosephDeacon said: Anyone read this article yet? Allison Bell of LifeHealth Pro states comp will be set at 1.5-2.5%. If so, game over. PPACA strategist: IT companies need specs I LifeHealthPro Allison Bell from LifeHealthPro simply quoted her source. The statement came from John Sarich, vice president for strategy for a health plan software and service hosting company. He made very interesting statements, so I wonder how much he knows. Here are some quotes: In practice, Sarich said, because of PPACA limits on administrative costs, most carriers will try to hold individual QHP policy producer compensation to \$75 to \$100 per year, or about 1.5 percent to 2.5 percent of premium revenue. That level of compensation is much lower than the current typical health producer compensation, but "there's going to be a lot more agents," because many consumers will find that signing up for coverage is complicated, Sarich said. Some have suggested that producers might find that the new PPACA exchange QHP market is similar to the existing Medicare Advantage plan market. In the Medicare Advantage market, commissions average about 5 percent of premium revenue. Sarich said he thinks producers and issuers in the QHP market will have to provide more customer service than producers in the Medicare Advantage market do. To cope with the need for live-human advice, many insurers hope to make heavy use of customer service centers in India and the Philippines, Sarich said. Even though producer compensation levels will be low, the QHP carriers also will try to shift some of the work they do for commercial plans themselves onto the shoulders of the QHP producers, Sarich said. This is funny. He claims that the carriers plan to pay pennies, but expect "a lot more agents, because many consumers will find that signing up for coverage is complicated." Yea, sure, that will work. And then they plan to shift more customer service to agent/brokers? For less money? But you must admit that the last paragraph is funny. Since health insurance is so complicated, then customer service reps from India and the Philippines will certainly help clarify things!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Exchange Commissions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/exchange-commissions.53360/#post-696347>

"vic120 said: I would love for you to explain more about the ins and outs of Tricare and MA When I first went indy in 2011 from various FMO's and when I was trained in call center in 2008 I was always taught with VA its simple, Go to VA than VA pays, Go out in public then MA pays But don't mess with Tricare as Tricare acts a Medicare supplement and MA would interfere on how that works Click to expand... You can go outside of the VA when you are in the VA system. If your appointment for whatever is going to be set out more than 2 months, you can request to go outside of the VA for care. Otherwise, everything but Dental is covered at the VA. So all those extra perks of an MA policy, except for dental, mean absolutely nothing."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Know it All Veterans · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/know-it-all-veterans.108924/#post-1427937>

"Indiana licensed agent/broker here. Our state is adopting the "Birthday Rule" for Medicare Supplements, meaning anyone can switch to another one regardless of health and avoiding underwriting. This opportunity would be available to beneficiaries yearly and within a 60 day period around their birthday month. That's a major change for us as it will help many people stuck on high premium plans, but it will also inevitably raise rates for everyone. I'm very interested in how it will play out."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o59zlh/a_brief_summary_of_the_coming_changes_to_medicare/nj9e8am/

Dialing all day for a handful of conversations · 8 documents · 8 voices

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gat2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

"I dealt with this a lot when I first started. The most important thing is to practice your pitch, this helps calm the "what do I say if they pick up trigger". Realize that most dials won't answer, some will and really need help and you'll have a pleasant conversation and you'll either sell them or you won't, and if you get someone who is screaming and yelling, you hold all the power to hang up and dead the lead. Any shitty person you call you only have to talk to once. Also what helped me too was realizing THIS is the job I signed up for and while I hate bothering people A) they signed up for this, that's why they should have read the fine print when putting in their info and B) if it wasn't you in that seat dialing someone else would be there doing the same thing. Also it may feel like you're alone diving into a crowd but in reality the person you're dialing is dealing with a crowd stampeding their phone, you're just a faceless head in that stampede until you build rapport. I used to sit there and comb through the lead and think of who's going to be on the other line until I realized I would always be wrong and most of the time I'll probably never talk to them, so I kinda space out while dialing now and if someone picks up I just snap back with the pitch I've practiced a thousand times and start building rapport while I pull everything up. Also look at a bad phone call as taking them off your list and cleaning up your pipeline (which is still a win), my first thought after a shitty call is always "Thank god I never have to talk to that guy/gal again" then move them to dead."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wmt560/reluctance_to_dial/pbd1bx5/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/mko7utp/

"Go Back to the roots Please!! This is awesome!! I'm a bit frustrated with dialing, but If I get an in home apmt. Its like really easy. Keep the content coming, this is so beneficial to me as a rookie"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=UgzwhjnB0EL0gRPRrB54AaABAq

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Bought leads from vendors · 320 documents · 20 voices

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through (carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"Be your own boss" "80% starting commission" "change your life" Donated 100% of my income to my friendly lead vendor who definitely does not take advantage of agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gjXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg_9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMjJeY8

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

"Finally got my dream job!! I don't know if anyone else is in Alabama but I finally found an agency where I don't have to buy a single lead and I can bring in consistent income, they have a nice office in Vestavia and they offered to pay for my licensing too though I already had mine! Really excited to see what the future holds, I also made my biggest check last week!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qxr5nv/finally_got_my_dream_job/

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq85spe/

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"Bad\$\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

- 1. Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
- 2. Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition — this avoids AEP complications.
- 3. Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
- 4. Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo>) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"I'm sorry you are in the wrong organization? I sell final expense and Medicare, I ended up with the lifestyle you talk about after about 3 years. I buy leads, but I've never spent more than 50k in leads in the course of a year. I've been insanely profitable, without needing to build a downline, for almost a decade. It exists. But, you do need to have good contracts and leads that don't bleed you and actual sales training."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbgq/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/nfbupuz/

"Is this really something you can do as a side hustle? I met someone the other day that apparently makes 50 grand in commission each year on medicare renewals alone, and she also does life insurance. She told all of us that she does this part time on the side as a side hustle independent. She has a full 9-5 job. She buys leads but most is from word of mouth. My question is for someone coming into this with no experience, do you think it's doable to start out doing this part time and expect to make decent income? Or... is this really a full time gig? I don't want to half dedicate myself to this when it really takes full dedication. Interested to hear your thoughts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/

"Work for an independent that has the best prices in my province, so nothing. They come to me. We have 25 companies. Provide quick quotes, quick binds, quick service when they need something done to their policy. A variety of ways they can reach out. Retain most of my clientele year over year. Re-market my current clients if I need too. The way it should be. This lead factory head hunting, farming for clients you barely know and paying for someone to send you a list of numbers is wild to me - is this common in America? I think the Canadian industry is a bit different. I don't know anyone who has to buy leads. Seems like an awful way to retain a trustworthy client base. Is it just dog eat dog down there, constantly churning through clients or what?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4j6o3w/

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnc/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaaq95t/

Cold calling, door knocking and seminars · 211 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C%266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Why are we selling insurance like its 2005? Not trying to start drama just genuinely curious. We've got tech for everything now food shows up in 15 minutes, people find houses on their phones, we match with dates using algorithms. But when it comes to insurance? We're still cold calling, chasing unqualified leads, and quoting people we were never gonna close in the first place. We spend hours dialing and quoting but half the time it's with someone we can't even write a policy for. What if there was a smarter way to work where we only connect with people based on what they actually need and what we actually offer? Not saying tech solves everything, but there has to be a shift from the old school hustle to something more intentional. Anyone else feel like the traditional model is wearing thin?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l3wj8v/why_are_we_selling_insurance_like_its_2005/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvgEjciQ?feature=shared>(<https://youtu.be/4yFDvgEjciQ?feature=shared>) Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I *me*, the *salesperson* am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtq3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"NYC Im a terrible life insurance agent. Can I sell medicare plans? I've posted before about not being able to sell Life Insurance even though I work for one of the biggest companies. I need to transition into something lucrative yet flexible as I have a child and they have a million days off and school events etc. I thought maybe I could get into health care sales but tons of reddit post say that NY is the worst place for health care sale due to the restrictions. If health care is so restrictive, what does everyone over 65 do for medicare?? I hear about FMOs and IMOs but no one lists the good FMO companies in NYC. Anyway, Im at a loss. I need income and flexibility but I dont know how to get that that. Any advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/

"Is 41 too late to get into insurance? Hey guys, looking into getting my p&c license and give selling insurance a go. I currently bartend, but that's only a side hustle really, not an actual career path. So my questions to you are • Is 41 too late to get into the industry? • Am I going to be sitting at a desk/cubicle all day? Or can/will I be up and moving about? • What are some of the best companies to apply for entry level positions at? Places with some of the best training. •Am I gonna have to cold call every day? Are leads provided? And if there's any other info you'd like to provide on what to expect as a first year insurance agent please feel free to drop it here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1id8ena/is_41_too_late_to_get_into_insurance/

"AVOID: Bankers Life Had the worst experience with BL. No base pay! Horrible leads, cold calling, no benefits, wasting gas to go to appts and door knock, no reimbursements and you basically have to pay to work for them. I had to share leads with 20 other agents and we were all paying for these crap leads that don't even answer. Your managers make money off you when you sell and it's all triangle shaped.. AVOID!!!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gaf2yn/avoid_bankers_life/

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

"Dude I just want to say I started an ad. The first day not much happened. The second day I didn't think much was going to happen but then I got two leads. The third day I woke up to 4 leads and collected more throughout the day The fourth day I got even more. Every single one of these leads I can get on the phone I sale. I hit them as fast as I can, ideally within 60 seconds. My biggest challenge right now is just getting them to answer the phone. Peter I can't begin to thank you enough this gives me soooo much more flexibility in my business as before I looked into this I primarily relied on door knocking one year old leads and it was more expensive and time consuming. Thank you thank you thank you"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=UgxcG3JUruxdb4y1pCR4AaABAq>

↳ @thethriller1287 (2): "Hey Man I just started running ads myself. How do you get notified when a lead comes in/fills out a form to call them so fast?"

↳ @sleeperr (0): "@thethriller1287 need to link it to your CRM"

↳ @HealthyHair424 (0): "What is your update on the facebook leads six months later?"

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

"It gets easier. Cold calls suck. I started on cold calls. You need an agency that invests in leads for their producers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1vgk/i_got_my_licence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p92oxsp/

Referrals and their own book · 208 documents · 20 voices

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoROzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAg>

↳ @davidcampo2902 (13): "Everything you said is spot on! I I don't understand how this guy can generalize something as broad as a medicare into a little 16 minute video. There's so many other reasons why somebody would choose a Medicare Advantage plan as opposed to a supplement plan. Aside from your part B why would you pay a monthly premium for some thing that keeps going up for the most part every single year plus pay a separate premium for your part D drug plan plus pay copayment on top of that. You mentioned low income subsidy there's also state Medicaid and that comes along with a bunch of other benefits."

↳ @roberthoeller5516 (5): "I too sell both and agree with you 110%."

↳ @rodbutler4054 (4): "Spoken like a true insurance salesman!"

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Best leads in 2024???? This video had nothing to do with helping agents find reputable lead sources. You mentioned 10 different lead gen sources (none to be named) and said nothing referring to the actual title of your vid. Try renaming to " Don't make these mistakes ". I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable. Waste of 14 minutes."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg>

↳ @Peter_Roberts01 (44): "Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

↳ @itssmee1597 (9): "@Therealjames100you legit just did the same thing"

↳ @Therealjames100 (5): "You just wasted alot of time typing this pointless comment lol."

"Anyone's agency not do cold-calling for leads? I'm not sure if this will sound sane, but my agency grows solely off of referrals and advertising. Of course it's not the quickest growth, but it's been working for the past 5 years. We're a small independent agency that sells personal and commercial. I'm curious to hear others' thoughts and experiences!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/

"Lessons from my first year as an agency owner. AMA I started my p&c agency in May 2025. For context, I posted when I first started and about half way through year one so go check those out. I started my agency because I had 10 years experience up to that point and I was tired of working for others and following their lead when I knew there was better ways to innovate and bring a superior experience to the clients. So after one year, what have I learned? 1) The power of taking 100% ownership for your life and business You will make mistakes, you will have setbacks, you will burn through money trying to figure things out. These are unavoidable and part of the learning process. Don't be reckless, but know that you will not have all of the answers out of the gate and that's okay. Accept your responsibility as the captain of the ship and you will find a way to overcome the hurdles that get in your way. 2) The power of the niche In the early months, I chased any and all kinds of business. That lead to me spinning my wheels but getting no traction. It was only after I picked a lane and stuck with it (for the most part, just because you pick a niche doesn't mean you have to turn away business that doesn't perfectly fit in the niche) that the trajectory of the business shifted. 3) The power of relationships and finding your tribe Once I picked a niche, I sought out power partners that I could help make their lives easier by offering their clients a needed product and service, so the power partner actually had an incentive (not a monetary kickback, although you'll find that helps grease the wheels) to refer me because I would strengthen their core offering. Think your typical referral partners (real estate agents, lenders, etc) but also think outside the box. 4) The power of delegation You cannot do everything. Know thyself, know what your strengths and weaknesses are. Hate doing your books? Get a bookkeeper. Not good at social media, find someone or a service that is good at it. Not a marketing guru? Find one. Don't try to be a hero, find others that have what you want and work out a deal. There's many more lessons, so ask me anything."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ts41sg/lessons_from_my_first_year_as_an_agency_owner_ama/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj1/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

"Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadqv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/

"Is this really something you can do as a side hustle? I met someone the other day that apparently makes 50 grand in commission each year on medicare renewals alone, and she also does life insurance. She told all of us that she does this part time on the side as a side hustle independent. She has a full 9-5 job. She buys leads but most is from word of mouth. My question is for someone coming into this with no experience, do you think it's doable to start out doing this part time and expect to make decent income? Or... is this really a full time gig? I don't want to half dedicate myself to this when it really takes full dedication. Interested to hear your thoughts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vzuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/

"Young guns I am a season attorney that left the profession I believe I have a high professional acumen and this business is stuff. I have spent the last 8 months building my book of business and it is important to state that you better have money for bills and business operating costs for the 1st 2 years until residuals kick in because I have to spend 2-3 k a month on leads to sell 10-30 apps a month and must discuss Pro rata pay"

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=Ugx7CT46A-qWKzOysnV4AaABAg>

↳ @Seniorbenes (5): "I plan on having about 800-1000 client sin the next 5-6 years"

↳ @MedicareMillennials (3): "@Seniorbenes Thats an awesome number to shoot for"

↳ @richsantiago7391 (1): "@Seniorbeneshow has it been since this comments? Self development check"

"I think the biggest factor in what you'll make, is the company you sell for. This is my 3rd year in the insurance industry, I sell both P&C and life/health insurance. Make sure your company pairs you fairly, you would be shocked at the commission rate difference between companies. I have seen anywhere from 15% all the way up to 90% on FYC (first year commissions) on annual premium rate. Also brush up on your marketing skills, make your clients do your work for you with referrals! The closing ratio of referrals is so much higher than a client that you found on your own. The roof does not exist in this industry, sell as much as you can and live a good life!"

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgWtQbhhxRF2diL6pNh4AaABAg>

"AEP apps vs chargebacks Happy December, fellow medicare agents! We made it through AEP! Just here to get some perspectives and experiences of what to expect with AEP apps vs which ones actually follow through! For those of you who have been through multiple AEPs, how many apps do you usually write? This was my first year, and I wrote 172. The majority of them are renewals, but I did have a few initial enrollments. Do you think this is exceptional? Also, how many of your apps ended up being chargebacks/cancelled (due to enrolling with another agent)? I'm curious to know what to expect here for my book. Last question, I promise, what percentage of your book ends up sticking around the following year? I know everyone's market is different, but I'm trying to get a sense of what's "normal." Any insight from seasoned agents would help a ton. Thanks so much and happy holidays!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/6l3fuc/

"Daniel, I completely agree!!! As a licensed independent health insurance agent for almost 15 years, I can tell you there is some serious "truth twisting" in this video. He is basically taking the worst HMO product and the worst MA features and casting a blanket about all MA's across the county. In our area, we have highly rated PPO (Non-referral) plans with huge premium savings and extra benefits compared to Medigap plans. If you want the absolute best coverage and are willing to pay the huge premiums, go ahead and get a Medicare Supplement plan but if you are healthy and want to act as your own insurance company (by keeping those premium savings in your pocket) the MA plans are a VERY good option!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxXgatwixQRn4vQ4Bh4AaABAg.9Ybsc0dtWig9Z1d6pg3zOj>

"This guy. Started my own agency about 3 and a half years ago now. Probably made 10-15 cold calls in that time, don't think I'll make many more. Advertising, referrals and company provided leads. I'm not trying to scale, I'm not trying to make a million a year. It's going well. Spend about \$20k a year on advertising. When I got in the business 25 years ago, I was a cold calling machine."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n7fouui/

Captive or call-center job first · 204 documents · 20 voices

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLLHQAIVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&prefix=how+to+win+friend%2C&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Insurance sales is a joke, right? Former insurance salesman here(notice that it doesn't say agent) and after having several sales roles with varying commission structures consistently the worst ones were always the insurance roles besides working for a moving company. Having to pay for my licenses, taking 20-60 hours of coursework, having to deal with some of the worst pools of leads I've had to work with from people who don't even know who you are, to having to try to sell a 500\$ monthly premium to the couple paying a fourth of that through a local farm bureau. It just never, ever felt rewarding. The icing on the shit-cake being that you never even saw a lick of commission until you reach a certain threshold. Even the other shitty companies would let you have a crumb of the pie, but insurance tends to fall on the "salary" model so that while your base is higher than most, you better get used to that base. I've gotten good training in my career from jobs like this, but unless it's a me issue how the hell has anyone survived there longterm besides outlasting and inheriting books of business? I work in the dealership side of things now and do not regret it a sliver. edit:

"clarification"

— r/sales · 202 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1wknc2g/insurance_sales_is_a_joke_right/

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong.(never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you.** I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before 🍷, but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!"**

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive agent but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"Incomes can widely vary based on captive or independent. When you have a salary or safety net, the incomes you mention are doable, it is recommend that newbies start out as captive before venturing out on your own. Most will fail in the first year going it alone. My agency did over 1.2 million and on track for 1.5 this year, but many years of hard work, it is definitely more rewarding on the independent side, but not for everyone."

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgiZY&lc=UgxPaeU0nrh1AzCEkX94AaABAq>

↳ @catmouse2882 (0): "Is your agency hiring?"

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"The thing that frustrates me about recent news is that many of us likely completely agree that for profit health insurance is just not a good model. But people who hear insurance just assume all of us are in health insurance and just rolling in cash and laughing. I'm a PC reinsurance broker working mainly with captives. People have no clue what I actually do."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1i58bx2/given_how_much_the_insurance_industry_has_been_in/m81suw3/

"I run my regions claims department. If you have written proof we'd consider covering it. I will admit if your captive it's a lot more likely independent it becomes our discretion"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2k0su/

"Should I stick with 100% commission? My wife is pregnant and I am unable to pay my mortgage. When I tell my managers they explain that I'm just not trying hard enough. I currently sell final expense and Medicare supplements. Should I stick with this or switch to something with a salary plus commissions? My last checks have been \$0 despite running around 24 appointments per week."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l4vp1u/should_i_stick_with_100_commission/

"StevenjKSU said: I never wrote their MA and don't see that ever happening. If they are still the most appropriate plan for any of my stand alone people, I will educate them and help them get set up, but we will just have to set some boundaries around service through the year. I have a feeling their call centers are going to have a bad time in 2026. I can stomach service for \$50 a year, but no business can work for free. My clients will understand and I am sure that a few of them will be letting Aetna and Wellcare hear about it. Click to expand... "Mrs. Smith, I'll help you as much as I can but WellCare no longer allows insurance agents to advocate for their members. If you run into a problem, I can try to point you in the right direction but I won't be much help because of how WellCare chooses to operate." If there's another suitable plan option, I'll mention it and explain that they operate differently and I'll let the client choose. In other words, I'll be helpful but the help will be limited, and I'll be clear that the help is limited because of how WellCare chooses to run its business."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Wellcare paying no commissions on pdp's · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/wellcare-paying-no-commissions-on-pdp%E2%80%99s.113845/#post-1504617>

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"Just commenting to see the comments from captives. I'm interested to see their opinions. I could see marketing/leads being one."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hygnnd/why_do_so_many_stay_at_a_captive_agent_vs_broker/m6hcbjs/

"I need a realistic understanding of what I can make as salary. So to break it down, I work for an agency I make \$40k salary full benefits plus a cruddy bonus structure, I'll probably end up hitting \$65k maybe \$70k with overtime and bonus during OEP I sell ACA plans thru the market place and state exchanges in 16 different states along with gap coverage and STP's. I really hate the 9-5 hours and I have an hour drive to the office. I want to go 1099 very badly but I don't have any understanding on how I would get paid or what the pay would be since my company takes care of that for me and I came into the insurance business thru them. I want to be able to profit at least \$65k, what would this take? I have about 100 clients in my book of business here, what would that translate to if I was independent? What are some numbers people are bringing in just selling ACA plans? Whats the average commission? Tips tricks? Anything would help. My company is crunching numbers and basically asking everyone to either step up and match the top 2% of agents at the company or they're getting the boot... I need a plan"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k042ke/i_need_a_realistic_understanding_of_what_i_can/

"A couple of Medicare agencies who are frequently looking for remote workers, that pay a steady base and a little extra money for enrollments are ResultsCX, and Select Quote. You won't get rich working for either outfit but you can get your feet wet and gain the confidence necessary to go 1099, which is what I'm doing this year since my first AEP and OEP as an hourly sales agent went so well. Getting in is mainly a matter of timing though. Seems I got hired in mid July, to start late September, so you might be a little early. Keep looking on indeed, and you will progressively see more Medicare Sales ads show up day by day. You'll eventually see one or two that offer an hourly base. Good luck!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/mxojw3i/

"P&C builds a book of business with renewals but also client relationship which leads to sales of other ancillary products. The shoe can drop on the captive side if the carrier decides to blow their rates out of the water in your area. Life pays the best but there's zero client relationship after the sale. ACA is a grind, especially going into this year's enrollment with the new rules in place, small per-person as-earned commissions where you'd need to enroll a lot of people for years and years to really see it start to add up. I sell life to small business owners, but with no renewals, it's great money but it's also Groundhog day every day."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n5603iv/

FMO / agency leads and 'free leads' programs · 106 documents · 20 voices

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37g7CBMR8CY54AaABAg.9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8>

"Finally got my dream job!! I don't know if anyone else is in Alabama but I finally found an agency where I don't have to buy a single lead and I can bring in consistent income, they have a nice office in Vestavia and they offered to pay for my licensing too though I already had mine! Really excited to see what the future holds, I also made my biggest check last week!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qxr5nv/finally_got_my_dream_job/

"Anyone's agency not do cold-calling for leads? I'm not sure if this will sound sane, but my agency grows solely off of referrals and advertising. Of course it's not the quickest growth, but it's been working for the past 5 years. We're a small independent agency that sells personal and commercial. I'm curious to hear others' thoughts and experiences!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go theres trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like " you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"Is 41 too late to get into insurance? Hey guys, looking into getting my p&c license and give selling insurance a go. I currently bartend, but that's only a side hustle really, not an actual career path. So my questions to you are • Is 41 too late to get into the industry? • Am I going to be sitting at a desk/cubicle all day? Or can/will I be up and moving about? • What are some of the best companies to apply for entry level positions at? Places with some of the best training. • Am I gonna have to cold call every day? Are leads provided? And if there's any other info you'd like to provide on what to expect as a first year insurance agent please feel free to drop it here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1id8ena/is_41_too_late_to_get_into_insurance/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholmed" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

- 1. Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
- 2. Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition — this avoids AEP complications.
- 3. Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
- 4. Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course their are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

"It gets easier. Cold calls suck. I started on cold calls. You need an agency that invests in leads for their producers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_liscence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p92oxsp/

"ALRIGHT I PASSED! So I passed finished my pre-licensing course on Saturday midnight and scheduled the state exam at 8am for that morning. I passed! I currently am getting contracted for an agency that does medicare - they have their own leads coming in and a good team it seems like. As well as training. Now that's the health side. I already did my fingerprints, got my license approved and I am waiting for the next steps. However, I have been seeing people make money in life insurance and what excites me is the 2-3 day deposits of commissions in the bank. Since I had the license I am thinking of doing this as well but don't know where to start. What are you opinions or advice you'd give to me? P.S. I got my license because I am having a baby soon and my goal is to get my wife out of work and stay at home. I was going to college and working part-time but now I am trying to ramp things up. College still is a priority for me because I promised my mom I'd finish before she passed away. But right now I believe and seen results through Life/Health to make something happen for my future family."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwmm/leads/>

"Tons and tons. How me and my business partner both started. Cold calling commercial. Sucked, was hard, learned a lot. Then built my agency with internet leads that felt easy by comparison. I wish I could upvote this thread 100x"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1udkyjb/just_do_it/otdbpxd/

"I think this is accurate. However I think there's also a huge disconnect with many agency owners and their expectations of their employees. Yes gaining 6-18 months of experience working under someone is huge for experience. Also when someone is new and they come into an agency that expects them to do everything, from buying leads and networking to building lead generation websites and social media pages to produce more sales while retaining no book ownership and working off a half broken commission structure any one in their right mind ponders why they wouldn't just open up an agency themselves. It's also a fairly different landscape now with many more tools to help inexperienced agents. Yes they may fall flat on their face in the first year or two but many would rather do that than run on the hamster wheel of someone else's race. Most people get caught in someone else's hamster wheel easily and they watched their parents do it their whole lives and they told themselves they would never let it happen to them and that's what keep them driven and motivated to keep pushing even if it takes working other jobs too keep it pushing until they reach the pinnacles of success."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0yu3l/rash_of_inexperienced_agency_owners/npor2g6/

"Ex globe life agent here, and everything you said was correct. Fortunately for me, my lead was a woman who didn't do the gloaty car thing or flashy shenanigans. But everything else yeah. We even got a book for a "book club" which was a self help book written by the ex trainer of Kobe Bryant's (wasn't bad but still). The pitching script of elderly people was a big factor in me leaving, among many other things. You were "coached" to be pushy on people that were blue collar workers, because they made the big bucks. Meanwhile, the not so fortunate retirees of those companies were on a fixed income, yet you were still trying to sell them high premium, shitty contract, whole life policies. Elderly folks were the ones you were told to push the hardest, because they were simply more expensive premiums. Everything that company does is disgusting and they never once taught about the other benefits of life insurance or the financial/tax aspects of life insurance that a client could utilize. Since then, I've gone independent and have done... *decent*... but also had to pick up a full time job to supplement that lost income from being 1099. It's really hard not having your leads provided, and I didn't have the capital to invest in them (or find a reputable company NOT using old/recycled leads). Life insurance is sorta on the back burner while I work, that and I've signed up for information technology/cybersecurity classes that focuses on AI and computer programming. If anything, I hope to bring businesses better systems and structure. And my first market would be the people like me who couldn't figure it out and needed a better program/structure for their business. Anyways, always good to hear badmouthing of shitty insurance companies and the practices they preach. Keep fighting the good fight 🍌"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/omzw0l8/

"Well, the main ones I'm aware of and that I do are Medicare, ACA, Life/Final Expense, fixed Annuities and Ancillary (dental, vision). There is also Group, but I've never done it. Also be aware that some captive agencies operate like call centers and provide leads that are brought in with bait and switch ad tactics. I ran into quite a few of those early in my career. Don't be scared to ask any agency or company you join about their lead sources. Independent is definitely better, but requires you to invest more in yourself and your own marketing. ACA will require the FFM certification, which is free. Medicare requires AHIP certification or equivalent. I pay \$125 annually with the \$50 discount offered by some carriers. Life requires AML, which is free through the LIMRA website. Annuities generally require annuity training, and some states require Best Interest training to sell Life and Annuities. Definitely do more research before you sign any contracts, whether captive or independent. Hope this helps 😊."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibn4xz/passed_my_life_and_health_exam_today_now_what/m9k6pkw/

"That's why many go captured. When I was with a salaried and commissioned company, I made a little over 60K/year with some OT so let's say I worked about 42 hours/week. I laugh when I see posts in these life insurance groups on FB and you'll see someone who's personal profile is that of an entrepreneur, agency owner and/or digital creator yet they're asking the group questions about how they can get free leads or I'll see them applying for a FB insurance ads for a job. The entire industry is made up of people who lie and recruit. lol #truth"

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzBhzZADZactwz8f514AaABAq>

↳ @ASheepNoMore (2): "@solomonscourt8118 Did you watch the video? THE MAJORITY OF INDEPENDENT AGENTS ARE MAKING ONLY \$5K/MONTH. LOL that's probably all you're making too if you don't lie. And those independent agents don't get benefits or paid time off. So the CONCEPT is that UPLINES lie to the downlines saying they're gonna millionaires and PROOF in the pudding is that most agents make Less than \$70K a year. David Duford did a video on the same thing a week ago and the same statistics showed up."

↳ @MoneyStrategiesSOULutions (1): "Wow yeah that's not good"

↳ @ASheepNoMore (1): "@solomonscourt8118 Abd thats why 90 plus percent of agents fail within the first 5 year so I think I understand the concept."

Live transfers and inbound calls · 104 documents · 20 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Had my first sale today! I'm a new agent in Florida, independent. All inbound leads. Today was my first day on my own after training. Just super excited n I needed to put it out there!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"A few things: - Anyone you buy leads/calls from need to give you contract language specifically for this situation. - Litigators are 100% bad faith, this is how they "makes living". The upside is that between the "I paid for a live transfer and you'll need to talk to the company that drive the call" is valid - Litigators are lazy assholes. Best bet is to match their energy and say you will show up in court to litigate this. \$10k is the small claims limit in a few states. Some are \$5k and a few are higher. The MO is to file in SC, show up to the hearing and then get a judgement. That's why you should show up with a contract to give to the judge showing you are not responsible for this litigator doing what they're doing. That \$25k settlement is now Civil Court territory, meaning you need to retain representation... in other words, it's costs money. Call their bluff, show up to any SC hearing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjv8uf0/

"Interesting to see the other side of a serial litigator. Questions for you: What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call and hop on Indeed dude. No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y0u2a/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Hi, I also work at an Allstate agency and this is my first insurance role. I just got licensed and accepted the first offer without doing much research. My day looks a lot like what you're describing: mostly outbound calls and working marketplace leads. There are people in my agency making six figures, but they're grinding hard like working Saturdays, staying late every day and they're extremely strong on the front end of the call. I've realized I'm probably not built for that style long-term. I don't think it's impossible at Allstate, but it's definitely a tough model and not for everyone. At my agency, the owner hired over 40 people this year and let about half go for performance, so the turnover is real. I'm personally looking at inbound roles (possibly Liberty Mutual) because I'm still very new and feel like I'd benefit more structured training and warm leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/nujrdl0/>

"Pulling my hair out I work for a small insurance agency in a commission-only sales role, and I'm trying to figure out whether I'm being unreasonable or whether I was genuinely misled about what this job would be. During my interview, I was specifically told that the phones were constantly ringing and that I wouldn't have to worry about finding enough opportunities. The impression I was given was that there was plenty of incoming business and that my job would primarily be to sell and close it. That ended up being very different from reality. After starting, I learned that I was expected to do a significant amount of networking, prospecting, attending events, making community connections, following up with cold or old leads, and essentially generating most of my own business. I understand that sales involves prospecting, especially when you're commission-only. My problem is that this wasn't how the position was presented when I accepted it. I'm also not the only sales agent who was hired with the same general pitch. It seems to be a pattern where people are brought in believing there will be substantial inbound opportunity, and then once they're there, they find out they're largely responsible for creating their own pipeline. More recently, the office structure has changed even further. Other employees now handle most incoming calls and leads, along with accounts that became available when another employee left. I've essentially been pushed into a purely outbound role. So at this point, unless I personally generate the lead, there's very little opportunity coming my way. What makes it more frustrating is that I've actually done what was asked. I've gone to networking events, built relationships, promoted the agency, followed up with prospects, and tried to create business from scratch. But if someone hears about the agency through something I did and then calls the main office without specifically asking for me, that business may go to someone else anyway. I've tried raising concerns about needing more opportunity to actually make money, but the response is basically that the company pays for some networking opportunities and I need to make those work. That leaves me feeling like the expectations have completely shifted from what I was originally told. Had I been told during the interview, "This is a commission-only role where you'll primarily be responsible for networking, cold prospecting, and building your own book from the ground up," I could have made an informed decision about whether I wanted that job. But being told that the phones were ringing off the hook and that lead flow wouldn't be an issue is very different. There have also been smaller things that have made me feel increasingly disconnected from the office, including seeing other employees receive opportunities, accounts, recognition, or inclusion that I don't seem to get. Those things wouldn't bother me nearly as much if I were actually making enough money for the job to be sustainable. I'm now updating my resume and considering other positions, either in personal-lines insurance with a more stable structure or possibly outside of insurance altogether. For people who have worked commission-only sales jobs or in small insurance agencies: would you consider this normal shifting expectations, or does it sound like the job was misrepresented during hiring? I'm especially curious how long you would give a situation like this before deciding it probably isn't going to change."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/

"Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually "get" the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcm82b/

"Senior Life offers a few different options. Expensive live transfers at \$70 a call. Discounted Facebook leads at \$10-\$15 a call. I'm a firm believer that you can be successful at any imo with any lead cost. The trick is that you have to get good at your craft before going broke. That is what nukes most agents. There is no shortcut. There is no magical lead. There is no magical training, there is no magical IMO. You have to put in a massive amount of Reps to get good at this. Once you sell your first 30-50 policies then start looking into higher cost marketing. I know you can do it , push yourself to do it. Keep your head up , you got this!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/myqsmm0/

"I work at an agency where we receive only inbound calls. We have a weekly charge of around \$850. This covers everything from the dialer to the office space and the leads as well. The first two weeks are free though. My one call today covers that charge so I'm ok with it. People who have been doing it for a while are just killing it there. I used to work furniture sales and during slow season when the snowbirds were out of town, that was all I would make in one or two weeks occasionally. Definite Upgrade!"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/oum8y9g/

"5 deals a day is high unless they're doing shady things and selecting SEP's that are not valid. In other words, they're not compliant. I'm an independent agent and do inbound calls too and having 2-3 sales in a day is an awesome day for me. so two scenarios is what I'm gathering here; your co-workers were burning through calls and hanging up on people they couldn't service. and those who they could service, they're non-compliantly selecting SEPS"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh7v52z/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. > I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. > Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call. Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. > No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding. You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realized that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, you're not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0bm9o/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."
— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"
— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤨"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

Aged leads · 86 documents · 20 voices

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAg

↳ @thomasmorris2245 (6): "Congratulations on your first sale"

↳ @15pluna (4): "hey quick question do you mean the leads are 5-10 yrs old???? impressiiveeeee!"

↳ @oExlucive (0): "@15pluna I was calling aged mortgage leads, the company that had sent out the ads, sent mailers in around 2018-2022 was the earliest lead I seen, and so many people have already called on these people so the 2 sales I had off 600 leads had a lot of smoke screens and they already had policies so I had to switch them over, Mutual of Omaha and royal neighbors are the 2 carrier's we used to find more coverage at better rates"

"I've been calling very old leads, some a year plus. Wanted to share the opener I've been using & it's been working. "Hi Mark, my name is David, calling from not too far down the road here in Tampa. First & foremost i wanted to apologize for it taking so long to follow up with you, how have you been?" I've never talked to these people in my life, but guards seem to be let down. Great video. Keep it up."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugy-hLbZx8ABAWNvJdX4AaABAg>

↳ @robofreak425 (2): "Well, first impressions are important after all. Best to start off showing that you care about them and their time. Helps you come across as amiable (friendly) and considerate."

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if I had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgwyw8/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"Dude I just want to say I started an ad. The first day not much happened. The second day I didn't think much was going to happen but then I got two leads. The third day I woke up to 4 leads and collected more throughout the day. The fourth day I got even more. Every single one of these leads I can get on the phone I sale. I hit them as fast as I can, ideally within 60 seconds. My biggest challenge right now is just getting them to answer the phone. Peter I can't begin to thank you enough this gives me soooo much more flexibility in my business as before I looked into this I primarily relied on door knocking one year old leads and it was more expensive and time consuming. Thank you thank you thank you"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=UgxcG3JURuxdb4y1pCR4AaABAq>

↳ @thethriller1287 (2): "Hey Man I just started running ads myself. How do you get notified when a lead comes in/fills out a form to call them so fast?"

↳ @sleaperr (0): "@thethriller1287 need to link it to your CRM"

↳ @HealthyHair424 (0): "What is your update on the facebook leads six months later?"

"Hi I have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media. They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers (old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(I have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent... harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"For those of us who've already been living in this final telesales telesales world, I thought it would be a good idea to share tips, carriers, and lead vendors to our cohorts to help them during these uncertain times. Whats your favorite carrier? Whats your favorite kind of lead? What tips do you have? --- My favorite carrier is American Amicable because of the ease of doing business. Although, I am finding, that many other carriers are getting better daily. The best lead for telesales is still TV. However, Facebook lead costs have CRASHED. This is a great time to jump in and get leads for \$2-\$3. I wouldnt use a vendor only to pay 200% more. Research and do it yourself. Heres my tip. Dont go back through all your old leads and think you are going to resurrect intrest. Buy new leads, and buy alot of them."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344504>

"Pulling my hair out I work for a small insurance agency in a commission-only sales role, and I'm trying to figure out whether I'm being unreasonable or whether I was genuinely misled about what this job would be. During my interview, I was specifically told that the phones were constantly ringing and that I wouldn't have to worry about finding enough opportunities. The impression I was given was that there was plenty of incoming business and that my job would primarily be to sell and close it. That ended up being very different from reality. After starting, I learned that I was expected to do a significant amount of networking, prospecting, attending events, making community connections, following up with cold or old leads, and essentially generating most of my own business. I understand that sales involves prospecting, especially when you're commission-only. My problem is that this wasn't how the position was presented when I accepted it. I'm also not the only sales agent who was hired with the same general pitch. It seems to be a pattern where people are brought in believing there will be substantial inbound opportunity, and then once they're there, they find out they're largely responsible for creating their own pipeline. More recently, the office structure has changed even further. Other employees now handle most incoming calls and leads, along with accounts that became available when another employee left. I've essentially been pushed into a purely outbound role. So at this point, unless I personally generate the lead, there's very little opportunity coming my way. What makes it more frustrating is that I've actually done what was asked. I've gone to networking events, built relationships, promoted the agency, followed up with prospects, and tried to create business from scratch. But if someone hears about the agency through something I did and then calls the main office without specifically asking for me, that business may go to someone else anyway. I've tried raising concerns about needing more opportunity to actually make money, but the response is basically that the company pays for some networking opportunities and I need to make those work. That leaves me feeling like the expectations have completely shifted from what I was originally told. Had I been told during the interview, "This is a commission-only role where you'll primarily be responsible for networking, cold prospecting, and building your own book from the ground up," I could have made an informed decision about whether I wanted that job. But being told that the phones were ringing off the hook and that lead flow wouldn't be an issue is very different. There have also been smaller things that have made me feel increasingly disconnected from the office, including seeing other employees receive opportunities, accounts, recognition, or inclusion that I don't seem to get. Those things wouldn't bother me nearly as much if I were actually making enough money for the job to be sustainable. I'm now updating my resume and considering other positions, either in personal-lines insurance with a more stable structure or possibly outside of insurance altogether. For people who have worked commission-only sales jobs or in small insurance agencies: would you consider this normal shifting expectations, or does it sound like the job was misrepresented during hiring? I'm especially curious how long you would give a situation like this before deciding it probably isn't going to change."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤔"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"Back to school? I'm a Medicare Telesales (captive) agent for a large health insurance company. I'm doing fairly well, not the best on my team but not the worst, but I DO know that I hold leadership qualities that some do, and some do not possess. I really love my job, I love the my colleagues, and I really want to move up in my career. I have not been in school for 10+ years... I am honestly not even sure how going back to college would even work, entirely. I am a single mom of a four year old boy who's in preschool full time. (just to give a little background and knowledge of my very limited schedule) What classes should I take in order to make myself stand out ahead of anyone else who may be aiming for the same leadership roles, such as supervisor or lead? Bachelors in Heth Sciences? Any helpful advice/insight would be IMMENSELY appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1cqssyh/back_to_school/

"I agree, it doesn't matter who you buy leads from. I've tried quotely google ads (terrible ROI), quotewizard/smart financial leads. I would call the lead the moment they would come through. The amount of times the prospect would tell me they submitted the form online for their insurance request 2-7 days ago and they have already now purchased a different policy from a caller already was massive. They all sell you aged leads even though they all say they are given in real time the moment they submit the form or they are fake information. I think cold calling/referrals from current clients/referrals from referral partners are the only ways to truly get people. I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/

"My first agency was horrible. They kept telling me dont learn the numbers or the business but just keep recruiting and running old leads. They forbid me from buying new leads even when I had the money and had 6 months experience. Im with a good agency now, but watching that first place scam desperate people was almost enough for me to quit entirely. I still feel bad for recruiting a few people into that when I hadnt made a dime. I ended up blocking my upline because he kept trying to get me to buy the ceo's motivational material. Whole place was like a cult."

— YouTube · 102 Former Insurance Agents Explain Why They Quit [No BS] · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xv8pQ6cZ7oU&lc=UgwnbxaP7SOajk2jFuV4AaABAg>

↳ @TheDIGAgency (1): "Good job sticking it out. Lots of people share a similar story."

↳ @danbushnell8043 (0): "Lemme guess, A to the I to the L"

"Most are resellers thats why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why i only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer5k7f/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"They are gonna say "oh yeah, we got a lot of hot internet leads and in-bound calls. We usually give the warm-leads to the juniors to cut their teeth." The fact of the matter is you're gonna be grinding cold calls for months to a couple years, you will have to show activity s until you get decent leads. Occasionally you'll get some hot transfers; then once in a blue moon a bunch of hot leads will fall in your lap because everybody got too busy, somebody quit, or you happen to call a cold lead who was just about to turn hot. Honestly, the book Fanatical Prospecting is a solid quick read to prepare you for the cold call mindset. It's pretty straight forward, practical, and easy to remember. Its so practical that it sounds like you should already know these things about prospecting LOL. It'll help you workflow your calls for the day and qualify leads so you don't burn out on dead leads. Unless you're lucky, most agents won't teach you how to prospect, they'll teach basic selling techniques, presenting the product and maybe, maybe teaching you how to effectively close. Prospecting is an important technique and skill to learn, it extends past the phone and you'll start to see everyday situations to potentially to prospect for future customers."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wl6371/i_just_became_licensed_in_pc_shortly_becoming/pawdym3/

Self-generated leads (Facebook ads, own marketing) · 68 documents · 20 voices

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 😊"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"This is what they don't tell you is that you have to learn to generate your own leads. Don't waste your time I'm with the competitor of Aflac which is colonial life. I do Facebook ads, Tik Tok etc.. to generate my own leads it works. The old methods don't"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5v01x4/

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I toggle generators on as I need them. If I am going to be writing that day I turn on a generator around 530 am or so for that day. Sometimes I just leave one running. I spend anywhere from 20 to 50 per day myself depending on what I need. Number of leads depends on the spend. Self gen takes time to learn and can be very frustrating while you are in the learning curve. This is why most agents simply go to vendors even for outbound. Much like the rest of the industry only a small % of us are successful long term with this. I should ad that we do this mainly because I do not like to be stuck needing anyone but myself to run my business. If you are independent then you should be independent.....lol. So to me that means growing your own food from start to finish!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pnr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu2l322/

"I run a digital agency. Turn on monetization on this video, cause I want to run my ad letting life insurance agents know that I can run their FB ads for them, for a nominal monthly fee."

— YouTube · How I Sold \$56,038 Of Life Insurance In 30 Days With Self Generated Leads · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60LbRzSZNPs&lc=UgzQoMbhX0odje7KfcZ4AaABAq>

↳ @clydebarrow1933 (5): "@coffee.cup123 His channel has zero content!"

↳ @coffee.cup123 (0): "let's do business where can i contact you ?"

"Here's what I'm doing (not be construed as legal advice): 1. Update your compliance language on all opt-in forms. 2. Switch from shared/data leads to self-generated leads if you're doing anything more powerful than manual dialing. 3. My interpretation is that you can work aged/data leads on a single-line dialer as that counts as manual dialing. However, doing so would be akin to self-mutilation. Overall, the spirit of the law is great and hopefully will greatly limit call centers and the amount of mass dialing data "leads" they do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hszzi5/doing_anything_about_the_new_tcpa_rule_whats_your/m59vn00/

"Have you ever considered, you know, actually generating your own leads with community engagement in a niche market? Seriously... It works. I have done it for nine years. Wouldn't even know where to get a lead that was purchased if I tried. Also, thank God this is happening. The number of spam calls I get per day is ungodly and they interrupt my actual calls from call waiting. It's horrible. I hope all the overseas scammers shrivel up and go back to the holes they came from. I am tired of trying to tell my mom that I did not go to mexico and will never be kidnapped there, she does not have a tax debt, and her Amazon order doesn't exist. Most of the time she is fine, and sends me an 'lol you are not in Mexico getting robbed are you?' text. But I know the day is coming when that fails and I will be very grateful if it comes after this happens."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/mx7qq7x/

"Most are resellers thats why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why i only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer5k7f/

"I'm confused as in to why someone would purchase leads??? You're better off generating those leads yourself. The odds are more in your favor to close a deal without any losses to generate your own leads than to purchase them from someone else."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/odhmyvj/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"This my first month, and I should be finishing with 30kAP, I generate my own leads though."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otnmi6a/

"Looking for advice on starting an independent brokerage Hey everybody, Captive producer going on two years in production at SF. Licensed in P&C and L&H. Goal was always to start an agency (captive or independent) after gaining some good experience; however, due to circumstances out of my control, it looks like I'll need to make that jump sooner rather than later. I'm located in Colorado. I've averaged \$45k in premium a month with 5-7 life policies working 32 hours a week solely on internet leads (Everquote and Quote wizard, plus my captives leads that come in). Due to some personal things I've been dealing with in the past 2 years, I'd say my prospecting and overall activity has been half-assed at best. Prior to this, I worked as a finance director/Sales manager in dealerships for 13 years, so hiring, firing, training, placing loans with banks, working long hours etc. are all very familiar to me. I assume this experience should translate well to the independent world. I'm working through a business plan now and have hit a few bumps on the road. I'm planning on primarily personal lines, though I'll sell life and health incidentally and hopefully land some large commercial accounts as well 1) I'm looking at Agentero Elite and First Connect as aggregators. Does anyone know if they can be enrolled in simultaneously? Agentero has some non-standard carriers I'd like access to, but First Connect seems to be the standard as far as commissions, fees and payment. 2) I'll lean heavily on Facebook Ads for marketing, but of course plan on building a referral pipeline and supplement with paid leads to keep me busy dialing the phone. Can this be done initially around \$1500/month? Or is that spend too low? 3) Outside of setting up a commission account, PFA, obtaining my LLC, and purchasing E&O, am I missing any major components? I'm looking at different AMS platforms (First Connect provides a discount on EZlynx), but might wait 6 months or so before enrolling unless I absolutely need it immediately. 4) Goal is to end the first year with \$500,000 in premium with an average 12% commission. Hoping to average 8% on renewals and shooting for a retention around 85% before scaling and employing a CSR and an additional 1099 producer. Is this realistic? Too high or low? Hiring too fast? Thanks in advance for any answers and advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/

"I was thinking of getting into selling life insurance. Bought a course and everything. I stopped though because I decided to take a different route, but I found this post very enlightening and exactly what I would have needed back when I was first getting into it so thank you for such transparency. It seems like you might be spending a lot of money on leads but they aren't high quality. I have a background in marketing. It might be worth looking into generating your own leads. You could market with Meta ads or Google PPC. FB will definitely be cheaper than PPC, but PPC definitely has more intent. Regardless though, if you do your own marketing, you can qualify leads to your liking and you'll also know the lead is fresh. Might be worth looking into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/oussrjd/

"Yeah that door to door is old, it works but I don't want to waste my time.. and their Agent Assist platform and calling people isn't my thing. I'd rather generate my own leads. Use Linked in and ads targeting your local business owners. Your phone will ring like a christmas bell once you generate the leads on your own. Much better way to grow."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5wran3/

"Where do you buy these leads from? I want to try this. Been shopping around and trying to figure out where to go. I'll probably try running my own ads too but if the primary goal right now is to up my phone game and sell on the phone it would be nice to know where I can buy cheap old leads like this. Any advice on where to go?"

— YouTube · Watch Me Call 3 Month Old Leads And Make \$1,221.78 Profit I Selling Life Insurance · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hO2QakBEoJQ&lc=UgyiQQLq6l0QQCFOOHJ4AaABAq>

↳ @JavanniWright (1): "@RightHandRetirement there's lead vendors w aged leads, he typically runs his own leads so they are his own aged leads, there is vendors I can send you for aged leads."

↳ @RightHandRetirement (1): "@JavanniWright When he says he's using old leads at .25 cents a piece that makes me think he's buying them from somewhere rather than producing them himself with a FB ad. I suspect even if he generated them himself with a FB ad and they were older they would still cost more than .25 a piece that way."

↳ @JavanniWright (0): "Are you looking for cheap aged? Or fresh new?"

"Facebook Marketing I am looking at doing Facebook ads. I've looked at doing my own vs hiring someone to do them for me. I hear of many people running themselves but usually I hear they think it was a waste as they don't get any ROI. I know there are many YouTube videos to help do it yourself but I wanted to get people's take on if they thing it's worth running yourself or if it's better to hire a marketing company to do it. I'm an independent agency and no employees so I do the quoting/binding/servicing. Not expecting to write \$100,000's a month from this, just trying to get more inbound leads (outside of my referrals) Please let me know your thoughts. (I've tried smart financial/quote wizard/awl leads and hated them all due to poor quality)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o6mxp8/facebook_marketing/

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Looking for a new FMO / IMO that delivers · 12 documents · 12 voices

"Independent agent looking for IMO with no requirements — just carrier access Independent agent here. I run my own leads and dialer and don't need training or a system. Looking for a true hands-off IMO/FMO that offers: \- Street-level comp \- No required meetings or Zoom \- No CRM fees \- Full contract ownership Just want carrier access and to be left alone to produce. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s75pbn/independent_agent_looking_for_imo_with_no/

"I'm a new agent and looking for a IMO that provides proper mentoring and training. I'm currently with an IMO but not a fan of the environment. I want honest sales and reliable income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nq8czox/

"I'm primarily looking for a FMO that will send me a birthday card."

— Insurance-Forums.com · What is important to you in selecting an upline FMO? · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/what-is-important-to-you-in-selecting-an-upline-fmo.94948/#post-1259111>

"I do Say at least a 2 week free lead gen , to help agents generate some income , or a month . training , make agents feel like their somewhere where they are serious ab improving, inbound sounds great as well . Also looking for a new agency , sign me up lol !! 🍷 "

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p7ouj4/starting_my_own_life_insurance_agency_i_have/nqzjf9w/

"Looking for FMO Comparison Chart Hi all, I'm about to become an independent insurance producer in Michigan, and looking to sell only medicare products. There are so many FMO/IMO available, but cannot decide which ones to choose. Any charts/comparison available for most FMO stating what insurance they contract and what commission?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1ty6ew/looking_for_fmo_comparison_chart/

"Curious who your company is cause I am looking for a new IMO/FMO and yours sounds legit... coming from a mlm type of agency"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mkv0ypx/

"Anyone have Humana take their book of business when they switched from Individual to a new Upline? Humana calls it a strategic partner move, so therefore they've "moved my commissions to a house account." I just received another communication, that they say I owe them money, too."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/mxc3knm/

"I get what you mean, but a lot of carriers don't contract directly with individual agents. I'm looking for an IMO mainly for access to multiple carriers and good compensation."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wi94nj/looking_to_switch_to_a_good_imo_for_final_expense/pa8q9z4/

"DS4 said: I'm primarily looking for a FMO that will send me a birthday card. low expectations..."

— Insurance-Forums.com · What is important to you in selecting an upline FMO? · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/what-is-important-to-you-in-selecting-an-upline-fmo.94948/#post-1259140>

"In search of Mortgage Protection Upline who is excellent at selling I just passed my life insurance exam. More importantly than an IMO, I am looking for an upline that is excellent at sales. I have multiple opportunities at different IMOs but those uplines do not have records of big numbers and have just switched to recruiting because it is easier for them. I am looking for someone to go all in under."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wk2lqf/in_search_of_mortgage_protection_upline_who_is/

"Looking to switch to a good IMO for Final Expense Looking for a good IMO for Final Expense. I'm already licensed and actively producing, so I'm mainly looking for a solid IMO to get contracted through. I don't need leads, training, scripts, or coaching. Just looking for good carrier access, competitive comp, and a straightforward contracting process. Any recommendations?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wi94nj/looking_to_switch_to_a_good_imo_for_final_expense/

"I'm looking for recommendations for a solid life insurance IMO/FMO. Hello! I'm a new agent and I'm looking for an IMO/FMO that has a solid free lead program but also will gives the option of moving up to independent 100%+ commission. I really think I need a foundation to learn and I want to be trained in different types of life insurance like final expense, term, IUL, etc. I also would need it to be flexible as I work as a full time nurse 3 12hr shifts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wffv2/im_looking_for_recommendations_for_a_solid_lif_e/

Wishing someone had told them the truth about the job · 9 documents · 9 voices

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzc0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj5uxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

"Man I wish someone told me about the cluster trap earlier. Joined a big one first year and the exit clause was basically "we own your book forever" - took me 3 years to buy my way out of that mess. Read every contract like your life depends on it, especially the part about who actually own the business when you leave For software don't go crazy at start. I spent like \$800/month on fancy CRM that I barely used first 6 months. Get good rater and simple accounting, rest can wait until you got actual revenue coming in. The only thing worth paying for right away is a decent phone system and maybe EZLynx if you do personal lines What worked best for leads was literally just walking into real estate offices with donuts on Saturday morning. Cost me 15 bucks and got more referrals than the \$500/month online leads I tried. Would specialize early too, I wasted 2 years trying to write everything and made no money until I focused only on contractors"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p5fdhsa/

"Really depends on what kind man but I wish I knew how disgustingly vile the industry was and how disgustingly stupid medicare advantage clients are. I tried to be a knight. I really really did and got shit on over and over. Im still fully compliant but if Agnus wants the worst medical coverage I have ever seen in order to get a grocery card im signing her up Had plenty of people turn down the beat coverage in their area because it didnt have a giveback or card and even one where EVERYTHING was better but he would lose just 20 bucks on his giveback, thats it. Save 100's on his meds and seeing doctors and great out of pocket too Still said nah over the 20. If theres a really good policy I see but it'd be humana hmo to humana hmo so I wont get paid I aint talking about it. The very very very few times when I ask about medical needs or coverage and they actually tell me something im more than happy to find best i can offer but that NEVER happens. Its always oh idk oh you tell me.which obviously I cant tell you. Maybe 2 of 300 conversations are about actual medical needs or concerns. I also see TONS that dont even know they were switched recently or pending a switch or any of that and when they say they didn't know I fully beleive them because the checked out ones or no medical decision ones I bang on anyway"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62oxd3/

"My experience working for AIL so far: USA based here; i finished my training with them in early December and have been with them since. I encountered the same issues as OP with the MacBook compatibility issue however no one told me this beforehand. Instead i had to buy cheap windows laptops hoping they would work but ended up having to spend even more (\$300) on Parallels to run windows on my MacBook bc anything under that price in a laptop was absolute shit. I've made a few sales but nothing that allows me to even pay rent; I'm fortunate enough to have a partner who is able to support us during this time but if i had kids?? Forget it. I dont even have time for my 2 pups really, let alone the piling dishes, laundry, and other chores I'm falling behind with in the house. Most are not going to be successful in this field, and requires you to be a dog in sales while being taught that we're protecting families, this is true, but the lovely motivational words are blanketing bait-and-switch tactics we use with clients to force our products on them and force to make a decision that same night when they didn't even know they would be shown life insurance products in the first place. It doesn't make sense that we have to use such shady tactics to sell our products when the products themselves are very good honestly and at affordable comparative rates to other companies. I love helping people, and when i have to meet with someone who has a very limited income that knows for a fact they will be working until the day die, it becomes insensitive for me to say "okay but what's your retirement plan" and basically have to ignore their honesty about their financial situation and continue to push them into signing up for a life long bill to leave money for their family; obviously the concept of life insurance is valuable and i see the need for every family to have it, but I'm completely ignoring the reality that many people just cannot afford to take on another bill for whatever valuable reason it may be, and assuming there will be a time when they comfortably decide to stop working is just pretentious in today's reality. My background is working in retail/ management and for the life of me I can't get behind working for no base pay and all commission, the potential for getting rich is a long game here, and for anyone with recurring bills TODAY this is not the path for you (including myself). Everything you're taught about the customer being right is incorrect here and requires reworking that mentality to be pushy and somewhat tone deaf to accomplish your own goals while 'protecting a family's needs' (if their needs are X amount and they can only afford 1/4 of x amount, am i really properly protecting this family then or just making a buck??) Don't get me started on the leads we call. We are promised it's not cold calling and only requested by the people themselves but let me tell you there must be an underlying temporary amnesia issue going on in the world if so because half the people absolutely do not remember making a request that will be listed from a couple days before or the lead will be for a product they have 000000000 connection with (a single man with no gf or kids endin up as child safe kit lead in my pack). You'll also be contacting people other agents resolved so people will be pretty fed up on the phone, even policy holders who are harassed several times a year by us for a 'policy review' where we continue to upsell and tell them they're coverage isn't enough anymore. I have seen my relationship take a hit even though he's been as supportive as possible to see if this career can work for us. I am about to go back to retail bc i know i at least can depend on a check coming in after putting in 40 hours of effort every week For reference my work weeks have been 7 days a week for avg of 9 hours/day. Training takes up other hours in my day for work that has to be done on my personal time. There is a 'suggested' schedule but if you don't follow it you will be talked to over and over about it until you do. Honestly dangling the WFH carrot in my face blanketed me to doing any proper research before hand to see how the real employee experience is at AIL. Sorry for the super disorganized rant but I'm avoiding making dials right now LOL"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m7mtwat/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"There was an AMA on here a few months ago where the dude swears on his ACA success comes from buying leads, but qualifying the lead companies. I'm like you, everything in person for the older folks, but I do wonder if there's anything to lead generation. I should add when pressed on sharing the lead generation companies he works with, the AMA OP wouldn't share publicly. Now was that out of competitive advantage or is that dude full of it? I wish I knew. Guess AMA doesn't mean I'll answer anything 🤔"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/odoknzo/

"Girl, same I feel you on this. I started a year ago being an independent life insurance agent and buying leads is crazy and nobody tells you they just tell you about getting a license, but no one talks about the startup cost of the fingerprints. The license is for each state and also how expensive fresh leads are and even aged leads so I had to look for a company that provided leads to get my feet wet and get experience because it was so discouraging."

— YouTube · A REAL Day in the Life of a Life Insurance Agent (Work from home) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JDaChBx6iQ&lc=Ugxy16rMqgHI7akC9dd4AaABAg_AM3ga4OZquAA_u1B2vB5Vk

Wishing for leads that are real, exclusive and consented · 8 documents · 8 voices

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage.m, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"I am referring to using a different lead vendor. Vendors offering exclusive leads are more expensive, but worth it to get a client that is looking for insurance. BA Leads are the only leads I received that were absolutely horrible — not recommending you buy more of them by any means! (Just wanted to clarify)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/movynrx/

"I have had them since last October. The leads lately have been difficult to contact and my wife is not setting a high pct. They have been ok at times. My acct runs out of money in a week or two and I am still undecided if I will reactivate and re-fund the acct. We have more success with Insureme overall, but their appts have slipped in quality also. Setting too high an expectation for lead companies will result in disappointment. If you are struggling and depending on lead companies for most of your business it is going to be very difficult to find satisfaction. I would pay more for an honest exclusive lead, but at this point I have not found a source that is willing to take it on. It is very expensive to do, and it requires a commitment of resources aimed at a specific geographic area. Lead companies have as much trouble trusting agents and their level of commitment as agents have of lead companies. It is a two way street, and both parties have commitment anxieties."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Insuranceleads.com · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/insuranceleads-com.10352/#post-137981>

"Hi, I am new to the forum and had a question on buying leads. I was wondering if there are any other health insurance agents in California that could recommend a good lead source. I was told buildmyagency was good but wanted your opinions. Thanks Dave"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Leads · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-insurance-leads.9368/#post-124057>

"I would love to start buying my leads off of ca boom if it makes me more money than buying the leads that I am right now which aren't good leads.... is there a way I can book a 1 on 1 call with you, Cody???"

— YouTube · Life Insurance Leads - The Best Place To Get Them · 1 likes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dr_xERFNUH0&lc=UgwVp3Z8X9_p99l9qHt4AaABAq

↳ @usmanajibola6794 (1): "Cody has given us ways to get leads but personally and base on the life insurance agents I have discussed with buying leads don't work which you have also testified. Curious to know what are the other ways (maybe lead funnels, Facebook Ad, Google Ad, or through Press Release) you have Implement in making sure you start getting consistently qualified leads?"

↳ @NardiaStone (0): "@usmanajibola6794the ads method is what Cody uses he generates leads in real time"

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Six figures, or the month it finally worked · 55 documents · 20 voices

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Finally got my dream job!! I don't know if anyone else is in Alabama but I finally found an agency where I don't have to buy a single lead and I can bring in consistent income, they have a nice office in Vestavia and they offered to pay for my licensing too though I already had mine! Really excited to see what the future holds, I also made my biggest check last week!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1qxr5nv/finally_got_my_dream_job/

"I was just terminated: any advice? I just completed 3 years of service with LM. A year ago my department was dissolved and I moved into our choice department. I held my own pretty well for 6 months but this year they changed the metrics around, and as of today our 155 person strong department stands at 77. Well I was 77 now I guess 76. The goals got higher. The leads got tougher. I make no excuse, but all it took was falling into the bottom 20% once in my first few months, and second time in July, and finally a third time last month- my performance continued to degrade as the goals increased and my stress and feelings of ineptitude built up. I clocked in today and was terminated 10 minutes in. I was told to direct any questions to HR, who told me to direct questions about my 401k to fidelity, and my licenses are kind of in limbo no one seems to have any idea what happens with those. LM was my first broach into this field. It was the best money I ever made. But now I have a family, and I don't know what to do or where to go next- im not looking for job recommendations, I'm sure plenty of people already are. But what can I do to hit the ground rolling? How do I try to find a way back into an industry that just rejected my honest to God, best performance?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1fyelhw/i_was_just_terminated_any_advice/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"Still arguing about the wrong part of the healthcare battle in America. Year after year, insurance company this and greedy insurance company that. The issue is our price gouging money hungry healthcare system. \$5 bag of saline marked up to \$70 for the patient. Baby has a fever here's your \$800 ibuprofen (under a certain age a fever warrants only an ER visit). 90 yr old has a 30 percent blockage in 1 artery. No need for a stint will do a full open heart surgery at 90K. We love to get upset about CEOs at the insurers making millions, but it happens at the hospitals too. Top 5 For-Profit system CEOs made between 8M and 22M last year. Not for profit CEOs are comfortably in the millions as well. This doesn't include all the other C-Suite companies packages and the deferred compensation they've hidden from the public. ACA has been great to insurance companies. UHC's stock is 10x what it was when the ACA went into effect in 2010. That's after losing 50% in price since December. Everybody was accepted AND everyone was required to buy it. Cash cow."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lr23yx/the_big_beautiful_bill_passed_here_are_the/n18jx6b/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustrd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

↳ @fleridalara888 (4): "@Seniorbenes everything he's saying is scary. I am interested in this business but I am new and don't have the capital even for leads rinow"

↳ @Seniorbenes (3): "@michaelhuebner6843 Michael Thanks for your response ,factually It is just me I am not an agency, I just did some pre-planning before getting into the business and some due diligence. I listened to the successful agents and worked my but of because I did not want to be part of the failure statistics. If you plan, execute, assess, and repeat it comes together before you know it. The secret is 12 hour days kkkkk"

↳ @michaelhuebner6843 (2): "@Seniorbenes Well you are running an agency and that is not feasible for most new agents because they lack the capitol to start on a large scale like that. Yes if you scale to the point you are doing then it can work, but your investment is huge when this industry has 90% of new agents failing in the first 2 years. My description is what an average independent agent will perform. Nick from Medicare Millionaire is an independent agent and works by himself. He is a seasoned agent and very good at selling yet he only sold 127 policies in 2018 and he does this full time and employs his own telemarketer for \$3 per hour and uses direct mail leads. I was an assistant office manager for a Medicare brokerage firm for 9 years and out of 10 agents that our office had we only had 2 top producers and they each had about 1,500 clients. They serviced all of their clients and they were extremely stressed out all the time especially during AEP when MA plans became discontinued and they needed to review plan changes every year for their large client base. The average agent had about 500 clients. You need to provide customer service for your clients if you want to keep them long term and the sheer amount of work required to service MA plans simply isn't worth it. 95% of the calls we got at our agency was people having questions about their co-pays, the network, prescription drug co-pays, Part D late enrollment penalties, prescription drug issues, and how their plan worked. You spent all your time servicing MA and Part D clients and this is why you can't have more than 500 clients on your own before you are forced to hire help. Having 2,000 clients yourself means you aren't providing service to them when they have issues or you are just selling Medigap. Sorry to say but 70% of seniors on Medicare nationwide have Medicare Advantage. You and I both know how hard it is to market Part C and D plans selling over the phone as CMS makes this almost impossible. You need a partnership with a carrier to pull that off on a large scale and be successful which makes you captive to that carrier. I am in this industry to help seniors, not to help some corporate insurance carrier gain market share. CMS doesn't allow you to market Part C or Part D on social media, you need to read your AHIP test again my dude."

"I need a realistic understanding of what I can make as salary. So to break it down, I work for an agency I make \$40k salary full benefits plus a cruddy bonus structure, I'll probably end up hitting \$65k maybe \$70k with overtime and bonus during OEP I sell ACA plans thru the market place and state exchanges in 16 different states along with gap coverage and STP's. I really hate the 9-5 hours and I have an hour drive to the office. I want to go 1099 very badly but I don't have any understanding on how I would get paid or what the pay would be since my company takes care of that for me and I came into the insurance business thru them. I want to be able to profit at least \$65k, what would this take? I have about 100 clients in my book of business here, what would that translate to if I was independent? What are some numbers people are bringing in just selling ACA plans? Whats the average commission? Tips tricks? Anything would help. My company is crunching numbers and basically asking everyone to either step up and match the top 2% of agents at the company or they're getting the boot... I need a plan"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k042ke/i_need_a_realistic_understanding_of_what_i_can/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making "\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my as off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~\$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤨"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"@catbee1452 my mom had Kaiser thru her union, it was fine until they said she needed a pacemaker. Then she subjected her to 3 surgeries installing faulty pacemakers. In her area, Kaiser was a teaching hospital and she was the guinea pig. I got IN THEIR FACE and said enough I don't want these experimental new contraptions. I did research and DEMANDED a well known unit and she FINALLY was fine. But then I knew how to navigate the broken system as a LICENSED AGENT and I went to the insurance commissioner and demanded they stop experimenting on her. I was an advocate as well having volunteered in hospital for decades. I knew the cages to rattle to get results, and I went after them ALL like a pit bull and got my mom the care she deserved. Kaiser can be good or seriously iffy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugzf5shtQ8Hcv2WyllV4AaABAg.9ZD5zSRIHs.t9ZFaEy2VUJ>

"🚩 American Income Life = Scam 🚩 I spent 6 months inside American Income Life, and if you're even thinking about working here, please hear me out: it's a trap. They lure you in with promises of six-figure income, freedom, luxury trips, and "helping families." What actually happens? You're bled dry from day one. You pay for your license, exam fees, Zoom account, computer—money, money, money out of your pocket. By the time you realize what's going on, you've already invested too much to walk away easily. The first week, they make you feel like you've accomplished something huge: passing the exam, starting your "career." But then you're thrown into terrible training and endless busywork—basically just making calls for your upline. When you finally get your own "opportunity," they hand you garbage leads that have been recycled a thousand times. People scream at you to stop calling, and you're forced to keep going. It's harassment, plain and simple. The schedule is insane: 12-hour days, almost no breaks, constant check-ins and micromanagement. When you finally catch someone, you drag them onto a Zoom call and read a script full of lies that you've been drilled on. Without even realizing it, you're tricking people into buying one of the worst insurance products out there. Meanwhile, you're broke, stressed, and exhausted. They parade "success stories" in front of you—agents claiming they were once in your shoes but now they're making six figures. Fake trips, fake recognition, fake promises. It's all smoke and mirrors. 🗨️ If you're considering joining, or if you're already inside and thinking "I've put too much time and money in to quit now" — wake up. That's exactly how they keep you trapped. You're not building a business. You're being used. They're scamming new agents and clients alike. This place wrecks people's finances, mental health, and self-worth. It operates like a Ponzi scheme disguised as a career opportunity. To anyone on the fence: don't fall for it. Get out while you can. To the authorities: How is this still allowed to exist?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nggbda7/

"I've worked for Bankers for 13 years in mostly management. I feel qualified enough to answer this. **Pros:** * Give you great training to learn how to sell insurance. They will fly you to Chicago and other cities to learn techniques if you are good enough. * You will learn to do a fact-finder/needs assessment and sell multiple products in a household. The annuity end game is Banker's bread and butter. They do a great job getting into houses with Medicare as the door openers and rolling over qualified accounts into annuities. I'm finally independent now and meet so many "successful" independent agents trying to prospect low-commission dental plans and ACA. I've rolled over client's retirement accounts and built value enough to get constant referrals. I couldn't stay in the business this long if I was selling dental plans. **Cons:** * The commission is lower. Their final expense policies pay 45% for the level and 37.5% for graded. Their Medicare supplements were overpriced, but they taught you to sell your service and the company. They were one of 8 companies in Texas still selling Long-term care. I was with them when the only MAPD carrier you could sell was Humana. They later changed this and now you can sell mostly all carriers now. The commission is \$225 for new to Medicare and renewals are half."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/khtjk6i/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/

"Beware of unethical FMO. Integrity Marketing Group (based out of TX) has been on an FMO buying spree, trying to gobble up as many FMO's across the country as they can, simply in order to reduce market competition. FMO's, such as Agent Pipeline, Holland, NAA (Superior Performers), AGA, Premier Marketing, Western Marketing, and many others are included in their portfolio (this list can be verified/expanded via the Integrity website). Integrity hasn't been able to grow organically (i.e. gaining more Agents via better support), and so acquisitions have been their key to growth. As per another post elsewhere: "Welcome to the world of insurance full of empty promises and recruit anybody with a pulse." And Integrity owned FMO's are no different, even perhaps amongst the worst offenders. Burn & churn is the Integrity way. Integrity has adopted a quantity over quality approach in regards to Agents. They would rather have 100 low-producing Agents (often via lack of support) that each write only 1 app than 10 better-producing Agents that each write 10 apps. The net dollar gain is the same for them (100 apps written is 100 apps - regardless of the sources). Integrity only cares about Integrity. Again, burn & churn is the m.o. for Integrity (in regards to both Agents & employees). Perhaps worse, many Medicare carriers could care less about Integrity, and so offer little-to-no dedicated support and/or training, meaning Agents are often left completely in the dark. Most Integrity employees themselves don't even know the process for onboarding new Agents, and so cannot offer any real help. Even worse, Integrity has in-house CRM's & databases that are outdated by some 30+ years, but continue to pump out propaganda claiming they are "leaders" in "AI" (ha!). Let's not ignore the massive data breach that recently occurred at some Integrity companies (a class action suit is pending with NAA/Superior Performers in particular). Plus, many of those Integrity owned FMO's all operate on different systems than each other, so any one of their FMO's is largely unaware of what the other(s) are doing, and there is virtually no cohesion amongst those similarly owned FMO's (imagine the nightmare caused when several subsidiaries of the same parent company each have different policies, procedures, processes, computer systems, forms, etc.). Worse still, many of those Integrity similarly owned FMO's simply don't get along with each other (given the lack of cohesion/cooperation between each other), and so don't even offer support for each other. I have frequently seen employees from one Integrity owned FMO simply refuse to return calls/emails from employees of another Integrity owned FMO. And I have never seen as many data processing errors as I have w/Integrity owned FMO's (Integrity hasn't even initiated training programs for their employees, thus many don't even know how to properly submit Agent info to conform with NIPR/licensing info, creating unnecessary delays and/or rejection when trying to onboard. Integrity has completely ignored sustainable operations and infrastructure, meaning lack of knowledge, low efficiency, low productivity, and low effectiveness. One of the main reasons why their Agent support is so bad. And many Integrity Managers are amongst the least knowledgeable of products, carrier processes, etc. I once had to speak to four different Marketing Managers at an Integrity FMO, and was given four very different answers, each of which was completely wrong (which I discovered after finally speaking to carriers and getting the correct answers). Integrity is easily one of the worst run companies I have ever seen. My best recommendation, is stay far away from any Integrity owned FMO."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/m36p0b0/

"Medicare Advantage plan commissions are regulated and publicly posted online each year. It is not possible for anyone to SCAM you about commissions unless you don't do your own research. For 2027 people who are enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan for the first time earn the agent \$725.00 (some carriers pro-rate this during the year but most pay the full commission all year). Then agents receive a renewal commission of \$363.00 per year typically paid out monthly for as long as the client is enrolled. Some states like CA and NJ pay much higher commissions. Commissions typically go up each year based on whatever Medicare decides to pay. For example, in 2018 agents were paid \$400 per new enrollment and \$200 for renewals, so commissions have kept pace with inflation fairly well. If you enroll 50 new clients per year, (1 per week) your RENEWAL income total for those 100 clients in year 3 would be \$36,300 plus another \$36,300 if you continued to write one new one per week. Yes, I think is a great side hustle until you get that renewal income high enough to go full time (which is exactly what I did) and no, I am not interested in recruiting anyone on Reddit. It is not EASY to enroll one new person per week, but it is certainly attainable. You will not have time to get ready for this Annual Enrollment period, there is too much training required. But next year if you start early you will be ready by the time October comes. Just my two cents."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/p6a89lz/

"I can completely relate to your struggles. I joined 2 agencies that provided free leads and promised they were fresh in exvhnage for a cut of commissions. I thought I finally had the answer to my problems. The first place didnt work out and I was making 500 dials a day and getting nowhere. The leads were old and tired of getting calls. The 2nd place- the lead quality was almost just as bad as the first. I learned that free leads is not the path to success but it helped me get over the fear of being on the phones. Now, Im at a place that I pay for my own inbound leads but the close rate has been insane. They have figured things out and have a great system in place for people that are willing to pay for leads and work hard. If you want to know more.or to come hang out with us for a day in zoom, let me know and I will set it up so you can see what we are doing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1su3zm9/i_am_stuck_frustrated_and_ready_to_give_up_on_my/oithfeh/

A book of business paying renewals · 14 documents · 14 voices

"How Keyboard Warrior Marketing Built My Commercial Book Faster Than Ads Ever Did I wanted to share a prospecting approach that has been huge for me, especially with small commercial accounts like pressure washers, lawn care, and other contractor niches. I call it **Keyboard Warrior Marketing**, and it is about showing up where potential clients already spend time online and leading with real underwriting insight instead of a hard sell. The workflow is simple. I join industry Facebook groups using my personal account, I watch for posts where people talk about pricing or ask coverage questions, and I jump in with quick risk checkups, not full quotes, just a few smart questions like what is your day to day, any employees, roof work, vehicles, or subs. It positions you as the expert and builds trust right away. After the comment I like and add the original poster and anyone else engaging. Over time Facebook starts suggesting me as a friend to more people in the same trade, which creates a passive lead funnel. From there I message when it feels natural, I quote small general liability policies in about five to ten minutes, I send PDFs and payment links so they can buy at their own pace, and I follow up one week, one month, and one quarter later if they do not close right away. It has been a steady stream of warm leads without ad spend. If you are an independent agent who wants to break into commercial, or you are tired of cold calls and expensive ads, this is worth trying. I am curious if anyone else here has been using something similar, or wants to share scripts and messaging strategies that work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o1c6iq/how_keyboard_warrior_marketing_built_my/

"Can I Sell Obamacare Independently & Keep Full Commissions? (San Antonio, TX) I recently found out that independent agents can sell ACA (Obamacare) plans and get paid per enrollee. I have an unusual connection to a ton of lower-income people who don't have health insurance, and if the plans are free for them, I don't see why they wouldn't take it. I have some questions before I jump in: 1. Can I work 100% for myself and keep the full residual commissions? 2. Do all ACA plans pay commissions, or do some \$0 plans not pay anything? 3. What's the standard commission per enrollee in Texas? I've heard numbers between \$10-\$20 per month per person, but I need confirmation. 4. If I go independent, can I start right away and get full commissions, or do I need to be under a broker at first? 5. How long does it take to get licensed and start enrolling people? I'm based in San Antonio, TX, and I know a ton of uninsured people who would easily sign up if I could get them covered for free. If this is real and scalable, I'm willing to grind hard and build this into a full-time business. If anyone has real experience selling ACA plans independently, please let me know what I'm missing. I don't want to waste time if there's a catch I haven't seen yet. Thanks in advance! Oh PS: My sister in mesa AZ wants to do the same thing. She manages a huge trailer park with residents."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8i38s/can_i_sell_obamacare_independently_keep_full/

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

"Medicare Advantage plan commissions are regulated and publicly posted online each year. It is not possible for anyone to SCAM you about commissions unless you don't do your own research. For 2027 people who are enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan for the first time earn the agent \$725.00 (some carriers pro-rate this during the year but most pay the full commission all year). Then agents receive a renewal commission of \$363.00 per year typically paid out monthly for as long as the client is enrolled. Some states like CA and NJ pay much higher commissions. Commissions typically go up each year based on whatever Medicare decides to pay. For example, in 2018 agents were paid \$400 per new enrollment and \$200 for renewals, so commissions have kept pace with inflation fairly well. If you enroll 50 new clients per year, (1 per week) your RENEWAL income total for those 100 clients in year 3 would be \$36,300 plus another \$36,300 if you continued to write one new one per week. Yes, I think is a great side hustle until you get that renewal income high enough to go full time (which is exactly what I did) and no, I am not interested in recruiting anyone on Reddit. It is not EASY to enroll one new person per week, but it is certainly attainable. You will not have time to get ready for this Annual Enrollment period, there is too much training required. But next year if you start early you will be ready by the time October comes. Just my two cents."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vuzbf/is_this_really_something_you_can_do_as_a_side/p6a89lz/

"Damn, I'm currently 'in the process' of getting hired, so far I'm out \$150ish for the fingerprints and licensing fees, was finally approved to 'move forward ' and take the open book test then I can meet the regional stiff (been almost 2 months). Should I just cut my losses and stop now? I'm new to town (100k ish pop) and really have few to no possible leads... I also worked for Cutco, this sounds just like cutco..."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ceu431/my_honest_review_of_aflac/lnvsziz/

"not in insurance personally but i run sales at a b2b software company so take what applies and ignore the rest the contracts thing is the one i'd hammer home hardest - book ownership is non-negotiable from day one. if you dont own your book you dont own your business, full stop. seen people get torched on that and its not pretty on niches - specialize early. i know everyone says "cast a wide net first" but the agencies i've seen scale fast picked a lane. contractors, trucking, whatever, just pick something you can actually get good at and where referrals compound lead gen: referral partnerships over paid leads, always. paid leads are a treadmill you never get off. find one or two good referral sources (mortgage brokers, accountants, whoever touches your niche) and go deep there software - dont overbuild your stack in year one. AMS is a non-negotiable, everything else can wait until you're actually producing revenue. the fancy quoting tools and automation stuff sounds good but you'll change your mind about what you actually need after 6 months of real volume anyway the aggregator question is the one i genuinely cant answer for you - that's too specific to insurance and regional carrier access for me to have a useful take"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vwadgv/independent_agency_owners_what_would_you_do/p60fzp7/

"I don't know anyone who is paying street level compensation with free inbound leads. I would ask for it in writing. Most places, will give you Leads, but they're gonna take a cut or they're not going to give you residuals. There are a lot of places popping up that will offer free inbound leads now I've noticed but they do not pay street global compensation and or do not give you residuals at least not full residuals. Also, most inbound leads are going to be calling for a food card. Just be aware. I'm an inbound agent right now, but I'm W-2. I've looked at being independent with inbound Leads, but the math didn't make sense after all my benefits, not saying it never does. It just wasn't a good fit for me at the time. Most places that are offering free about Leads. Most place, want at least one year of experience. The training is very different at an independent shop than a W-2 shop. Medicare has a lot of changes and a lot of plans that are not commissionable this year. You can always work for a carrier or for one of the many brokers that are offering free Leads just remember a lot of these places don't last very long."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofgspsp/

"That is actually an easier question to answer than you might think. "IF" you manage to work even 35 hours per week for a full year you will likely be around \$75k including the holdback that the insurance company does not pay out until the 9th month after the policy is booked. Most, and I do mean most, agents do not last more than a few months full time. And anyone that does, is making money. The top 20% are all going to be over six figures. Most will be less than \$5k, but that is because most will not work 40 hours per week and most will not work for a full year. If you are still an agent after a few months it will be because you are happy with your income."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/kod2pfl/

"Hi Luis, Brandy Cameron. I have subscribed to your channel and love your videos, I also signed up for Shaun's course so I have your work flows. You have great content, I'm planning to get agent CRM soon but wondered if you have a slide show presentation you use with a client, or is it your smart book you use, I'm wondering how to use a presentation to help cross sell more, any thought about buying your books but wanted your opinion, if you have a presentation I would love to see it and your intake form as well. This video was so helpful and sending out that intake form may help me to. Thank you, keep up the good work. 😊"

— YouTube · 🔥 ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 📄 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cLRWdaqypkc&lc=UgzAEaxYtDdigwh7Qx94AaABAq>

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "Here is the link to get the ACA and/or Smartbooks: <https://simplyhealthinsurance.thinkific.com/>";

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "thank you for watching and commenting"

↳ @InsuranceAgentTraining (1): "I am going make a video this week on cross selling. Stay tuned!! I assume this for cross selling ancillaries to ACA book?"

"All my business is by referral only. On average, that process takes about 4 years before you can make a living most of the time. I always had a full time job while I was building a book. The competition where I live is insane. Honestly, I don't think there's much future in selling Medicare anymore."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vtziac/my_experience_with_these_instagram_life_insurance/p5vz0fh/

"You absolutely should stick with Medicare, however, find an upline (I can recommend a few) that offers lead cost reimbursement tied to your sales. Then you could keep your book, your FULL commissions, and your upline gets their override. It's a win for everyone. Especially you after 2 years :)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/m67eyzp/

"aufan said: Where's John? Disneyland.....hahahahahaha....I can see the comment section hammering the individual market..... 'm single mother with degenerative disc disease. I can only work 30 hours a week and cannot afford the insurance available through my job. After years of paying medical bills out of pocket, I HAD to relenquish my pride and put my daughter and myself on state-sponsored insurance. I have a good primary care doctor, but can't get any kind of specialist - they just won't take my insurance. All my doctor can do at this point is try to get me medications so that I can function, but to no avail - they aren't covered. I have spent countless hours on the phone and driving from my doctors to the pharmacy and back again. Health Net continues to use every stall tactic in the book - taking well over a month while I scramble for "pre-authorization" and "medical necessity forms", even outright lying to me and offering me over the counter alternatives only to finally deny them. Of course, they give themselves another two weeks to "review" my appeal...while I wait in agonizing pain. How is this right? Posted by JTRUE67 at 09:02 PM : May 24, 2007 + report abuse See, this doesn't happen in other Western Nations because they have universal health coverage. Goodness, put these vicious sharks (health insurance companies) out of business!! They shouldn't be allowed to prey upon our weaknesses. Posted by rudy654 at 08:00 PM : May 24, 2007 + report abuse I can't believe someone finally lifted the rock to reveal the heartless, conscienceless moneygrubbing evil that is Fortis/Assurant. Four years ago I was struck by a mystery illness that left me with crushing exhaustion, confusion, joint pain and heart symptoms. Unfortunately, my disability was through Fortis. When I told them I was so sick I was barely able to rise and shower let alone drive, they told me to take a bus to work. I spent two years, sick as a dog, with morphing symptoms, fighting for disability. I finally received my diagnoses just as they were to give the final determination - Lyme Disease. Fortis laughed. DENIED. It took another two years after IV treatment, careful attention to my health and a move to a warmer, less polluted environment to get my strength back. Meanwhile I have lost everything I worked a lifetime to earn - including my home. Alone, struggling, 56 yrs old, uninsured and probably uninsurable, my biggest fear is that my health will fail again and my family will go down in flames financially trying to save me. I would, quite honestly, rather die. Texas Health Insurance Posted by mickisuzanne at 07:27 PM : May 24, 2007 + report abuse I would like to know how these insurance companies are getting away with this. I was hurt in work. I had given my employer a doctors note not to put me on a certain machine. The employer put me on it anyway. My back blew out. Now I have been fired from my job. Lost my health insurance, and am being told it will cost me thousands of dollars to be insured because I have a pre-existing back and heart problem. Pre-existing. It wasn't pre-existing when I worked. Now it is pre-existing. I had insurance when it all happened. I was fired from my job and my insurance was taken away. How can this happen to an American who has worked and payed insurance for over 35 years? The insurance company for workers compensation doesn't want to pay either. So now I may lose my house I've been in for over 18 years. I have written to the governor and the local news stations and they all say it isn't anything they can work on. Why is that? Someone is having a problem losing \$40,000. I am going to lose over a million due to my employers neglect and there isn't anything I can do? What a wonderful world. Posted by nepats1234 at 07:21 PM : May 24, 2007 + report abuse"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Assurant on CBS news tonight · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/assurant-on-cbs-news-tonight.1424/#post-19390>

"This is a completely unsolicited review of ACA Express and solely my opinion: I went through the demo video last night and am enrolling in the standard package today (no set up, no monthly, \$20 per app)-this is truly a no brainer for a single producer. I give ACA Express enormous credit on this because they have figured out a great business model-they built in a supplemental benefits option (called Out of Pocket Protector) that, if only added on 10% of the apps, will more than pay the application fees in full for using the system for the first year and provide an on-going stream of income in future years (renewal commissions on the lowest level package are 20% or \$200 per year). For them, of course, as an upline, they get the overrides on all of these sales and I'm sure this will be a significant revenue stream. Just a quickie on the Out of Pocket Protector-it is a typical gap plan, the base premium for an individual is \$69 per month (\$89 for a couple) and includes about \$300 a year in 'routine benefits' for office visits and lab tests-so the actual cost is about \$45 per month Individual and \$39 per month (couple) for all of the other stuff (figure an Accident indemnity plan plus benefits for hospital stays, outpatient surgery, and \$250 for an ER visit) and not a bad deal-I wish there was a critical illness rider that could be added, that would make it even better. In addition to the Standard package they do have a Pro package that is more for call centers and agencies with multiple agents with a monthly fee and lower fee per app. On a scale of 1-10, I give ACA Express an initial 9.2 (if they could eliminate carriers on the agent facing website it would be a 9.9-nothing is a '10' except Bo Derek about 35 years ago)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACAexpress.com · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/acaexpress-com.69122/#post-910567>

"hello there I came across your comment on a YouTube video and I noticed that you might be interested in generating leads for your business. As a digital marketing expert, I would like to introduce you to an effective way of generating leads through Facebook ads. Facebook is one of the most popular social media platforms, and it has a massive user base that you can tap into to promote your business. With Facebook ads, you can create highly targeted campaigns that reach your ideal audience and generate leads for your business. In conclusion, Facebook ads are a powerful tool for lead generation, and a professional leads generation service can help you take full advantage of this platform. If you're interested in learning more about how we can help you generate leads for your business, please don't hesitate to get in touch."

— YouTube · 6 Easy Steps To Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ck8W8FDaGYE&lc=Ugwst5wHv3WUgBeQy_14AaABAg_9ihjScRzgyO9mEn8-36CPP

Inbound business: clients who call them · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/16l3fuc/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internet.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trusted lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"It's great to see your enthusiasm for the real estate industry! The collaborative nature of this field really does open up so many opportunities, not just for personal growth but also for building a strong network that can lead to more successful transactions. Connecting with mortgage lenders and other service providers can create a seamless experience for clients, which is invaluable. I completely agree that the benefits are endless, especially when you leverage those relationships effectively. Staying engaged with your network and being proactive in seeking out collaborations can really set you apart. Full disclosure: I'm the founder of REReferrals.com, a SaaS that can help you in this because it streamlines the process of connecting with other agents and enhances your ability to close deals through referrals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iqsrez/love_this_industry/md31pcu/

"Put simply, internet leads are usually crap. It's much better to advertise, network and get referrals from existing happy customers. I'm not saying give up on internet leads altogether, just....make sure you know what their refund policy is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/ot4d3nt/

"full commission, I'm capped at 20 calls a day before 5p, then unlimited inbound after 5p. Also, I'm good on the phones, or so that's what I've been told by a good number of people."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nsuk4xc/

"I don't know anyone who is paying street level compensation with free inbound leads. I would ask for it in writing. Most places, will give you Leads, but they're gonna take a cut or they're not going to give you residuals. There are a lot of places popping up that will offer free inbound leads now I've noticed but they do not pay street global compensation and or do not give you residuals at least not full residuals. Also, most inbound leads are going to be calling for a food card. Just be aware. I'm an inbound agent right now, but I'm W-2. I've looked at being independent with inbound Leads, but the math didn't make sense after all my benefits, not saying it never does. It just wasn't a good fit for me at the time. Most places that are offering free about Leads. Most place, want at least one year of experience. The training is very different at an independent shop than a W-2 shop. Medicare has a lot of changes and a lot of plans that are not commissionable this year. You can always work for a carrier or for one of the many brokers that are offering free Leads just remember a lot of these places don't last very long."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofgspsp/

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Dialing and the phone, all day · 91 documents · 20 voices

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"I accidentally did not add collision on a clients car and they got into an accident Recently about a week ago, a customer of mine called in saying that they got a new car and over text. They let me know that they wanted comp and collision on it while the rest of their vehicles have liability. For some reason, I thought I added both comp collision, but she called me later today saying that she got into an accident and after looking her policy up, I notice the only comprehensive coverage and collision was not on there. Is this going to result in a E&O claim? Just want some advice in case anyone has ever gone through this. I know it was a negligent mistake on my end and I should have double checked. *UPDATE* I went and called first thing in the morning and explained the situation and they understood that it was agent error and accepted the backdated endorsement where they should have had collision. Thank you everyone for the advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/

"Job offer from Chubb I recently applied for, interviewed, and received a job offer today from Chubb. The position is for a UW tech on the farm and ranch side. Now, I've read post after post about the environment at Chubb, and the workload, and I really wanted to know if was as bad as people say. My interviewers led me to believe there was a great training program, and that getting out of the tech position, and moving up the ladder to a full UW, after a year or so was a possibility. It's currently on a 4/1 in office to WFH schedule. They seemed open and honest, and made it sound like most people on their team had some tenure. I've also heard to get in, get experience, and get out. Coming from a high stress career of LE/Military - can it actually compare? My experience in the insurance industry has all been in sales so far. Additionally, I had another interview today that was for a team lead role (different company), and I've already been offered a 2nd interview. I also received a phone interview for another UW assistant position with a different carrier later this week. Thoughts?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1k4pgc1/job_offer_from_chubb/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"2-14 Life and Annuity Exam (FL) Having just completed my certification course and passing the licensing exam, I figured I'd give a little insight to anybody considering it. It's a bit long winded but hopefully helps at least one person. If you're like me, any time you have a state exam, you immediately go online to find as much info possible to assure yourself that you can pass... YOU CAN! That is the reason for this post. I couldn't find ANYTHING on the 2-14 specifically. Only that it has a 61% pass rate. Which was intimidating compared to the SIE pass rate in the low 70s. The 40hr course: I used Kaplan. It's very straight forward. You read through the LEM while answering questions along the way. There should also be an additional LEM specific to your state and its pertaining regulations. After completing the course, the certification exam is unlocked, and after passing, the certificate of completion becomes available to print. Take it with you for state exam. Having just taken the SIE and Series 65, I'm a Qbank junkie. Definitely recommend doing as many practice questions and simulated exams as you can tolerate. The state exam: If you did the course as Kaplan instructs, and spent some time on practice questions, this test is a walk in the park. It's 95 questions broken up into a 55 and 40 question sections with, I believe, 15 being "experimental" and not counting towards your score. 2 hours allowed. I studied for 8 days and was in an out in 50 minutes. YMMV. You will be asked about riders, provisions, nonforfeiture options, benefits and how they're taxed, suitability, accelerated death benefits, premiums, conditional receipts, just about everything in the Kaplan course you will see at least once. I believe I only got one question on retirement plans, but I paid my dues on those in the s65. A fair amount on annuities and a lot on life insurance and rules/regs. Tips: - I'm big on reading the entire LEM. This one is short and sweet, so I'd recommend reading through it one full time before starting the course. - There will likely be discrepancies between the general LEM and your state specific LEM. Some time frames will be slightly different between them. I'd say go with your state specific, BUT I had one question about how many hours of continued education is on ethics. General LEM said 4hrs. My states LEM said 5hrs. 5hrs wasn't an optional answer on the exam. Take that for what it's worth. There's not enough discrepancies to make or break your final score, so don't stress it too much. - spend 1/3 of your time in the state LEM. I spent 1/5 of my time doing so and regulations ended up being my lowest scoring section of the exam. It's extremely boring, so just quickly read through then spend a solid amount of time doing practice questions on that section alone. - study everyday leading up to the exam and read over the cram sheets every night and once before you walk into testing center. Some people say don't study on test day. I study till I walk into the testing center. - get a good nights sleep, a healthy breakfast, and look pretty for your picture to be taken at the testing center!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/19fd8s0/214_life_and_annuity_exam_fl/

"Is 41 too late to get into insurance? Hey guys, looking into getting my p&c license and give selling insurance a go. I currently bartend, but that's only a side hustle really, not an actual career path. So my questions to you are • Is 41 too late to get into the industry? • Am I going to be sitting at a desk/cubicle all day? Or can/will I be up and moving about? • What are some of the best companies to apply for entry level positions at? Places with some of the best training. • Am I gonna have to cold call every day? Are leads provided? And if there's any other info you'd like to provide on what to expect as a first year insurance agent please feel free to drop it here."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1id8ena/is_41_too_late_to_get_into_insurance/

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if I had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgwyw8/

"Allstate? I accepted a sales position at an Allstate agency about a month ago and was told it would be a six figure opportunity. However, now that I'm in it, I don't see how. Allstate Marketplace Leads are pure shit. Anyone have experience working for an Allstate agent? Should I quit and just be independent? Seems like I might as well work for myself if all I'm doing is cold calling on bunk leads all day."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/>

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhxu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

"We do. But we also pay commission only since we are a younger agency. There are other agencies out there that would too. We buy 15-30 leads a day a producer. Warm leads. They average 30-40 calls a day, sell between 15-25k in premium a month. 3% ish close rate, quote about 10%. Not great, but every source we've tried sucks, this is the cheapest and the leads are decent."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygk/i_got_my_liscence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p93nnh0/

"Hi, I also work at an Allstate agency and this is my first insurance role. I just got licensed and accepted the first offer without doing much research. My day looks a lot like what you're describing: mostly outbound calls and working marketplace leads. There are people in my agency making six figures, but they're grinding hard like working Saturdays, staying late every day and they're extremely strong on the front end of the call. I've realized I'm probably not built for that style long-term. I don't think it's impossible at Allstate, but it's definitely a tough model and not for everyone. At my agency, the owner hired over 40 people this year and let about half go for performance, so the turnover is real. I'm personally looking at inbound roles (possibly Liberty Mutual) because I'm still very new and feel like I'd benefit more structured training and warm leads."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pp14vp/allstate/nujrdl0/>

"I'm now hearing Fauci talk about issuing immunity certificates, aka "freedom papers." I don't care who the President is - we cannot go down the road. While no one can deny the virulence of this disease and its ability to cause lasting damage to some and to kill others, we have to remember that this world survived the Black Plague and the Spanish Flu, both of which seemed far worse than this. This morning we find that researchers at Stanford now believe Corona came to California in the Fall, and the reason that Cali hasn't been hit as hard as New York is that millions of Californians had been exposed and thus allowed to develop herd immunity: Coronavirus herd immunity in California? Dr. Alok Patel shares his thoughts If that is true, then we have been going about this too severely. I do not know, but we should at least be as willing to consider that we have over reacted as we have been willing to consider this the end of the world as we know it. I posted an article the other day claiming COVID-19 was now leading cause of death. Today the CDC calls bull\$hit on that claim. Coronavirus is not the leading cause of death in the US, CDC says - CNN Now, how do we know the CDC isn't BS'ing us? I don't know. But with respect to the CDC and out government, we need to resume a healthy skepticism (not a hard-headed skepticism as some have displayed but not a naive Panglossian denial either). I've been struggling to understand what has been happening the same as y'all. What seems certain to us one day is revealed as misinformation or outright lies the next. But this is not the plague. This isn't even Spanish Flu. This outbreak should not be used to create what would necessarily become a police state: "Papers, sir? Where are they? Sir, turn and face the wall and place your hands behind your back." So I think it is time we start paying attention to what is being done to us and who is doing it and to stop letting folks convince us that life has to be different when we come out of this. We will come out of this quicker than many think, imo. And we need to be prepared to resume living our lives as free citizens. The only way we come out of this "changed forever" is if we let it change us. There is no reason we need to become card-carrying, mask wearing, slavish subjects of the Bureau of Truth. I still am committed to better safe than sorry. But I am unwilling to go beyond that. And if there appears evidence that we'd be safer by protecting the seniors and others at risk while the rest of us take our rational chances and go about out business, I'm ready to commit to that as well. Trust, but verify. And don't let them hide evidence from us. We need to keep our eyes out for all of us. We're all in this together in a way we haven't been in anything together, in my lifetime. We must expect the return of normalcy. We must not sit here planning for anything other than a return to normal American life - with as much Freedom as we had before going into this crisis. So, I'm getting ready to door knock, and I am expecting to be at it sooner than later (but probably not too soon, and certainly not soon enough). How about y'all?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Post-Corona, Preparing for Normalcy · 8 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/post-corona-preparing-for-normalcy.101857/#post-1348228>

"I'm a captive Medicare agent, formerly a life/health broker and I have zero interest in going back to the 1099 life. I get PTO, I work from home, I just sit here and take calls all day and I get to truly clock out and spend time with my family instead of always feeling like I should be dialing leads. I'm a carrier rep and made \$130k last year, on pace to break \$150k this year. So yea, the broker path has a higher ceiling but w-2 isn't poverty."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1v1wdq6/why_would_anybody_want_to_be_a_captive_agent/oyqslzd/

"I've been wanting to share this insight for a while but never got the chance to. If you're considering being a life insurance agent- Specifically if you're considering working for globe life or American Income Life insurance (that was my run off branch) I'd like to offer you the most transparent what to expect in terms of your pay since I don't see anyone else being blunt with their numbers. I worked for AIL for 3 years from 2019 to 2022. on average my salary was around \$60-\$70k a year. With that income I was typically working 10 to 12 hours a day on the phone 7 days a week and attending weekly (and sometimes daily) training calls with my "team". I didn't do the recruitment side of the business, just the insurance hustle (I know this is where a lot of people are going to point out that THAT IS WHY I DIDNT MAKE AN EXTRAVAGENT AMOUNT PF MONEY) but let's be real, I didn't my my insurance liscence to recruit other people trying to get their insurance license, I did it to swell insurance. When you see that people are making"\$100k a month" or "\$MILLIONS a year" know this. If I sold a \$10,000 life insurance policy (which is a very minimum, basic, but affordable policy) I made \$55 in commission. with a \$1 residual pay that I would receive the following month. HOWEVER, when we hop on calls at the beginning of the week it would be announced that I "MADE" \$10,000 (completely untrue) and to capitalize on this they always ask "how much of that amount do you get to keep" to which you are trained to respond by saying "all of it" pretty manipulative too the new people huh? but we take what we can get and convince ourselves that if we just do that 10x over we'll eventually have what would look like a 'good check' here's the kicker about those "residuals" after the following month of each policy, you don't get them anymore. for whatever reason they give you, those get kicked to your upper and you basically only have that one time payment to count on. so if I can give you any advice on 'residual payments' it's that somewhere in the fine line of your contract I can guarantee they're not yours to keep. they will find some rhyme and reason as to why it will go back to the company. so, for over 10 hours of work a day, you might make \$55. "oh but what about those that ARE making millions" or "you just needed to work harder" let me tell you something: I busted my as off on the phone and my spline KNEW I had no interest in recruiting people so EVENTUALLY (we'll say after a year) I got granted some pretty good leads. Now I was finally able to make some big bucks! Without getting too verbose the average policy amount for these clients would be ranging from \$150k ~\$500k. The largest I ever sold was for a \$500k policy and here's the breakdown for that : I got paid a whopping \$1,300 in commission and a \$300 'residual' the following month. so ...you do the numbers"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mh1vhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nhgtz0w/

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating im new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12–13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am garanteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

"I work at an agency where we receive only inbound calls. We have a weekly charge of around \$850. This covers everything from the dialer to the office space and the leads as well The first two weeks are free though. My one call today covers that charge so I'm ok with it. People who have been doing it for a while are just killing it there. I used to work furniture sales and during slow season when the snowbirds were out of town, that was all I would make in one or two weeks occasionally. Definite Upgrade!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/oum8y9g/

"Just giving an update. I followed your video and my ad has been up and running. So far I've generated 2 leads going on 48 hours set at 50.00 daily."

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFTo3FiUCM&lc=UgzSHGMVmxVflzSg01N4AaABAq>

↳ @phylliskalu3442 (3): "I only recommend doing this if you have multiple states. I only have one state didn't generate enough leads."

↳ @amillionairerise (2): "@phylliskalu3442 what about the quality of leads?"

↳ @matthewjanssenAutoSavvy (0): "What state?@phylliskalu3442"

Service work: renewals, changes, client problems · 35 documents · 20 voices

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"I was just terminated: any advice? I just completed 3 years of service with LM. A year ago my department was dissolved and I moved into our choice department. I held my own pretty well for 6 months but this year they changed the metrics around, and as of today our 155 person strong department stands at 77. Well I was 77 now I guess 76. The goals got higher. The leads got tougher. I make no excuse, but all it took was falling into the bottom 20% once in my first few months, and second time in July, and finally a third time last month- my performance continued to degrade as the goals increased and my stress and feelings of ineptitude built up. I clocked in today and was terminated 10 minutes in. I was told to direct any questions to HR, who told me to direct questions about my 401k to fidelity, and my licenses are kind of in limbo no one seems to have any idea what happens with those. LM was my first broach into this field. It was the best money I ever made. But now I have a family, and I don't know what to do or where to go next- im not looking for job recommendations, I'm sure plenty of people already are. But what can I do to hit the ground rolling? How do I try to find a way back into an industry that just rejected my honest to God, best performance?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1fyelhw/i_was_just_terminated_any_advice/

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell of the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"For those of us who've already been living in this final telesales telesales world, I thought it would be a good idea to share tips, carriers, and lead vendors to our cohorts to help them during these uncertain times. Whats your favorite carrier? Whats your favorite kind of lead? What tips do you have? --- My favorite carrier is American Amicable because of the ease of doing business. Although, I am finding, that many other carriers are getting better daily. The best lead for telesales is still TV. However, Facebook lead costs have CRASHED. This is a great time to jump in and get leads for \$2-\$3. I wouldnt use a vendor only to pay 200% more. Research and do it yourself. Heres my tip. Dont go back through all your old leads and think you are going to resurrect intrest. Buy new leads, and buy alot of them."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344504>

"Hey, I'm a new Agent, I got licensed less then a year ago. During my training, I was taught for that rebuttal was "I don't do any second appointments, because we shop every A Rated carrier today to see who you would get approved for." Something within them lines. To avoid that rebuttal, I was taught to ask who they make their financial decisions with & if they was around. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugxu8xdq4l-QqJxrU4x4AaABAg>

↳ @Countmoneyforever (4): "i think it helps! Also the better you qualify the better youll close. for example i always ask "who makes financial decisions for you?" and "if were able to find something affordable that meets your needs, when would you like that plan to start?" if they say today you keep going but if they say "im not sure" or anything else you gotta figure out why BEFORE you present any options! Our most important asset is time, dont let these ppl waste any"

↳ @bejrnews (0): "New agent here. How's your book of business doing?"

"The date of the accident was today and she formally requested "both Comprehensive and collision please" over text last Wednesday to me. I tried going in there today and making an endorsement backdating 3 days ago but I'm sure they will see that and question it or deny the claim, so I don't know what I should do"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2eytp/

"P&C builds a book of business with renewals but also client relationship which leads to sales of other ancillary products. The shoe can drop on the captive side if the carrier decides to blow their rates out of the water in your area. Life pays the best but there's zero client relationship after the sale. ACA is a grind, especially going into this year's enrollment with the new rules in place, small per-person as-earned commissions where you'd need to enroll a lot of people for years and years to really see it start to add up. I sell life to small business owners, but with no renewals, it's great money but it's also Groundhog day every day."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n5603iv/

"I'm now hearing Fauci talk about issuing immunity certificates, aka "freedom papers." I don't care who the President is - we cannot go down the road. While no one can deny the virulence of this disease and its ability to cause lasting damage to some and to kill others, we have to remember that this world survived the Black Plague and the Spanish Flu, both of which seemed far worse than this. This morning we find that researchers at Stanford now believe Corona came to California in the Fall, and the reason that Cali hasn't been hit as hard as New York is that millions of Californians had been exposed and thus allowed to develop herd immunity: Coronavirus herd immunity in California? Dr. Alok Patel shares his thoughts If that is true, then we have been going about this too severely. I do not know, but we should at least be as willing to consider that we have over reacted as we have been willing to consider this the end of the world as we know it. I posted an article the other day claiming COVID-19 was now leading cause of death. Today the CDC calls bull\$hit on that claim. Coronavirus is not the leading cause of death in the US, CDC says - CNN Now, how do we know the CDC isn't BS'ing us? I don't know. But with respect to the CDC and out government, we need to resume a healthy skepticism (not a hard-headed skepticism as some have displayed but not a naive Panglossian denial either). I've been struggling to understand what has ben happening the same as y'all. What seems certain to us one day is revealed as misinformation or outright lies the next. But this is not the plague. This isn't even Spanish Flu. This outbreak should not be used to create what would necessarily become a police state: "Papers, sir? Where are they? Sir, turn and face the wall and place your hands behind your back." So I think it is time we start paying attention to what is being done to us and who is doing it and to stop letting folks convince us that life has to be different when we come out of this. We will come out of this quicker than many think, imo. And we need to be prepared to resume living our lives as free citizens. The only way we come out of this "changed forever" is if we let it change us. There is no reason we need to become card-carrying, mask wearing, slavish subjects of the Bureau of Truth. I still am committed to better safe than sorry. But I am unwilling to go beyond that. And if there appears evidence that we'd be safer by protecting the seniors and others at risk while the rest of us take our rational chances and go about out business, I'm ready to commit to that as well. Trust, but verify. And don't let them hide evidence from us. We need to keep our eyes out for all of us. We're all in this together in a way we haven't been in anything together, in my lifetime. We must expect the return of normalcy. We must not sit here planning for anything other than a return to normal American life - with as much Freedom as we had before going into this crisis. So, I'm getting ready to door knock, and I am expecting to be at it sooner than later (but probably not too soon, and certainly not soon enough). How about y'all?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Post-Corona, Preparing for Normalcy · 8 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/post-corona-preparing-for-normalcy.101857/#post-1348228>

"I mean I started in insurance 7 years ago and first 2 years was basically all cold calling. Sold U65, just call up and say, "hey my name is Bob, I help people with their health insurance coverage, do you feel like your getting good coverage for what your paying?" 400+ calls every day and made a good little book of business but haven't done that in awhile and I know things have changed"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1udkyjb/just_do_it/otdok1t/

"Yeah I'm a captive agent. Do you think I should call the claims department first thing in the morning and explain the whole situation? It should I wait for them to try and deny the claim and then bring up the mistake and written proof"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2kmnp/

"Addiction Treatment Facility's Receptionist is Playing Medical Insurance Agent. A "Provider" can't make these types of recommendations? (hint: i'm noticing so much corruption in this industry...but I forget the specific laws regarding this situation). Hi All! I was a Group Medical Benefits Agent/Producer for 6 years...licensed...stopped in 2018. (I live in WA State but I imagine the laws for what I'm explaining here should probably be similar from state to state). I'm not in insurance now...I'm in an "adjacent" industry. Anyway, in late 2018 I got a DUI...and I've been completely sober since...don't judge. 😊 However, as part of the conditions from the court I was required to attend Intensive Outpatient Treatment. I went to a place my lawyer recommended. (I'm 90% positive he receives kickbacks from the treatment center for sending his clients with court orders...but that's for another post...this could easily become a series...truly...the crookedness—on so many layers—in the treatment industry is shocking...and they're doing it all in plain sight). Anyway, I'm 45-years-old...and there are a lot of young folks who attend the program with me. (Learned my lesson later In life maybe? 🙄) I found out that I'm paying MUCH more than MOST of the other people in my "group". My monthly out-of-pocket cost/monthly bill is much higher—obscenely higher—than most everyone else I attend with. I understand VERY well how every plan is different...they reimburse differently...cost shares vary as do deductibles and OOP Max's. I get that...I have BCBS of IL...I work for a large public ally-traded company and my insurance is considered "really good"...it reimburses well...\$1000 ded...and it's a 90% plan...but that's not the point of this post. This specific question came from a girl named Megan who just turned 21. (I changed her name to protect the...er...young :)). Anyway, when I asked her about her costs each month she told me that after a month of evening "groups" at "The Center"...the girl who answers phones at the front desk of the treatment center (she makes coffee for before groups too) told her, "Oh you should definitely change your insurance carrier to Amerigroup...it has WAY better coverage and "pays more". Then she said, "I tell EVERYONE to switch to them...I should get commission , haha!". Well...i talked to an old coworker who sells individual policies and, sure enough, Amerigroup definitely reimburses/pays the Treatment Provider aka "The Center" more...so Megan pays less. In other words...it's much better for "The Center" if more of their patients have Amerigroup as their carrier. When I heard this, my ex Agent/Producer ears perked up and I thought, "Wait...I'm pretty sure that NOBODY—in a professional setting, dealing with customers—is supposed to give insurance advice to relative strangers on what insurance to buy or what carrier they should choose, right? Or can they? But I'm pretty positive that Medical or Treatment Providers, specifically, aren't supposed to recommend specific carriers to their patients...or can they?" That's why I'm here asking. My opinion—due to several other reasons—is that this place is crooked and corrupt. First, I want to look into this practice at "The Center". In this specific instance, I'm quite sure the front desk staff has been coached on what plans to recommend "in passing"...and she is making these recommendations based on which Carriers/Plans "reimburse" the most to "The Center"...and she interfaces with 100s of clients/patients every day. Seems like a conflict of interest...right? The WA OIC probably wouldn't like this...ya? Pretty sure I had to take a test, work for a broker, and take C.E. classes periodically; in order to sell health insurance policies...yep...I do remember that. :) Can anyone explain the law here...I'm a bit rusty. Can the Provider in this case potentially be in hot water for this practice? What about the front desk receptionist herself? She is giving advice to people to switch carriers specifically based on how much it reimburses the Provider...or, "because this carrier covers more than your current carrier"...can she potentially be in trouble? Or is it "The Center" who would take the heat for training her that way? She's a nice girl...the front desk gal...but I'm afraid her corrupt overlords could get her in trouble. Thanks for reading all of that!!! This place is advising and billing lots of youngn's...but mostly bilking ACA/State-sponsored insurance plans/carriers...aka Uncle Sam. I kinda wanna "get em". Feel free to ask what else is corrupt there...I'm learning a LOT! :)"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/f4n1tq/addiction_treatment_facilitys_receptionist_is/

"Have a team of few hundred agents , the goal we set for agents is to write at least one policy a day if you are new. If you have been here for more than 90 days 2 policies a day. If you have been here for 6 months 3 policies a day. If you are a veteran agent the goal is 5-10 policies a day. The average policy is to 1000AP. So the question you need to solve first is do you have more time or do you have more money right now? Most agents have a lot more time than money. The next problem is that you need to know how to develop your skillset before you burn all of your marketing capital. You can take the slow route of forming referral partners, warm market, bingo nights etc. unless you are a boring 60yr old who started 20 years ago this isn't the move. Embrace the times, it's all about internet leads, a lead driven business, there is an endless amount of people to talk to and pitch insurance. It has never been easier. When we started it was suits and kitchen tables, now any Gen Z with a laptop and a Stiiizy pen can sit in sweatpants with a Stanley and crush \$500-\$1000 a day in deposits like clockwork. It was hard to watch at first considering what use to have to be done, but we have to embrace the times. Tip: start with final expense leads that are less than \$1 , preferably something that is about 15 cents a lead. Yes, it's going to require a ton of dials. You will have to put a bunch of sweat work in before you get paid. I tell my kids , in order for you to start selling 2-3 policies a week in your first month, you need to spend 15 hours a day on the phone for a good 7-10 days in a row to develop some grit. Then someone can start working with you. The next most important thing is who you marry? It's not the IMO , it's not the carrier, it's not the comp plan , you need a solid mentor who can work with you daily and give you feedback. This will cut down the learning curve by 50%, having someone who sells at a high level giving you feedback is priceless. Accept that you can work your tail off and still not make 10k in your first month. That is ok, you are nothing less. Understand that when you have put enough time and reps in the 10k will come easy. Then you will start chasing the 20k, 30k and 40k of Deposits ; it's not that hard to write 10,000-20,000 AP a week. The hardest thing is going from 0-10,000 consistently. Once you have your skill set somewhat polished then you just scale up the marketing. Wish you the best , get after it !"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ouo21x/anybody_here_make_at_least_10k_a_month_in_life/nof72gg/

"I have been contracted with about seven carriers for life insurance and I'm slowly getting the rest of them but yes I just got licensed left my 16 year career in the dental field and I have not yet sold one policy but I am officially two weeks and after getting carriers And I'm currently working still at a dental office helping a dentist for three days while I transfer out completely but I own my own small business seeing clients and also now trying to sit behind a desk and dial all day it's a lot, but I know I can do it. Glad I found this videos for more information on how a life insurance agentcareer is pass my exam the first time and have bought leads, but haven't had much success so I've made flyers."

— YouTube · PROS & CONS OF BEING AN INSURANCE AGENT · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UfHT3xWq4TY&lc=Ugzr4N3sCTVahCgXMbd4AaABAq>

"Kinda already is (for Medicare with strict rules) but these ad agencies just use oversea lead generators who have very little regulation. Literally spam an ad out saying "click here for \$3000" and then sell that as a lead. It's pretty ridiculous they allowed it to get to this point, Something has to give. My clients say they can't even use their phone because of these call centers and ads popping up nonstop. Nonstop ads spamming them from every direction with spam calls that follow."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nszc7mq/

"I actually work for this company and have been for almost 10 years. I'm sorry you had a bad experience but your take on this is pretty jaded and not to mention one-sided. This industry might not have worked for you, but if you go anywhere else, you would probably have the same complaint. I remember when I first started I had a really rough start, I started 2018 with almost \$1,500 in chargebacks. But I worked my ass off and actually made productive agent that quarter. I focus mainly on Medicare; generally, the clients I talk to aren't interested in \$ 15 to \$ 30-a-month life insurance policies. It's pretty obvious you didn't research this company or the business before you got into it. Almost every single company out there is 1099; yes, there are W-2s, which is nice, but a lot of those are P&C. All of the products we sell are legitimate and offered by almost every insurance company out there. The government mandates Medicare supplements, and a supplement from Bankers or XYZ company is the same. Not to mention, Medicare Advantage is the same across the board. Our universal Life policies are very competitive in the market and are quality products; not to mention, we are one of the few companies still selling long-term care. As far as that lady goes who bought her own car, well, that's sort of on her. Bankers didn't force her to buy that car. I rode around in a 99 CRV for 4 years, then a 04 Accord for 2, and then I bought my next car outright in cash. The insurance industry in general has tons of turnover just like any other sales position. I realized Bankers gets a lot of hate here and across the industry, but insurance is personal responsibility and holding yourself accountable. I sleep very well at night knowing that my clients are well taken care of and are on compliant, good products that serve their needs."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/pbk7ksx/

"Medicare consumers are actively searching for licensed agents who can help them compare Medicare Supplement plans and understand options in their state. MedicareSupp.org helps them find you. [Get Listed on MedicareSupp.org] MedicareSupp.org gives agents a low-cost, high-visibility way to build credibility, generate quality leads, and grow their book of business, without cold calling. Over the past year, MedicareSupp.org has had 85,000+ new users and 10,000+ directory searches by Medicare consumers. "I got three new clients within the first month of joining. Best investment I've made in my Medicare business." — David R., Licensed Agent in Ohio Claim your listing today and start getting discovered by Medicare consumers nationwide. [Get Listed on MedicareSupp.org Today]"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Join MedicareSupp.org: More Than a Directory — A Trusted Medicare Marketplace · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/join-medicare-supp-org-more-than-a-directory-%E2%80%94-a-trusted-medicare-marketplace.117749/#post-1583206>

"LostDollar said: So it is my opinion that a significant portion of today's (Today meaning something like current decade) hoopla over how wonderful MA coverage is for vets stems from financial incentives created by carriers for those selling and holding MA-MAPD type insurance plans. I think that High Deductible medigap plans could also continue to be viable supplementary Medicare insurance products for some veterans. lol..... You're a one-trick pony. LD's insurance services: "Have you considered a high deductible med supp?" That's probably the last option I'd recommend to someone with TriCare or even non-Tricare VA Benefits. (And in your mind, you'll think I'm saying this only for financial reasons. You'd be wrong)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Know it All Veterans · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/know-it-all-veterans.108924/#post-1427998>

"Get a job at Neilson Financial Services in Downtown Toronto I got the job here after working at AIL and going through an interview with Serenia life too this company pays you handsomely for Salary and a good amount for commission they generate actual good quality warm leads that allow you to call all day and actually perform I been here for approx 2 months now and the benefits start for me next month I'm loving it so far and they are always hiring and the companies they represent have great reviews from actual customers who talk to advisors on a daily basis they also pay you while getting ur license if u don't have it already and they have fair metrics"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fx4zhe/i_hate_american_income_life_ail_so_bad/maaa35u/

AEP and enrollment season hours · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Okay. I mostly just do Medicare. I am licensed in everything. I get \$250 - \$350 per enrollment, and they supply all the calls. I make my own hours. During AEP, which is 10/15 - 12/7, I did 170 enrollments working around 6 hours a day. The go-getters did 400+ enrollments. The second busy season is 1/1 - 3/31. After that, I'll do some odd jobs until next season. I do have the option of grinding it out all year. They are going to incorporate life insurance, along with Medicare and ACA, to keep us busy. I'd rather not work the slower season because you have more opportunities for personalities to clash when it's slow, and management needs something to do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pwf3y3/how_much_do_insurance_brokers_actually_make/nwgjplm/

"Well this is where thr studying comes in. I the first quarter you have OEP and in the rest of the year (ROY) you have various other enrollment periods and 10k people turning 65 every day. Lots of opportunities. But you have to learn to understand the system first. Your ability to sell is directly proportional to how well you can navigate Medicare and the various rules."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/ldlzz3/

"You blame Medicare marketing compliance rules for this.. You CANNOT say Medicare is ANYTHING like ACA. ACA will become like Medicare with *compliance and disclosures*. AND with our new admin(🍌🍌). We might not have ACA anymore. Just STM. Some of those short term medical plans are only for 3 months in some states even after the recent changes. And there are rules where you can't reinstate with some carrier in same year. Health insurance is a circus right now. Medicare(MAPD) and ACA are typically uneducated people getting harassed all day during AEP/Open Enrollment. The chronic flips thinking they're getting something *more everytime added*. If you want to talk about *deceitful* then look at limited med with multiplan without major medical carrier with it. Which is way less compliant than ACA. And they're discount plans not real insurance for 2-300\$+ Yes people click once or couple times. And those leads are sold and sold again every month(.20 cents - 50\$). And 90% of that business you could get from those cheap leads will be flipped by end of the year or within 3 months clawback time. Vs your 30% you're suppose to lose on avg every year. Call Amazon or some other large company right now and watch you get redirected from Customer Service to Medicare agency. Sometimes the smaller newer agencies do spoof the numbers or emails to look like local food business even Amazon. Everyone wants a piece of the pie"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/npm451h/

"Can I ask, have you spoken to a Mike from that company? L After I attended the group 'interview' spoke to the person who invited me to the zoom meeting, Alyssa was her name literally yesterday. Anyways I told her the training schedules were out of my ability to commit to and was no longer interested at this time. We said our goodbyes and she wished me good luck because I was taking my life insurance exam the same day (and I passed!!) And went on with my day. This was December 4th, 2025. Now today around 530pm CT time December 5th, 2025 this guy Mike calls me who lead the majority of the group interview. We spoke for about 30/40 minutes and honestly was excited. But now I decided to look up the company, read the reddit forums and now things are clicking. Im already working with a different company. Its a Brokerage and I feel more at peace/home with that company than Global life. Im just a 24 year old so someone please be honest. Im already struggling and i dont need a company to duck me over some more...."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mnj1p8/warning_globe_life_zuzick/nsioz39/

"AllenChicago said: Thank-you for that valuable feedback MWoodbrid! It sounds like HealthSherpa would be your primary go-to WBE, if it was as accurate, and intuitive, as ACA Express. I am not reading it that way since we provide additional benefits such as AgencyBlock integration, i.e. all things being equal we still have features they do not. While he did not compare customer service response directly in his post, he did say we have many options and have been responsive. <snip> AllenChicago said: I'm going to Google locate an ACA Express quoting site, and test the workflow to see if it's more intuitive than Sherpa. We will be providing an option soon to have on the CFS (Client Facing Site) the current flow which is, as MWOODBIRD said, better than theirs, but also flow more similar to last years. AFS (agent Dashboard) already has this option via "Quick Quote" or "Create Applicant". AllenChicago said: The two different quoting platforms Health Sherpa uses are at odds with each other. I totally dislike the "public facing" version. Prefer the Agent platform, but it's somewhat awkward to have to log into your Dashboard and run quotes from there. Especially when sitting next to your client, because He/she sees other people you've enrolled. Thanks again for taking the time to share your experience-based insights, MWoodbrid. And congratulations on being able to enroll 9 people every day during the open enrollment. Quite a feat for a 1-man operation! -Allen Click to expand... Agreed! And glad to be part of it for him!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA Express -vs- HealthSherpa · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-express-vs-healthsherpa.78694/#post-1050586>

"Thank-you for that valuable feedback MWoodbrid! It sounds like HealthSherpa would be your primary go-to WBE, if it was as accurate, and intuitive, as ACA Express. I haven't had anyone "get lost" in HealthSherpa this year. Last year, their labeling of the application fields was screwy, which generated quite a few phone calls from people who were right in the middle of the enrollment process. I'm going to Google locate an ACA Express quoting site, and test the workflow to see if it's more intuitive than Sherpa. The two different quoting platforms Health Sherpa uses are at odds with each other. I totally dislike the "public facing" version. Prefer the Agent platform, but it's somewhat awkward to have to log into your Dashboard and run quotes from there. Especially when sitting next to your client, because He/she sees other people you've enrolled. Thanks again for taking the time to share your experience-based insights, MWoodbrid. And congratulations on being able to enroll 9 people every day during the open enrollment. Quite a feat for a 1-man operation! -Allen"

— Insurance-Forums.com · ACA Express -vs- HealthSherpa · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-express-vs-healthsherpa.78694/#post-1050570>

Private Worries

Not making money, no sales, broke in year one · 17 documents

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"We do. But we also pay commission only since we are a younger agency. There are other agencies out there that would too. We buy 15-30 leads a day a producer. Warm leads. They average 30-40 calls a day, sell between 15-25k in premium a month. 3% ish close rate, quote about 10%. Not great, but every source we've tried sucks, this is the cheapest and the leads are decent."

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wd1ygg/i_got_my_liscence_a_month_ago_ive_sold_zero/p93nnh0/

"I went broke trying to sell insurance. I drained my savings and had to take money out of my annuity. I left owing the company I worked for over \$2500 for customers who flaked out on their policies. I worked over time, never missed a training meeting, joined the chamber of commerce, bought leads, went to promotional events, spoke to members of rotary clubs and held an informational brunch which I paid for. I did all this because I truly believed I would succeed. Now I'm broke."

— YouTube · 102 Former Insurance Agents Explain Why They Quit [No BS] · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xv8pQ6cZ7oU&lc=Ugzxfw9nKcH1vVv4XF14AaABAg>

"Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, youre not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0bm9o/

"Recent L/H licensed, selling medicare advantage, need career advice So I've been selling Medicare Advantage plans since last summer and it's been good overall. The agency culture is nice, fully remote, warmish inbound leads, good training, decent commission, and I sold 110 policies in AEP. I'm doing well during OEP so far and have averaged 2-3 policies a day. I just got my life license to sell final expense after OEP since many enrollment codes are going away. That being said, commission only is tough, but I'm lucky to have savings and to live with my parents. I don't want to live with them long term and am looking to move out later this year. I know final expense can be good, but I want to see what's out there. Does anyone here work for agencies on a remote basis that offer base + benefits or at least renewals while giving you decent leads? I get \$275 per policy but I have to wait until the policy clears 120 days to get the whole payment (get 50% upfront). I'm realizing that NAC and churn can screw with your pay too. It'd be great if I got some sort of renewal, but they are paying for leads so it's up front commission only. I just have my L/H licenses and I've heard good things about employee benefits too. I have a strong preference for fully remote, but am open to hybrid in San Diego if it's the right opportunity. I also don't want to get involved in MLMs or pitch friends and family. I'd be grateful for your 2 cents. Thanks in advance!"

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hx3ebv/recent_lh_licensed_selling_medicare_advantage/

"L&H broker considering transition to commercial P&C... Opinions? I currently broker Medicare plans as an independent agent. I do remote sales and do very well relative to most in the industry. I have some lead gen systems in place that I am confident can transfer to any other sales role. However, my one concern is the endless compliance regulations for selling Medicare plans to seniors. With almost every way of contacting a prospect being uncompliant, I can't help but worry that in the future one slip up could cause me to lose my business that I have gained over years of selling. I do ethical business and I will not screw someone over to make a commission, but I am looking for something else with less regulation on how I acquire a client, that also pays residuals and decent upfront commission. I am not going to go captive, I am a commission only type of person, I want to lose big and win big. I'd rather put in the work to own my book of business and get my full commission. Anyone with experience in independent commercial P&C brokering with some insight on my next steps or where to learn more? How is compliance and regulations in that sector? Is there anything better than commercial P&C as far as commission and residuals? I only mention commercial because I heard that can be big money. Let me know opinions and if there are any other commission only sales routes I should pursue for good residuals. Thank you!"

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dwvp5q/lh_broker_considering_transition_to_commercial_pc/

"bro! everything you said in your spunky 6 min recruitment video was awesome, everything you said is exactly what my IMO says i should do or say door knocking and chargebacks are ruining me, i sell Fex with transamerica, RNA, Liberty Bankers, prosperity i can do upgrades policy reviews im very good at this but sadly i just lost my car due to an asshole who crashed my car while it was parked in my driveway plus like i said chargebacks are ruining me, i liked your working from home setup.... BUT!!!!!! i skimmed towards the end and i saw your catch, its sad because you sound like whats wrong with this world, if i had \$1000 to invest in your little setup here i wouldnt be so stressed about how im not making a penny in this bussiness. im broke and thats why i need to make money but if i have to invest \$1000 i cant join because im broke hence why i would like to join so i can make money, seems more like you make more by having pepole join and by the time they notice its just like every gimmick out there you already made a grand each person that joins. maybe one day ill make money but so far i dont see that any time soon. nice try."

— YouTube · Day In The Life Of A Life Insurance Agent (Work From Home) · 5 likes · life / final-expense agent · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D8Uca74uodA&lc=Ugzj6AUt086V5zoqcR4AaABAq>

"I am in for 2 years doing great-no sales to family yet-leads provided!"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/ojxdil/

"Most I've seen are commission only. Several are reaching out to me lol. Which did you work for?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/mxper3h/

"Thank you so much for showing how to do this! I knew it existed but could never figure out how to set it up. I have a question - If I wanted to switch uplines :-)As long as my current upline agrees to release me, does the 6 month waiting period before the ACA carriers will change my upline still apply? I just became contracted with the ACA carriers recently and haven't made any sales yet, if that matters."

— YouTube · FREE LEADS!! How to get free leads for ACA "Obamacare" · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sBopPuhBx74&lc=UgwM4KV9akHGUUfoIwV4AaABAg>

"I've spent the last year and a half looking for an IT job. 🤔 I have my CompTIA A+, studying for my security+, and haven't been able to find a job. So I got my insurance license. And I've been working for a subsidiary of Globe life/ American Income life called AO. I love all the people on my team and they are all very helpful when it comes to training, and they paid me for the two weeks of training. I've had my own leads for about a week and a half. I haven't made any sales yet, but I'm still giving it a shot. At the same time, I have still been applying to IT jobs, so hopefully, I can find something. I don't think I'm made for insurance. Lol but IT seems to be really hard to get into if you have no experience. That being said, I wish you all the luck!"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fmntn2/life_insurance_recruiters_are_liars/ojcm6s/

"What numbers are you calling. We are a commercial independent agency and my agents make 50 to 100 calls a day based on x dated leads in industry they focus on. They write 100k to 400k a month in premium and make 5k to 20k a month as 1099 commission only agents. They get 50% of what agency gets in commission new and renewal."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wjj70/what_are_your_thoughts/paefk5l/

"Do you have any additional licenses? One of the training agencies I know focus a lot on helping people on the PNC side cross cell multiple lines or bring in commission only reps to assist. Also finding a cost-efficient way to market. What ratio of live transfers are converting to a quote and then to a sale?"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1w0agml/insurance_broker_advice_needed/p6bj8dd/

"I make 2000-3000 outside of open enrollment and 3000-8000 in open enrollment... commission only"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=Ugxp475MeA9l4l3wXEJ4AaABAq>

"So if I just get my license, how would I get leads if I'm broke 🤔"

— YouTube · How To Work Insurance Leads Like A Pro! (Cody Askins & John Wetmore) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nf_TnViVvls&lc=Ugww-5LRmwpP-S1knGZ4AaABAq

"I've been in sales for a couple years and am migrating to life insurance to make more money. I'm nervous about working commission only but where I work now I'm a top closer. Any tips for first time reps aside from closing tracks? Maybe logical opportunities such as "well if you're paying x for x amount of coverage, I will actually give you more coverage for a better rate, you get more bang for the buck" essentially. Any more things like that?"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=UgyTH1UYFafju6eL9114AaABAq

Money burned on leads that never answer · 29 documents

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"Bad\$\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just dont waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

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Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

1. **Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues. 2. **Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications. 3. **Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends. 4. **Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo>) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gy923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxh2u/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/ml267eh/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"You answered your own question. Leads are shit abd the vendors are reselling leads. In my state, there will be a new 1:1 consent law possibly going into effect early 2026. This will prevent lead vendors from reselling the same fucking lead to 10 different agents. Leads are just shit overall right now. My close right is the worst it has ever been because of these trash leads. Half of them don't even qualify because they have no prior."

— InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer9kzq/

"Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/

"that's a honestly great question. I guess I have two sides to it. 1st. Do not leverage yourself past your means for leads as far as I'm concerned that's gambling and not a good idea. 2nd. while the slow grind sucks, I would do what you can to save every dollar to buy high quality leads. buy one a month two a month whatever you can afford and work events out side of that. This industry can snowball and quickly if you provide exceptional customer service. But just because you can make 100K plus commissions easily doesn't mean there isn't people out there and didn't go broke and a lot in my opinion is having bad leads. With good leads it's nearly impossible to lose money, but that's the trick finding good leads I would say for every good source there is 50 bad ones if not more. I went through 30-40 before I found the one I have now. that's just my 2 cents I'm by no way or shape an expert I'm not even with 1 year under my belt I get my story is unique and I got very lucky and swung for the fences. I only did it cause I had the income to burn and it wasn't going to leverage me in the slightest. Even knowing the future I wouldn't have put it on a credit card."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/nantrn/

"⚠️ American Income Life = Scam ⚠️ I spent 6 months inside American Income Life, and if you're even thinking about working here, please hear me out: it's a trap. They lure you in with promises of six-figure income, freedom, luxury trips, and "helping families." What actually happens? You're bled dry from day one. You pay for your license, exam fees, Zoom account, computer—money, money, money out of your pocket. By the time you realize what's going on, you've already invested too much to walk away easily. The first week, they make you feel like you've accomplished something huge: passing the exam, starting your "career." But then you're thrown into terrible training and endless busywork—basically just making calls for your upline. When you finally get your own "opportunity," they hand you garbage leads that have been recycled a thousand times. People scream at you to stop calling, and you're forced to keep going. It's harassment, plain and simple. The schedule is insane: 12-hour days, almost no breaks, constant check-ins and micromanagement. When you finally catch someone, you drag them onto a Zoom call and read a script full of lies that you've been drilled on. Without even realizing it, you're tricking people into buying one of the worst insurance products out there. Meanwhile, you're broke, stressed, and exhausted. They parade "success stories" in front of you—agents claiming they were once in your shoes but now they're making six figures. Fake trips, fake recognition, fake promises. It's all smoke and mirrors. 🐔 If you're considering joining, or if you're already inside and thinking "I've put too much time and money in to quit now" — wake up. That's exactly how they keep you trapped. You're not building a business. You're being used. They're scamming new agents and clients alike. This place wrecks people's finances, mental health, and self-worth. It operates like a Ponzi scheme disguised as a career opportunity. To anyone on the fence: don't fall for it. Get out while you can. To the authorities: How is this still allowed to exist?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/nggbda7/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pick up the phone."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"I guess my question is why would you ever stay somewhere that has bad leads where you don't actually own the client and work to generate your own leads that ultimately you basically give the value of to somebody else just so you can get a comission that is ultimately inferior compensation to you doing the exact same amount of work at an agency where you own your client? Where you are in effect compensated for finding your own leads."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1egg6kv/my_agency_is_targeting_the_wrong_crowd_and_its/lfvun7o/

"New Agent Advice I got my life insurance license back in February (at the same time I was let go from my previous W2 position). I have really struggled to find my footing with IMOs and FMOs. A lot of these companies just throw trash leads at new agents and expect you to find gold. To make matters worse, my current company's inbound transfer leads completely dried up because another agent didn't pay their invoice. The system was supposed to be you receive inbound transfers, get paid from your commission Thursday and pay the invoice Friday. Since I'm currently unemployed and don't have any savings, I can't afford to buy expensive leads or wait out cash-flow gaps. I recently interviewed with State Farm but didn't hear back. At this point, I really need a W2 captive agent role or an independent position that offers exclusive, provided leads for a lower commission cut so I can build a stable bankroll are my thoughts. Does anyone have any help or suggestions?"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgdgt5/new_agent_advice/

"Yeah. Globe AIL. You're a hostage. I mean captive. Poor fit for anyone needing flexibility or has a good paying periotic job. They want to babysit you in a Zoom breakout room for 6 hours a day having you call the same tired or bad leads over and over. It's non medical so the pay is pretty fast though when you make a sale. This is a profession that requires a great deal of time while real life doesn't stop responsibility wise. Also, you must detach very quickly from previous carriers or they will drop you and not even tell you. Even if you had no prior business on any books. Then they harass you with letters and threats. This was my experience with them."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jpsc95/it_finally_happened/mptyead/

"You can register your number with Hiya and First Orion, but I don't know if that'll do you any good if you're using a dialer. Are you sure the numbers are good? Are a lot of them disconnected numbers? If the numbers are good, timing might be a problem. How many times are you calling, and at what times? More people respond to texts than calls. A text response might lead to a call more easily. But a lead is somebody who may or may not buy from you--- most likely not, even if they pick up. Some may WANT to buy, but not be READY to. They may not have the money, or might not qualify. None of this is your fault, but the game makes it your responsibility. It's why there's such a high turnover. You have to live with it or overcome it. You have to find a way to make the most of the ones who DO pick up, that'll improve your production more than anything. You don't have as much influence over the other variables."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nhtq0n/struggling_to_get_prospects_to_pick_up_calls_how/nefzrla/

"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlman3/

"Same experience with quote wizard every number is either not in service, wrong number, or they never filled anything out and have no idea how we got their number..."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsbxd1/

"I fell for the Badass Lead Scam as well. I purchased 100 leads, all wrong numbers, disconnects or a lot of voicemails. Don't waste your money"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/oml980e/

"Well that's amazing. I hope that to be my story someday soon. I'm struggling trying to create Google ad campaigns. I'm trying to generate my own leads because these lead providers are scam artists. They tell you they have the best data the first few test leads wrong numbers names aren't matching on the voicemail. Straight crap."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/hqn7tau/>

"Sincerely the worst experience I've ever had working with any marketing agency, not just in Life Insurance but in marketing as a whole. Their creatives are trash, they somehow produce the lowest possible lead quality I've ever seen for and above standard cpl... Even the leads I bought from them at \$5.00/pop were over 40% wrong numbers... it's actually impressive how horrendous it was."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhzu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/ob5zhmn/

Chargebacks and clawed-back commissions · 52 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . Id say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzyaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

"How to Start an Insurance Agency (IMO) Okay, basically I'm at an Insurance Agency called Roman Financial that is providing me no value, apart from constant jargon and motivation and looking at fast cars. I'm 19 and hit the ground running right away selling 5 figures in my first few weeks. I quickly realized that I'm way underpaid as far as "street level" for the final expense providers we go through. Good news is I didn't sign any NDA or a non-compete. As of right now, I am 10000% unnecessarily paying my upline hundreds of dollars that I'm breaking my back to get dialing 8 hours a day on measly 75-80% commission. With little research I've found that the exact same insurance providers give 120% first year to agents. Apart from the 45% of my check that I'm giving to my undeserving upline they are also making me pay for my CRM and the shiddy leads. I've figured that I'd go my own way and own my own lead source to grab leads rather than listen to their manipulation all day. In this way, I want my recruits to be taken care of instead of letting people fall out of the industry going into debt through leads and chargebacks. Long story short, they keep telling me to dial more and to drop the ego. I know I'm worth more than what I'm getting commission wise and nobody is going to have control over how much money I make anymore. That being said, I plan to create my own agency/IMO. Where my agents aren't paying most of their checks to me and don't have to fend for themselves in a constant uphill battle. I plan to have everybody pool for leads to fund ads for the lead source and direct mail etc. I plan to promote recruiting but have everybody come in at a fairly decent commission. No rah rah bullshi, just effective business owners who want to succeed and slam deals. I plan to pay appt setters to book quality leads so guys don't have to dial like their lives depend on it. I have a general outline of what I need to do: name, logo, llc/scorp, e&o, recruiting, marketing, but as far as contracting with providers, whats the best way to go about doing that? If anybody has experience building an agency lmk? ORRR if anybody is seemingly in the same boat and would like to build an empire with me... i'm taking partner applications lol. EDIT: My upline saw this and "released" me which is hilarious since I was getting them paid in everyway. Unfortunately for them I have everything laid out already and already talked to a business accountant and everything. Roman if you guys are reading this, You are 100% correct when you say that I'm gonna try to take my recruits with me. Actually you're 90% correct because you used the word "try". As I was recruiting them I already told them it wouldn't be long until we left Roman just get your licensing course. And hey, when my agencies up and running you can always come work for me at a higher contract than Norm and Carlo got you at. Remember you're never gonna be richer than your upline. :)"

— InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/

"That's me too, but no lead purchases, no charge back, but extremely low sales!"

— YouTube · My First 90 Days As A Life Insurance Agent · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9lF5hTEjK7U&lc=UgzUZfl62c3LV5cDsJt4AaABAq>

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He "maybe" profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"AEP apps vs chargebacks Happy December, fellow medicare agents! We made it through AEP! Just here to get some perspectives and experiences of what to expect with AEP apps vs which ones actually follow through! For those of you who have been through multiple AEPs, how many apps do you usually write? This was my first year, and I wrote 172. The majority of them are renewals, but I did have a few initial enrollments. Do you think this is exceptional? Also, how many of your apps ended up being chargebacks/cancelled (due to enrolling with another agent)? I'm curious to know what to expect here for my book. Last question, I promise, what percentage of your book ends up sticking around the following year? I know everyone's market is different, but I'm trying to get a sense of what's "normal." Any insight from seasoned agents would help a ton. Thanks so much and happy holidays!"

— InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbg/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/

"Making too little for Marketplace Insurance??? I am a college student live in FL. I enrolled health insurance through Marketplace and received premium tax credit in year 2025. Now when I'm trying to enroll for 2026, my estimated income for 2026 is lower due to job change. The Marketplace shows I have \$0 premium tax credit. I called them, they say I make too little to qualify the premium tax credit. Although they mentioned I make too much to qualify for Medicaid, I don't qualify Medicaid anyway. My question is: - My income dropped tremendously in 2025 due to job change. Is it possible that I have to pay back the Tax Credit if I made less than 2025 100%FPL? I am worried now that when I file taxes, I might owe crazy amount of money for the insurance. - how do I get cheap insurance coverage (just for serious emergency like accidents or unforeseeable disease. I normally don't go to the hospital to get checked up or for some small things like cold cuz I literally can't afford it right now) P.S.: My school don't have anything. It's a very small private school & they don't care. I'm waitressing and they do not offer insurance. I can't get on my parent's plan either."

— HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"I watched the FX vid that was posted here and he talked about a rogue agent writing 40k of bad business and fleeing the country. My Assurant regional manager told me a better one. Assurant came out with a feature where if an app was instantly approved - meaning the second you submitted the app it was approved without any UW, you got 12 months advanced commission. What could go wrong? A new agent signed up his entire network of friends. They chose the most expensive plans, listed zero health conditions and all were auto-approved, earning him \$48,000 in commissions. His friends all then cancelled the policies during the 10 day free look. His MGA apparently didn't think it was a flag that a new agent wrote that much in two weeks. Every dime was charged back to the MGA who had to file BK over it and the agent went off to Mexico."

— InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lrh008/lets_remember_what_selling_health_was_like_preaca/n1b228y/

"It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies.: There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

— InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc4pyQy/

"Hi OP! I'm a relatively new insurance agent been license for almost years and yes no one is ever transparent about leads, how to generate those and how costly they can be. To get leads you either pay a lot of money for them or spend a lot of your time chasing them. I personally gave up selling life insurance and supplementals because the amount of chargebacks was awful. Now I just focus on U65 ACA marketplace plans. I am also part of the HealthSherpa enrollee assistance program which pays me per person I have enrolled. I prefer this over getting commissions from the insurance carriers. I'll be happy to offer some feedback but you can also do your research."

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/h5veshz/

"As a new agent, 99% of the game is TRIAL BY FIRE. Get yourself in front of people, understand selling to their needs vs selling for commission (charge backs aren't fun) your different types of objections and how to overcome them, tuning your tonality, the product knowledge comes from time and closes, which you can't get studying all the time. You gotta dial, you gotta BUY leads from different sources until you find one that works great for you,"

— YouTube · What To Expect Your First 90 Days As An Insurance Agent! · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HF4onytfV3c&lc=UgzDFYFSFBFMw6QScV4AaABAg>

"Congrats on passing! As a life agent, it is nice to get paid quickly and with the advance pay it adds up quickly as well. However, please be cautious of chargebacks if you are on advanced pay. A safer choice is to request "as earned" especially if you're not dialed in with managing your money. Have a solid schedule, good lead flow, and just stay consistent."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ju62n5/alright_i_passed/mm1gxex/

"Thank you. After dealing with MLM's for years (mixture of insurance and product sales), I don't want to deal with the structure anymore. "No More Recruiting". I moved into the medical field for a change in pace but now I need to make more money. Looking into life insurance and I'm getting told to recruit. I'm glad I ran across this video. I support you in this. I just want to sell policies with great leads with no charge backs. On your application you ask for prior sales proof. I been out of the game for years and don't have anything to show proof of past successes. Can I still join your team?"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgzJaldo-PZu7wQUnsB4AaABAg>

"AEP always feels like a gamble because the apps come in fast but the chargebacks hit months later when you least expect it. I've learned to treat a chunk of that commission as untouchable. Otherwise the clawbacks wreck your momentum and your sanity."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgybbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nsx1skx/

"Did 304 on my own pen. I have extremely low chargebacks, like 1/4%. Depending on the lead source, you could have 10-30% chargeback after AEP. Depends on clientele"

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgybbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/nsw3ovd/

"Independent agent here that only does term, IUL, and annuities. You can make a ton of money if you know what you are doing. The biggest issue agents run into is either leads or chargebacks and both can be rectified pretty easily. Get paid as earned not advanced. Yes you get paid less upfront but as long as they keep their policy you are getting paid every month on that policy for the first year then renewals after that. Leads always do your own or connect with a social media marketing company that will build out a system for you. That way you are on complete control. Doing these 2 things it is not hard to make mid 6 figures a year."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kkwa3n/survey_most_profitable_area_of_insurance/ms1e3j/

"Independent Life Insurance Brokers: Is Anyone Else Struggling Right Now? I genuinely feel like selling life insurance as an independent broker has become a falling knife. The broader economy is putting immense pressure on both clients and agents. Families are dealing with inflation, high interest rates, mounting consumer debt, stagnant wages, and rising costs for necessities like housing, groceries, insurance, and utilities. When people are struggling just to cover essential bills, life insurance, despite its importance, is often one of the first expenses they postpone or cancel. As a result, brokers are facing a combination of declining sales, higher policy lapse rates, more difficult underwriting conversations, and clients who simply can't justify taking on another monthly payment. At the same time, lead costs remain high and declining in quality, chargebacks can erase months of income, and many brokers work entirely on commission without a guaranteed paycheck or benefits. It creates an environment where the financial risk falls heavily on the broker while the probability of closing business decreases. I still believe life insurance is one of the most valuable financial products a family can own. The need for protection has never disappeared. In fact, uncertain times often make that need even greater. The challenge is that economic hardship makes it significantly harder for people to act on that need. Until consumer confidence and household finances improve, I think independent life insurance brokers will continue facing an uphill battle, making the profession feel less like building momentum and more like trying to catch a falling knife."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vcziks/independent_life_insurance_brokers_is_anyone_else/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

CMS, carrier and TCPA exposure · 46 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Be honest, how many of you are too hungry or greedy to actually care about your clients? Too often on this sub, I see posts full of frustration: "I can't close deals because customers are cheap." "The competition is undercutting me." "I need a new company with lower rates." Sound familiar? Complaining doesn't sell policies, and it certainly doesn't build trust with clients. What does work? Taking a step back and focusing on what you can control—helping people understand their risks and providing the guidance they need. Like Zig Ziglar and Jerry Acuff teach: "Help people get what they need, and you'll have all you need." Show, Don't Just Tell: Use Real-World Stories One of the best ways to help people understand the importance of proper coverage is by sharing real-life examples. Here's one: Imagine you're driving and accidentally hit a pedestrian—a 43-year-old father of three making \$90,000 a year. You only have \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage on your auto policy. Do you think \$100,000 goes far in this situation? Absolutely not. This man's medical bills could exceed \$500,000. He may lose his income while recovering, or worse, never return to work. The court won't just hold you responsible for his current medical costs—they'll look at his lifetime earning potential. That's millions of dollars. Now picture yourself on the stand in a courtroom. The plaintiff's attorney asks, "Why did you carry only \$100,000 in bodily injury coverage?" You respond, "Because that's all I could afford." (Which is a total lie) Then the attorney points out you're driving a \$60,000 vehicle with a \$600 monthly payment, yet you chose to skimp on your liability coverage. How does that look to a judge? Conversely, you get a \$2000 vehicle with bad breaks or ball joints, hit the same pedestrian and not only will the judge be siding with the widow, if the judge finds out that you knew about the bad parts, you may be in for a manslaughter charge because of willful endangerment. Odds are, the widow will be awarded 40% of your pre-tax income until her children turn 18, then 20% for the rest of her life. I would tell the client that the 57 dollars a month in savings just cost you everything. This is why your job as an agent isn't just to sell policies—it's to help people manage their risks. Clients often don't understand the implications of their choices, and it's our responsibility to make those risks tangible. When we fail to explain the "why" behind higher limits, we're doing them a disservice. Here are other examples: A client with only \$150,000 in dwelling coverage on their home didn't realize rebuilding after a fire would cost \$244,000. They had to pay the difference out of pocket and face years of financial hardship. A business owner declined professional liability insurance, only to be sued for \$1 million after an employee error caused significant losses for a client. That lawsuit forced them into bankruptcy. Conversely, a family that opted for umbrella coverage was protected from losing their home after their teenage son caused a major accident. These stories aren't scare tactics; they're real-life scenarios. And they underscore the importance of listening to your clients, helping them understand their risks, and showing them why the right coverage matters. People don't want to feel "sold." They want someone who cares about their well-being and offers real solutions. Ask thoughtful questions. Share stories that make the risks relatable. Build trust by focusing on their needs—not your commission. When clients understand how proper coverage protects their family, their assets, and their peace of mind, they're more likely to say yes to higher limits. As agents, our job isn't just to provide a quote—it's to protect lives and livelihoods. Stop blaming external factors for lost sales. Instead, focus on what you can do better: Educate, advise, and build trust. Help your clients understand that managing their risks now can save them from life-altering consequences later. Let's stop complaining and start helping. Have any of you used similar real-life stories to educate clients? How did it work? Let's share ideas!"

— InsuranceAgent · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hj1p7v/be_honest_how_many_of_you_are_too_hungry_or/

"Is this against AIL or Globe Life in general because I worked for the Liberty National division and if it's a class action lawsuit against globe, I would love to become a part of it."

— InsuranceAgent · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i1evot/ailglobe_life_scam_employees_were_suing/m75jzrt/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Telesales Tips · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out that test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwHbqfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umxt4AaABAg

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mifjh/

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating in new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12-13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkhia/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

"I spent my first year in the industry at BL. Fortunately I was in CLT which seemed to be one of the better-ran offices. Management was realistic with us - if you don't work, you don't get paid. If you don't want to do this, don't. There was a lot I learned that I'm very grateful for. Lots of training in Medicare, life, annuities, securities. I was able to parlay that experience for a much higher paying role as a broker elsewhere. 16 months later, put all that experience on a resume and secured a nice position in employee benefits making more than I ever did in 1099, as a w-2. With commissions on top. All of this to say - the 1099 side of personal lines insurance will probably feel scammy wherever you go. You can choose to make less money and use it for the experience, only writing business where you think it's 100% ethical. You will not be a top performer that way. I wasn't. But my head hit the pillow easily every night, never had any compliance issues, and walked away from the position on good terms with everybody because I was a team player there to learn and grow in the industry. Any 1099 position like this is going to dangle the carrot in front of you, using their top performers' books of business as an example. "This guy has been here 10 years and makes over 6 figures off of residuals alone" is one you'll hear often. Congrats to the people who stick around and make it work. But stats show about 92% of people don't stick around after a year."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wn5pwj/do_not_work_for_bankers_life/pbchnca/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9gic/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"What I would do if I were you: 1. Scrub your data against a litigator and changed number list on a regular basis. 2. Get Convoso. Kixie is OK. Most other dialers are terrible. Connection rate is everything. 3. Move out of New York. You cannot get contracted in New York with American Amicable as a New York resident. AmAm is arguably the best final expense telesales carrier available. Answers to your questions: 1. Maybe. Biggest levers to get best results: 1. Script and skillset 2. Dialer to maximize connection rates. 2. See above. 3. Convoso only. 4. Stay away from DSNP. 5. 100% TCPA compliance adherence. 6. Set daily activity goals. Consider bonuses/rewards for hitting call/conversion goals."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkhia/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/mko7utp/

"I do an educational only call. "Medicare 101", just an overview of the program and supp vs mapd etc. Not breaking any rules there. Then get SOA and schedule follow up call to talk details"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1g3w4zk/how_to_handle_prospect_call_before_scope_of/sajuu2/

"> It's a bit funny that the only thing you didn't acknowledge in my comment was the fact that you don't just get a regular job. ACTUALLY I worked in commercial finance for years + ran 3 small businesses so there's that. I actually got fired from the finance company partly because I couldn't get any work done with my home phone ringing 50 times before lunch. >There's absolutely no way you can convince me that you're making ZERO action to receive these calls. You're not getting 100's of illegal calls by being just a random needle in the haystack, you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. Believe what you want to believe, but I feign interest to see who buys the lead and that's that. I do not opt in anywhere. >you're intentionally seeding your number(s) out there. I do no such thing and I dare anyone to prove that I do. >Of course the jig is up if you'd ever confess that, but also the calls would stop too and then there goes your income. I don't want the money. I want the calls to stop. Since the calls won't stop, I will take the money. >We all get random calls from shady oversea call centers. Will I get 2-3 of these calls on a bad day? Yes. Do I decide to engage the call, pretend to be interested so I can sue the American receiver of the illegal transfer who is likely unaware this call was generated illegally? Absolutely not. img-wouldbealotcoolerifyoudid.jpg >You're trying to call it justice but it's just not. TCPA/DNC laws are set up to protect regular consumers, especially vulnerable ones like seniors, not to create a side hustle for bottom feeders like you. I'd be willing to bet when you find a carrier/brokerage/agent who's willing to fight you instead of just throwing you a couple of bucks to save the legal fees - you drop the suit because you don't want this going to discovery. Believe what you want to believe. I don't opt in for ANYTHING and I'm on every single marketing database known to man. Landline is 40+ years old, same address. Cell is 20+ years old same subscriber Registered voter, property owner, business owner, etc etc. The dataminers have enough out there on me that I don't need to opt in for a single goddamn thing for them to already know me Oh and I guess I'll clarify that I'm a carrier rep, my calls come from our own marketing. We don't use third parties at all. I fight and litigate EVERY single suit until summary judgement/jury verdict. Don't put words in my mouth."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8vgvfc/

"New Medicare Insurance agent with questions ​ ​ My name is Robert and I am a licensed insurance agent contracted through Cigna as my only carrier. I am interested in learning more about your leads and how I can partner with you to sell Cigna Medicare plans. ​ I understand that Medicare can be confusing, and I want to make sure that I am providing my clients with the best possible service. I have a few questions that I would like to ask you: ​ Can I walk a client through the [Medicare.gov](https://www.Medicare.gov) website and refer them to an agent who is licensed to sell the product that is the best deal for them? Can I make sure that a client does not have a group health plan, has Medicare, and that their doctor and prescriptions are covered? Can I explain plan benefits and costs, and compare Cigna plans to other plans that might cost less? Can I mention that another plan might be a better fit for a client, or try to compare Cigna plans to other plans that might be better for them? Can I offer them a referral to see someone who is licensed to sell the plan that may be better for them? Can I invite them to talk to me about Medicare 101 through email, then get an SOA to talk to them about Cigna? Should I just sell them the plan that is the best fit for them out of the products that I'm licensed to sell? I'm trying to imagine what my plan is, but I can't find any good scripts or guidance for selling Cigna. I want to gain clients through an email list that isn't specifically targeting Medicare and through Next Gen Leads. I understand that Medicare has a lot of rules, and I am not here to challenge them. I am here to ask questions to help me better understand how I can work with you to provide my clients with the best possible service. ​ Thank you for your time and consideration. ​ ​"

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/17j8bis/new_medicare_insurance_agent_with_questions/

"How are you working aged leads and keeping TCPA compliant? I'm genuinely interested. I stopped working aged leads 4 years ago after I saw a bunch of agents get fined."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9ley0w/

"Depends on what you're selling but they're not typically very responsive, and I'd avoid them personally. A lot of aged leads aren't even TCPA compliant much less FCC 1, which means one complaint to the DOI and you could be facing a lawsuit, license suspension/revocation, etc. When we ran a dialer it was about a 0.8% conversion rate on 30 day+ leads and about 0.2% on 365+ leads. Interestingly enough the 3-30 day leads were just as bad, my running theory is that a lot of those 3-30 day people are getting blown up by agents or just not in the mindset to buy at the time, but after 30 days the calls start to die down, they're in a clearer head space, and they're more receptive. I've spoken to many clients who just were overwhelmed and only responded to me because it had been a few weeks and things weren't as hectic."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pmr7pi/how_are_we_generating_leads_going_into_2026/nu3qz9h/

"100% agree. I highly doubt any of these agencies that cold call are following TCPA guidelines... I operated a callcenter for 17 years prior to starting my agency. We specialized in calling past customers for Newspapers. We had all the compliance in place because I kept abreast of it all for the states we operated in. We only had 1 violation that we paid out and it was to a massive litigator of call centers that would purchase people cell phone numbers from all over the country and then litigate against anyone that missed the port request in the 30 day window. If you aren't solely in the calling space it doesn't make sense to cold call... Calling paid for leads is different because they will normally come with a record of how the person opted in to receive the call."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/n8ccb55/

"That's not a lead vendor, That's a criminal accomplice! marketing companies are not allowed to take personal client information give quotes etc... What you just described is **not** Lead generation. Its marketed as "pre sold policies by shady dudes in facebook groups" and its illegal.. If an agent doesn't know that they deserve to lose their license. There is no way this was surprising to him. he knew what was happening., he paid more for this "service" specifically because he is Lazy..... There are in fact marketing companies that want to sell legitimate CMS/ carrier compliant leads and inbound calls. They do exist. You never interact with them because you are a professional litigator on the DNC list. Legitimate companies pay money for subscriptions like this <https://www.dnc.com/dncscrub/> and make api calls to stay DNC compliant. Those same API calls check Professional Litigator lists, which you are likely on...Any one who can afford \$300 per month and knows how to call an API will make sure they never call you. The only marketing companies you ever interact with are the Bad ones... here is the medicare manuals <https://www.cms.gov/medicare/health-drug-plans/managed-care-marketing/medicare-guidelines> As you can see this is COMPLICATED. Many Insurance brokers choose to outsource marketing because there is a lot of rules to follow here. Some companies Aka "third party" marketing companies offer a legitimate service to insurance brokers, allowing them to legally outsource marketing., just like very other industry. Some agents do get deceived by shady companies. many don't even think to ask marketers, "how do you check DNC /TCPA? how do you generate leads or data? "what qualifications do you use to turn data into a lead? how many people are you selling this data to? What liability do you have regarding DNC/TCPA violations? These are all legitimate questions any legitimate marketer will have no problem answering.. Keep up being a professional litigator. get the Bad apples out of the industry. you should put up a you tube channel like Coffeezilla. I bet it would be more entertaining the most insurance industry content.. i think it would be helpful for a lot of agents if you posted content of this stuff. Its the dark underbelly that many agents never see.. they get pitched an offer that's too good to be true.. and well it is..."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ni7wbo/another_reason_not_to_trust_lead_brokersthird/nf78cv7/

ACA marketplace suspensions and enrollment-fraud fallout · 4 documents

"If I contract, will I get fillable forms the consent forms? What about for recording? would not the CRM automatically record calls? I also need this recordings for Medicare as well I am probably going to buy if its workable depending on few other questions I gave you about leads What is voice consent with that just be the easiest way to do it?"

— YouTube ·  ACA Agents: This Sales Script Closes More Obamacare Clients (Copy & Paste) 🗨️ · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cLRWdaqypkc&lc=UgzFPjqJDBVsQUI7VN54AaABAq>

"ABC said: I called to speak with them and no one was available, I am really suspect since they are an Insurance Agency now. I don't think they are an insurance agency. I did some research and I think its a startup and they are running it out of their house. The owner has 2 jobs, check him out on Linked In. I want to know what happens a week later with the app. And a week after that with the feed to the carriers. I want something in writing that they aren't stealing my clients. (Which probably won't do any good, but it will make me feel better) For this year, I will probably use them on my webpage and also to send to people when I have run out of time. But not for people I am running the clients on via join.me"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Sherpa New Portal For Agents Working On the Exchange · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/health-sherpa-new-portal-for-agents-working-on-the-exchange.66461/#post-874324>

"Yes. I just had the first one terminated by the Marketplace for not sending in income verification documentation. This person is self employed; owns a flooring company. His adjusted gross income for 2014 was \$50,000. His taxes are with the tax accountant now. He is out of the country with no insurance. He does not know his income for 2015 yet. He thinks it may be higher. I called the Marketplace. They insist they have to have a bank statement; something. They said there was a discrepancy in his income. I was wondering how long it would take for this to begin? Now, I know."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971669>

"MaryDallas said: Yes. I just had the first one terminated by the Marketplace for not sending in income verification documentation. This person is self employed; owns a flooring company. His adjusted gross income for 2014 was \$50,000. His taxes are with the tax accountant now. He is out of the country with no insurance. He does not know his income for 2015 yet. He thinks it may be higher. I called the Marketplace. They insist they have to have a bank statement; something. They said there was a discrepancy in his income. I was wondering how long it would take for this to begin? Now, I know. Click to expand... Why would they cancel coverage? Why not just terminate the subsidy? The income has zero to do with their health insurance (other than if they receive the cost sharing subsidy)."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Can Marketplace Health Insurance Terminate for Not Sending In Documents? · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/can-marketplace-health-insurance-terminate-for-not-sending-in-documents.73346/#post-971722>

FMO / upline lock-in and release fights · 83 documents

"Why I left the life insurance industry Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— LifeInsurance · 83 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1eqggok/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of each other. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Why I left the life insurance industry I posted this in r/insurance but i'm going to post it here too. Here is the story as to why I left the life insurance industry as a whole and I'm going to let my license expire on December 31st, 2024. I saw somewhere that you can make 10k a month selling life insurance. I was hooked. I took the pre-licensing course and got my state license. I then got with an agency and the recruiter told me that the leads were exclusive and pre-qualified meaning I didn't have to do any cold calling or door knocking. I was even more hooked. This seemed too good to be true. I start working at the agency and the first alarm bell goes off in my head. I have to pay for leads. I asked my spline about this and he said the reason they cost money is because they are high quality leads. I said hm okay, so I purchased them. Turns out the leads were aged, recycled, and most of them claimed to never have shown an interest in life insurance, including usage of foul language and making threats to get law enforcement involved. I made no money, helped no families and was extremely dissatisfied. And mind you, my upline told me that the leads were exclusive and the best in the industry. What. Lie. I left that agency and got with another one. They also told em the same thing as the previous agency. No cold calling, no door knocking, we provide you with the best high quality leads in the industry with a blah blah closing ratio. Once again, the leads cost money but this time they were 1 month old instead of 3. I said hm okay, what can go wrong? Well, turns out that this agency was worse than the previous one. Once again despite me being told that the leads were high quality, I got ghosted a lot, cancelled appointments, loss of interest due to not being able to afford it, people claiming that they had never shown an interest in life insurance, insulting me and making threats over the phone. The whole thing was even worse than working retail during holiday season. This time, I lost \$1,000 buying E&O coverage, fingerprint background check, and overpriced leads that ended up not even working out. This is when reality hit me that this is not an industry I want to be in. At this point in my career I had felt the dirtiest I had ever felt and I wasn't even making any money to justify it. I was LOSING money while being treated like garbage by angry prospects. I rage quit that job. I ended up going to a THIRD agency because "third time's a charm". This company did not make you pay for leads, however, it had a very similar business structure as Herbalife and amway where you have to recruit. You have to ask your friends, family, neighbors, and social media followers if they are interested in working. Once again, I made no money, people knew it was a pyramid scheme and lost a couple of friends because they didn't want to deal with my sales tactics. This was it. I said I'm done. I'm done with insurance and I'm done with sales. I ended up going back to community college for an associates in I.T (paid for with FAFSA federal pell grants) and I'm also studying for my CompTIA certifications to work in the I.T industry and I could not be happier with my decision. Till this day I still get messages and calls from recruiters trying to hit me with the same "we are seeking licensed agents. No cold calling. We have the most exclusive leads in the industry" & it fills me with so much rage how stupid they think I am to fall for their nonsense again. Insurance sales recruiters are straight up liars and they seem to feel no shame towards it. Finally, a lot of them love to promote the lavish luxury lifestyle to reel people in. I also don't care about that. I am happy with what I have. Family and health is more important to me than some Tesla Model 3."

— InsuranceAgent · 46 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dt0fnh/why_i_left_the_life_insurance_industry/

"Legit life insurance wfh job I recently took a job with primerica not realizing it was an mlm after the fact I'm following through and getting my licensing because they provided that but after that does anyone have any legit recommendations for an entry level wfh not mlm insurance company I don't mind them being 1099 but I don't want to have to spend a lot on leads when I'm just learning"

— InsuranceAgent · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"NEVER work or get life/health through Globe Life 🌐 Worst recruiting experience I have ever had, didn't help with getting license at all, lead me on for weeks, paid everything out of pocket, had to have gallbladder removed right after starting and they told me to kick rocks. Just got off the phone with regional manager yelling and cussing me and they told me because I missed part of training and had a second job (security night shift) that I wasn't committed enough and should go to a flack that "committed" agents are a dime a dozen and they could hire any loser to fill my spot they didn't need me. I have 15+ years sales management and experience I even was on finals for the next great American speak off and I get treated like another entry level sales rep. Even in training they were more focused on the sale rather than the customer. I got into life/health to help people not suffer the same fate I did due to having an emergency hip replacement last year in May. It ruined me financially and cost me my business in adventure tourism. I just wanted to spread knowledge on the importance of coverage and actually get customers what they need, not just get their money for my own benefit like Globe Life's primary focus. I'm just pissed right now, dumped money I really couldn't afford at the time on the things I needed to be successful, the class, the license, everything and for nothing. Now I don't even know what to do with this license because 99% of the recruiters I talk to are still just wanting people for MLM crap or straight up scams. Just wanted to rant, if anyone sees this that is legit contact me. If you put me in a position to take EVERY contract from my local globe life offices I will make it my personal mission to take their business."

— InsuranceAgent · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1irtig7/never_work_or_get_lifehealth_through_globe_life/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Overall there's just less chatter about Medicare here. I feel like majority of users in this sub are P&C agents, followed closely by the MLM Life Insurance folk. Could just be a demographic thing. Reddit users tend to be of the younger generations and maybe the majority of Medicare reps are all chatting in those cesspool Facebook groups."

— InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n565vur/

"Primerica, World Financial Groups, and other MLMs So currently I work with an independent financial advisor, we are under an RIA and an FMO that gives us insurance product access. I have been in the business for a few short years starting out with a larger insurance firm, then eventually into a wealth management firm. So I've been around the insurance and financial services block. How do you guys deal with these agents from these MLMs? I just found out my Aunt is in it and she's trying to recruit me to WFG. While I don't consider them competition, they are getting annoying. They also seem to really go after colored communities. I was in the North Jersey/NYC area talking to community leaders that I was reconnecting with. And the first thing they say is, "You're not with Primerica or WFG, right?:" There is enough distrust in the insurance and banking industry in general, and these MLM outfits make it worse."

— Insurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/b8o8hz/primerica_world_financial_groups_and_other_mlm/

"Do you know of any health insurance companies who pays their captive agent on an per hourly basis plus commissions? I just started with mine and its only 100% commission based, so for starters who dont have yet their clientele, money is a struggle. Do you have any advices?"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgzzDyeN1Egxb-37nx4AaABAg>

"I did the same, leaving a 9-5 job for 100% commission rep but I had a different outcome. I did not have to buy leads, I was fed leads by PnC agents. My outcome was different. After two years of making over 200k, I left for the PnC side thinking it would be more secure. It has been a challenge being a captive agent when a parent company changes the goal every year not allowing for stability. All the goal changes, commission changes and rules did not allow for stability. Employees unhappy with all the changes would fizzle out. It's a lesson learned for me as well. It all serves a purpose in life. You will find your way and you will do great things. Head up high!"

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ouw3b4d/

"I work as property and causality agent for a major insurance carrier. My leads are given to me but they are mostly bullshit. Pretty much a name and number. I work pretty hard as a captive agent. Our goals are set and we need to hit or exceed them to make any money. I am paid salary plus bonus. I am a top 5% producer and clear over 125k a year."

— InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ax5nn1/what_is_it_like_being_an_insurance_agent/krm96tw/

"I would love to have a sit down with John about this. This is such amazing advice. I'm an agent through a captive agency in NY and I have been having such a tough time, with what I thought was leads. My problem isn't that I can't get people to answer, my problem continues to be no shows and I feel like I'm stuck in that "hamster wheel" where I've called the leads to oblivion and have a tough time booking those. Mind you, some of the leads I'm given are 6 or 7 years old where we're told to, "throw them against the wall and see what sticks." I'm going to implement this more aggressive calling method and see how it helps. Thank you so much."

— YouTube · How To Work Insurance Leads Like A Pro! (Cody Askins & John Wetmore) · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nf_TnViVvis&lc=Ugy_-op6VjG4LLmRuwN4AaABAq

"Everyone does it differently I was working as a captive agent and doing pretty well in terms of sales but not great in terms of income. A friend of mine who left the captive carrier about six months before contacted me one day and said "hey, come do a ride along with me. There is a better way to do this." He explained to me that instead of selling for 40% commission I could be earning over 100% commission selling the exact same product and all I had to do was be willing to buy my own leads. And I could sell other products too, so that I never had to walk away from a client because what I had to offer was the best fit. I could always have the best fit. I ended up not working with his agency, the owner gave me the willies, but I did end up thinking it was a good idea and found one who had an owner I got on with and trusted. I borrowed three thousand dollars from a friend, and got my father to agree to buy me 3 weeks of leads. By the time I had been in independent for six weeks I had made enough to pay my friend back, and by the time I was in the business 2 months I was able to repay my dad. And I never looked back. It was not always easy. I worked very hard the first few years, but less hard than I ever did as a captive (I had gotten used to 10 hours a day six days a week, and... Never again) 12 years later things have worked out."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/ngdmhig/

"Working at a captive agency can be tough. Ive been working as a producer for an Allstate agency for over 3 years now and there are definitely rough months, but good ones too. There are benefits, like marketing resources, to working in a captive agency like myself, but you lose the flexibility of an independent agent. When im making calls I cycle through paid leads, win backs, cross sales and cold calling. I find having to adjust my approach from time to time helps me get through some of the rough spots. Comp plans are always going to vary from agency to agency, the only reason I've been thinking of leaving recently is my health, dental, etc. are either non existent or just suck"

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jzdkd/started_at_allstate_already_considering_leaving/mk95av6/

Wanting to quit: rejection, hang-ups, burnout · 17 documents

"Update: Being let go from a toxic agency turned out to be the best thing that could have happened to me As you can see from my original post, I received a lot of negative comments. To be fair, I posted less than an hour after being let go and was extremely emotional. I should have taken some time to calm down before posting. That being said, I still stand by the main point of my post: a toxic workplace is not something anyone should be expected to tolerate simply because an industry can be stressful. The insurance field is not "too hard" for me. I have dealt with difficult customers throughout my entire working career. I have been yelled at, hung up on, spoken down to, and blamed for things outside of my control. That comes with working with the public. However, your boss should not tell you to "shut the hell up before I get nasty with you" in front of your coworkers, especially over a routine replacement or add-on — and especially when you did not make a mistake to begin with. In this situation, it was actually a replacement, and my former boss was the one who had it wrong. (never got that apology from him lol) After I formally addressed the way I was spoken to, the situation became retaliatory. My separation letter included five days as though I had called out repeatedly, when those were days I had asked to delay my original start date so I could handle personal matters and begin the following week with a clear schedule. I even found the email confirming that discussion. I was going to remind him of that by replying to the separation letter with that email, but at this point, I decided to leave it alone and move forward. And that brings me to the real update: To everyone who told me to look into working for an independent agency: **thank you**. I start my new position on Monday. It is much closer to the type of work I was doing before 🍷, but with an independent agency. I was told that others in the industry were already familiar with the turnover issues at my former office, which helped remind me that my experience was not simply a reflection of my ability to succeed in insurance. My new position includes: **A \$7,900 salary increase** Benefits beginning after 30 days A one-hour lunch instead of 30 minutes Five eight-hour workdays No weekends Paid nationwide holidays The employer covering 90% of the health insurance premium Looking back, being fired by that office may have been the best thing that could have happened to me. To anyone who said the insurance field was not for me: standing up for yourself does not mean you are incapable of doing your job. Refusing to accept humiliation, harassment, or retaliation does not make you lazy, overly sensitive, or full of excuses. If you wake up every morning wondering what the yelling, condescending remarks, or unnecessary criticism will be about that day, start looking for another job. I am not talking about someone who simply dislikes working or cannot accept constructive feedback. I am talking about people who work hard, are genuinely being treated poorly and starting to question their own abilities because of it. The insurance industry is huge. One toxic workplace does not represent the entire field, and one difficult boss does not determine your future. Sometimes one door shuts so that a much better one can open. **Thank you, independent agencies!**"

— InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ty3ilq/update_being_let_go_from_a_toxic_agency_turned/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"Depending on what state you're in, we're in the middle of a lot of rate increase. Can't do much about it realistically but I took as much of that off of my CSR's as I could and did it myself (review/explanation/solutions). Do I feel burned out? Yea but my name is on the door and my CSRs haven't left and morale is good. We do what we can and don't get overwhelmed with things we can't control. Better for me to do the "tough" stuff than them IMO because I can't afford for them to get burned out and quit."

— InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gagmgg/23_years_in_this_business_and_ive_never_seen/nz6ed67/

"If they fired you after two weeks then that's not the type of company you want to work for, Medicare is an endurance test the only way someone fails is if they get fired or give up. As an independent it's a little scrappier, you eat what you kill so to speak. You do earn monthly passive income off of your sales as well as new commission but if you don't sell you don't get paid. Find a good FMO and up-line who actually cares. It's hard at times, the industry is chaotic right now, I want to quit all the time but the money is great and the relationships you build with your clients are priceless. 10/10 would recommend going independent."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oezwib/just_got_fired/nl629qw/

"Unfortunately, just happens very often. That's why most people don't make it in industry. If your license, and want an actual job, look for a job instead of running your own business. When you're a 1099 commission only, it's a business. I would much rather work somewhere where I'm getting some type of paycheck and have benefits to start. I have never been great at prospecting and I've been in sales pretty much my entire life. I've made low six figures in several different types of sales including insurance, but always on the W2 side. I've also realize that I do much better in an inbound environment. I'm more of a consultant and a closer. I'm not a Hunter. Nothing wrong with commission. But when you're 1099 and contracted, they really don't have to do anything. There are some legitimate places, but you have to either buy Leads or prospect. Or you can do what many people like myself did, and get a W2 Job where you're getting paid to base plus commission. People don't realize that benefits, social, security, tax, retirement savings, all those things add up, so you have to make way more money as a 1099 "employee" versus a w2 position. It's not difficult to make a minimum of 65,000 year and a W2 Job and the insurance industry. In fact, I know. Plenty of people who make 125,000 or more a year. I also also plenty of people who can't make it because of the KPIs and the burnout. I would never work for free. Well, never again because we've all fall for the sales pitch. I keep saying this and Will keep saying it, youre not being hired. You're being recruited. You have to interview them. It's so different than a traditional W2 Job, where they actually interview you. Most these places will hire anyone. That's breathing with the license."

— InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0bm9o/

"I hate my job 100%. My agency is so desperate we just sign any and all ghetto lead sources that send us the worst of the worst for leads. Carriers have restrictions so we can barely sell, yet we have big sales goals put on us."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bogj6l/how_is_everyone_handling_burnout_during_these/kx4smcf/

"They are gonna say "oh yeah, we got a lot of hot internet leads and in-bound calls. We usually give the warm-leads to the juniors to cut their teeth." The fact of the matter is you're gonna be grinding cold calls for months to a couple years, you will have to show activity s until you get decent leads. Occasionally you'll get some hot transfers; then once in a blue moon a bunch of hot leads will fall in your lap because everybody got too busy, somebody quit, or you happen to call a cold lead who was just about to turn hot. Honestly, the book Fanatical Prospecting is a solid quick read to prepare you for the cold call mindset. It's pretty straight forward, practical, and easy to remember. Its so practical that it sounds like you should already know these things about prospecting LOL. It'll help you workflow your calls for the day and qualify leads so you don't burn out on dead leads. Unless you're lucky, most agents won't teach you how to prospect, they'll teach basic selling techniques, presenting the product and maybe, maybe teaching you how to effectively close. Prospecting is an important technique and skill to learn, it extends past the phone and you'll start to see everyday situations to potentially to prospect for future customers."

— InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wl6371/i_just_became_licensed_in_pc_shortly_becoming/pawdym3/

"I've only done a little over a week of actual calls myself. Never regretted any choice so much as the one to go into selling life insurance. Though it's not the angry customers and hang ups that have me burnt out. I had no idea the costs involved in buying leads (on top of licenses), and started this job while already in debt in several areas of life. I'm looking at a foreclosure on my house while barely being able to afford 20 leads a week. Which is too few and only half of what my company expects me to get, and I'm constantly aware of what little money I have left for more leads. I've had very few people even answer the phone (and I call often and have left voicemails), and have yet to get through the first 10 seconds with those few that did, so my confidence has taken a dive. I've made changes to the way respond to those initial objections, I feel I'm better prepared to keep the call going, but I just can't afford to buy more leads to test them out. I'm about to try out a burner in the hopes I can breathe some life into one or two of my old leads and get them to pick up, as well as get the next leads to answer. With all that I might still be able to push through, but having my boss make comments about taking responsibility for ourselves and our destiny, and telling me he took out credit cards when he got started (which I wouldn't be approved for anyway, and already took out my 401k), pretty much led to a meltdown the other day. I'm aware of my shortcomings, and usually good with constructive criticism, but with those I can't control like finances, being told indirectly I'm making excuses has about done me in. Being in on our morning meetings usually gets me pumped and feeling confident but all of a sudden.. it's just gone, and I'm deflated like a balloon. I'm struggling to get back into the mindset I need to be in. Just 20 or so leads a week is costing me \$400, and I'll be almost broke after the next batch I get on Monday, and I just can't escape that thought of what do I do if I don't make a sale. And the live transfers go too fast for me to grab them. They're expensive but at least I would be able to do a presentation and not feel like such a failure so soon after starting. Sorry OP, I'm not very helpful lol. But I feel you. It's not an easy career by any means. I haven't given up but I'm not sure what else I can do when the money runs out. I feel like motivational books might be helpful for you though. Before the meltdown (as I already have issues being naturally confident) I was reading "The magic of thinking big" by David Schwartz. It really was helping with motivation and my frame of mind before now. You might give it a go, it can't hurt."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jxx2oa/i_am_burn_out_and_i_just_started_help/mmups74/

"I really suggest starting full time and going with Duford - but they do not take just anyone. Go through all of their YT videos and figure out if this is something you want to do. You will need to be licensed in your state AND you will have to pay to be licensed in 10 other states. After you get your state license you only have to pay a fee to the other states, but it will cost \$600 to \$900 depending on which states. Duford has a free lead service for full timers. That is the best way to start because it gets you fully trained and does not cost anything for leads. Once you start to close sales you can switch to the paid leads. You should be able to 2x or 3x the cost of leads every week, so as long as you have time, you can spend as much as you want and 2x or 3x on your spend. Duford and Globe Life Family Heritage Division both have in-person sales, too. You should be able to close 50% of your in person sales because they are usually more motivated, which is why they are letting you in their house. If you are very young, in person may not be the way to go. Regardless, you can still do the free leads full time with Duford to learn and start. Most people fail because they do not make the calls - you need to double and triple dial to get people to answer - and 80 to 90% of the people are not going to remember they asked for information and they are going to hang up on you. After a few weeks of that people get burned out and quit. BUT - if you make 3 to 7 sales per week, you will be on your way to a great income. I have another company I would recommend but I can't do it on here, they would be pissed and I do not know how or if I can DM from Reddit. Bottom line is to save your money for getting all of your state licenses, work free leads until you figure out if this is what you want to do, watch Duford's YouTube videos to learn about the business, figure out if you can stand to be hung up on and yelled at 20 times a day, and get your P and C license, too, so at worst, you can get a job in the local Allstate or State Farm agency and sell car insurance."

— InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/kk9tjuf/

"I had a guy scream at me... "I keep getting calls all day! what if I come down there and blow you!?" Will you then stop calling me!?" Then he hung up on me. He was fed tf up."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznn/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oahvpk2/

"Just a back story on my thought process....Market factors and the price offered was hard to pass up. I am in an area of the country where insurance carriers are trying to decrease capacity and they do not want our business. I also had 40 percent of our revenue with one carrier and that carrier is also pulling back in our area. I had three carriers pull out of my agency as well 12 months leading to the sell. After the sell Helene destroyed my area so the market has gotten even worse. Once I sold to PE I realized the leverage they have that I didn't have. My agency was a nice size (2.5 million in rev) but a 1 million book with a carrier isn't what it used to be in an unprofitable area. I have a commitment to my family and this allowed me to achieve my dream as well. If I am an idiot I could run through all my money but at the moment I am comfortable with no debt and a lot of zeros in my account. I did agree to a three year contract known as a work out to get even more money on top of the initial offer. So far I have gotten 1/3 of the additional money. I am hoping to get the remaining 2/3 and then evaluate what I want to do next. If they treat me fairly I may continue but time will tell. Also...If another hurricane hits my area this year or even next I suspect we are heading towards a Florida scenario. I am too old and too burned out to have to tackle that type of marketplace."

— InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kr7bqt/pc_agency_owners/mtgh4s0/

"See, I think we need to keep in mind most people - the "average" "most people" - do not understand much about insurance "at all." I have been reflecting lately on when I was in my 20s and even 30s, I really had no clue. That lady - \$100 says she thinks you decide the rates. When I was 20s, I wouldn't have known any better. I do remember getting auto insurance probably the first time and the agent said "ok so you want comp and collision" and I was like - "ok sure... if that's what I'm supposed to have. Is that what I'm supposed to have?" lol. I literally had no idea what that even meant. I never really thought much else about it until I needed to use it. Same with health insurance. So yeah - I think she probably believe that you absolutely do have a say in what the rates are that you're giving her. Maybe she just needed to hear the words "I really wish I could get you a lower rate. I would if I could to anything about it at all." Maybe it's also just cuz I've worked retail and I'm used to people yelling at me for stuff that has nothing to do with me, lol. It's just the way people are, sorry to say"

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r99hmi/is_it_just_me_or_are_we_all_changing/o6d73ag/

"The income potential with insurance is 100% higher than with a vet tech job. So if the work is more satisfying to you with being a vet tech, then absolutely it's such a win. Especially if you can afford to live on that income. But just because you weren't making enough money in the insurance industry at that current point in time, doesn't mean that you wouldn't have worked up to it. It sounds like maybe you worked in the personal division, which has limitations and also has a really high burnout rate. The average commercial lines account manager makes near six figures, more with heavy experience. My only point is that you can make a really good living in the industry, but it does require sacrifices."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rek2rd/be_honest_how_many_of_you_lost_your_soul_in_this/o7l0slm/

"With life and health, it's gonna be a few options. Now they'll be some places where you go more towards the Financial advisor side. Unfortunately, you're a couple months late for health. Everyone was hiring for the Annual enrollment period.. That's what I did for many years. I did get burned out and wanted to do more. But I did make Good money. Unfortunately, there are layoffs every year and every time I was up for promotion. There was a lay off, so I tried to go. Independent again myself. I may eventually go back to being independent one day, but I'm in the process of getting my series 7 and 66 while I get a base salary. It wasn't easy and it took four months of interviewing. After that, I plan on adding on with RICP and CFP. But that's because the company that I'm working for Will pay for it and try to grow with a W2 company. There are plenty of jobs. That will take a lot of work that pay well. I started as a W2, Medicare Agent, and made between 80 and 125,000 a year for the last six years. I wasn't doing that when I went. Independent, though, I had to spend so much money and the training, technology, Support just was so different. You gotta realize they are selling you. There's a few really good independent organizations out there, but it really depends on what you're good at and what you want. Most of them. Don't care because they get paid. Regardless. If you do nothing it doesn't matter to them. I hate MLM structure too so I stay away from those places. How have you spoken to over 50 different places and they all sound amazing, but a few actually follow through."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/pb0iw84/

"I agree with you! It's been so much harder. It's nice to see CMS loosen up some of the rules for 2027 but 6 years ago, i was making a lot more money. I am burned out."

— InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/og362z2/

"@WitsEndFL Thanks. I'll now pay special attention to max out of pocket when comparing plans. Some sources say you should start learning about Medicare 6 months before you are eligible, and as much as I hate it, it's true. It's scary to be near the enrollment deadline (whatever it is in relation to when you need your effective date to be, which I'm still not sure, due to unknown processing time after you apply), and you haven't learned enough about a very complicated topic. Just today, I'm learning from a BOOK on Medicare, that I have to produce a birth certificate which I don't even have, before I can sign up. So I have no clue how an agent even signs me up for a plan if I can't yet enroll with the government. One agent I know said Florida was a hugely expensive state for Medicare costs, so I don't know why you're calling their plans good. What prospecting methods did you use? Which ones work? Did you buy people free dinners? Do all the meals pay for themselves in commissions as a result? Did you use powerpoint in restaurant meeting rooms? You hated it, but I would enjoy it as long as the money was there. I've done 100% commission sales before, and only came to hate prospecting it when it didn't pay off after the real estate market tanked. I'm used to speaking in public and enjoy giving presentations. But I'm not paying for 25 dinners at \$20/pop if everybody just eats and leaves. I suspect good agents are eventually making thousands of dollars over time as a result of their meal investments. Some presentations are titled "Medicare Made Simple in 1 hour" which of course is a crock. Medicare is complicated, and you have to memorize a whole book to be able to answer anyone's odd questions. What they mean is, "I can give you a broad overview in 1 hour that barely scratches the surface." It allows prospects a chance to get to know the agent in a group setting, but that's about it. No one walks away remembering all that stuff. If anything, they walk away in a fog. I can already tell it will be much more costly in time, and possibly gas (if you can't get them to drive across town to come into your office) to sell to even half the room, as compared to a canned presentation to 15+ people at once, which is the easy part. The work comes later. But I'm surprised there aren't more people doing the free meal shotgun approach to maximize the hourly income. People I've met at meetings say they get 15-20 telemarketing calls per day, which I've read is against the law. I haven't gotten any. I mainly get junk in the mail, and there's no way to differentiate one agent from the next. Assuming a new agent did well and wanted to keep doing it, what's the minimum numbers of year you'd recommend it takes for the overall process of getting licensed and building up referrals and residuals for the whole thing to be worth it? I'm thinking that if you start young, it's more likely worth it, making more each year. But if you're looking for part-time income after retiring from your main career, it may be too late if you're going to quit in less than 5 years and retire for good. (or die)"

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgwznXpDAJJG44WTG054AaABAg.9lUZZMzAxJm9loBO8nfeFK>

"I called about the grocery allowance.... I called about the grocery allowance and first agent was very pleasant. The next agent for the program, in my area, was friendly at first. But then things turned rude and dismissive. His name was Mike something and I called at approximately 5:15 pm on July 8, 2024. He seemed to take offense at my statement of already having same coverage with current Medicare plan... to the point that he stated " Well if you are not going to let me tell you about the benefits, then our conversation is over. Goodbye. And he HUNG up on me! No DROPPED call, no Accidental disconnect. One minute we were discussing the Catastrophic Coverage option available to me in my county of residence. I worked as an agent in a brick and mortar agency and from home for UNITED HEALTHCARE, KAISER PERMANENTE, BC/BS and HUMANA to name a few and would have been coach and written up if I spoke to a customer as he spoke to me.....and fired for hanging up on a potential client. This person needs some refresher course on manners and code of conduct. Needless to say, I will no longer be interested in your company during open enrollment and will be advising others as well about "Mike".

— TrustPilot · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/668c7113466a6bbcfcadc0a>

Lead Sources

FMO / IMO lead programs · 311 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37gZCBMR8CY54AaABA9z9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8>

"Imo owner now, it when I was independent as a Final Expense and Medicare agent I grossed 500k a year for 7 years in a row and 300k for several years before that. My first year in the business it was 180k. Net was lower, I had to buy my own leads, pay my own business expenses. But I don't know that I ever had more than 100k in expenses a year. I was an exceptionally good agent and I made sure to write business that paid renewals which is how my income grew to be so high."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/hq85spe/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"Has anyone else seen these black market leads going around? Ok so I gotta talk about this because it's getting way too normal and nobody's saying anything. There's these "black market leads" floating around right now that are stupid cheap and come loaded with everything. Like everything. Carrier, coverage amount, draft date, personal info. The agent doesn't even have to prospect. You just call someone who already has a policy and flip them into a new one. Sounds like a cheat code right? It's not. That data is straight up stolen. Breaches, insider leaks, sketchy vendors selling info that was never theirs to sell. This isn't a gray area, it's illegal. Depending on what you actually do with it you're stacking felonies without even realizing it. And half the time the "sale" is just twisting anyway. You're replacing a policy the client already had, restarting their contestability, and usually leaving them worse off, all so somebody can grab a fresh commission. It's crazy how many new agents have no clue what they're holding. Upline hands them a list, says start dialing, and the kid thinks he hit the lottery. Nah. You're the one whose license and voice is on that recorded call. Not them. When is the fraud gonna end lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ukowmo/has_anyone_else_seen_these_black_market_leads/

"NYC Im a terrible life insurance agent. Can I sell medicare plans? I've posted before about not being able to sell Life Insurance even though I work for one of the biggest companies. I need to transition into something lucrative yet flexible as I have a child and they have a million days off and school events etc. I thought maybe I could get into health care sales but tons of reddit post say that NY is the worst place for health care sale due to the restrictions. If health care is so restrictive, what does everyone over 65 do for medicare?? I hear about FMOs and IMOs but no one lists the good FMO companies in NYC. Anyway, Im at a loss. I need income and flexibility but I dont know how to get that that. Any advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

- 1. Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
- 2. Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications.
- 3. Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
- 4. Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"Am I Crazy for Wanting to Leave My \$200k+ Job to Start and Independent Agency Background, I'm mid 30s, 2 kids, and I've just about had it with my extremely high stress/toxic culture job (in a healthcare/pharma marketing related field). I have a few years of savings and I'm ready to pivot my career into something more personally rewarding.....I'm seriously considering insurance! I know how to build a brand, manage CRM systems, create effective communications (the one-on-one sales aspect is new to me, but I know I can figure it out). Plus I have a solid background in many aspects of prescription drugs and healthcare (i've taken a practice licensing test without cracking a book and got a 72%, so there's more for me to learn, but a solid foundation) The idea is to start a medicare-focused agency, brand it to appeal to the communities I want to target, partner with an FMO, and begin sourcing paid and earned leads directly (this is not a challenge for me, I'm been doing it in the pharma space for years). My goal is to use the next 6 months to start up the business, get my licenses and begin lead generation. I would then quit my job in time for the end of year enrollment season, see how that goes - (pick up some light contract work throughout next year to supplement my income) and then go all-in on the business late 2026 - hoping that I can be clearing \$150k+ in 2027 and back to 200k+ earnings in 2028. Over time I'd branch out into other lines, but I want to keep a narrow focus for now so I can effectively source clients. That's the high-level plan, of course their are many more details that I'm figuring out (I'm building financial projections, comparing FMOs, analyzing the competitive landscape for local agents and the large nationals...and a lot more to make sure I'm going in with solid goals and expectations) So, am I crazy to get into this world? What are the biggest pitfalls to watch out for that will get in the way of me being successful? What is the biggest deterrents for those starting out that will my make feel burnt?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jdknqh/am_i_crazy_for_wanting_to_leave_my_200k_job_to/

Referrals and word of mouth · 204 documents

"I am a licensed agent since 2006 and have clients on both Medigaps and Advantage Plans. It's our duty and obligation to give each client to do a thorough presentation and give them their options. Medigap plans are excellent but not all can budget a Medigap plan which increase every year and when it's a husband and wife the expense can really be a hardship. Then they have to pay separate for their part D and separate for dental insurance and so on. On the other hand, my parents and in-laws with medical issues like cancer and diabetes have done very well with advantage plans and still continue up to this day. Not to mention some clients may also qualify for Low-income Subsidies and Medicaid programs from their state so truly they are covered even 100% for all Medicare costs. Although they are managed care plans there are many professional physicians who participate in these advantage plans and the referral process is not a headache. There are not a one size fits all plan. Every client has unique situations, lifestyles, income and so forth. So, at the end of the day give your clients the option because if you don't do a good job explaining their options as discussed on Medicare and You handbook, another agent will come along and enroll them in a managed care plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 93 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz1PoROzLPt1BvWDah4AaABAq>

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls that with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Best leads in 2024???? This video had nothing to do with helping agents find reputable lead sources. You mentioned 10 different lead gen sources (none to be named) and said nothing referring to the actual title of your vid. Try renaming to " Don't make these mistakes ". I was looking for actual usable content with names of companies that are skilled at lead gen and are reputable. Waste of 14 minutes."

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg>

"Anyone's agency not do cold-calling for leads? I'm not sure if this will sound sane, but my agency grows solely off of referrals and advertising. Of course it's not the quickest growth, but it's been working for the past 5 years. We're a small independent agency that sells personal and commercial. I'm curious to hear others' thoughts and experiences!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mk37eo/anyones_agency_not_do_coldcalling_for_leads/

"Lessons from my first year as an agency owner. AMA I started my p&c agency in May 2025. For context, I posted when I first started and about half way through year one so go check those out. I started my agency because I had 10 years experience up to that point and I was tired of working for others and following their lead when I knew there was better ways to innovate and bring a superior experience to the clients. So after one year, what have I learned? 1) The power of taking 100% ownership for your life and business You will make mistakes, you will have setbacks, you will burn through money trying to figure things out. These are unavoidable and part of the learning process. Don't be reckless, but know that you will not have all of the answers out of the gate and that's okay. Accept your responsibility as the captain of the ship and you will find a way to overcome the hurdles that get in your way. 2) The power of the niche In the early months, I chased any and all kinds of business. That lead to me spinning my wheels but getting no traction. It was only after I picked a lane and stuck with it (for the most part, just because you pick a niche doesn't mean you have to turn away business that doesn't perfectly fit in the niche) that the trajectory of the business shifted. 3) The power of relationships and finding your tribe Once I picked a niche, I sought out power partners that I could help make their lives easier by offering their clients a needed product and service, so the power partner actually had an incentive (not a monetary kickback, although you'll find that helps grease the wheels) to refer me because I would strengthen their core offering. Think your typical referral partners (real estate agents, lenders, etc) but also think outside the box. 4) The power of delegation You cannot do everything. Know thyself, know what your strengths and weaknesses are. Hate doing your books? Get a bookkeeper. Not good at social media, find someone or a service that is good at it. Not a marketing guru? Find one. Don't try to be a hero, find others that have what you want and work out a deal. There's many more lessons, so ask me anything."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ts41sg/lessons_from_my_first_year_as_an_agency_owner_ama/

"New life insurance agent — how are y'all actually generating your own leads? I'm a newer life insurance agent and trying to figure out how to consistently get leads without spending a bunch of money. I see people on TikTok all the time talking about how they generate their own leads and don't have to buy any... but when I ask people in my group how they're doing it, I usually just hear stuff like "go pass out flyers at grocery stores." That's just not realistic for me. I've got three kids — two of them are still really little — so standing outside a store passing out flyers isn't something I can easily do. So for those of you who have actually found a way to generate leads yourself (especially from home), how are you doing it? Social media? Referrals? Something else? I'm willing to put in the effort, I just need a smarter strategy that works around my life. Appreciate any tips 🙏"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tg4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj1/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

Cold calling, door knocking, dialing · 177 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHQAVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&srefix=how+to+win+friend%2C%266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad.&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: | Industry | Description | | --- | --- | | Tech | You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. | | Med | You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in *The Pursuit of Happiness*. | | Finance/Insurance | You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. | | Hardware/Construction | Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. | | Cars | You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. | | Door to Door | Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. | | So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. | JOB TITLE | PAY RANGE (Salary) | PAY RANGE (OTE) | DESCRIPTION** | | --- | --- | --- | --- | | SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) | £25,000 - £40,000 | £50,000 - £80,000 | Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. | | SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive | £30,000 - £60,000 | £50,000 - £140,000 | Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. | | MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive | £40,000 - £75,000 | £60,000 - £150,000 | Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. | | ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive | £50,000 - £100,000 | £70,000 - £250,000 | Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. | | SALES MANAGER | £60,000 - £120,000 | £80,000 - £200,000 | Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. | | MD: Managing Director | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. | | HEAD OF SALES | £100,000+ | £100,000+ | Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. | | Terminology | Description | | --- | --- | | Cold call | When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. | | Lead | This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead'', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. | | Account | This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. | | Contact | This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. | | Example of a lead, a contact and an account. | Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

"8 Tips for New Agents to Sell Insurance Successfully Below I've compiled a list of 8 strategies imperative for new agents to execute on, if you want to see success selling insurance, regardless of the agency, niche, or product you sell. Here they are: # 1. Clear the Calculator Selling insurance is largely a mental game. In other words, you have to keep your emotions and focus in check at all times. This means you must not allow distractions from your personal life or sales calls gone sideways to affect your mindset. Here's some tips that have helped me stay mentally sharp: * Treat every sales call as a fresh start. Getting rejected on one sales call doesn't mean you'll get rejected on the next. * It's helpful to think of your clients rejecting **your offer**, not you. The rejection is business, not personal. * Maintain balance in your personal life—exercise, eat well, and manage relationships. Mental clarity fuels sales success. # 2. Eliminate Distractions Selling insurance is great, but especially those who sell remotely, it comes with endless distractions. To stay focused: * Set clear boundaries with family—work time is **work time**. Make sure your spouse and kids respect this. * Keep your phone muted and out of reach during work hours. Group your texts and calls to a scheduled time. Most of them can wait. * Social media and internet use while you should be selling kills productivity. Consider a low-cost app like Freedom.to limit internet access while you should be working. # 3. Prioritize Activity Over Everything Activity leads to "app-tivity." In other words, tracking your numbers is critical to uncovering opportunities to improve your results. Try tracking these metrics daily: * **Connection Rate** – How many people are you actually getting to pick up the phone? If this number is low, explore dialing technology that helps keep your number off the spam- and telemarketer-likely lists. I like Convoso and Kixie. * **Quality connections** – How many conversations last longer than two minutes? If you're having trouble keeping your prospects on the phone, work on your opening script by practicing objection rebuttals until you can say them on the fly without hesitation. * **Closing rate** – How many policies are you selling compared to presentations? If these numbers are low, adjust your strategy. Retrain your scripting. Success is a numbers AND a skill development game. # 4. Master Your Scripts and Rebuttals The best agents **sound natural** but follow a proven process. If you don't have a script, you're winging it! And winging it doesn't work long-term. A good script consists of the following: * A strong intro that overcomes initial objections while simultaneously helping the client remember that they in fact requested the information you're calling about. * A handful of effective fact-finding questions that help build value and urgency to buy what you're selling. * A good list of underwriting questions that help you figure out which product works best. I like using Insurance Tool Kits for life and final expense policy sales. * How to close confidently. # 5. Stay Consistent with Your Schedule Consistency wins. The more you treat your profession like a job, the better off you'll be. I recommend the following: * Set a fixed start and end time every day. Stay disciplined to this as much as possible. * Avoid checking email or social media during work hours. Schedule a time before and after work for this. * Batch tasks. Separate prospecting, calling, and follow-ups. # 6. Improve After Every Call After a completed sales presentation - whether you sell or not - don't just move on! Analyze what worked and what didn't. Ask yourself the following: * Did I control the conversation? Or did the prospect control the pace? Remember that the person asking questions is in control. * Did I handle objections smoothly? If you're stumbling in your script, practice it multiple times until it's smooth. * What could I do better next time? Biggest pro-tip I can offer is to record your sales calls and listen to them. You'll hear all sorts of opportunities to improve =). # 7. Develop Thick Skin Rejection is part of the game. If you get rattled after a bad call, you're losing twice. Keep moving. Instead, think about the following: * If someone hangs up? Act fast and dial the next lead instead of ruminating. Don't spiral out of control! * If a prospect is rude? Probably like that with everyone. Don't take it personal. Next! * If you get 50 rejections in a row? Think: a sale is that much closer =). # 8. Work Smarter, Not Harder Successful agents **leverage** tools and systems to increase efficiency: * Use a CRM to track leads and follow-ups. AgentCRM is a pretty good CRM to start if your agency doesn't provide it. * Automate tasks where possible such as a chat bot to speak with your leads. Or use a compliant powerdialer to speak with more prospects faster. Again, I like Kixie and Convoso. * Constantly refine your approach based on data. Hope this helps =)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kfmbhp/8_tips_for_new_agents_to_sell_insurance/

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability **and** refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"Why are we selling insurance like its 2005? Not trying to start drama just genuinely curious. We've got tech for everything now food shows up in 15 minutes, people find houses on their phones, we match with dates using algorithms. But when it comes to insurance? We're still cold calling, chasing unqualified leads, and quoting people we were never gonna close in the first place. We spend hours dialing and quoting but half the time it's with someone we can't even write a policy for. What if there was a smarter way to work where we only connect with people based on what they actually need and what we actually offer? Not saying tech solves everything, but there has to be a shift from the old school hustle to something more intentional. Anyone else feel like the traditional model is wearing thin?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l3wj8v/why_are_we_selling_insurance_like_its_2005/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAq

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through without their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"anyone else hate receiving AI-voice generated cold calls? the usual AI-generated cold calls I got were usually those that assume you aren't interested. "hi. this is x from x company. we are calling to tell you that you are eligible for our medicare benefits. do you have plan A or plan B?" "plan A" "I understand, but this call will not take too much of your time. it will only take a minute to discuss your eligibility.""

— r/sales · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1fhlgv1/anyone_else_hate_receiving_aivoice_generated_cold/

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

Call centers / captive employers · 167 documents

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Buying an Independent Insurance Agency I am interested in purchasing my own independent agency and currently in the process of researching what that entails. Background: I currently work for a family agency where I am 3rd generation. My grandfather started the business, and I work under my dad and alongside my siblings. I have been at the agency for 5 years. I thought that it was fixable, but things are not going the way I hoped. There is always a ton of family drama that spills into the workplace, and it is a very unprofessional environment that drives me crazy. I am the only one who has outside work experience (previously an engineer for 10 years). Everyone else came straight to the agency and lacks very common and important real-life skills. Managing a calendar, Microsoft office knowledge, how to communicate effectively (to carriers, customers, and co-workers), etc... I come from a sales background so managing a pipeline and working with business owners or homeowners comes naturally. I've also been managing marketing, accounting, and day-to-day business operations, referral commercial lines quoting, CL renewals and networking for the agency. 90% of the daily decisions are made by me and then my father just blindly signs off on them because he is the principal and checked out (ready to retire). I have transitioned the agency to a new AMS, new accounting software, and transitioned most of our book away from agency bill. I have successfully increased efficiency by taking our 8-person agency down to 3.5 people. No one was fired, we had old staff and everyone retired. I thought we were going to be able to work together as siblings and run the agency, I was wrong. I tried a couple times to sit everyone down individually and talk about goals, dream responsibilities, and other things that would help align all our visions but am always met with "I dunno", or "I don't care", or "This is stupid, stop trying to make this a corporate office". Anytime there is a disagreement there is either a huge fight or one sibling goes to our mom who manipulates my dad into making the decision behind our back. I am looking for guidance from agency owners or industry veterans. What mistakes did you make when starting out or how would you do it differently now. 1. I am not interested in a captive agency 2. I understand PE acquisitions are at an all-time high but there are a good number of small mom and pop shop agencies around with limited succession planning (Ohio) 3. I understand getting a new carrier appointment right now during the hard market is very difficult if not currently impossible, but I will weigh the agencies current carrier selection very carefully 4. I understand this is a HUGE undertaking and the YEARS of work it will require Thank you in advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l48ryh/buying_an_independent_insurance_agency/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavgn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"It's my first day as an independent insurance agent! I used to be a captive age but I didn't feel like I was able to provide the service I feel my community of artists so I quit and decided to become an independent agent. After 2 months of hemming and hawing applying to jobs in other sales fields I finally decided it was enough and found 2 IMOs. One focused on health the other focused on life and P&C. Today I signed my last contracts to be appointed with their major carriers and I started prospecting. I sent out maybe 50-70 linked in messages with one simple goal in mind. Ask 5 people to sit for an appointment with you. I accomplished my goal at 1 pm with one appointment set. Then I went out networking and was able to book a second. 5 is tomorrow's number as well. I want to go a full week with 5 tasks every day except Sunday. As a wise poet from the San Francisco Bay Area once said, "I'm feeling myself"."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pc01jr/its_my_first_day_as_an_independent_insurance_agent/

"Incomes can widely vary based on captive or independent. When you have a salary or safety net, the incomes you mention are doable, it is recommend that newbies start out as captive before venturing out on your own. Most will fail in the first year going it alone. My agency did over 1.2 million and on track for 1.5 this year, but many years of hard work, it is definitely more rewarding on the independent side, but not for everyone."

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Makelbeingbougie · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgxPaeU0nrh1AzCEkX94AaABAq>

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"The thing that frustrates me about recent news is that many of us likely completely agree that for profit health insurance is just not a good model. But people who hear insurance just assume all of us are in health insurance and just rolling in cash and laughing. I'm a PC reinsurance broker working mainly with captives. People have no clue what I actually do."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1i58bx2/given_how_much_the_insurance_industry_has_been_in/m81suw3/

"I run my regions claims department. If you have written proof we'd consider covering it. I will admit if your captive it's a lot more likely independent it becomes our discretion"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1n20wgr/i_accidentally_did_not_add_collision_on_a_clients/nb2k0su/

"StevenjKSU said: I never wrote their MA and don't see that ever happening. If they are still the most appropriate plan for any of my stand alone people, I will educate them and help them get set up, but we will just have to set some boundaries around service through the year. I have a feeling their call centers are going to have a bad time in 2026. I can stomach service for \$50 a year, but no business can work for free. My clients will understand and I am sure that a few of them will be letting Aetna and Wellcare hear about it. Click to expand... "Mrs. Smith, I'll help you as much as I can but WellCare no longer allows insurance agents to advocate for their members. If you run into a problem, I can try to point you in the right direction but I won't be much help because of how WellCare chooses to operate." If there's another suitable plan option, I'll mention it and explain that they operate differently and I'll let the client choose. In other words, I'll be helpful but the help will be limited, and I'll be clear that the help is limited because of how WellCare chooses to run its business."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senior Insurance Forum · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/wellcare-paying-no-commissions-on-pdp%E2%80%99s.113845/#post-1504617>

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABA9>

"Just commenting to see the comments from captives. I'm interested to see their opinions. I could see marketing/leads being one."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hygnnd/why_do_so_many_stay_at_a_captive_agent_vs_broker/m6hcbjsj/

Seminars, events, workshops · 124 documents

"THE SCHEME OF GLOBE LIFE | AMERICAN INCOME | ARIAS | I am writing this to prevent others from wasting their time and money and perhaps even a great deal of second hand embarrassment. In this post I am going to cover in detail the scheme that is otherwise known as "American Income" or "Globe Life"; heavily trending in Miami. It starts with roping vulnerable people in. On social media, agents are FORCED (yes FORCED) to post dramatic "before" stories like: "I dropped out of school," "I had no direction in life," or "I couldn't provide for my family," followed by claims that American Income/Globe Life completely changed or "saved" their life. Then come the flashy posts: high-rise apartments, Lamborghinis, first-class flights, private jets — all paired with captions implying that this lifestyle came from becoming a licensed life insurance agent and "changing people's lives." The entire image being sold is designed to make people believe they, too, can achieve immense success in as little as ONE YEAR and financial freedom if they join. You send the DM like instructed and are invited to join a Zoom call, usually on a Monday or Tuesday night. You join the Zoom and one of the "big names," Spencer K "self made multi millionaire", walks everyone through the process. They explain the learning modules for the licensing exam and tell you that you're expected to complete the program within about a month. The Zoom itself is usually brief, but before it ends, you're assigned an "overseer" or mentor whose entire job is to make sure you complete the program. From that point forward, this person is contacting you constantly — almost daily — checking in to make sure you're completing modules, taking practice exams, and staying on track for your test date. At first, it feels supportive. It almost feels like people genuinely care about your success. But later, it starts to make more sense why they're pushing so hard to get as many people licensed as quickly as possible. Eventually, test day comes. You pass. Everyone congratulates you, hypes you up, tells you how proud they are, and immediately instructs you to be on another Zoom the very next day. On this zoom you're told your job is now to make 300 dials a day MINIMUM and schedule as many Zoom appointments as possible in order to sell life insurance policies — specifically whole life insurance. It is made very clear that whole life policies are the priority. You are essentially trained to convince people they need it no matter what. The focus quickly stops feeling like helping families and starts feeling like pushing expensive products onto vulnerable people. And here's the part that genuinely disturbed me: the "amazing free leads" they brag about are, elderly individuals or people who seem to have very little understanding of what they're being sold. Many of them were connected through labor unions or rotary/member organizations and were told they were receiving benefits or information. After only a few phone calls, it became painfully obvious that a large portion of these people were either financially struggling, lacked the education to fully understand the policies being pitched to them, or were extremely elderly and easily confused. Some could barely follow the conversation. Others sounded lonely and simply happy someone was talking to them. Yet the expectation was still the same: keep pushing, keep booking appointments, keep trying to close deals. Here's where it became even creepier. During these calls, you're expected to stay connected to Zoom the ENTIRE time, completely unmuted, so your "mentor" can listen live, interrupt, correct you, and coach you in real time while you're speaking to potential clients AND "make sure you are working at all times". You had to ask permission to USE THE BATHROOM AND MUTE YOURSELF. A situation in particular that genuinely stuck with me: I witnessed another agent on a call with a single elderly man who calmly explained that he simply did not have extra income to afford another policy. While the man was speaking, the mentor suddenly started screaming through the Zoom call, instructing the agent to say — and I quote: "Can you really put a price on leaving your family with nothing to collect when you die?" The agent was obviously uncomfortable and hesitated instead of repeating it. The mentor immediately became furious. Meanwhile, the elderly man on the phone had gone silent because all he could hear was awkward dead air on the line. Eventually, he just hung up. The second the call ended, the mentor redirected everyone's attention back to the Zoom and proceeded to criticize the agent for "losing the sale," as if the issue wasn't the fact that an elderly man had just explained he couldn't financially survive another monthly payment. At one point, the mentor actually asked us: "Does a lion care about the sheep's feelings before it kills it to eat?" That was the mentality being pushed. That was the "mindset training." And somehow, it only got stranger from there. The following day, there was a branch-wide Zoom call with some of the higher-ups, including someone referred to as "Big Brah," who is, in my opinion, one of the most unhinged people involved in the entire operation. He screamed at everyone for not completing 500 dials a day. He told us we "had no real desire for a better life" and "didn't want it bad enough" claimed that if we weren't actively dialing, we should either be sleeping or working. He demanded that everyone send screenshots of their iPhone screen time at the end of the day every day so he could supposedly see "who was really hungry" and "who deserved to be there." And somehow, the environment got even more cult-like..... We were told the only acceptable reasons to not be working were going to the gym or "dieting." Inside their Slack-style group chats, people were genuinely posting PROOF that they had gone to the gym along with photos of their "clean eating" meals for approval and validation from leadership....DAILY. The craziest part is that people were actually doing it!!! Fully grown adults reporting their screen time, workouts, meals, and daily activity to complete strangers in order to prove they were "committed" enough to sell insurance. At that point, it stopped feeling like a workplace entirely. It felt like a bizarre mix of toxic hustle culture, manipulation, and psychological control disguised as "motivation.". If you weren't in the Zoom room exactly on time, your mentor would immediately start BLOWINGGGG up your phone with calls and messages asking the location of where you were, why you weren't online, and what you were doing instead of working. It created this atmosphere where people felt guilty for having any life outside of the company. You were expected to be constantly available, constantly dialing, constantly "improving," constantly proving yourself. There was this underlying pressure that if you slowed down for even a second, you "didn't want success badly enough." And the scary part is how quickly people normalized it. Having strangers monitor your activity, demand proof of your productivity, question your whereabouts, and pressure you into spending every waking hour working somehow became framed as "discipline" and "commitment." Here's the gag- You're told there's a second way to make money — and this is where the entire structure really starts to reveal itself. Instead of endlessly making calls yourself, you can recruit multiple agents underneath you and "build a team." Once you have enough people under you, you transition from being the exhausted person cold-calling all day into becoming the mentor managing everyone else. In other words, you become the same person pressuring others to stay on Zoom for hours, tracking their activity, demanding productivity screenshots, and pushing them to sell policies or recruit more people beneath them. The real money, they imply, comes from building downlines and living off the production of the people under you. BUT it gets crazier.... The reality behind the "luxury lifestyle" being advertised online. One thing that stood out immediately was the car situation. These "big dogs" constantly post themselves supposedly buying new Lamborghinis, Ferraris, and Rolls-Royces every other month. The image they push is that they're making so much money selling insurance with their teams that they can casually keep adding exotic cars to their collection. But if you actually pay very close attention, the cars NEVER come directly from Lamborghini, Ferrari, or Rolls-Royce dealerships. They repeatedly come from the SAME luxury used car dealership in Miami. Why are all these guys only buying their luxury cars from the same dealer? Well a little birdie told me that these vehicles are NOT being purchased outright at all — they're being LEASED at extremely high monthly rates/ have a maximum number of miles they can not exceed and then the cars are swapped in and out frequently. That's how they're ab"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/

"Rant- Big Red is one of the worst employers (and the most petty) I've had a long career and in my 25 years I've worked at a lot of carriers. Some were better than others but most of them weren't terrible. That is until I worked for Big Red. I should have known from the horrible interviewing/hiring process it was going to be bad. A recruiter reached out because a colleague gave them my name. I applied and didn't hear back for three months. They initially offered me to interview for section manager position but after the interview they decided to offer me a team manager position. I wasn't going to accept but my wife convinced me that it could be a good opportunity. I agreed to the position. Then my first day it was absolute chaos. 900 people starting at the exact time as me and my credentials not working. No phone number to call or anything. Finally at 3pm after panicking that I left my consulting gig and wasn't getting hired I got a phone call asking why I wasn't online. This lead to them telling me I never signed my offer letter. Fast forward and it turns out they changed their mind and were offering me the section manager position but no one called. I'm now a section manager Fast forward a few months and this job is hell. I spent two months getting the most basic training ever. None of it has anything to do with management. None. I am never taught how to use the time card system. I'm not taught T2 or Workday. Nothing. Then I'm saddled with a team that has questions from minor claim stuff to HR issues. That I have no idea on how to handle. Then my claim manager has the nerve to tell me I need to get my CPCU, that management is expected to have their CPCU. I have my CPCU. So I tell him that. He asks why I haven't been putting it in signature. It's simple I don't see value in it when I have decades of real experience. He then tells me that I need to continuously improve and to sign up for another designation. I choose the ARe. I go on and buy the three ARe exams study material and sign up for the tests. I take the first one and pass. Then I sign up for the next two. I decided to get all the materials for a few other designations that overlap the CPCU (like 6 other study materials). Keep in mind I'm using the corporate codes. While all this is going on I am still trying to figure out the job. I have leaders asking me questions and talking to me like I should know how certain obscure systems work. The absolute worst part is the other new folks. I had four brand new team managers reporting to me. Three were external hires and one was an internal hire. I honestly felt like every day I was letting down my team because I didn't have the faintest clue how to teach them systems that I didn't have any clue how to use. There was zero training for them. These folks had brand new adjusters of their own and they didn't know how to help them. I had one associate get out to the middle of the country in their van and their gas card stopped working. This is a 22 year old recent grad with no real world experience. Stuck in the middle of the country because they don't have enough spare credit to pay to keep filling up that gas hog. Their team manager had no clue how to fix the situation and I had no clue. It took us three days to find someone to fix it. I felt like pure dog shit. No one would respond to emails other than giving a vague area of the internal portal. All the while my one on ones were just my claim manager asking me about personal development. Develop my skills in how all this runs.... I resigned a couple of weeks ago and it was the most asinine process I've ever seen. My claim manager was on time off. None of his colleagues would respond. I go to HR and they don't have a process for it. Finally after they fail to reach anyone they "take a message". Eventually I get an email saying mail back the laptop, phone, and mifi. The final touch is that they emailed me a list of stuff to return them. Which is a lot more exhaustive than they originally said. It's not like I wanted to keep the equipment. It's honestly that I didn't even keep most of it. When I got hired on I was originally going to be a team manager so they sent me adjusting equipment. I've worked at this so long I've got better equipment than the junk they gave me. So I literally threw a lot of it away and gave the rest to younger adjusters I knew. I didn't even keep the monitors because I had a nice office already. They hounded me for weeks over it. The box I did send back was so small the laptop had to sit diagonal and I got a nasty email about the laptop being damaged. (They provided the box) Then they did the most petty thing ever.... I had a test scheduled with The Institutes for April 15th. Today they had the institutes send me an email asking for certain printed material back and they removed my online access to all the material and my last scheduled test. I understand the test, sure you don't want to pay for that. But to go back and retroactively remove study material is absolutely insane work. Especially because I purchased corresponding tests to that material with my own money since they only pay for one exam per quarter. End rant. Actually P.S.- when people say that the company is failing. It's not for all the obvious reasons. At its heart it's because it's become a bloated bureaucracy. In all their efforts to streamline and create operating procedures for everything, they have made the whole process inefficient. They can't keep employees because they won't invest in their training. New adjusters with two months of training shouldn't be set wild to figure it out on their own. Designations shouldn't become the goal of what success looks like."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1jzcv0m/rant_big_red_is_one_of_the_worst_employers_and/

"5 Reasons Why Selling Insurance May Not Be For You... While selling insurance has been a blessing for myself and many others, the reality is that the business is a brutal battle for most, certainly not for the faint of heart, and probably isn't an ideal fit for most who enter it. After working with thousands of agents since 2013, I think there's 5 core reasons why upwards of 90% or more of new agents eventually fail out of the insurance sales business. Here they are: 1. **Opportunity Mismatch:** Understanding what you TRULY want from this business is crucial. Are you aiming to recruit agents, sell insurance directly, or something else? Many enter this field based on recruiters and agencies' misdirection and empty promises, only to discover that their goals never actually aligned. My advice: don't jump in bed with the first agency that wants you. Instead, take time to evaluate what you want out of the insurance business, and work to find an agency that supports your vision. 2. **Multi-Level Marketing Pitfalls:** A significant portion of agents inadvertently join MLMs, where the focus is more on recruitment than on sales. These agency structures can drain your resources while offering lower commission rates than average. If you find yourself in a situation where the agency's leadership heralds recruitment over selling, you're likely in an MLM. If that's the case, then get the heck out ASAP. 3. **Lack of Training:** Many new agents fail due to insufficient training. It's critical you find a mentor who can provide constructive feedback, and help you when the going gets tough. Without the correct type of training and support systems in place, failure is much more likely. 4. **No Lead Generation System:** Your leads are the lifeblood of your insurance sales business. Without a solid prospecting system, you'll find it nearly impossible to succeed. Therefore, it's essential to ensure that the agency you join has a reliable lead generation strategy proven by others to work. 5. **Entrepreneurial Shock:** Transitioning from a regular paycheck to a commission only income can be jarring. Many new agents are unprepared for the unpredictability of entrepreneurial life, including managing taxes and budgeting personal expenses without a guaranteed salary. My advice: take time to ensure you can manage your financial affairs on a straight commission. Consider salary plus bonus or no-cost lead system agencies to help eliminate or defer costs, so you can better eliminate stress that formulates from risking your money in lead systems."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jtu5mt/5_reasons_why_selling_insurance_may_not_be_for_you/

"Globe Life-American Income Experience/Warning Just wanted to drop my experience working with American Income/Globe Life for those who have been contacted, recruited, or are looking into this company. I was recruited via LinkedIn and contacted for an interview that ended up being a 50+ person seminar that required little to no personal information/questioning to get an official job offer. After the "interview" I was prompted to complete my Life & Health Insurance Courses & Exams. The courses were about \$110-150 each. Each exam was \$45 each time you took it. Once you completed these requirements you had to actually pay to receive the licenses for the states you want or are required to be licensed in. Globe Life wanted us to be licensed in at least 3. They were roughly 150 each. FYI NONE of this was reimbursed by the company. So before I even began "training" I had already spent roughly 1k and had made \$0. "Training" consisted of hours of Vimeo or Google Drive training videos. These training videos were literally just recordings of prior trainings that had been done via zoom. So there was no questions to be asked and no interactivity at all. After the videos you shadowed a trainer who essentially was just doing their normal day to day, but with your assistance. My "training" was just me making cold calls for the "trainer," and any interaction I did get, was transferred straight to the trainer so they could complete the sale. REMINDER: at this point you are still making \$0. After about two weeks of this you get released full time. BUT under one specific stipulation... For your License's to become "activated" (whatever this means) you had to make an initial sale prior to being released. Their workaround to becoming activated, was making me reach out to a friend or family member and have that individual buy an insurance policy that was the lowest amount possible we could input into the system. Why they had us doing this? They never explained or even could explain when asked. It was "just a requirement to get your license activated." So now that I have a family member in the system and paying like \$15 for some useless policy, I am finally released. I was given about 100 free leads to call on. I spent 3 weeks calling my leads only to find out, most of these individuals had already been reached out to and denied our services. So I was 100% Cold Calling people who were already upset and had rejected calls from prior employees... Eventually I quit. I had been working for roughly 3 months, 45 hours a week, and had made \$0. I also hadn't seen more than 6 sales TOTAL made amongst our ENTIRE team. This included about 30 individuals, team leads, sales reps, and higher-ups. We worked on zoom together in groups so we could witness sales and build off of eachother. Again, I witnessed first hand MAYBE 6 sales total in roughly 3 months. Meaning only 6 of the individuals out of that 30 made money during this 3-month period. Not to mention that the random tiny policy my family member bought to "activate" my license gets daily calls because they turned off their card after I quit due to fear they were getting scammed. I start asking questions because none of this made sense. How are these people who've been here for years supporting themselves? How are any of these people making money? Well come to find out. The only people making anything, are the individuals who are working in high up positions. The managers and team leads are being paid bonuses for simply hiring people and training people. Why? Because these trainees are being used to do the grunt work. All the trainees are making calls for the managers and "trainers" who are financially benefiting off these trainees solely based on them being hired, as well as them making all the calls and interactions. Meaning all the sales these trainees potentially would've gotta, are being given to trainers and managers. On top of their bonuses given for simply hiring people. I saw plenty of posts here on Reddit and other forums claiming Globe Life/American Income was an MLM and I didn't believe it until I witnessed it first hand. I didn't see any of these posts go into great detail on how it worked so I just figured it was lazy people not wanting to work. I sure learned my lesson and wanted to provide a very detailed breakdown of what exactly goes on in the Globelife/American Income workspace."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mhlvhy/globe_lifeamerican_income_experiencewarning/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"Warning: My Experience with Symmetry Financial Group – Please Read Before Joining Hey Reddit, I've been in the insurance industry since 2021 and have had success in multiple roles. I know what real mentorship and growth look like. That's why I feel the need to warn others about my experience with Symmetry Financial Group — because it was one of the most toxic, disorganized, and emotionally draining environments I've ever worked in. Here are the biggest red flags I encountered: • The leads are extremely aged. I was handed leads from as far back as 2016. Calling people who haven't requested life insurance info in nearly a decade felt unethical — more like harassment than service. It genuinely made me uncomfortable. • The culture is toxic. Uplines and agency owners frequently humiliate agents on Zoom calls in front of everyone. There's no support — just power plays, ego, and public shaming. • You're not in control of your own business. They make you ask for permission to get licensed in new states, claiming they won't get paid if you get licensed somewhere they aren't. It's controlling and makes no sense if this is "your business." • Shaming over conferences. Can't afford to attend one of their big events? Be ready to get publicly called out and guilted like you're not serious about your career. It's manipulative and unprofessional. • The training is the worst I've seen in this industry. There's no real structure, no proper onboarding, and no consistent support. You're left confused, overwhelmed, and underprepared. • It affected my mental health. I've never struggled with anxiety — not even in high-pressure sales environments — but while working with SFG, I had debilitating anxiety that impacted every area of my life. As soon as I walked away, that anxiety vanished. That tells you everything. The good news? I've since joined a different IMO with real leadership, training, and respect — and I'm flourishing now. This experience taught me that it's not the industry that's the problem — it's the people you align yourself with. If you're thinking about joining Symmetry Financial Group, please think twice. Don't ignore the red flags. You deserve better."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"NYC Im a terrible life insurance agent. Can I sell medicare plans? I've posted before about not being able to sell Life Insurance even though I work for one of the biggest companies. I need to transition into something lucrative yet flexible as I have a child and they have a million days off and school events etc. I thought maybe I could get into health care sales but tons or reddit post say that NY is the worst place for health care sale due to the restrictions. If health care is so restrictive, what does everyone over 65 do for medicare?? I hear about FMOs and IMO's but no one lists the good FMO companies in NYC. Anyway, Im at a loss. I need income and flexibility but I dont know how to get that that. Any advice?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f81t9g/nyc_im_a_terrible_life_insurance_agent_can_i_sell/

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/](https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/) I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircj/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent_i/

"If you were starting over today with no book of business and no carrier appointments, what would you do first? Hi everyone, I officially passed my Texas Life & Health licensing exam yesterday (self studied via an online prep course), and I'm trying to be very intentional about how I build my business from Day 1. A little background: I'm 39 and transitioning from a successful corporate finance career (\$175k, annual) after being laid off in 2025. I want to use this unexpected time to invest in a career pivot to an independent producer, eventually building up to a small boutique style agency. Short-term, I plan to focus on Medicare, ACA, Life Insurance, and Supplemental Health. Longer-term, I'd like to expand into ICHRA and small employer benefits, but I don't want to spread myself too thin in the beginning. My vision is to build a referral- and relationship-based business. I'm much more interested in creating a trusted advisory practice than becoming a high-pressure salesperson. If you were in my shoes today —with no book of business, no carrier appointments, and no industry experience—but knowing what you know now: What would your first three steps be? What mistakes would you avoid? Would you join an agency/FMO first, or would you try to build independently from Day 1? Is there anything you wish someone had told you before your first year? I'm not necessarily looking for the "highest commission" straight away. Instead, I'm trying to build the strongest long-term foundation and book of business. I genuinely appreciate any advice from those who've been through it. Thanks in Advance"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uxw9ko/if_you_were_starting_over_today_with_no_book_of/

"Boots to the ground!!! It's free my man. That's how I got started 3 years ago. Go to every senior center, senior apartment, retirement homes, food banks and do table events wherever seniors show up. I have so many great relationships. I do a lot of fun events at these places. Keep at it, don't give up. After year 2, referrals start coming in, and you start seeing the fruits of your labor in monthly deposits into the bank account, just keeping your clients happy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1d5disv/turning_65_leads_medicare/16l3fuc/

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

Live transfers and inbound calls (pay per call) · 110 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought *pre-sold leads* from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the *insurance carrier, not the agent*, for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** — This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** — Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** — If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Had my first sale today! I'm a new agent in Florida, independent. All inbound leads. Today was my first day on my own after training. Just super excited n I needed to put it out there!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1uj9u0m/had_my_first_sale_today/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp...which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"How do y'all deal with actually insane clients? Was at my desk today when my service manager calls me and says "I have someone you need to talk to." She never does that to me, so I knew it was going to be a ride. I answer the phone. Lady leads with "I went to your office and you guys vanished in the middle of the night! Do I even have insurance!? I'm reporting you to the government!" Reality: we moved nine months ago. Across the parking lot. Our Google listing has been updated. All our policy docs reflect the new address. There's a literal sign taped to the old door with an arrow saying "we moved next door." She then accuses me of not mailing her documents because I'm "screwing with her bill." Her payment has changed once in the last. It went down from \$92 to \$84. At this point she's yelling more about reporting me for moving. I told her "I'm not interested in getting yelled at. What would you like from me today?" She rants a bit more. I respond with "Okay. I am happy to transfer you to another office if that sounds good to you." She ranted more and eventually hung up. Curious how other agents handle the loons like this. I'd love to move her out of my book, but also can't really do it without her consent. People are nuts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kt8utu/how_do_yall_deal_with_actually_insane_clients/

"How I retired my wife with my insurance agency, AMA I launched my agency in 2023 after working for years as a producer, underwriter, and consultant. It started as a side project with one goal in mind, to build enough recurring income to retire my wife and give us both more freedom. Within the first year I turned it into a full-time operation using an aggregator for market access and an organic marketing system that focused on building real relationships instead of buying leads. If you are trying to start or scale your own agency, here's what I can share: • How I used social media to generate consistent inbound leads without paying for ads • How I manage quoting, follow ups, and virtual assistant support to keep volume moving • How niche markets like pressure washing and contractors helped create stable renewals • What commission structures and business habits made the biggest difference early on • How to build an agency that supports your family and gives you time freedom Ask me anything about licensing, operations, staffing, lead generation, or what it actually takes to build an agency that can change your lifestyle."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1o2ysrs/how_i_retired_my_wife_with_my_insurance_agency_ama/

"What Uplines Don't Want you to Know - Carrier Release Process - Explained This is a question I get a ton from new agents, and its what every upline doesn't want you to learn, so please... learn it. Treat this information like it's required for you to be in the industry to know. Review your contracts with your uplines and make sure you have protection within them as well. Heck, get a lawyer to review it. Whatever it takes, I see too many agents getting trapped in awful comp deals and abusive uplines and get "Stockholm'd" into buying bad leads from them and then gaslighting them into thinking its their fault. I've been there done that. This info is for the agent that calls themselves independent:

Demystifying Agent Contracting, Releases, and Blackout Periods I work directly with 54 carriers, 4 FMOs, multiple agencies, and nearly 1,000 independent agents. My role involves overseeing contracting, licensing, and agent/agency development. With experience spanning so many entities, I've had the chance to see the contracting process from all angles and business models. Let me break it down for anyone who's struggling to navigate this space. # Steps to Understand Contracting and Releases

- 1. Contract Level (LOA vs. Broker):** * If you're directly contracted with a carrier as a truly independent broker *and* haven't signed an agreement restricting you to one entity (or an LOA contract, which assigns your commission to your upline), you should generally be free to contract with another carrier or upline without issues.
- 2. Private Contracts (Non-Competes or No Non-Competes):** * If you're tied to a brokerage or agency and have a private contract (like a non-compete), get a lawyer to review your options. Some of these cannot be upheld in court, that's important for you to know. * Medicare agents may want to wait until the start of the year for a smoother transition —this avoids AEP complications.
- 3. Carrier Blackout Periods:** * **New agents** can contract anytime, even during AEP, for Medicare Advantage (MA) and Medicare Supplement (Med-Supp) plans. * **Switching uplines or FMOs, however, is restricted** during AEP for MA carriers (typically September–December). * If you're contracting with a carrier for the first time, you can get a **new contract** during AEP, but you can't **switch uplines** until the blackout period ends.
- 4. Release Process (To Release or Not):** * Brokers contracted directly with carriers usually retain their commissions unless restricted by a private contract (see Step 2). * You can file a self-release with an "intent to transfer". After 90–180 days, the carrier can re-contract you under a new upline while allowing you to keep producing during the interim. (you will be compensated according to your previous contract if you decide to continue producing, you wont get commission for producing if you WERE an LOA agent because your effective comp is 0%) * This safeguards agents from being stuck in unfavorable relationships. Most agents prefer waiting until the start of the year to minimize risks. The key is understanding your contract and navigating transitions safely, which is something many agents overlook. # A Brief History of the Release Process (why the heck is it this way?) The "agent-release" process emerged in the late 90s and early 2000s to manage transfers between FMOs and carriers. Unfortunately, it was often abused, with FMOs refusing to grant releases, especially during AEP, leaving agents trapped in bad contracts. To address this, carriers like UnitedHealthcare, Aetna, and Humana introduced transfer freezes during AEP to protect their investments. The "intent to transfer" process, developed in the late 2000s and early 2010s, aimed to fix these issues by providing agents a path to transfer without jeopardizing their business. # Misunderstandings About Releases If your agency/FMO/upline tells you "you can't transfer," it's likely because their training hasn't been updated to reflect the proper release procedures. This isn't usually malicious, they just want to ensure you're not left without commissions. Nobody wants to risk that. Also, the information is incredible "gate-kept", it's not a "sexy" process everyone wants to learn, until they need it... If you're looking for additional insight, this [YouTube video](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NaExikyNwzo) (not affiliated with me or my company) provides a solid overview of the release process. However, it doesn't touch on the contract-level distinctions I've outlined here. Understanding these processes can help you avoid costly errors and confidently take control of your career. If you have questions or need clarification, feel free to ask!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/

"How is everyone marketing in 2025 without spending a fortune? For years, live transfers were my primary lead source but in the last 24 months (especially since the one to one consent incident happened) costs have skyrocketed and quality has gone down. Since, I've tried multiple vendors, and I've tried data leads + telemarketers. It feels like no matter what I do, I have to spend 5 grand a month in marketing at least for each of my producers just to hit our goals. It's way too much, and as we spend more to make less, I'm feeling bad burnout as my margins shrink. Primarily P&C, captive agent. So what is everybody doing that's working?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/

"A few things: - Anyone you buy leads/calls from need to give you contract language specifically for this situation. - Litigators are 100% bad faith, this is how they "makes living". The upside is that between the "I paid for a live transfer and you'll need to talk to the company that drive the call" is valid - Litigators are lazy assholes. Best bet is to match their energy and say you will show up in court to litigate this. \$10k is the small claims limit in a few states. Some are \$5k and a few are higher. The MO is to file in SC, show up to the hearing and then get a judgement. That's why you should show up with a contract to give to the judge showing you are not responsible for this litigator doing what they're doing. That \$25k settlement is now Civil Court territory, meaning you need to retain representation... in other words, it's costs money. Call their bluff, show up to any SC hearing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/mjv8uf0/

"Interesting to see the other side of a serial litigator. Questions for you: What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call and hop on Indeed dude. No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y0u2a/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Journaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use journaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I'll give you the secret sauce. Go to Claude A.I think about an ad you want to create. Take the creatives and go to Facebook and create an ad. Then have the lead transfer into your crm that will text them within 30 seconds of them responding keeping them warm and active until you call the client. Sounds harder than what it is. Or pay someone to set it up. But it's your leads exclusive to you. Never resold."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/ocy1xro/

Google ads / search / SEO · 92 documents

"SDR GUIDE - How to become a slick, silver-tongued, money-making SDR. So you want to be a slick, silver-tongued, money-making salesperson? Well, this is the guide for you, giving you all the information you need, terminologies, book recommendations and tips to impress even the coldest manager. Maybe you have always been destined to get into the life of sales, or maybe this is a brand new yellow brick road you have just stumbled upon. This guide is going to go through the absolute basics and then get into more and more niche topics; if you want to read fast, skip the stuff you know, otherwise grab a notepad and get your plan in order. **Understanding the concept of sales** ** Before we even think about getting into tips on how to get a job, let's get a pure basic understanding in place, go read the following books: - [How to win friends and influence people](https://www.amazon.co.uk/How-Win-Friends-Influence-People/dp/0091906814/ref=sr_1_1?crid=11ZYLHHAOVSTP&keywords=how+to+win+friends+and+influence+people&qid=1582153753&sprex=how+to+win+friend%2Caps%2C266&sr=8-1) - [Rich dad, poor dad](https://www.amazon.co.uk/Rich-Dad-Poor-Teach-Middle/dp/1612680194/ref=sr_1_1?keywords=Rich+dad%2C+poor+dad&qid=1582153771&sr=8-1) - [4-hour workweek](https://www.amazon.co.uk/4-Hour-Work-Week-Escape-Anywhere/dp/0091929113/ref=sr_1_5?keywords=4-hour+workweek&qid=1582153785&sr=8-5) These books probably won't teach you much that you don't already know, but they will tell you what you already know in a new way. You need to understand that sales is about connecting with people; that is the number 1 most important thing. Everything else is strategy and techniques. But even if you know every technique, if you're a dick to be around, well... you probably won't make it far in sales. Choosing the industry So you want to be in sales? selling what exactly? If you can't install an app on your phone, maybe tech sales isn't for you. But that doesn't mean your dreams of being the #1 salesman are dead... this could be the beginning of something better for you. Listed below are the most common industries, and what I know about them: I Industry I Description I I --- I --- I I Tech I You sell consulting or software to companies. These could be small hair salons and vape stores or giant operations that use your software as the backbone of their business. You probably need to work in a city/tech hub. I I Med I You sell hardware/pharmaceuticals to hospitals/surgeries/local practices. You might manage a list of accounts or you might be hustling hospital to hospital like Will Smith in "The Pursuit of Happiness". I I Finance/Insurance I You sell financial packages to different operations and individuals. Might mean cold-calling an account list, or could be consultative. I I Hardware/Construction I Schools, houses, roads and cities need materials to be built. You work with different groups selling equipment, services or supplies. I I Cars I You sell rocket ships..... It's car sales... you sell, cars. I I Door to Door I Knock, knock? - Who's there? - Give me your money for this solar panel. I So if you're looking for advice on 5 out of the 6 of the above, then you just ran out of luck, buddy. I don't know anything about those industries, so figure it out yourself. Tech buddies, however, let's make some money! Terminology. What the hell do these words mean? SDR, AE, MM, SMB, PROSPECTING, ACV, OPS - What the hell gibberish are you talking about? We have all been there, a million different abbreviations and references to things nobody has probably ever spoken about before. So let's break down all the common terms you will come across in the near future. Make sure to drop these buzzwords in your future interviews to really sound like you know what you're talking about. Pay will vary based on location - These are averages based on first hand experience. There will also be outliers. Jobs in the USA may vary from the below figures. Typically 30% higher pay, but will vary depending on location. I JOB TITLE I PAY RANGE (Salary) I PAY RANGE (OTE) I DESCRIPTION** I I --- I --- I --- I SDR: Sales Development Representative (sometimes called Business Development Manager) I £25,000 - £40,000 I £50,000 - £80,000 I Dialling and smiling. Your job will be to get in touch with people at different companies, with the goal of piquing their interest enough that you schedule a meeting with them. Done via email, LinkedIn, calls or conferences. This meeting is either ran by yourself or an AE and is used to learn more about a company before showing them a demo. You will typically get paid if they show up to a demo. I I SMB AE: Small Medium Business Account Executive I £30,000 - £60,000 I £50,000 - £140,000 I Dance, monkey, dance. Your job will be to put on a show and present (demo) to an individual/team at a company with the goal of convincing them to buy your software. This involves showing them a demo, organising follow-up meetings and going through the process to get a decision-maker (DM) to sign a contract with your company. You will typically get paid when they sign. I I MM AE: Mid-Market Account Executive I £40,000 - £75,000 I £60,000 - £150,000 I Fancy suit monkey. Your job will be the same as an SMB AE but will involve more steps, with bigger companies. Have you ever gone through the terms and conditions of an agreement before? if not, get used to it. I I ENT AE: Enterprise Account Executive I £50,000 - £100,000 I £70,000 - £250,000 I Fancy suit monkey with top hat and monocle. I see you have been putting on some good demos and somehow lucked out on some big deals. Well now it's the big leagues. You live by the sword or die by the sword. The length of the interaction and complexity to get a DM to sign a contract has now rapidly increased. Get on a plane, fancy suit monkey, and go dance. I I SALES MANAGER I £60,000 - £120,000 I £80,000 - £200,000 I Smart monkey or dumb monkey? Your job will be to guide your team to victory. To make sure they are motivated, understand their mistakes and are using the best tips and advice to get deals in. You're likely going to a meeting, but are supporting your team and helping manage internal politics and resources. You get paid based on your team's accumulative sales. I I MD: Managing Director I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or super dumb monkey? Your job is to manage a team of managers and individuals, and to make sure your managers are leading and not bullying their teams. You are helping on big deals and making sure that important clients get what they need so that you can make those dollar dollar bills yo. I I HEAD OF SALES I £100,000+ I £100,000+ I Very smart monkey or lying monkey? Your job is to manage the managers and work with other heads of the organisation. You are the captain of the ship, the life of the crew is in your hands. I I Terminology I Description I I --- I --- I Cold call I When you call someone who is not expecting your call. Typically done in an attempt to book a meeting. I I Lead I This is the classification within your database for individuals/companies that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. Typically this will be used when 'marketing assign a 'lead', meaning a individual who has engaged in marketing activities (i.e. clicked a email), in which they now believe there is a higher chance of that person being interested in buying your goods/services. I I Account I This is the terminology used to refer to a company/group that you are trying to get in contact with/manage a relationship with. I I Contact I This is the terminology used to refer to an individual who is listed under an 'account'. I.e. Susan is my contact at ABC company; she is Head of E-commerce. I I Example of a lead, a contact and an account. I Susan at ABC company visits the website of the company you work for. She enters her email address in order to download a webinar. This information is passed onto your marketing team, who gives the information to an SDR and asks the SDR to email/call Susan to try book a meeting. Susan responds saying that she isn't interested, however, her colleague Tom from Marketing would be a better person to speak with. Susan is now changed from a lead, into a contact. An account is created for ABC company and an additional contact is created with Tom's details. This allows you to enter notes for the company and write down what has happened, so that you and your organisation can manage lots of relationships with differ"

— r/sales · 587 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/f8q9r9/sdr_guide_how_to_become_a_slick_silvertongued/

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

"New rules (with a slight change) Thank you to everyone that has assisted with helping with the new rules. Here's where we landed, and there is one small tweak: 1. This is not a place to sell your services or generate leads or recruit agents/downlines. Consumers should not get offers to quote or to privately "help". This includes asking people to vet your software/AI or other peripheral concepts as well as advertising your website or app (even if it is currently free). 2. Do not post any unethical, illegal or unhelpful content. 3. Be a good reflection of the industry and remain professional. The difference is in Rule #1, and it is specific to a pattern of behavior of some life agents that have been trying to recruit to some quasi-MLM companies (I say "quasi" because I don't think that any DOI has stated it as a fact). Many of those trying to recruit are doing so with little to no posting history, which makes it very odd. The sidebar will be reflected soon to reflect this, but you should consider that these rules are currently being enforced as of this post. Edit as of 7/23/26 - effective immediately, we're no longer allowing posts that are asking for help with ideas for software, websites, apps or other SaaS concepts. Even if it's currently free, if you're linking people to something of yours, expect it to be removed at a minimum. Even if you're just asking for people to vet an idea, expect it to be removed at a minimum."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cdomsd/new_rules_with_a_slight_change/

"The Lifeboat Mentality The art of selling is truly an art, and guess what, it's something that every single one of us needs to master - fast. I'm going to get the first, and what I think is the most important step out of the way immediately: **Stop trying to sell *products* and start selling *yourself*** When I first started, I always had this question in my sales experience: Why is it that one guy has extreme success selling the same product, and another guy doesn't? Let me tell you about a time when I sold life insurance that completely changed the way I sell, and will sell for the rest of my life. So, I got hired at a huge brokerage in Florida. We were contracted with 40+ different insurance agencies to market and sell their products. I had to be licensed to sell annuities, medicare products, health insurance, prescription drug packages, and life insurance. So, needless to say we had an **ARSENAL** of products to choose from. During the orientation, we were greeted by the companies top salesman. The idea was for him to come in and share his success, and answer any questions us newbies may have before we ventured out on our own. It came about time for him to come speak, and in my head I'm thinking some young 20-something was going to bolt through the door with excitement and enthusiasm. Wrong. In walks a 60-year old retired war-veteran who had been crushing the insurance game in this company for the last year, month after month! His annualized premium average was close to \$26,000 per month. (This is the amount of Premiums people that he sold to were paying on a monthly basis. He not only receives residuals off of this, sometimes he'll even receive a 90-95% commission off of the first-year premium total - If they pay \$100 per month, he receives around \$1000) I couldn't believe it. But, me transitioning from shock to understanding, I began to listen to him. His success was no secret. He literally worked "harder" than everyone else. His military mentality came into play big time in this field. Why? He would knock on 30 doors per day. Non stop, wake up at 7am, and not go home until 5pm, or until he successfully spoke to 30 people. His strength was in his numbers. Law of averages! If he got a "No." he wouldn't waste a second, bat an eye, or fold. He knew his power was in his ability to talk to as many people as possible. Day after day, same mentality: Do it, or die. (Not to that extent, but you get the idea!) **Takeaway One: Understand the law of averages, and commit to it!** However, although we had an arsenal to sell from, I became completely overwhelmed because it seemed impossible to take in all of the product specs and legalities, all while trying to create a smooth sales pitch. So, instead of focusing on things I didn't know, I just focused on one of the many things I could sell that would give me the best chance at success: life insurance. I modeled the success of the older salesman, and knocked door to door to offer our product relentlessly. But, door to door sales isn't as easy as it seems. Actually, it doesn't seem easy at all. Think about it. Have you ever bought anything from someone who randomly walked up to your door trying to sell something to you? The idea is crazy. But, it works. Numbers game. Same with cold calling, and same with any service. The idea is to put yourself in a position to collide your product with a consumer in demand, at the time they have made up their mind to purchase. If they haven't made up their mind to purchase, it's your job, as a salesman to help them. But, knowing how crazy this idea is, I had to separate myself and treat people as if they were my friends. I didn't come across as pushy, I came across as informative, and very confident - I adopted the **Life Boat Mentality** The Life Boat Mentality is simple: Your customers are drowning. They are drowning from poor quality products or services. You see them drowning in these products or services, and paddle on over in your Lifeboat. The idea is this: With impeccable trust, of course, you persuade your client to get in your life boat. Your life boat is the "best" option. And if it's not the best option, you need to find a company that offers the best option and sell that. (I'm not about selling garbage - Honestly) If you truly in your heart believe that what you are selling is the best option, the Lifeboat Mentality will help you tremendously. For example. I own a small residential repaint company now. I've taken the Lifeboat Mentality with me throughout my entire duration owning a business. I've got the branding where I want it, I have the production where it needs to be, and the Lifeboat mentality that I carry with me says this: Mr. & Mrs. Customer: I know that there is a TON of options in the marketplace. So many to choose from, however, I know this for a fact. There will be none other than my company that will show you the amount of respect and care you deserve throughout the entire tenure of us working for you. From the initial handshake to the final good-bye I can guarantee that our quality of service is of exemplary fashion. How do I ensure that this remains true? How do I have the confidence to pitch this? Because as the business owner, I insure it. My sales process is down to a science and has clear concise wording, professional formatting, and a great follow-up procedure. We have references and a great website for them to visit, and provide insurance and legal information up front. I ensure that I will be at each job to make sure that our quality of service is exactly as promised. In other words, I'm showing them that I "me", the "salesperson" am the lifeboat! It may seem silly at first, but think of yourself as a lifeboat. Start saving people! Happy selling! P.S if you're interested in knowing more about the painting business, feel free to PM me I'd be happy to answer any questions you may have!"

— r/sales · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/7tph4u/the_lifeboat_mentality/

"Sorry I didn't provide value so I'll do it here: my favorite lead vendors I've used 1. Smart Finaical - seo leads 2. Happy agent - Fb leads 3. Nectar leads are insurance leads for seo and Fb Also if you are an agent your upline or leader should be able to provide you the best sources. Sorry for this I care about you"

— YouTube · The Best Life Insurance Leads For 2024 | My \$500k/Yr Lead Source · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gtXNK0-8f7c&lc=UgxSK3d37q7CBMR8CY54AaABAg.9zPnaAfMyXt9zPrRMljeY8>

"Are there ANY truly "good" life insurance companies to work for?? I'm in the process of getting my license, so still very new to the biz. I've read the horror stories of truly bad MLM-like companies and am staying away from those (although strangely, they seem to have their fair share of happy employees), so I did a very basic Google search of "The Best Life Insurance Companies to Work For." I got answers like Northwestern, Mutual of Omaha, New York Life, etc. So I go to Glassdoor & Indeed to read employee reviews, and those are just as all over the place as the MLMs! "Best company in the world, changed my life", "Shit leads, non-existent training, if you don't meet production goals you're fired". My question is: How do I know where the truly GOOD companies are if all the reviews are like this? I just want an entry-level role to get my feet wet, aiming for \$80k/yr in the first couple years. Nothing crazy. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"Brand New Independent Agents This is just a rant post. I find it extremely weird when brand new agents want to be independent but also expect everything to be given to them. The entire point of being independent is that you are the OWNER of YOUR business. If I decided to open to a floral shop, I would have to pay for inventory, supplies, a website, marketing, and anything else that I needed to run my business. I'd be responsible for going out and marketing myself & my business to attract customers. I wouldn't expect to make money if I was only open for a couple of hours a few days a week, because no one else is giving me a paycheck. And if I didn't know how to run a business, I would find someone who could give me the play by play. Not just someone who said they could, but someone who had proof they'd done it. Insurance is no different. New independent agents are constantly complaining about back office fees, that their IMO doesn't provide them free leads, being 1099, and having to actually bust their ass to make money... and after putting forth half ass effort, blame their agency or upline for not making money. If you want a paycheck, to clock out the same time every day, and someone to provide you leads, GO CAPTIVE. This is why most new agents fail because they saw someone on TikTok that told them they could make \$20,000 in a month. Which is POSSIBLE, I have seen it, not fresh out the gate. You don't even know what you're doing yet! And honestly, you already need to have money put back to carry you in the beginning months until you start to make money... that's where you need to start anyway. This isn't a get rich quick scheme. It's a real business that you have to put real work into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tnmhue/brand_new_independent_agents/

"Is a Life & Health Insurance License Useless? 🤔 I've had a Life & Health Insurance license for 2 weeks. It feels useless for finding a job. All the local captive agents focus on Property & Casualty. They like seeing L&H but they don't sell any. Even if they advertised for a L&H position. I applied to local banks and credit unions. I'm a notary too but heard nothing back. A recruiter from Brown & Brown reached out. She liked my resume and experience a lot. B2B Sales and Marketing, Tradeshows, SEO, etc. She has no job for me. I've had Life Insurance and Medicare outfits calling me. All commission based. They sound like scams and MLMs. I've tried getting an Employee Benefits Advisor job but these seem rare. Ideally I'd like to work at a hospital and help people choose health plans. Applied with health insurance companies. Haven't heard back. Are L&H license useful at all? What should I do to find a job? UPDATE - The Kaplan training I did was part of a hiring process for a Financial Services company. They paid with no strings attached as part of the final hiring process. They ended up not hiring me even after I passed the test. The goal was to do SIE and other FINRA certs. UPDATE 2 - Many of you are saying just go get a Property & Casualty license via DM. Yes would be good to do but I don't have a ton of money right now. Would much prefer to get a job that will pay for my P&C training and licensing. I was thinking of just watching Melissa from Insurance Exam Queen. She and Peter were so valuable for passing the L&H test."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lavqn1/is_a_life_health_insurance_license_useless/

"He had to search us out, go to our website, and submit a form with info about the company so that an agent can get in touch"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_tooaaarbi/

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

"How to get contracted as an independent health ins agent! I recently got licensed as a health insurance agent and am currently selling Obamacare. It took me forever to figure out who to contact within each insurance company to get contracted (their websites are a labyrinth!!) so I'm making this post to help out future agents! <https://agent.communityhealthchoice.org/becoming-an-agent/> <https://www.aetna.com/insurance-producer/become-appointed-with-aetna.html> <https://www.molinamarketplace.com/marketplace/brokers/en-us/Become-A-Broker/Agent-Appointment.aspx> <https://www.bcbstx.com/producer/prospective.htm> <https://www.humana.com/agent/contract-with-humana> <https://www.ambetterhealth.com/for-brokers.html> <https://www.uhc.com/broker-consultant> (email [appoint@uhc.com])(<mailto:appoint@uhc.com>), it took FOREVER to find this email and I found it on some random blank contract they had on google but NOWHERE on their website) BONUS use <https://www.healthsherpacom/> to compare insurance plans, generate quotes, and complete applications! They have a rly nice interface c."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/gl705l/how_to_get_contracted_as_an_independent_health/

Aged leads · 73 documents

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigator (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigator wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigator. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Quiet quitting - byeeeeeeee I'm an sdr at an insurance company. Fully remote. We grind hard every day - like 200+ dials. Warm and cold leads - no break in the calls or voicemails. All day. Every day. Calls and voicemails pop literally every 10-15 seconds. The commission is crap, but the base is comfortable. Here's the issue - I have decided this is not for me and I am going to quiet quit until they fire me. How do I disengage completely when I am compelled to do well and to succeed? Do I just ride the clock? Do I blow sales intentionally? Or what. A little help and guidance. TIA"

— r/sales · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/14m75j1/quiet_quitting_byeeeeeeee/

"I'm learning off 5-10 year old leads making 300+ dials a day to learn as fast as possible made my first sale yesterday thanks for the video"

— YouTube · Cold Calling 3-Month-Old Leads LIVE – Watch Me Close Insurance Sales · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qvBEaHr_MGU&lc=Ugybs2i2wGd1cChHPq54AaABAg

"I've been calling very old leads, some a year plus. Wanted to share the opener I've been using & it's been working. "Hi Mark, my name is David, calling from not too far down the road here in Tampa. First & foremost I wanted to apologize for it taking so long to follow up with you, how have you been?" I've never talked to these people in my life, but guards seem to be let down. Great video. Keep it up."

— YouTube · LIVE Dialing: Cold Calling Insurance Leads (SCRIPT GIVEAWAY) · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=POOoucTXJYc&lc=Ugy-hLbZx8ABAWNvJd4AaABAg>

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"What would you do if you had to start over from scratch? I'm 2.5 years into owning my agency and my book is just over \$100k. I've had some rough patches, hell, the first 2 years was a rough patch- but about 6 months ago I came to the conclusion that I'm going to put everything in me and do whatever it takes to grow my business and make up for the two years of my life that I wasted. I've gone 25 years untreated for ADHD and 2 months ago finally made myself an appointment to see what the hell is wrong with me. Fast forward 2 months later and I can finally function like a normal human being. Not only am I able to focus better, talk to people better, feel knowledgeable and handle things more professionally, but I actually care. I want to build something that will feed my family one day, pass down to my children, something that will provide us stability. I scheduled a 30 minute call with an agent I met a few years ago to see how he was doing and quite frankly, how he was doing what he was doing. I took a sneak peek at our companies production reports and this guy was selling nearly \$100k in premium a month. This meeting ended up being an hour long, but the biggest thing I took away was when he said this: "Dude... I have 5 kids", and it clicked. I have to get into survival mode, as if it wasn't just me, but those who depended on me. I think about my parents (whom I want to help retire because they are helping me financially), my girlfriend (whom wants to get married and have children with me one day), and my future kids. At this turning point in my life I am constantly asking people who are doing better than me, or are in places that I want to be, what would you do if you were in my position right now? What can I do to grow amongst these huge \$10M+ book size agents in my area? My goal is to quote over \$160k in premium a month, hopefully the quote to sell conversion ratio turns out good. These are mostly old leads, and eventually I will run out. Every Friday I am going out to 5-6 locations with realtors/brokers/lenders/title agents and handing out cookies, business cards, and a handwritten letter. Hopefully this helps me build a pipeline. I did this last week and people seemed receptive and related to the hustle. What is something I should be focusing on everyday to maximize my agencies growth?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tq4cq1/what_would_you_do_if_you_had_to_start_over_from/

"The shxty part is most agencies teach their agents it's a numbers game while they sell you over priced aged leads. Then you're outside all day chasing shxx leads like an axxhole and then they give you poor sales training. My advice is to master reframing and tonality. Get those two aspects down and fine tune your pitch and you'll increase your close rate. I been there and it honestly was horrible. Left and got into AI SaaS but if I had to do it again I'd master those two aspects first. Also remember Chase compassion, not commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ueswou/i_fully_respect_the_hustle_that_is_insurance/otmgwyw8/

"My number one recommendation is to buy leads. Not any leads, Aged Leads. Specifically leads that are 9-12 months old. Old enough where they don't get calls but need a policy or are open to getting a policy at a lower rate. The CPL and CPA are low enough to give you the ability to generate considerable revenue over a 90 day period. At that point in time you can pivot into more expensive marketing solutions or paying someone to run the marketing for you."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygpk0u/

"Dude I just want to say I started an ad. The first day not much happened. The second day I didn't think much was going to happen but then I got two leads. The third day I woke up to 4 leads and collected more throughout the day The fourth day I got even more. Every single one of these leads I can get on the phone I sale. I hit them as fast as I can, ideally within 60 seconds. My biggest challenge right now is just getting them to answer the phone. Peter I can't begin to thank you enough this gives me soooo much more flexibility in my business as before I looked into this I primarily relied on door knocking one year old leads and it was more expensive and time consuming.

Thank you thank you thank you"

— YouTube · Generate UNLIMITED Final Expense Leads On Facebook In 2024 (Full Tutorial) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aTFT03FiUCM&lc=UgxcG3JUruxdb4y1pCR4AaABAq>

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower internt.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. .get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"For those of us who've already been living in this final telesales telesales world, I thought it would be a good idea to share tips, carriers, and lead vendors to our cohorts to help them during these uncertain times. Whats your favorite carrier? Whats your favorite kind of lead? What tips do you have? --- My favorite carrier is American Amicable because of the ease of doing business. Although, I am finding, that many other carriers are getting better daily. The best lead for telesales is still TV. However, Facebook lead costs have CRASHED. This is a great time to jump in and get leads for \$2-\$3. I wouldnt use a vendor only to pay 200% more. Research and do it yourself. Heres my tip. Dont go back through all your old leads and think you are going to resurrect intrest. Buy new leads, and buy alot of them."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-134450>
4

"Pulling my hair out I work for a small insurance agency in a commission-only sales role, and I'm trying to figure out whether I'm being unreasonable or whether I was genuinely misled about what this job would be. During my interview, I was specifically told that the phones were constantly ringing and that I wouldn't have to worry about finding enough opportunities. The impression I was given was that there was plenty of incoming business and that my job would primarily be to sell and close it. That ended up being very different from reality. After starting, I learned that I was expected to do a significant amount of networking, prospecting, attending events, making community connections, following up with cold or old leads, and essentially generating most of my own business. I understand that sales involves prospecting, especially when you're commission-only. My problem is that this wasn't how the position was presented when I accepted it. I'm also not the only sales agent who was hired with the same general pitch. It seems to be a pattern where people are brought in believing there will be substantial inbound opportunity, and then once they're there, they find out they're largely responsible for creating their own pipeline. More recently, the office structure has changed even further. Other employees now handle most incoming calls and leads, along with accounts that became available when another employee left. I've essentially been pushed into a purely outbound role. So at this point, unless I personally generate the lead, there's very little opportunity coming my way. What makes it more frustrating is that I've actually done what was asked. I've gone to networking events, built relationships, promoted the agency, followed up with prospects, and tried to create business from scratch. But if someone hears about the agency through something I did and then calls the main office without specifically asking for me, that business may go to someone else anyway. I've tried raising concerns about needing more opportunity to actually make money, but the response is basically that the company pays for some networking opportunities and I need to make those work. That leaves me feeling like the expectations have completely shifted from what I was originally told. Had I been told during the interview, "This is a commission-only role where you'll primarily be responsible for networking, cold prospecting, and building your own book from the ground up," I could have made an informed decision about whether I wanted that job. But being told that the phones were ringing off the hook and that lead flow wouldn't be an issue is very different. There have also been smaller things that have made me feel increasingly disconnected from the office, including seeing other employees receive opportunities, accounts, recognition, or inclusion that I don't seem to get. Those things wouldn't bother me nearly as much if I were actually making enough money for the job to be sustainable. I'm now updating my resume and considering other positions, either in personal-lines insurance with a more stable structure or possibly outside of insurance altogether. For people who have worked commission-only sales jobs or in small insurance agencies: would you consider this normal shifting expectations, or does it sound like the job was misrepresented during hiring? I'm especially curious how long you would give a situation like this before deciding it probably isn't going to change."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wlnr8v/pulling_my_hair_out/

Named lead vendors (EverQuote, SmartFinancial, QuoteWizard, NextGen, Aged Lead Store, AllCalls...) · 72 documents

"I have no idea how internet leads are profitable, even by their own claimed results. I spoke with Smart Financial last week because I could use another source to supplement my office's quote volume. Leads are \$10 each. They are claiming a 3-5% close rate based on the internal agent dashboard results they can see. I started to build a spreadsheet out to model both 3% and 5% scenarios, using my average new policy auto premium. After paying between \$200 and \$330 for the sale, and paying my sales guy out on it, my break even would be like 1.5 to 2.5 years. 2.5 years is longer than the average customer lifespan for the internet leads we have previously written. I'd say "well, we make money by selling additional lines of coverage" normally. But the customer quality on internet leads is usually renters. It's been a long time since I've run internet leads at any volume. Are any of you actually tracking ROI and coming out ahead on these?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ucbfrx/i_have_no_idea_how_internet_leads_are_profitable/

"150 Internet Leads Bought & ZERO Sales. Just took over an agency (P&C) from an agent that sold out and since the start of the month we've been getting internet leads. I am using Smart Financial but we haven't gotten any closes on these leads or even really any correspondence. Are we doing something wrong in the office or is that just the name of the game?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vyv0ou/150_internet_leads_bought_zero_sales/

"Leads! So here's my situation. In the last few years, I've consistently closed 2 to 3 out of every 10 phone calls, and about 1 out of every 3 full pitches. But the agency I used to work for masked the lead provider and changed the names, so we never actually knew where the leads came from. Now that I'm working for myself, finding a solid lead provider has been way harder than I expected. I really didn't think it would be this difficult. Out of 46 ACA leads from NextGen, I've closed zero. Not even a maybe. Does anyone have recommendations for good lead providers, or even insight on how they generate their own leads? Open to any direction at this point."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/>

"Online leads Hello, been an agent for 8 years never had a good experience with online lead companies. I see most people here are active with online leads. Any life lead companies worth suggesting to try out? Appreciate all the suggestions. Not afraid of the competition I believe it's enough money to go around for all of us that put in the work. These are the companies that were pretty much trash and disappointments for me, I wouldn't suggest any of you wasting time and money with them. A plus leads, Hometown quote, Everq, QuoteWizard, Smart financial."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1dfe69c/online_leads/

"Sorry. I have no interest in recruiting you. Just sincerely trying to help. Understand that DigitalBGA is a competitor of mine and I still recommended them, largely because the lead sources you recommended are extremely expensive or aren't very good. Sometimes you have to do more than just buy leads to actually *get* the good leads, as most vendors who create quality leads realize the money in this business is made in agency building, not lead selling. Here's my experience as an agency owner dealing with them: 1. Datalot: Very expensive - agents working with me in the past used them and did not get very good results. 2. SmartFinancial: I've talked to agents outside of my agency who used them. The one guy was getting 50 or 60 transfers a week and paying several thousand a week. He had to have extreme scale to get decent results (think it was \$10,000AP+ weekly). My thoughts were that his results would be good on production but considering the high cost and high volume of the inbounds, would yield him a low ROI on average, which could be potentially dangerous on low production weeks. 3. Benepath/NextGen Leads: Don't know anyone who has used them. Hope that helps."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcm82b/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3g/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"I agree, it doesn't matter who you buy leads from. I've tried quotely google ads (terrible ROI), quotewizd/smart financial leads. I would call the lead the moment they would come through. The amount of times the prospect would tell me they submitted the form online for their insurance request 2-7 days ago and they have already now purchased a different policy from a caller already was massive. They all sell you aged leads even though they all say they are given in real time the moment they submit the form or they are fake information. I think cold calling/referrals from current clients/referrals from referral partners are the only ways to truly get people. I hear of agents who spend \$5-\$10k on leads a month and write \$200-\$500k of premium a month, those just feel fake lol."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer7u8e/

"Its \$1M, but policy count is correct about 45avg/month ~25 household average. I get enhanced commissions first year. Its a grind but I don't quote everyone I come across. I have a really good idea of my company's sweet spot rates. I can also guess peoples rates with my company & competitors and be within ~5% nearly every time lol. Saves time on quoting which to me is the time consuming part. I don't quote people whom I know I have a high chance of being slaughtered. Working this way increases my closing rate from 15% to 40%. Less time quoting more time selling. Leads from quotewizd & my own marketing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oma6hp/whats_everyones_total_compensation_for_2025/nmr46z6/

"Following to hear others input. We have been struggling with quality leads as well. And I'm not talking we expect to close every deal, but we have purchased a ton of internet leads who said that they never requested a quote in the first place (InsuranceQuotes, Everquote, etc.). We understand it's a numbers game at the end of the day. But we at least want a chance to win their business, and we aren't even getting that most of the time and just spending money on leads with 0 potential."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1orzwnm/leads/nnu829f/>

"Best live transfers?? What live transfers have you had the most success? From my research the top three are Smart financial (contactability)- Lead star- Datalot- There are also these companies: Benepath Next gen leads Insurance quotes- What company should I sign up with? Any recommendations? Thanks"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/

"I'm assuming you're in a sales role. Are you getting renewal commissions currently? If you are, I'd look at what your retention rates are and what you can do to improve retention. Something that was helpful for me was that I make it a point to see every single one of my clients in person at least once a year and speak to them at least one additional time....i found that to be a good way to build a relationship and get referrals. I also found that I got a very good ROI using warm transfer leads like Tivly and Smart Financial. I had some learning pains initially, but once I figured out the filters that worked for me, they were very useful in growing my book. Something else would be to try and focus on a specific industry or a couple of industries that you like and have good carriers for."

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1ntvaed/burnt_out/ngwz3p2/

T65 lists, direct mail, mailers · 72 documents

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdoteal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent.. harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

"I started at 24 years old and just started my agency exactly a year ago after 12 years of being a captive agent. I would suggest you don't rush to any conclusions before thinking them over. Everything sounds great what you said, but not that easy and very expensive. I made a substantial investment in purchasing direct mailing equipment to create leads at cost for my agents. I pay for all leads and I still have agents not wanting to "work" and complain the leads don't work. I have over \$55k worth of direct mail equipment that will "handwrite", insert in envelopes, and apply postage. My costs for postage, mailing permits, CRM software, scrubbing software, etc are about a Mercedes car payment. I recently ran the numbers and cleared profit working on my own. I think I'm going to focus on myself working in the field and sell my direct mailing services to agents with other agencies that want to follow what I do to offset my costs of operation. My suggestion would be for you to find a good FMO/IMO as an agent first. Build your business in a year and decide to take on new agents. I show my 1099 to prospective agents to show them to follow my lead and everything I do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/yvgguy7/

"Wow, I never thought of that—thank you so much! I've been looking into doing ads too, but I know I need a bigger budget to really test and make sure I'm doing it right. Just trying to be smart so I don't burn through money too fast. Also, really appreciate your tip about skipping the direct mail leads. What are your thoughts on telemarketing leads?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/11fsdj/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mygqfig/

"Yikes, that sounds like a terrible job. I would look for an agency that is focused on working with people who are turning 65. They are out there. I am not hiring at the moment or I would ask you to send me a resume. But, I promise there are t65 agencies who would put your licenses to work."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/mh9kxtg/

"Oh jeez, where to even start on this one. Leads...the biggest hurdle on your way to success in sales. I struggled with a decent lead source for a while after leaving the agency I started with. They ran direct mail leads and financed them to agents...we had it made. They trained to door knock your leads and only call to set appointments as a last stitch effort. They were very "old school" in all areas of their business, but I have to say...it worked. It worked well. I was a new agent and I didn't realize how good I had it at my first agency and allowed myself to get recruited by FFL. They had all the glitz and glamour and the agent that recruited me was persistent to say the least. The lead store was so appealing to me ...the idea of hopping online and buying leads at 1/4 the cost of the ones I was using was obviously too good to be true. I would buy "instant" internet leads for \$30 each to later find out that they were over a month old and been dialed 2000 times already. I bought 3 months "aged" leads that were actually over 8 years old....it was nothing short of diabolical what they were doing to agents. They wound up with a lawsuit over it all thank God, but it doesn't make up for how shitty they were doing these brand new agents they were recruiting by the dozens. Me being the resourceful and gritty bitch that I am decided to say fuck it and do what I had learned from the beginning and door knock all these shitty leads I had bought and.....it worked. It worked well. Idk what is in the psychology of someone being at your door, but whatever it is...it works. People let you in, they buy from you, you make money and lifelong clients. After that I found a good direct mail company and just keep a steady drop going with them. I never get an objection from someone when I'm at their door holding a piece of paper with their handwriting on it asking for life insurance. I get plenty of objections during the sales process, but I almost ALWAYS get in the door and give a presentation. Take the phones and the uncertainty out of the equation and just show up there....as the real person you are....and talk to these folks. Also...sourcing your own leads is always an option. I learned how to do this and can help you set up a pipeline but I will say that it is A LOT of work and it's expensive. I'm busy and don't like to deal with all the work that goes into it so I just pay about the same price for direct mail and enjoy my time off."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mewzaun/

Facebook / Meta ads (self-generated) · 44 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/

"If you want to get advanced: Google is the more expensive option but the leads are higher quality. Someone googling already has intent to buy, whereas on Facebook you're just scrolling your timeline and someone is interpreting you with an ad. Also there's more fake leads for some reason on Facebook, but they're also way cheaper. What we like to do is get traffic from Google ads and then use Facebook remarketing to put our Facebook ads in front of the expensive Google traffic that didn't buy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yj/stop_buying_leads/mo7pbhg/

"This is what they don't tell you is that you have to learn to generate your own leads. Don't waste your time I'm with the competitor of Aflac which is colonial life. I do Facebook ads, Tik Tok etc.. to generate my own leads it works. The old methods don't"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5v01x4/

"Medicare brokers, help me set realistic goals for years 1-3 as an independent agent. Background: I just got my insurance license this week, planning on finding a good, not shady FMO/IMO in the next month. I am a full time engineer so I will be selling Medicare part time as an independent broker. Plan is to leave work at 2pm and start doing Medicare. I understand that this will be insanely difficult and time consuming. I don't feel comfortable leaving my job with out trying this part time first. Completely fine working long hours. Medicare is quite confusing but I am very active on the Medicare subreddit answering questions I know and learning from the posts I don't. I want to do this to provide the best care for the seniors in my area not just shove MA plans down their throat. Now my main question. Are my goals realistic. 1st year (now through open enrollment): 10 clients mixture of MA and medigap (roughly \$3000-4000) 2nd year: 50 new clients roughly (\$17000 - 20000) 3rd year: 125 clients total (\$35000-50000) quit job and do Medicare FT. Marketing plan: I will be doing in person in my local area. Already signed up for a very popular Saturday farmers market and a couple county fairs. All marketing will be in person + local advertising. I am active in the community and just generally enjoy talking to people. Thoughts are struggle year 1-2 with a lot of local events on weekends and then word of mouth will hopefully pick up if I am able to provide the assistance and knowledge I strive to. Create an easy to use website (I'm a software engineer) and optimize SEO so it shows up to locals searching. Facebook page and local Facebook advertising"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j6vyj8/medicare_brokers_help_me_set_realistic_goals_for/

"Hi i have been on all sides of this transaction, agent lead broker and publisher/marketer. I am actually building a tech start up to solve this specific pain but that's not material. I will walk you through how this lead process works. 1. Real Leads are generated from lead capture via social media . They have varying degrees of intent. The people who do this are digital marketers. 2. Data is purchased from data providers, who are data aggregators. They buy from many sources including other lead brokers(old leads become data) data is used to dial live transfers, target digital campaigns mailers and for lead stuffing. 3. Honest good lead providers. Sell only optin form leads and disclose how many times they are resold and the age of the lead. 4. Sometimes leads are stuffed with data. This is a great way to make money as a lead broker and it's very hard to catch people doing it. Basically you buy 100 leads. 50 of them are actually form leads that are a week old. The other 50 are data or old leads. This is POS behavior and fraud. My estimate is 20-30% of all leads sold are stuffed(i have no evidence to support this other anecdotal personal experience) Jornaya id is supposed to counteract this but, it's easily fabricated and any experienced person can use jornaya to wash data into an opt in lead, so in practice it means nothing. Live transfers are exclusive by default, but may have lower intent... harder to work. The best leads in the industry are optin in live transfers where a lead fills out a Facebook ad or mailer is called and then transferred hot. It's vetted high intent and exclusive. Most agent will never see these. What's the way forward? Find a trustd lead provider or two. Dip your toes in spend enough to see but don't get the farm. ,get good at working leads. Crm stuff. Learn to run your own ads(you won't save money but you will have exclusive unstuffed leads. It's very hard and a job in itself. Any one who tells you it's easy is lying. Get great at live transfers. Harder to scale as agency owner Easier to scale as an agent! They can be hard to buy in quality and quantity. Finally get good at referrals. This is the secret sauce."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer844c/

"Big Daddy leads (BDL) Leads Review TL;DR: Tried Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection. Lots of disconnected numbers (they did replace some), most people never picked up despite hammering them with 8–10 calls a day + texts, and the show rate was awful. The ones who did pick up all expected their entire mortgage covered at ~70 years old. I tried downselling to equity protection/payment protector, but they wanted all-or-nothing. Honestly, you'll get better results just running your own ads. And yes I did track my numbers for everything. --- I tested Big Daddy Leads for Mortgage Protection recently and wanted to share an honest review for anyone thinking about it. Lead quality: Pretty bad overall. I got a lot of disconnected numbers — to be fair, they did replace those — but even with the "good" ones, most people didn't answer after I hammered them: 8–10 calls a day, double-dialing, leaving voicemails once, and texting every time. Show rate was rough. Expectations: This was the biggest killer. Every single MP lead I got seemed to expect their whole mortgage covered. I did try to downsell into equity protection/payment protector plans (covering monthly payments for a set amount of time), but they flat-out didn't want it. It was whole coverage or nothing. And look — I've been doing this for years, I'm a ~\$30k/month producer, I know how to handle objections, but I couldn't flip that expectation. These leads were just set up the wrong way from the start. How they generate leads: You don't control or even see the ads. They run simple image ads into Facebook lead forms, optimized for cheapest CPL, not quality. If you've been around marketing, you know that's not the same thing. Not trying to bash them unfairly — just being real about my experience."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nxhu2/big_daddy_leads_bdl_leads_review/

"I run a digital agency. Turn on monetization on this video, cause I want to run my ad letting life insurance agents know that I can run their FB ads for them, for a nominal monthly fee."

— YouTube · How I Sold \$56,038 Of Life Insurance In 30 Days With Self Generated Leads · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60LbRzSZNP&lc=UgzQoMbhX0odje7KfcZ4AaABAq>

"Here is a list of all I tested. Life leads Caboom : See above MediaApha : 1 out of 15 to 20 sale. ROI sucks Aria leads : crap. Their Instagram commercial is in a rented abandoned office, btw Smart Financial: spent 1500 for both data and live transfers. Nothing Everquote: I bought 50, and they canceled supporting life when I joined. No sale Benepath: 1 sale out of 10 leads, and they canceled life line as well Aged lead store: You better be ready to piss everyone off and dial a couple of weeks through wrong and not in service numbers before you get a hit. AWL: data leads suck. Live transfers 1 out of 4 normally sell, but they are overpriced, and if someone lapses or canceled, it ruins the whole ROI Integrity leadcenter: This has been the best of the worst so far, but buying the bronze is no different than the diamond. They say you get them exclusive on the sale, but that's bullshit because my upline bought me some from the same states I got, and they were duplicates. Google Ads : bots. I got all these leads at \$400 a week designed by a Google affiliated advertising company. I installed Captcha, and no more leads came in Fb: mostly people browsing. I feel like they are waiting for a gift after submitting the form. Money pit. Leadrilla: I never tried their campaigns, but if it's anything like the leads they sell in the marketplace, then it's shit too. USA DATA: 50% not in service and are all cold calls Direct mail: 1 to 2% return on mailers if you're lucky and you're always waiting. I sometimes wonder if they really mail anything out. Prospect 4 agent lead company: it was good in 2021, but by 2023, they caught the same disease all these other assholes have."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mezvm3q/

"Most are resellers thats why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why i only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer5k7f/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"Looking for advice on starting an independent brokerage Hey everybody, Captive producer going on two years in production at SF. Licensed in P&C and L&H. Goal was always to start an agency (captive or independent) after gaining some good experience; however, due to circumstances out of my control, it looks like I'll need to make that jump sooner rather than later. I'm located in Colorado. I've averaged \$45k in premium a month with 5-7 life policies working 32 hours a week solely on internet leads (Everquote and Quote wizard, plus my captives leads that come in). Due to some personal things I've been dealing with in the past 2 years, I'd say my prospecting and overall activity has been half-assed at best. Prior to this, I worked as a finance director/Sales manager in dealerships for 13 years, so hiring, firing, training, placing loans with banks, working long hours etc. are all very familiar to me. I assume this experience should translate well to the independent world. I'm working through a business plan now and have hit a few bumps on the road. I'm planning on primarily personal lines, though I'll sell life and health incidentally and hopefully land some large commercial accounts as well 1) I'm looking at Agentero Elite and First Connect as aggregators. Does anyone know if they can be enrolled in simultaneously? Agentero has some non-standard carriers I'd like access to, but First Connect seems to be the standard as far as commissions, fees and payment. 2) I'll lean heavily on Facebook Ads for marketing, but of course plan on building a referral pipeline and supplement with paid leads to keep me busy dialing the phone. Can this be done initially around \$1500/month? Or is that spend too low? 3) Outside of setting up a commission account, PFA, obtaining my LLC, and purchasing E&O, am I missing any major components? I'm looking at different AMS platforms (First Connect provides a discount on EZlynx), but might wait 6 months or so before enrolling unless I absolutely need it immediately. 4) Goal is to end the first year with \$500,000 in premium with an average 12% commission. Hoping to average 8% on renewals and shooting for a retention around 85% before scaling and employing a CSR and an additional 1099 producer. Is this realistic? Too high or low? Hiring too fast? Thanks in advance for any answers and advice!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1sav5b8/looking_for_advice_on_starting_an_independent/

"I was thinking of getting into selling life insurance. Bought a course and everything. I stopped though because I decided to take a different route, but I found this post very enlightening and exactly what I would have needed back when I was first getting into it so thank you for such transparency. It seems like you might be spending a lot of money on leads but they aren't high quality. I have a background in marketing. It might be worth looking into generating your own leads. You could market with Meta ads or Google PPC. FB will definitely be cheaper than PPC, but PPC definitely has more intent. Regardless though, if you do your own marketing, you can qualify leads to your liking and you'll also know the lead is fresh. Might be worth looking into."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/oussrjd/

Exclusive real-time leads · 33 documents

"Most are resellers that's why! It is rare to find the actual source of the leads. Also the industry is drowned to the max with resellers who bought 7 day old leads in bulk for like \$1000 and reselling for \$10,000! That is why I only recommend direct mail and doing fb ads. They will be your exclusive leads! If you are not the first agency to call that person after they filled out the online form then it is most likely a useless window shopper. They will just spin your wheels and will never convert!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mer5k7f/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"If you don't have a steady stream of leads, you have no business. Warm market burns out fast, if you can get referrals consistently you can keep moving forward. But for me, I needed consistency. I'm on a standing lead order, fresh leads just drop into my crm. I supplement with bonus leads other agents drop the ball with. What access to leads do you have?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/mz2vz54/

"I am also at 100% comp rate. Purchasing aged leads allow me to keep my investments low and ROI high. With purchasing CABOOM's fresh leads, I assumed that it would give me an instant return- but I was wrong. Please feel free to comment or share your experience. I'd love to hear from other life insurance agents! Bless 🙏"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9k9w6y/

"Yea it's crazy, I would spend about \$42 on a "fresh" exclusive lead just to finally get a hold of them after 10+ tries for them to tell me they already signed up with another agent a while ago... and of course the lead company doesn't reimburse unless it's a disconnected number, so the agent is forced to eat that cost"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujxuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/ourb2oq/

"I hardly write reviews but do not want people to go through the same thing as me. I was excited to try Caboom leads as they "are warm exclusive leads" but once they started coming through and making calls everything seemed off. I made over 400 dials on 50 leads purchased with several different numbers matched to the area code of the lead. My numbers are fresh and not tested multiple times for spam. I'd also call within 3 minutes of the lead as speed to lead is important. I had 17 answers with 9 saying they had no clue what I was talking about and that they did not fill in any form. I have followed up with leads for a week to not have one single person interested ready to discuss any final expense or term life coverage. Not one. Hope this helps!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mgr265r/

"The culture is definitely going to depend on who you're uplines are and what agency you joined. Of course that's obviously going to be true for every IMO that exists personally I didn't have any issue with culture or any of the things mentioned although I will say that there was a lot of focus on recruitment and I feel like that will probably be the same no matter what as symmetry has a heavy focus on recruiting. The leads are definitely junk. In my opinion that alone is the biggest reason not to join symmetry. Symmetry is not even an insurance agency they're a lead company that has a side hustle selling insurance. Even the \$50 fresh leads are a pile of junk that will give you no return on investment unless you're incredibly lucky."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/ms6l3wz/

"I'll check it out don't know if I'd rather fail out of the biz or recoup with aged leads. Been through the wringer I'm 18 been in the business for 7ish months did my fair share of dialing aged to hell leads. Intent behind the real time leads is wildly inconsistent some weeks it's like calling through the white pages others I'm on a hot streak. Seems too random for the price I'm paying for leads advertised as exclusive. Lost all my capital this month and am debating on just quitting all together. Also feel as if the top producers at my office are all also kind of winging it because the advice I'm given is "believe harder" essentially"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s8e1si/be_your_own_boss_80_starting_commission_change/odlxjip/

"I'm curious. How did you do it? Aged leads? Real-time leads? Live transfer calls? What was your process?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p3z4tt/how_much_you_earn_as_insurance_agent/nqagm4l/

"We use fresh lead sources and combine them with Badass Insurance Leads (aged data)."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lfsdjl/new_life_insurance_agent_how_are_yall_actually/nxbgxwd/

"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/nlrman3/

"I had the exact same experience with Bang Bang leads, but much worse. Customers were literally prepared to go on the record in writing that they did not complete the FB form the week the lead was pushed through.. And I called literally 1 - 3 mins after the lead arrived in many cases. I don't mind calling aged leads, but it seems like many of these unscrupulous lead companies like Bang Bang, advertising "exclusive leads" are too greedy to give up that aged lead spread over a simple little thing like ethics."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mweg5ue/

Booked appointments · 22 documents

"My experience at bankers life as a new agent. I don't understand the distaste. I came across a post after my interview that made me even more skeptical of the job because I've never had a commission based job, didn't have an insurance license, and this would be my first real job after college. Here is the post I read. [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/194rgk1/has_anyone_heard_of_bankers_life/] I got my license and passed first try (idk how, I studied hard but the exam was harder than I thought, I couldn't see how many I got wrong). It's the beginning of my 4th week, I've made one small sale but I've set appointments with clients that have a lot of money so they're sending an FA to discuss retirement planning. I've made contact with some of these clients, I study really hard, I do what I'm told, and honestly it feels great. I feel like I'm the edge of something that could be really good. I'm good at what I do and I can tell because not only are the managers impressed with me but so are the other agents that are in their first year. I kind of feel like I'm outpacing a lot of my peers but I'm trying to stay humble. I took a chance with these people because I had limited options but I knew that even if this is the worst company I've ever worked with (it's not) then I would at least come out with a resume with more licenses than I came in with, and could take another swing at the job market. I've been getting calls from other companies since I got my license trying to recruit me, I don't listen to them much. I will be an FA in a year or less with this company, I don't intend to leave here unless I go broke (doubtful) or something unforeseen happens. I was extremely apprehensive when I started but I trusted my manager and gave it my all since if I'm going to try, I'm going to try so hard that I will know without a doubt if it is my fault or the company's if I fail. I'm not failing, I'm impressing and improving. People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager) but there's signs everywhere about being a top 125 training company, have I fact checked this? No, but I haven't felt like I needed to. when I feel like it I will. My managers answer all my questions, see me working hard, and include me on appointments that I can't contribute much to, and we still split the sale. The online resources are extensive and cover so much in a very user friendly way, 30-60 minute panels of top producers explaining what worked for them. I am told this is why they are such a highly rated company for its training. I am also told that this is why BL is unique, because it is 1099 commission based but the support is unmatched. I really enjoy this company so far and if I don't start seeing financial results soon (I'm positive I will) then I will remove this post. Maybe after AEP I'll just drop how much money I've made in the comments and pin it or something and we can see how this post ages. I anticipate a couple thousand dollars in the next couple weeks from less than a handful of sales. Someone who's worked in other insurance agencies tell me what I'm missing if this company is so bad? If I'm being cocky then check back in January to see my suffering and plans to go back on Glassdoor. \-sept 27, 2025 UPDATE It's December 17th, I'm going to try to keep this update relevant to my original. For context, I was let go two weeks ago and am not looking back. Issues had been brewing for weeks and I was already interviewing at another company in case I decided I needed to leave, initially, I didn't see myself being fired but as things escalated, I knew I'd be less surprised. I had the confidence in being hired at another company to stay true to my morals in how I dealt with Bankers. I'll talk about why I was let go later in this post. **Since I referred an older post in my original and commented on it, I'm going to dissect what I said and show a newer perspective:** "People in that post I linked talked about being 1099 but treated like an employee with none of the benefits. No, you do not get company paid insurance (unless your a manager)" Quoting the linked post, "being 1099 but being treated like an employee..." I still think the user on the linked post is misguided. You are 1099, and I don't know what negatives they were referring to when being "treated like an employee" but I can say that bankers really does do business in person, the initial interview was the only time I had a formal conversation with my bosses online. Working with my managers in person was something I liked, my new job has had more formal conversation over zoom than in person (so far, I don't officially start until January which is another downside over here) and I miss that about bankers. I also liked that the hierarchy of the office was relatively clear cut. My manager knows she is responsible for me. I liked how there was structure to the company, I was told by my managers and in hindsight still agree that this is GOOD and sets bankers aside from the competition. Agreed. My second sentence regarding insurance as far as I know now, is still completely correct. But working for bankers I realized that everything is a sale, hiring people, building confidence in subordinates, getting your manager to like you even if you don't like them. Everything is a game and everyone is playing. All the sales tactics apply in every corner of the office. Now we have "office politics" where generally, every participant is skilled in how to get what they want from other people, so now there is another layer of paranoia I had and I think rightfully so. I have no idea if becoming a manager and qualifying for bankers insurance is as easy as it was laid out in the interview. I can't tell you how many times, big or small, I thought something would be as easy as 1,2,3 because that was the way it was laid out, when in fact there were so many undisclosed micromanagement tasks attached. Some had to do with clients and don't result in being paid. (Prescription drug plans are needed by most of our clients, but we get paid nothing. And I had an experience that took way longer than it should have) **In regards to my overall outlook on bankers as a company and my experience at the time:** I was pretty successful as a new agent I think, I saw people come and go, I got better and was super proud of my accomplishments being a new grad and never having been in sales before but booking more appointments than some of my peers. I was confident and working hard, everyone in the office saw it. Peers would ask me questions and "most" managers were always eager to help. However management was the reason I was fired, after awhile I realized that I knew I would be very successful at this company and would do everything in my power, without hurting anyone, to accomplish my goals. Before I go into why I was let go I want to say that from my perspective, I think bankers as a company could be very good, it may already be a very good company to work for. I think the resources available online is extensive and very very valuable, I do think working face to face with your company is very valuable too. And I think from a baseline, makes bankers a company to consider. For awhile I really enjoyed it, and I was trying really hard not to drink too much "kool-aid" I wanted to stay humble and careful, celebrate my victories at home and not let anyone see anything they could take advantage of. Ultimately, it could be and probably was, my branch that failed me. Not the company. And the branch did fail me. **Here is why I was let go:** As I've said I was a good new agent, and proud of my progress. As I got better and better I became more and more independent. At first I didn't want to meet clients 1 on 1 because I felt so nervous in my capabilities, naturally management wanted me to go on my own and I understood even if I didn't want to. As I went on these appointments I was told I could call my manager "anytime." Sure enough, questions came up, and without disturbing my rapport with the client, would text or call my manager. Eventually the response I would get is "read the agent guide" or "we'll talk about it during our meeting" but I would never know which agent guide I was being referred to and anytime I looked at our resources they would be 40 pages of word salad and fluff that I mostly already knew with a few bits of new information. Not user friendly and certainly not a good use of time when I could be making new clients, working on my current clients, or learning how to present a new product. So the other response was our meeting. 3/5 days during the week we are on appointments, 2/5 days we are in the office and here is the schedule: 8-12 dial, dial, dial. That's it. 12-1 people trickle out o"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nircjl/my_experience_at_bankers_life_as_a_new_agent/

"To form an LLC or to not form an LLC? 🤖🤖 That is the question.... 🤖🤖 Many people get the advice to spread out their liability and form an LLC with a business. If you are forming practically any other business, I would almost always say yes, go for it. In the insurance business, however, there are costs as well as administrative and compliance considerations to consider when forming an entity that could make things unnecessarily complicated for you in the beginning. In addition, for most independent agents E&O insurance is required for carrier appointments and covers you in the case of liability for any errors or omissions that pose the highest risk of liability. Now if you're concerned that maybe you go door-to-door or do appointment setting or something along those lines and an old lady trips and falls and blames you for it, that's a whole nother story of liability and perhaps a reason that you should form an LLC. The risk of that is very low in that regard, unless tripping old ladies is something that you're accustomed to. There are three scenarios in which I tell independent agents to go ahead and form an entity. #1 - you already have high Revenue Revenue can get to a certain point where you can file to be taxed as a corporation and get owner's distribution to lower overall tax burden. #2 - you have high production There are certain carriers in the industry that are worth having and also require an entity in order to attain certain contract levels (compensation levels). Some carriers also require an entity if you have downlines or a certain number of downlines. #3 - you have downlines (agents working for your agency) When other people's income start to get involved, other people's families, other peoples things, etc. it is always smart to have an LLC to limit your liability as a company. It's smart and it protects you from that liability of the many, many things that could potentially happen as business grows. I tend to advise not to give yourself an extra headache by forming an entity early. If you are going solo and are holding contracts independently, an entity typically does not need to be formed until these scenarios arise. A DBA is just fine until you produce, you get agents, or you get high enough revenue for a tax advantage. 🤖🤖 Please consult with a lawyer and CPA, as I am not a lawyer or a CPA, and this does not constitute official or licensed legal or financial advice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mp3psz/to_form_an_llc_or_to_not_form_an_llc_that_is_the/

"This rings true to my experience to a tee. The company is off the charts unethical and should be shut down imo. A lot of people don't realize AO Globe Life has 2 major hiring periods linked to bonus events within the org where managers are heavily incentivized to hire as many new people as possible. Many of the new hires at this time of year are hired solely for that bonus, with little to no intent to see them actually make it. Being strung along just long enough to qualify for the bonus then essentially left to sink or swim from there. This leaves such a bad taste in people's mouths for the industry as a whole when it's the company through and through And when you finally get a peak behind the curtain, it's like Oz all smoke & mirrors. Top tier agents aren't making 500-1000 calls a day like they brag in the videos and weekly calls. A few of them have their own appointment setting businesses and hire foreign call centers to push for live transfers. Sold leads are passed around to be sold again, multiple times. When I was with them you could look up a lead and be floored seeing how many times a person's been sold the same products by the org's top tier agents. And to this day, when I hear the phrase "you picking up what I'm putting down?" I just want to punch that guy in the face 🤖"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1tj8uqu/the_scheme_of_globe_life_american_income_arias/on4jz8u/

"Inbounds suck for a number of reasons: 1. Scam Central: most inbounds are generated in Pakistan and India. Literally the guys scamming your Grandma out of your inheritance are the ones providing inbounds to you, with entry-level scammers starting in lead generation before moving on to ripping off Americans. 2. Legal Pandora's Box: India and Pakistan will not comply to Federal TCPA rules. They will call everyone - even on the DNC - and you, and your upline, bear the legal risk. I had a good agent of mine buy one of these leads earlier this year and had to settle for five figures for just one phone call. 3. Did I Mention They're A Scam? These call centers are known to share client information, list information, and rework the leads over and over again. There are organizations that sell "pre-sold leads," which includes all major information about the client, claiming they call ahead of time to collect the information before passing it along to the agent to sell. Unbeknownst to the agent, they resell this information over and over again and you end up with huge chargebacks. I think Facebook ads are a much more durable, long-lasting, and safe lead generation solution. You own the leads, you control the ad creative, and you have a track record of the client opting in. Plus, you can scale upward to the level you're comfortable with, and can tie in pre-set appointments or call-ins for added benefit. Lastly, if you don't want to do it yourself, there are many good lead management options available that will do all of the above."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1oxuubl/is_this_a_good_offer/np4s2v6/

"Oh jeez, where to even start on this one. Leads...the biggest hurdle on your way to success in sales. I struggled with a decent lead source for a while after leaving the agency I started with. They ran direct mail leads and financed them to agents...we had it made. They trained to door knock your leads and only call to set appointments as a last stitch effort. They were very "old school" in all areas of their business, but I have to say...it worked. It worked well. I was a new agent and I didn't realize how good I had it at my first agency and allowed myself to get recruited by FFL. They had all the glitz and glamour and the agent that recruited me was persistent to say the least. The lead store was so appealing to me ...the idea of hopping online and buying leads at 1/4 the cost of the ones i was using was obviously too good to be true. I would buy "instant" internet leads for \$30 each to later find out that they were over a month old and been dialed 2000 times already. I bought 3 months "aged" leads that were actually over 8 years old....it was nothing short of diabolical what they were doing to agents. They wound up with a lawsuit over it all thank God, but it doesn't make up for how shitty they were doing these brand new agents they were recruiting by the dozens. Me being the resourceful and gritty bitch that I am decided to say fuck it and do what I had learned from the beginning and door knock all these shitty leads I had bought and.....it worked. It worked well. Idk what is in the psychology of someone being at your door, but whatever it is...it works. People let you in, they buy from you, you make money and lifelong clients. After that I found a good direct mail company and just keep a steady drop going with them. I never get an objection from someone when I'm at their door holding a piece of paper with their handwriting on it asking for life insurance. I get plenty of objections during the sales process, but I almost ALWAYS get in the door and give a presentation. Take the phones and the uncertainty out of the equation and just show up there....as the real person you are....and talk to these folks. Also...sourcing your own leads is always an option. I learned how to do this and can help you set up a pipeline but I will say that it is A LOT of work and it's expensive. I'm busy and don't like to deal with all the work that goes into it so I just pay about the same price for direct mail and enjoy my time off."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mewzaun/

"Sure, I'll explain: 1. Inbound leads are leads that call you (you already know this but explaining for all the new agents reading this). So... TV leads, live transfers, etc. 2. Outbound leads are leads that "you" have to call. Think leads generated on Facebook, for example. Someone fills out a form to express interest, and then the agent is responsible for the callback. With outbound leads generated on social media, you can program an option for prospects to schedule a time for you to call them. It only works for the minority of people filling out the form, but those who do book and show up, they are pretty good prospects that close at a higher rate. Pre-set appointments tend to no show at a 70% to 80% rate depending on how well you set the appointment in my experience. That's probably the biggest downside to them. However, plenty of those leads that did "not" set an appointment will buy from you, if you consistently dial them long enough."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lcn7ls/

"Man, I hear you. Live transfers used to be gold, but lately the costs are insane and quality's all over the place, especially after that one-to-one consent stuff. I've been helping agents (mainly Final Expense right now) with qualified, booked appointments instead of relying on live transfers or data + cold dialers. It keeps things way more consistent and way less expensive. Most of the agents I work with are getting around 15-20+ solid appointments a week without having to blow \$5K/month per producer. Margins stay healthy, and they're not burning out. Happy to share more if you're curious, just trying to see what's actually working for folks these days."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2g/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4kbsaz/

"@christianbrindle Thanks....I believe you said in the video you could put a link here for the actual phone appointment setting script? Maybe it's on your page...! I'll look there too"

— YouTube · How To Make \$500k A Year As A Medicare Agent In 2023! (Medicare Sales Training) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmppgLPuqeQ&lc=UgwI9PIWNLPjZc84RoR4AaABAg_9nh-qI3iu8x9nibzZu4Z3s

"The new rules dropped yesterday and I am copying the most interesting paragraphs below. Here is my admittedly optimistic reading of this rule. 1. Agents will get a \$100 increase in both MAPD and PDP commissions and CMS is anticipating adding an additional 2.5% on top of that. Commissions will be raised to \$726 for MAPD for most states, and PDP's will have a massive increase to \$200. 2. The new rule specifically states: This proposal, and all agent broker compensation rules at §422.2274(d) are limited to independent agents and brokers, and do not extend to TMPOs more generally. I am curious, is anyone as optimistic as me about the new rules? We do not get volume based enrollment bonuses from our NMA or the carriers and I have many levels under my FMO (SGA's, MGA's, GA's) I don't think this rule applies to overrides paid to them. I believe the rule is targeting HRA fee's and other administrative fee's such as some carriers paying you to get a clients email address, or paying a bonus if you select a PCP on an app. It also seems to be targeting "per app marketing money" that some carriers are paying outside of the override structure. I hope this is true. Read it and let me know what you think: We believe that increasing the FMV rate for new enrollments by a total of \$100, and therefore applied to renewals at a maximum amount of 50 percent of the total compensation amount, should provide agents and brokers with sufficient funds to continue to access necessary administrative tools and trainings, to offset appointment fees and encourage the representation of multiple plans, and therefore to continue providing adequate service to Medicare beneficiaries. Accordingly, based on the information provided in comments and for the reasons discussed in this final rule, we are finalizing a policy to make a one-time \$100 increase to the FMV compensation rate for agents and brokers for initial enrollments into MA plans for the 2025 plan contract year. TABLE FC-1: AGENT BROKER COMPENSATION UPDATES CY 2024–2026 2024 2025 2026 Initial Enrollment \$611 (FMV TBD) + \$100 FMV TBD Renewal \$305 (FMV TBD +100)*0.5 FMV TBD*0.5 By way of example, if we were to assume that the FMV increase in years 2025 and 2026 is 2.5 percent, the payment rates for those years would be as follows: TABLE FC-2: EXAMPLE AGENT BROKER COMPENSATION UPDATES CY 2024-2026 2024 2025 2026 Initial Enrollment \$611 \$726 \$744 Renewal \$305 \$313 \$372 Comment: Several comments expressed confusion about whether this payment is an "all in cap" that is intended to include all fees paid by an MA organization to an agent, broker, or other TPMO, and what that would mean for payments related to marketing activities. Response: This proposal, and all agent broker compensation rules at §422.2274(d) are limited to independent agents and brokers, and do not extend to TMPOs more generally. Therefore, this policy represents a limitation on payments in excess of those paid under "compensation" only for commissions paid for enrollments to independent agents and brokers. Though we are continuing to consider future rulemaking in this space, our current policy does not extend to placing limitations on payments from an MAO to a TPMO who is not an independent agent or broker for activities that are not undertaken as part of an enrollment by an independent agent or broker."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senior Insurance Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/is-the-new-2025-cms-rule-for-agent-compensation-actually-great-news-for-agents-and-fmos.112929/#post-1487879>

"Not trying to be disagreeable but that's not a complete picture imho. You're not wrong that you need to work large numbers to arrive at consistency. However, the openers that get taught are generally assumptive (I don't know anyone who teaches permission based) and tonality is either not taught at all or it's not taught very well. I did a deep dive into the b2b sdr appointment setting training and it really improved my first :30 seconds for personal lines and actually gave me a chance to win commercial accounts."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1twistot/is_insurance_really_this_bad_or_i_have_terrible/pafxy8f/

"That's awesome! Sounds like your Google leads are working pretty well. I've been helping a few agents myself, usually getting them around 15 to 20 booked appointments a week for each of them, and typically with less spend than that. Always interesting to see the different ways people are making it work!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m6fl2q/how_is_everyone_marketing_in_2025_without/n4kz15u/

"I'm sorry. What do you mean by outbound? Like someone else calls the lead then asks questions to make sure of interest then transfer to me? Where can I get pre-set appointments? I thought those were a scam honestly."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f7rwk7/best_live_transfers/lbucqqa/

HealthSherpa / marketplace tools (ACA) · 22 documents

"How to get contracted as an independent health ins agent! I recently got licensed as a health insurance agent and am currently selling Obamacare. It took me forever to figure out who to contact within each insurance company to get contracted (their websites are a labyrinth!!) so I'm making this post to help out future agents! <https://agent.communityhealthchoice.org/becoming-an-agent/> <https://www.aetna.com/insurance-producer/become-appointed-with-aetna.html> <https://www.molinalmarketplace.com/marketplace/brokers/en-us/Become-A-Broker/Agent-Appointment.aspx> <https://www.bcbstx.com/producer/prospective.htm> <https://www.humana.com/agent/contract-with-humana> <https://www.ambetterhealth.com/for-brokers.html> <https://www.uhc.com/broker-consultant> (email appoint@uhc.com), it took FOREVER to find this email and I found it on some random blank contract they had on google but NOWHERE on their website) BONUS use <https://www.healthsherpa.com/> to compare insurance plans, generate quotes, and complete applications! They have a rly nice interface c."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/qI705I/how_to_get_contracted_as_an_independent_health/

"ACA Shit-Show I am recently getting leads and I am using Health Sherpa for enrollments. I just came across a few clients who had 70 + writing agents ! Like WTF. Is this a data bresch , scam or what. In some cases I would actually call the person and they seem clueless about it when I would tell them you marketplace profile looks like a brothel with agents cocking each other. Secondly how does this effect their tax returns, since most of them are somehow enrolled in two three market place plans, all with premium subsidy applied, which as far as I know doesn't work like that. My question is should I presume such leads? Should I tell them to call CMS and report ? Or just ignore such customers. I feel like my inner conscious doesn't let it go I feel like I should help these people, because is most cases they are unaware."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bd66ik/aca_shitshow/

"Hi OP! I'm a relatively new insurance agent been license for almost years and yes no one is ever transparent about leads, how to generate those and how costly they can be. To get leads you either pay a lot of money for them or spend a lot of your time chasing them. I personally gave up selling life insurance and supplementals because the amount of chargebacks was awful. Now I just focus on U65 ACA marketplace plans. I am also part of the HealthSherpa enrollee assistance program which pays me per person I have enrolled. I prefer this over getting commissions from the insurance carriers. I'll be happy to offer some feedback but you can also do your research."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5veshz/

"Any tips on succeeding as a health insurance agent? How to succeed as an agent on my own? I work for an insurance broker which currently sells aca (Obamacare) products. I've thought about going solo so I can have more freedom with my schedule. I also have a partner who'd like to join with me. I can't get a straight answer when I research online. Do I need to be contracted with an fmo in order to be appointed with multiple carriers? I saw somewhere online that you do need an fmo. Also for anyone familiar with HealthSherpa, do they pay commission monthly on the plans or just a one time payment. Any advice or general help on how to get started would be greatly appreciated!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1adi8ew/any_tips_on_succeeding_as_a_health_insurance_agent/

"Best strategy to start selling health insurance (Medicare + ACA) Hi everyone, I recently earned my accident & health license and I am excited to begin my journey as a health insurance agent. I am still in the early stages of learning how the sales process and industry work, so I would appreciate any advice or insights from experienced colleagues. My goal is to build residual income by focusing on health insurance (either ACA or Medicare). For ACA, I am considering using HealthSherpa for their platform and training resources. For Medicare, I am thinking of starting with 1 or 2 carriers as a captive to access knowledge. I look at this as a short-term plan (about 6 months) to build a solid foundation to then transition to a broker or agency to access multiple carriers to provide best plan and maybe better commissions. Does this sound like a good plan? Are there downsides of going captive with more than 1 carrier? I see some offer AHIP certification discount, should I take it? I would love to hear your thoughts and any suggestions you might have. Thank you so much!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1i3ms00/best_strategy_to_start_selling_health_insurance/

"Medicare Enrollment Tools Hi all, I am an insurance agent and looking to expand into Medicare plans. I currently sell ACA plans through Healthsherpa and am looking to see if there is a good platform to quote and sell Medicare plans. Any insights are appreciated. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gz0ref/medicare_enrollment_tools/

"Yes they all so this is disgusting. The last company I worked for (HealthMarkets) did exactly this and charged us \$36 per call we answered, mind you none of those calls turned to sales. You should get appointed directly with the carriers you want to sell and then use HealthSherpa to enroll and keep track of your clients and commissions. That's what I did and it's been a game changer."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1p0mqo2/is_it_just_me/nps166v/

"I agree that learning new system is PITA, but one think that saved me ton of time is that I don't have to rewrite the whole application to renew plan. But yes, the rest is not agent friendly. Good thing that Get Covered has monthly meeting with agents and they actually listen, so I hope for the next year they will improve few things. You cannot do simple quote in the agent system. You just go to the public site and quote Prescreener enroll.getcovered.illinois.gov To get quote when you are logged in as agent, you first need to Search Existing Customer, and add them, and I'm not even sure if you have to first fill eligibility determination, before getting quote. That's why I do public quotes and save screenshots for future conversations. You cannot save quotes, like in Health Sherpa, and it's difficult to edit. Healthcare.gov in 2013-2014 was MUCH WORST, but they had 13 years, they should make it better now."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Exchange Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/get-covered-il-please-help.116785/#post-1560728>

"Special Agent said: the UHC Anocs are on Jarvis. Health Sherpa will show all plans but you have to change filter to show non commissionable plans. Hope that still applies for 2027 Not with suppressed plans. Non commissionable yes but not suppressed. i just ran a quote on healthsherpa and looking at PDP plans and Humana isnt even listed under the carriers available. Totally gone from the platform."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senior Insurance Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/humana-is-taking-suppression-to-a-new-level.118143/#post-1594080>

"Yagents said: Blue options ppo is on market also Maybe it's because I used healthsherpa to look but my blue select ppo 1442 wasn't listed. My wife is a FI blue captive agent and we had to do it off exchange. But you're right. Blue options is on there. Wish I could have kept my old pre ACA FI blue plan. But wife and kid got in the way."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Exchange Forum · 1 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/off-exchange-carriers-appointments-what-do-i-need-to-know.115010/#post-1523755>

"prencik said: I agree that learning new system is PITA, but one think that saved me ton of time is that I don't have to rewrite the whole application to renew plan. But yes, the rest is not agent friendly. Good thing that Get Covered has monthly meeting with agents and they actually listen, so I hope for the next year they will improve few things. You cannot do simple quote in the agent system. You just go to the public site and quote Prescreener enroll.getcovered.illinois.gov To get quote when you are logged in as agent, you first need to Search Existing Customer, and add them, and I'm not even sure if you have to first fill eligibility determination, before getting quote. That's why I do public quotes and save screenshots for future conversations. You cannot save quotes, like in Health Sherpa, and it's difficult to edit. Healthcare.gov in 2013-2014 was MUCH WORST, but they had 13 years, they should make it better now. Click to expand... I don't know anything about a monthly meeting, I did not even know I was going to need to do a new certification 2 days before OEP I did not know I would not be able to use HS like with GAs new exchange still allowed and Certainly cant get any reasonable information from the Robot on the site nor the over seas help you get when you call in The whole thing was a nightmare especially getting locked out till 2 weeks ago I am lucky I only had a few IL ACA clients, though one was a really good one I had hoped to talk about larger policies as far as annuities and such with, This is not going to happen now Hopefully there will be some resources to learn the system before to much longer"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance Exchange Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/get-covered-il-please-help.116785/#post-1560735>

"AllenChicago said: Thank-you for that valuable feedback MWoodbrid! It sounds like HealthSherpa would be your primary go-to WBE, if it was as accurate, and intuitive, as ACA Express. I am not reading it that way since we provide additional benefits such as AgencyBlock integration, i.e. all things being equal we still have features they do not. While he did not compare customer service response directly in his post, he did say we have many options and have been responsive. <snip> AllenChicago said: I'm going to Google locate an ACA Express quoting site, and test the workflow to see if it's more intuitive than Sherpa. We will be providing an option soon to have on the CFS (Client Facing Site) the current flow which is, as MWOODBRID said, better than theirs, but also flow more similar to last years. AFS (agent Dashboard) already has this option via "Quick Quote" or "Create Applicant". AllenChicago said: The two different quoting platforms Health Sherpa uses are at odds with each other. I totally dislike the "public facing" version. Prefer the Agent platform, but it's somewhat awkward to have to log into your Dashboard and run quotes from there. Especially when sitting next to your client, because He/she sees other people you've enrolled. Thanks again for taking the time to share your experience-based insights, MWoodbrid. And congratulations on being able to enroll 9 people every day during the open enrollment. Quite a feat for a 1-man operation! -Allen Click to expand... Agreed! And glad to be part of it for him!"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Care Reform Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/aca-express-vs-healthsherpa.78694/#post-1050586>

Shared real-time leads · 21 documents

"Stop buying leads I constantly see people on here complaining about shitty, expensive, shared leads. Listen guys, YouTube exists, this stuff isn't hard. Facebook and Google have dumbed setting things up so much it's ridiculous. You want to know how to create your own leads? On Facebook you can find a built in tool called Facebook ads library. Type in the insurance product you sell and filter the results to show active ads that have been running 6month-1year. The older the ad the more successful. If the ad wasn't making money, they would have killed the ad. Copy/model that ad. For Google, pick a big city, Google <what you sell> <big city> whoever shows up at the top probably has a good ad. Look at their ad copy then look at the landing page they use. Copy/model them. It's simple, YouTube to figure out the setup, research what ads work, copy them.... And now you're getting your leads at cost and you have full control of them. It's easier than you would think."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 163 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k466yi/stop_buying_leads/

"Be prepared for the phone apocalypse Apple dropped the hammer on all unsolicited calls. With the iOS 26 update in September, no calls will automatically go through unless their in your contacts. Instead, the person calling will have to state their name and the reason for the call. That will show up as a text and the caller decides whether or not to allow the call. Here's a demo: <https://youtu.be/4yFDvqEjciQ?feature=shared> Apple owns 60% of the market. If other phone manufacturers and even carrier follow, it's possible we see day where cold calling has died. This will have a direct, negative effect on leads, especially shared leads. Be prepared."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1l8sgfs/be_prepared_for_the_phone_apocalypse/

"the shared leads thing is such a scam and I can't believe we all just accept it Bought a batch of "exclusive" commercial leads last month. Called the first ten. Three of them told me I was the fourth agent to call that week. Fourth. So I'm paying, what, \$14 a lead to race three other brokers to the same shipping company owner who's already annoyed before I even open my mouth? How is that a business model for anyone except the vendor selling the list four times? The aged leads are somehow worse. Bought some for like \$2-3 each thinking okay, these are old but at least they're cheap. Half the businesses had closed or changed ownership. One number was a Subway. Not a Subway that needed commercial coverage, just a Subway where some guy named Dave was confused about why insurance agents kept calling him. I don't even know what the alternative is honestly. Every lead vendor I've tried does the same thing with slightly different branding. You either pay a lot for leads that five people already called, or you pay a little for leads that are basically dead. Pick your poison I guess. anyway rant over, back to dialing"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaag95t/

"Back to school? I'm a Medicare Telesales (captive) agent for a large health insurance company. I'm doing fairly well, not the best on my team but not the worst, but I DO know that I hold leadership qualities that some do, and some do not possess. I really love my job, I love the my colleagues, and I really want to move up in my career. I have not been in school for 10+ years... I am honestly not even sure how going back to college would even work, entirely. I am a single mom of a four year old boy who's in preschool full time. (just to give a little background and knowledge of my very limited schedule) What classes should I take in order to make myself stand out ahead of anyone else who may be aiming for the same leadership roles, such as supervisor or lead? Bachelors in Heth Sciences? Any helpful advice/insight would be IMMENSELY appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1cqssyh/back_to_school/

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

"Well, two things: - There are still plenty of top producers doing well, but some who aren't (like me), and some who used to do well (like our Agent of the Year in 2017) who did not do well last year, but are now doing well again. There are agents that I have consistently outsold in my time here that are performing better than me now. - My best guess as to why it's been crappy for me lately is that I consumed a lot of leads during our AEP and although I converted many of them (and placed 7th out of about 300 during AEP), there were plenty I did not convert and taking those leads "counts against me." My main goal right now is becoming more efficient so that my contact-to-close ratio improves, as that's what dictates the quality of lead you're generally getting (people inquiring directly on our website vs. shared leads), but it feels like I've dug myself into a hole I can't get out of."

— r/sales · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/bg1nab/anyone_here_work_in_medigapmedicare_supplemental/elkg0w8/

"I stopped buying shared leads last year. Burned too much time chasing people who were already annoyed before I even said hello."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1s5vcry/the_shared_leads_thing_is_such_a_scam_and_i_cant/oix60ig/

"Long time no post? Hey, whenever I have info that I think can benefit the agent community I'm gonna make sure I post it. First of all let's say this; anyone who knows me knows of my intense disdain for internet leads. Hopefull this will make this post more powerful when I come on and actually tout a source. I also know the incredible level of frustration agents have trying to find "quality" leads. An extremely good buddy of mine called me last week and opened with "John, if you were in my state you wouldn't be getting this call." Then went on to tell and show me his results from the Vimo live transfers. I was stunned - he has consistently been closing 1 out of 3 and just today closed 2 out of 3. I bit - but with caution. I actually had some Vimo credits baking in my account from over a year ago. My 1st two calls were two sales. One 25 year old girl in VA who just got dropped from the parent's plan. My next one was a husband who went to put his wife and two kids on his company plan. We all know how that turned out. I've since got two more transfers - one's signing up tonight - have an appointment with the other one for Monday. Monday's deal is a done deal - tonight's could be flakey. There's simply no way I'm closing less than 1 out of 3. And to be frank, who cares if it's 1 out of 4 or 5. The scoop: *A prospect calls into Vimo and a rep then qualifies them - asks them health questions and the general scenario - then makes sure they want to talk to a live agent (I guess as opposed to a dead one.) *The call then goes to the top bidder. That agent speak to the Vimo rep, not the client and can get the Reader's Digest version of the prospect. You then pass or play. If you play you are connected. How it works: *You simply bid on the leads. As you see from my screenshot, you can see the bids. You don't necessarily have to be the highest bidder to get the call. I wasn't for my 1st two leads. The 1st person might not pick up or pass on the leads. However, as you see, I'm max bidder now for my three states. No one's gonna beat my bid:-) *You can set the times you want calls and also pause your account. You also pay as you go - per \$100 transfers so there's no minimum and no contracts. This is ROI people. It's not about how much the lead costs, it's about how much the deal costs. So let's break it down: Shared leads: Close 1 out of 20 at \$7 average price = \$140 So it's 140 to get a deal which is great ROI to return \$700 commish on average How many pick up the phone out of 20? Let's use 5 (which is a pipedream but let's play fair) Speak to 5 people for \$140 is \$28. It costs you \$28 to speak to someone So how many of those 5 were glad you called? Let's say 3 - the other 2 bitch you out for being the 3rd agent to call. 3 happy people for \$140 = \$46 And you'll close 1. So you're not really closing 1 out of 20. You're closing 1 out of very 3 people who actually wanted to talk to you. Although that's a fair scenario I painted let's keep it real. You're getting 20 shared leads and 10% pick up - or 2 people and you have zero to 1 sale...maybe, then proceed to pummel the other 18 with calls and emails. Even with all that said those 3 happy people are speaking to 2 or 3 other agents. With the Vimo transfers they're exclusive. So it's not some "it's too good to be true" scenario where you're closing 1 out of 3 or 1 out of 4. You're simply cutting out all the BS and are on the phone with people who want help from an agent. So really, what will I pay for my phone to literally ring during the day? A lot. This is better ROI than my telemarketed leads with 1/10th the headache. So where's the ass kicking? Use \$35 per lead as an average and \$700 as average profit: \$35 into \$700 = 20. You'd have close 1 out of 20 live transfers to break even. In that case, hurry up and grab a job at Walmart - sales is not your calling. Close 1 out of 10? That's \$350 to return \$700 and your phone simply rings. Do that every day and it's \$1,750 per week net. Senior agents will tear this up. However, this gives newer agents a fighting change since the leads are not shared. Interested? Call Justin at 650-230-0070"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance and Ancillary Benefits · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-41297>

"I'll agree. If you're not on your A game you need to think about it. This is for people who know their products extremely well and are well established closers. This doesn't mean new agents don't have a shot - but I'd recommend some phone and sales experience. Regardless, if you don't have very sharp phone skills and know how to take clients from A to B to C you'll want to proceed with caution. I personally have not experienced low income but I'm sure it's coming. If I can close 1 out of 4 I'm still all over it. Again, at \$30 a pop on average I'll pay \$120 for a deal. I'm personally not seeing a scenario where ROI doesn't work out for me. What I won't do is call 20 leads, have 3 pick up and get bitched out by 2. I don't enjoy calling people who don't know I'm calling and don't want me to call. That's why I farm out telemarketing and am not a fan of cold-calling myself. I guess what can be discussed is if you're not sharp enough to close an exclusive prospect who's waiting on hold to talk to you, how well are you gonna fair fighting other agents for business. And if you're not willing to spend \$30 to speak with someone how do you have the funds to spend \$140 on 20 leads and only speak to 1 to 3 people? Also, shared leads are by far not income qualified and you call those 20 shared leads and still get "\$150 per MONTH?" I think this works very well with quote engines like Norvax - take 'em to your site and show 'em rates and plans. I'm taking people to my site while on the phone so they can run rates. It keeps them engaged when they're playing around with buttons instead of just listening to you. They obviously have a bit of time if they're waiting to speak to an agent. I disagree that it needs to be a one-shot-one-kill close. I've set two in-person appointments - closed the one this morning. The girl I spoke with yesterday was at work, I called her back at 1pm and signed her up online then. That being said, these are indeed people anxious enough to want to speak with an agent. Let's look at companies like Geico. Go call a Geico rep and see if they just want to email you stuff to review. Yeah...right. If they go over your scenario and can save you money they're taking the app right then. It's not gonna be "we'll email our brochure and call you back tomorrow.""

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance and Ancillary Benefits · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/vimo-live-transfers.3746/#post-41301>

"healthagent said: I'm in search of a new telemarketer and I'll pay any new agent here \$2,000 a week flat pay. Would you take that job? I'll require you to work 4 hours a day on the phone. Sound good? Great - I still get a lot of emails from agents coming into this industry struggling for a way to get off the ground. And while almost every new agent here would take me up on this offer the question is - why wouldn't you do it for yourself? You want a guaranteed way to get off the ground? Get either Goleads, SalesGenie Light or ReferenceUSA, and start making 4 hours a day worth of calls. You will generate 3 leads per hour, 4 hours a day - 60 leads for the week. If you're on a 20% contract average volume will be \$3,500. Two deals is \$1,400. My cat could close 1 out of 30 telemarketed leads - and remember these are leads you generated so obviously the quality is high. 3 deals is \$10,500 in volume and \$2,000 in commission. That's also 1 out of 20 closed but when you're brand new that's probably on target. Eventually you can close 4 or 5 out of those 60 leads. Marketing costs? Either \$10 a month with Goleads or free with ReferenceUSA. So again, would you telemarket 4 hours a day for \$2,000 a week? You're brand new and think buying shared leads is the way to go? That's like entering a body building competition after being in the gym for a week. Click to expand... Outstanding post. That really puts it in black and white. That doesn't only apply to "new agents". I would guess that most agents who have been in the business for a while are not making \$2,000 per week, \$104,000 per year. Why, they don't want to pick up the "dreaded" telephone. They must learn to "slay that dragon" to be successful. Their fortune is at the tip of their dialing finger."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance and Ancillary Benefits · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/looking-for-a-telemarketer-im-offering-2-000-a-week.2033/#post-27340>

"I'm in search of a new telemarketer and I'll pay any new agent here \$2,000 a week flat pay. Would you take that job? I'll require you to work 4 hours a day on the phone. Sound good? Great - I still get a lot of emails from agents coming into this industry struggling for a way to get off the ground. And while almost every new agent here would take me up on this offer the question is - why wouldn't you do it for yourself? You want a guaranteed way to get off the ground? Get either Goleads, SalesGenie Light or ReferenceUSA, and start making 4 hours a day worth of calls. You will generate 3 leads per hour, 4 hours a day - 60 leads for the week. If you're on a 20% contract average volume will be \$3,500. Two deals is \$1,400. My cat could close 1 out of 30 telemarketed leads - and remember these are leads you generated so obviously the quality is high. 3 deals is \$10,500 in volume and \$2,000 in commission. That's also 1 out of 20 closed but when you're brand new that's probably on target. Eventually you can close 4 or 5 out of those 60 leads. Marketing costs? Either \$10 a month with Goleads or free with ReferenceUSA. So again, would you telemarket 4 hours a day for \$2,000 a week? You're brand new and think buying shared leads is the way to go? That's like entering a body building competition after being in the gym for a week."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance and Ancillary Benefits · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/looking-for-a-telemarketer-im-offering-2-000-a-week.2033/#post-27338>

Dislikes

Compliance and carrier rules

"Getting Sued For \$25,000 With 1 Just Phone Call OK. I have an agent who's been with me for about 1.5–2 years. Good guy. He recently bought "pre-sold leads" from an offshore telemarketing center. "Pre-sold leads" are supposed to be people who had already agreed to buy a policy, had a budget in mind, and were pre-qualified for health. In theory, the agent just had to "close the deal." It sounded too good to be true—and it was. One of the WORST things you can do in this business is buy leads generated outside the U.S. These leads are often sourced in ways that are non-compliant with federal and state TCPA regulations, and the sellers can't be held accountable due to being out of US jurisdiction. That's exactly what happened here. The agent took a call from one of these "pre-sold" leads as a live transfer, went through his normal pitch, and unknowingly gave his info to a professional litigant (somebody who sues companies for alleged TCPA violations on a regular basis). Here's what the professional litigator did: he went after the "insurance carrier, not the agent", for the TCPA claim. He's alleging a \$10,000 TCPA violation for the state he's in, plus \$1,500 for several calls made to him from the company. The litigant wants a \$25,000 settlement to make this problem go away. You may think that the agent is safe. But he isn't. If the carrier settles, they'll pass the final settlement cost plus attorney fees to the agent to pay, even though the agent didn't knowingly violate the Do Not Call list when he spoke to the litigant. This isn't a one-off case either, and cases like these are very common, especially for agents and agencies using crappy leads and questionable lead generation practices. Pro-Tip: If you're purchasing your own leads, I highly recommend two things: 1. **Buy litigator scrub lists** – This list is generated from TCPA lawsuits, and filter out known professional plaintiffs. This is the best way to eliminate the biggest risks of getting sued. 2. **Phone number change scrub** – Very important here. This helps eliminate leads who have phone number changes after the lead is generated. You are not in compliance when calling a phone number owned by someone other than the person who filled out the lead. 3. **Don't buy from overseas vendors** – If you're going to buy leads, make sure your vendor is US-based. Better yet, stick with leads that have a track record of express written consent. Bottom line: Be very careful where you get your leads. One bad call can cost you big."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jke61x/getting_sued_for_25000_with_1_just_phone_call/

"Let go at 6 months pregnant This happened yesterday. I'm still processing. Couldn't sleep all night. And this is long. I apologize in advance. Been an AE at this small private tech company for almost 2 years. They recently went through a rebrand and wanted us targeting completely new verticals. Leadership and overall processes were a complete mess, and it was honestly a shit show. I wanted to leave, but was holding out until after baby arrived this summer. Q4 was rough. Partly because we have zero good inbound leads and are 100% reliant on outbounds, and we have a 6 month sales cycle on average. Except our CEO acts like it should be a 2-meeting close. My old boss was fired and I got a new boss in January. In February, I was told I needed to hit my revenue numbers by end of March, along with all these KPIs metrics, and training a new guy he hired. I've never been on a PIP in my life (been an AE for 7 years), but it didn't feel formal in that there was no document and I never signed anything. Just told I need to do this and this. Now, normally the advice is to start applying immediately. And I did. However my situation is a bit different as I'm pregnant and due this summer. Made it to the offer stage at another company and then informed them I was pregnant, hoping to negotiate some sort of leave. Unfortunately they couldn't offer me any paid leave and my job also wouldn't be protected since I wouldn't qualify for FMLA. At my current company, I would. So it felt safer in the moment to stay. I worked my ass off. Consistently delivered on outreach KPIs, spent hours training the new hire, helped with new marketing initiatives developing new 1-pagers and helping with new outreach playbook development. Really trying to show I'm an asset and praying I could stay on through the summer. After that, I wouldn't care. Still, my revenue was down and my other deals were tied up in legal and I was starting to worry. But out of nowhere one of my old deals I closed last summer was acquired and the new company reached out per their recommendation, and wanted to move forward. This new deal would single handedly hit my revenue numbers. However the compliance aspect took forever. Our team is so disorganized and makes it so hard to buy. Then onboarding. Unfortunately I also sell a consumption based product. So even though they sign the contract and commit to X volume, the revenue generated is dependent on their ramp....which is in the hands of the client success team. And then wouldn't you have it, this CSM did the bare minimum to help them ramp. I felt like I was being sabotaged. Even my boss agreed that they were not doing their job. I stepped up and held meetings to help the client onboard, go through the set up and integration. The CSM completely dropped the ball. No reoccurring meetings in place until they fully ramped, nothing. Basically told them "if you need help lmk". Insane. So, yesterday arrived and I was below my revenue number. But I SHOULD have hit it. And I've been doing so much I really didn't feel worried. Mind you, my entire team was below as well. Revenue was stagnant across the company. But my boss called me out of the blue and I was terminated on the spot. No emotion. No severance. No paid out PTO. No extended insurance. Nothing. My income makes up 60% of our household income. And I use their insurance. Which I have doctors appointments set up every 2 weeks. They've completely fucked me as no company is going to hire me when I give birth in 3 months and also pay me for leave. I don't know what the fuck to do. We genuinely cannot afford to not have my income until Fall. Do I have any legal leg to stand on, or can they just say I fell short of performance, even if I'm dependent on others to do their job AND the entire company was stagnant on revenue? (For reference, I was the only one with a contract signed in Q1 and I had 2 others under review)."

— r/sales · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/sales/comments/1jp0avi/let_go_at_6_months_pregnant/

"AMA - Never selling insurance to 85k monthly commissions starting my own agency **AMA: Nine months ago I'd never sold a policy. Today my ACA book does about \$85k/month with a \$34 CPA and ~3% loss. Here's what I wish I'd researched before spending money. Quick context** * Licensed end of Oct '24, started selling Jan '25 * Put **\$100k** in over the year * I buy **live inbound callers only** (no cold lists) **How I handle calls (this mattered most)** * Calls only route to me when I'm not already on the phone, so I don't miss people * If I miss a customer service call, I call back the same day—no exceptions * Clients get a real number that reaches me—my personal cell, 24/7. Hard work, but it built trust and referrals **What to research before you spend \$1** * Refund policy in writing: what counts as a bad call, how returns work, when credits land * Answer/contact rates by hour and source (real stats, not guesses) * County/ZIP targeting that matches ACA networks I can actually place * Consent/compliance language used before the call reaches me * Delivery control so I can cap/pause and touch every caller the same day **Money I wasted** * "Cheap" calls with vague or slow refunds * Buying volume before the intake script and follow-up rhythm were dialed in * Fancy software I didn't use every day **Money that paid off** * Speed + clarity: short script, quick verify, clear next step, same-day follow-up * Call recording + quick QC: 10 minutes a day fixed leaks I couldn't see in a spreadsheet * Knowing ACA cold: networks, formularies, prior auth, renewal quirks—explained in plain English (be the expert and put people at ease) **My lead-vendor checklist now** 1. Refund/credit rules and SLA (in writing) 2. Sample ads so I know there's no fake incentivizing 3. State targeting and delivery hours 4. I can throttle/stop calls instantly **Process that moved the needle** * 3 steps: verify basics → solve the real problem → set a specific next time/action * 1–2 plan options max, with reasons (menus slow everything down) * Same-day everything, or conversion drops * Post-enrollment customer care (ID cards, network checks, "what now?") drives referrals and keeps churn low (~3%) **Simple weekly scoreboard** * Reached calls / total calls * Kept appointments * Submits * Time to first touch * Service issues per member * Refund rate / turnaround * CPA (~\$34) and trend **If I had to start over (I could do it much cheaper—\$10–20k)** * Spend the first 2–3 weeks on scripts, routing, notes template, and a manual follow-up schedule * Trial multiple **live-call** vendors in tiny batches; only scale the one that proves contactability and refunds * Keep the tech boring: I run everything in Excel and Google Calendar * Give clients a real number and show up—that's what makes referrals happen That's my playbook and the lessons. AMA about the research, spend, setup, or what I'd cut or double down on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1okykm4/ama_never_selling_insurance_to_85k_monthly/

"To form an LLC or to not form an LLC? 🤖🤖 That is the question.... 🤖🤖 Many people get the advice to spread out their liability and form an LLC with a business. If you are forming practically any other business, I would almost always say yes, go for it. In the insurance business, however, there are costs as well as administrative and compliance considerations to consider when forming an entity that could make things unnecessarily complicated for you in the beginning. In addition, for most independent agents E&O insurance is required for carrier appointments and covers you in the case of liability for any errors or omissions that pose the highest risk of liability. Now if you're concerned that maybe you go door-to-door or do appointment setting or something along those lines and an old lady trips and falls and blames you for it, that's a whole nother story of liability and perhaps a reason that you should form an LLC. The risk of that is very low in that regard, unless tripping old ladies is something that you're accustomed to. There are three scenarios in which I tell independent agents to go ahead and form an entity. 🤖1 - you already have high Revenue Revenue can get to a certain point where you can file to be taxed as a corporation and get owner's distribution to lower overall tax burden. 🤖2 - you have high production There are certain carriers in the industry that are worth having and also require an entity in order to attain certain contract levels (compensation levels). Some carriers also require an entity if you have downlines or a certain number of downlines. 🤖3 - you have downlines (agents working for your agency) When other people's income start to get involved, other people's families, other peoples things, etc. it is always smart to have an LLC to limit your liability as a company. It's smart and it protects you from that liability of the many, many things that could potentially happen as business grows. I tend to advise not to give yourself an extra headache by forming an entity early. If you are going solo and are holding contracts independently, an entity typically does not need to be formed until these scenarios arise. A DBA is just fine until you produce, you get agents, or you get high enough revenue for a tax advantage. 🤖🤖 Please consult with a lawyer and CPA, as I am not a lawyer or a CPA, and this does not constitute official or licensed legal or financial advice."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mp3psz/to_form_an_llc_or_to_not_form_an_llc_that_is_the/

"Great idea. Favorite telesales carriers: RNA, Prosperity and Trinity. SS billing + voice sign for all 3. Favorite lead: Real-time telemarketed call back with verified checking, ages 50-79 and agrees to speak with an agent. Basically telemarketers calling on DNC scrubbed and TCPA verified data to call on (old FB leads or Journaya/Trusted Form verified) + scrubbed against TCPA Blacklist Alliance and inputting into a form to serve it up in a CRM immediately. Tip: You need proper training and sales systems to make telesales work. If you take your DM leads and try to sell them over the phone with your typical f2f presentation, you'll fail. If you buy internet leads and don't have proper sales training or sales systems, you'll fail. My advice is either partner with a telesales-focused agency with an open release policy (hey, telesales isn't for everyone) or wait it out. Don't waste any time/money unless there's a proven system in place."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · 11 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/final-expense-telesales-tips.101595/#post-1344555>

"I have been in this industry for 14 years and it has become a shell of it's former self. Let me explain. In 2009 is when CMS enacted over 100 new regulations in the Medicare industry. New regulations included annual enrollment periods, government regulated commissions for Part C and D, a Scope of Appointment form that must be completed prior to an agent's presentation, annual AHIP certifications to be able to sell policies in addition to annual carrier certifications, soon after new legislation that required MA plans to have to have a network which killed PFFS plans which were the most popular MA plans at that time, laws which forbids agents to market Part C and D products, laws which govern every aspect of agents holding seminars even including not allowing agents to offer free meals for attendees, the inability to call referrals (the referral must contact you), regulations on carriers that made it illegal for carriers to offer bonuses and trips to agents for production rewards, and many more that I can't think of off the top of my head. After these draconian regulations were passed most agents left the industry. The only ones that stayed were the agents that had a solid book of business prior to these new regulations which is why the average age of a Medicare agent is 60 years old. This industry's golden age was from 1998 to 2008. Medicare Advantage was a brand new concept as well a few years later Part D was brand new as well. There were plenty of reasons why seniors needed to talk with an agent during this time and the big money was made at this time. That all changed in 2009. CMS used the excuse that since agents were getting compensated with taxpayer money (Medicare funding Dollars) that CMS had the right to regulated everything about the agent's existence in this industry. In 2020, very little has changed under the Trump administration. The only good thing to be improved upon was CMS not requiring the Scope of Appointment form to be filled out 48 hours prior to an agent's presentation and changed it to the same day as the appointment. Not only has this industry been regulated into hell for agents, but carriers are so paranoid about compliance that they micro manage everything an agent does as well for fear that the carrier will get in trouble with CMS and lose funding for their plans. Part D plans pay almost nothing for the sheer amount of work that needs to be done reviewing your client's drug list every year that you are almost working for free. MAPD plans pay the same commission as MA only plans. Now if you understand inflation this is another issue as well. The US Dollar loses 2%-3% of it's value every year which causes prices to increase, but you get paid renewals based upon commission rates from the first year you write the business. So while you do make renewals, those renewals become less and less every year. Now that MA plans have ironed out their networks and funding is stabilized, there is little need for seniors to switch Medicare plans every year because they already are in the best plan possible. You can go after T65 business, but that has also become problematic as well. Since Social Security has raised the full benefit retirement age from 65 to 67, most seniors are still working for an employer at 65 and have no need for Medicare coverage until they retire, especially since many spouses are not yet on Medicare and their spouse needs the group coverage. The (un)Affordable Care Act aka Obamacare is terrible and has made major medical coverage too expensive and too restrictive. After 14 years in the industry I have finally realized all that is bad and the bad FAR out weighs the good. The commissions are too small for an agent to make it especially with so few seniors actually needing a better plan plus with everything I previously mentioned you need to be insane to become a Medicare agent in 2020. If you do start off in this industry you need at LEAST 6 months worth of living expenses saved and 3 months of marketing expenses saved or you will run out of money very quick and need to find an hourly job. You must write 100 policies every year to make it in this industry and you will max out at 400 to 500 clients because any more clients and you will have to hire help. So at \$250 commission per client earned every year you are looking at a max of \$100,000 to \$125,000 minus your marketing expenses which will cost you between \$12,000 to \$20,000 per year plus all the gas consumption and wear and tear on your vehicle driving all over town on appointments, double taxes you pay for FICA, Medicare and Social Security taxes, and lack of access yourself to affordable health insurance by not having access to group health policies. Covid-19 is a new hurdle agents must overcome and adds a dozens new challenges because of CMS regulations. The Medicare industry just isn't worth it anymore."

— YouTube · The RAW TRUTH About Becoming A Medicare Insurance Agent · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLR1pDwXRmU&lc=UgzB83ld5GS4cMtfOtB4AaABAg>

"Hi David! I always appreciate your videos, so thank you for making them and sharing your knowledge so freely and often. I passed the AHIP but haven't had really any training on how to sell Medicare plans, which is frustrating because I don't want to be out that test money and not using that knowledge to help people. I do telesales for FE and plan to for Medicare but I'm nervous about all the upfront compliance stuff (like fitting in SOA over the phone for example). I have reached out to my agency about it but haven't had any assistance as of yet. Any chance you're planning on a video like this, or have a start to finish example of a Medicare call that could help put me at ease to get started?"

— YouTube · How A Career Selling Medicare Policies Works · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d2SmzwhBgfw&lc=UgzJ1e_zsWcOx83Umx4AaABAg

"Here's what I'm doing (not be construed as legal advice): 1. Update your compliance language on all opt-in forms. 2. Switch from shared/data leads to self-generated leads if you're doing anything more powerful than manual dialing. 3. My interpretation is that you can work aged/data leads on a single-line dialer as that counts as manual dialing. However, doing so would be akin to self-mutilation. Overall, the spirit of the law is great and hopefully will greatly limit call centers and the amount of mass dialing data "leads" they do."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1hszzi5/doing_anything_about_the_new_tcpa_rule_whats_your/m59vn00/

"Advice for Final Expense Startup (High-Volume Cold Calling Team) Hi everyone, I'm planning to start selling final expense insurance within the next month or two. I'll be going all-in on cold calling and wanted to get feedback from experienced agents before launch. My Plan: I'll (22M) be working with my two 18-year-old brothers and operating in new york state Each of us will make 1,000 cold calls/day, 6 days a week We'll work 12–13 hour shifts, using a CRM + power dialer system We plan to buy leads daily at \$0.30 to \$0.50 each We're all bilingual (English/Spanish) and comfortable with high-volume sales We're not strangers to long hours or consistent effort — and we plan to maintain tone and energy throughout. Goals: Start with final expense sales Gradually add Medicare Scope of Appointments (SOA), enrollments, and eventually Medicare Supplements After a few months of production, I plan to negotiate a 140% commission contract We're expecting a 0.3% to 0.5% close rate based on what we've researched A friend of mine who only does medicare will share his hot leads with me since i will do final expense so i am guaranteed some early success at least if i dont screw it up --- My Questions: 1. Is this call volume and close rate realistic for a new team using aged or low-cost leads? 2. Is there anything crucial I'm overlooking in terms of compliance, licensing, or daily execution? 3. Are there any CRM + dialer combos you highly recommend for high-volume final expense/Medicare telesales? 4. For Medicare broker changes, is it realistic to expect consistent volume or are those more seasonal? 5. Are there any major red flags or rookie mistakes we should avoid early on? 6. Any advice for scripting, retention, or mental pacing during long dialing days? Thanks in advance — I really respect the grind this industry takes and want to do it the right way."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1jnkha/advice_for_final_expense_startup_highvolume_cold/

"You can still sell medicare this AEP. You'll need to approach it as a field agent. You can set up an educational kiosk anywhere you can get permission where there's consistent senior foot traffic, like grocery stores. You can go visit a local networking group like a BNI and share how you can help folks and ask for referrals. You can introduce yourself to 64 year olds who aren't on Medicare yet but who likely have questions about the process - keeping the conversation education for compliance - by using the T65 Locator app in the App Store. Cold calling seniors during AEP was always and is always a plague in our society, fucking leeches. Go do the best you can and after AEP you can change your contracts to another FMO who supports healthy field agent marketing activities."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ofi9mo/i_was_a_1099_agent_and_got_terminated_today/nlat6zfi/

"TCPA mainly focuses on robo calls and dialers. I don't use any of those to dial my leads. I'm pretty much old school and hand dial myself. It's been 2 years for me and I haven't had an issue yet. I also don't spam call my leads. If someone answers and states they're not interested, I move on to the next lead. I'm not in the business of begging or being pushy."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/m9mjifjh/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER the happen. Its annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. >I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. >Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. >No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only recieve direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9glc/

"Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith.... Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith claims adjudication by intentionally weaponizing administrative obstacles to systematically withhold mandated Medicare benefits under National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3. Detailed Description: I am escalating this dispute because Devoted Health is utilizing intentional administrative barrier tactics to evade its federal statutory obligations under my Devoted Choice Giveback ("Pay Back") PPO plan. The plan explicitly affirmed my clinical eligibility for chronic low back pain acupuncture in a formal postal letter and established a precedent by successfully reimbursing session one. Their subsequent withholding of payments for five identical, consecutive sessions is not an operational oversight; it is a calculated non-delivery of baseline federal Medicare benefits. Devoted's out-of-state corporate management team is exploiting its remote structure to issue repetitive, bad-faith demands for "insufficient information". Because the billing codes, clinician credentials, and clinical documentation submitted for the unpaid sessions are completely identical to the approved first session, these demands constitute an intentional strategy to create a cycle of administrative exhaustion. By forcing a local Hawaii senior to finance a federally protected benefit out-of-pocket, Devoted Health is in direct, willful breach of its CMS contract. I request that CMS bypass the plan's failed internal grievance metrics, launch an immediate compliance audit into Devoted's Hawaii PPO reimbursement protocols, and compel immediate restitution. Devoted Health formally established eligibility criteria and authorized coverage for the chronic low back pain acupuncture treatments via written postal correspondence. Under established Medicare Advantage guidelines, an insurer cannot arbitrarily revoke or obstruct an active, written authorization when the subsequent medical claims present identical clinical indicators and treatment modalities. Arbitrary and Capricious Claims Processing: The plan's administrative team has acted inconsistently by successfully reimbursing the initial acupuncture session, yet denying or withholding payment for the subsequent 5 identical sessions. Because the exact same provider information, billing codes, and clinical documentation were submitted across all claims, the plan's repeated assertion that there is "insufficient information" constitutes an arbitrary administrative barrier. Improper Adjudication and Unreasonable Administrative Burden: By demanding additional, unspecified information for ongoing sessions that identical documentation already sufficed to cover, Devoted Health is creating an uncertified administrative hurdle. This violates CMS expectations for fair claims processing, shifting an unlawful financial and administrative burden onto the beneficiary after prior approval was secured. Violation of CMS Chronic Low Back Pain Coverage Mandates: National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3 dictates that Medicare covers up to 12 initial acupuncture sessions within a 90-day window for chronic low back pain. By withholding payment for 5 consecutive sessions within this approved window, Devoted Health is failing to deliver the baseline federal benefits mandated under its Medicare Advantage contract. Demand for Prompt Equitable Estoppel and Immediate Reimbursement: Because the beneficiary reasonably relied on Devoted Health's explicit written assurances and the initial successful reimbursement to continue necessary medical treatments, the plan is legally and equitably estopped from denying coverage. Devoted Health must immediately resolve this internal processing error, honor their written commitment, and issue full reimbursement for the 5 outstanding sessions to prevent further financial injury to the beneficiary. On top of it all, they have escalated the excessive stress on MY HEALTH."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d09f0594549203e916983>

"Fraudulent policies. . The situation with Oscar Health Insurance is not merely a personal grievance; it is a glaring example of systemic malpractice that undermines the integrity of the healthcare system. The company has allowed unscrupulous agents, motivated solely by commission, to exploit the marketplace, enrolling individuals without their informed consent. This is a blatant violation of ethical standards and consumer rights. Despite having secured legitimate coverage through United Healthcare since 2023, I have been subjected to the unauthorized use of my personal information by these fraudsters from 2024 to 2026. Oscar Health's refusal to rectify this situation, despite clear evidence of fraudulent applications from 2024 and 2025, is not just negligent; it is a calculated disregard for the trust placed in them by their members. This behavior is not just bad business; it is an affront to the principles of honesty and transparency that should govern the healthcare industry. Oscar Health claims to prioritize integrity and compliance, yet their actions tell a different story. They have failed to uphold their own Code of Conduct, which mandates ethical dealings and respect for member privacy. I urge anyone who suspects they may be victims of similar fraudulent practices to take immediate action. Verify your enrollment status and ensure that your personal information is not being misused. The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) has acknowledged the rise in improper enrollments and provides resources for reporting such incidents. It is imperative that we hold companies like Oscar Health accountable for their unethical practices and demand a healthcare system that truly serves the interests of its members."

— TrustPilot · Oscar Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6983aef32974cbe9e9b23298>

Chargebacks and clawbacks

"State Farm just rewrote 19,000 agents' contracts overnight. If you think a captive book is a retirement plan, read this If you somehow missed it: State Farm is moving all 19,000 of its agents onto a single standardized contract, ending their deferred-comp/retirement program (AIPP), and dropping health insurance for agents and spouses. Agents are reportedly looking at 30–40% less on base commissions depending on contract and book size. I can't believe State Farm disputes that number but hasn't offered its own. The core shift is from getting paid to "retain" a book to getting paid to "write new business". They also put buyout offers on the table with a Sept 30 deadline. P&C side, I know. But the lesson isn't carrier-specific and it's the thing I keep coming back to: you never actually owned that book. State Farm did. And a 20-year "trailing income" promise is only worth as much as the carrier's willingness to keep paying it which turned out to be "until it's inconvenient." The part that should get every agent's attention is the direction, not the one carrier. Comp is going performance-based across the board, trailing/renewal-style income is getting squeezed, and AI is going to absorb more of the service and retention work that used to justify those trails. The "come build a \$3–5M book and coast" pitch a lot of us were sold is quietly being retired. So I'm genuinely curious how the room sees it: Are you seeing comp pressure at your carrier/IMO too, or is this a State Farm-specific overreach? Does owning your book independently actually protect you here, or is that just trading carrier risk for lead-cost/chargeback risk? For the newer agents is anyone factoring "can they rewrite my deal in 5 years" into where they sign? Not trying to dunk on State Farm agents since a lot of them got blindsided and it's a rough spot. More interested in what this says about where the whole comp model is heading."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1u8o7p3/state_farm_just_rewrote_19000_agents_contracts/

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ujsuxk/life_insurance_is_not_what_it_seems/

"Starting to think the money and lifestyle is a pipe dream from the depths of my soul I really need to know the truth of this I have a family to support. i've been selling life insurance for about two years now. I was attracted to all these big checks and the lifestyle that you can control your money and just buy leads and set appointments and do one call closes over the phone and you could make 200k, 300k 500 K a year. and there are tons of people showcase that are doing it. Even twenty something yr olds. So I got in and I bought the leads and I grinded my face off. I managed to make over 100 K within a handful of months. I thought I had it made and I cracked the code. And then I realized I still felt broke. all these crappy lead companies. these leads were supposed to be exclusive and I know they sold them to 10 other agents. I would sometimes dial eight hours a day and only have 1 to 3 genuine conversations. that's crap. I was on the phone all day long I was buying thousands of dollars a month in Leads. Then the chargebacks started hitting me. And now I have to work for free for the rest of the month. But you Gotta keep buying more leads And then customers would call in and need things. I needed to call the carriers. but I didn't really have time to talk to them because I need to buy more leads and call more people and make more sales. eventually I realized how unhappy I was I was working a lot and yet I still felt paycheck to paycheck despite writing 20-30k a month. and I feel like I could not get ahead. What the heck? Then I looked at some of my leaders I was following and they were making 400 K plus a year. and I thought if I ever get to their level then I will be an easy Street then I could take my foot off the gas and I could have a great lifestyle. Wrong. All of them are working their faces off. they couldn't take time off. they weren't spending time with her kids. they didn't have time to answer my calls. Or to train me really. And what's more they didn't even seem happy. they had this stressed out look in their face all the time. I thought how could that be? was this all a lie? is the money and lifestyle even real? I saw this guy who wrote \$1 million on stage. Come to find out he spent 250 K on Leads 30 to 40% fall off. and then minus the guaranteed issue and administrative costs like his dialer or admin... really he was making like 150-200k. That ain't a million. And. He was working 7 days a week. And stressed out couldn't take his foot off the gas. Not worth it. I don't want that lifestyle. If I'm making 400 K a year I better be able to enjoy time with my family and come home for dinner and take nice vacations and make money moves and investments. My goal is to have the lifestyle not to be a slave on the phone seven days a week 10 hours a day. I'm assuming it's just unsustainable biz model. and you're always fighting off chargebacks . And the lead cost will eat up all your profits and that's why most agents won't stick around. Is that the cold truth? am I chasing a pipe dream ? is there ever a way off the escalator if you are selling by yourself without a team? I was mainly doing final expense and mortgage protection.."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 59 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1nmbbqg/starting_to_think_the_money_and_lifestyle_is_a/

"I would say this is pretty accurate. I've been in the life insurance business since 2015 . I don't have any overhead and don't pay for leads . Id say I am pretty average and work about 30 hrs /week. strictly personally producing right now . I have 90% retention and make about 5k a month . I've had a team before and was making considerably more money but was putting in considerably more hours. I also have seen people in my company that are more motivated than me make 20k+ a month. I don't have a spouse or kids so working remotely is perfect and lets me travel all over and I enjoy taking time off to explore . For someone that is willing to put in the time and effort , life insurance is a great long term career . Just make sure you look into leads , chargebacks , and residuals when you interview with a company and be prepared to put in work ."

— YouTube · I Asked 166 Life Insurance Agent How Much Money They ACTUALLY Make Per Month · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLoTTqEO2AY&lc=UgzyaarWYK3Ns1QxAWF4AaABAg>

"How to Start an Insurance Agency (IMO) Okay, basically I'm at an Insurance Agency called Roman Financial that is providing me no value, apart from constant jargon and motivation and looking at fast cars. I'm 19 and hit the ground running right away selling 5 figures in my first few weeks. I quickly realized that I'm way underpaid as far as "street level" for the final expense providers we go through. Good news is I didn't sign any NDA or a non-compete. As of right now, I am 10000% unnecessarily paying my upline hundreds of dollars that I'm breaking my back to get dialing 8 hours a day on measly 75-80% commission. With little research I've found that the exact same insurance providers give 120% first year to agents. Apart from the 45% of my check that I'm giving to my undeserving upline they are also making me pay for my CRM and the shiddy leads. I've figured that I'd go my own way and own my own lead source to grab leads rather than listen to their manipulation all day. In this way, I want my recruits to be taken care of instead of letting people fall out of the industry going into debt through leads and chargebacks. Long story short, they keep telling me to dial more and to drop the ego. I know I'm worth more than what I'm getting commission wise and nobody is going to have control over how much money I make anymore. That being said, I plan to create my own agency/IMO. Where my agents aren't paying most of their checks to me and don't have to fend for themselves in a constant uphill battle. I plan to have everybody pool for leads to fund ads for the lead source and direct mail etc. I plan to promote recruiting but have everybody come in at a fairly decent commission. No rah rah bullshi, just effective business owners who want to succeed and slam deals. I plan to pay appt setters to book quality leads so guys don't have to dial like their lives depend on it. I have a general outline of what I need to do: name, logo, llc/scorp, e&o, recruiting, marketing, but as far as contracting with providers, whats the best way to go about doing that? If anybody has experience building an agency lmk? ORRR if anybody is seemingly in the same boat and would like to build an empire with me... i'm taking partner applications lol. EDIT: My upline saw this and "released" me which is hilarious since I was getting them paid in everyway. Unfortunately for them I have everything laid out already and already talked to a business accountant and everything. Roman if you guys are reading this, You are 100% correct when you say that I'm gonna try to take my recruits with me. Actually you're 90% correct because you used the word "try". As I was recruiting them I already told them it wouldn't be long until we left Roman just get your licensing course. And hey, when my agencies up and running you can always come work for me at a higher contract than Norm and Carlo got you at. Remember you're never gonna be richer than your upline. :)"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 24 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15nmk7/how_to_start_an_insurance_agency_imo/

"That's me too, but no lead purchases, no charge back, but extremely low sales!"

— YouTube · My First 90 Days As A Life Insurance Agent · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9lF5hTEjK7U&lc=UgzUZfl62c3LV5cDsJt4AaABAq>

"Beware of MLM structured companies (warning) So this was originally a response to a comment on this sub, but I see a ton of new people coming into insurance, (speaking to independent guys here) and there are many many hungry wolves waiting to recruit these naïve noobs and make a profit. So, I figured I could make a post using some of the content from my previous response to explain the caveats and expose the reality of these places. I come from a MLM originally, it was unbenounced to me at the time, but I'm still grateful because it gave me a first hand glance at what goes on there. How to spot a MLM? They typically start you off at lower commissions (70%-100%) when street level for Life insurance independent agents right now is 120% for most products. They will push you to build a team, because hey, don't you wanna make 6 figures "bro"??? Well then you gotta build a huge team so you get all those overrides off the guys under you. Now, there's nothing wrong necessarily with building a team, but in a MLM context and the way they act in a deceptive manner it is extremely unethical. The guys you see writing 100k plus in premium a year??? A fraction of that fell off the books and was a chargeback, then that guy like all of us has to pay taxes at the end of the year. He also probably was buying \$500 worth of leads a week. Burned gas every day meeting clients. He *maybe* profited 40k that year, and that's being generous. But as long as they can show boat how much premium they're writing a week? A month? A year? Then shove the rhetoric down new guys throats, boasting about how they too can make 100k a year? Then they're all good. I found out through a credible source, as well as David Dufford (has a youtube channel, good tips and insight for insurance) that alot of these "top producers" buy the trips that you can win with insurance carriers for writing a lot of AP. They do all of this and sugar coat their actual earnings because you'll buy the dream, go sell sell sell, and the guys above you get all the overrides off of you without investing any of their money into you at all. It's a fucking amazing model for the guys at the top to make a killing. They create a strong sense of family at those places to keep you on board as well. They push shitty products like Americo a ton too, because they get higher commissions off of that. Americo is also pricey, and you can easily find a cheaper product for that senior to actually help them out, but more than likely they won't have many cheap options that actually are economical for the client, because then you, and them get a lower commission. So MLM's will typically encourage you to get a higher premium out of the client and force a pricey carrier on them. Hope this helps. Reputable, ethical IMO's that offer you high commission contracts and don't push you to build teams are harder to find, because they don't market and recruit. Join an insurance forum, those guys are veterans and a lot of the IMO/Brokerage owners are members there. I've been in Life Insurance for a while now, and am branching into Health/Medicare, so anyone can feel free to PM me with Life Insurance questions if you'd like. Also it would be cool to maybe post any experiences you've had with these types of organizations."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/n4hblb/beware_of_mlm_structured_companies_warning/

"AEP apps vs chargebacks Happy December, fellow medicare agents! We made it through AEP! Just here to get some perspectives and experiences of what to expect with AEP apps vs which ones actually follow through! For those of you who have been through multiple AEPs, how many apps do you usually write? This was my first year, and I wrote 172. The majority of them are renewals, but I did have a few initial enrollments. Do you think this is exceptional? Also, how many of your apps ended up being chargebacks/cancelled (due to enrolling with another agent)? I'm curious to know what to expect here for my book. Last question, I promise, what percentage of your book ends up sticking around the following year? I know everyone's market is different, but I'm trying to get a sense of what's "normal." Any insight from seasoned agents would help a ton. Thanks so much and happy holidays!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1pgvbbq/aep_apps_vs_chargebacks/

"It is definitely a grind the first 2 years. Our path is slightly behind the other gentleman's. Year 1 was ugly, thankfully we had savings. Year 2 was easier and 3+ are much better. We are a health insurance agency that sells ancillaries and the odd life policies.: There are pros and cons to all areas of sales. For instance: life insurance has more chargebacks than Medicare which is why we took commission as earned - less financial risk to payback Medicare is subject to rules and regulations and the vagaries of politics. Life pays more up front, health pays longer term - so short term cash for life, long term renewals for Medicare. Life is more sales because you have to sell people on the need for it. 10,000 seniors turn 65 every day and need insurance. Life is year round and you have no real busy season. Medicare has open enrollment which is similar to tax season for accountants, but January through May (after you are established) are 20 to 30 hour work weeks. As you can see I prefer Medicare, but I am not blind to the fact that if you hate rules and details, you will hate Medicare. Whatever you do, learn to read books on your industry and sales, associate with top producers and put your customers interest before yours and you will get paid back in referrals."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/pkdfdw/independent_insurance_agent_a_viable_career/hc4pyQy/

"Hi OP! I'm a relatively new insurance agent been license for almost years and yes no one is ever transparent about leads, how to generate those and how costly they can be. To get leads you either pay a lot of money for them or spend a lot of your time chasing them. I personally gave up selling life insurance and supplementals because the amount of chargebacks was awful. Now I just focus on U65 ACA marketplace plans. I am also part of the HealthSherpa enrollee assistance program which pays me per person I have enrolled. I prefer this over getting commissions from the insurance carriers. I'll be happy to offer some feedback but you can also do your research."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mcl3e3/i_already_hate_my_job/n5vesh/

"As a new agent, 99% of the game is TRIAL BY FIRE. Get yourself in front of people, understand selling to their needs vs selling for commission (charge backs aren't fun) your different types of objections and how to overcome them, tuning your tonality, the product knowledge comes from time and closes, which you can't get studying all the time. You gotta dial, you gotta BUY leads from different sources until you find one that works great for you."

— YouTube · What To Expect Your First 90 Days As An Insurance Agent! · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HF4onytfV3c&lc=UgzDFYFSfBFMw6QScV4AaABAg>

"Thank you. After dealing with MLM's for years (mixture of insurance and product sales), I don't want to deal with the structure anymore. "No More Recruiting". I moved into the medical field for a change in pace but now I need to make more money. Looking into life insurance and I'm getting told to recruit. I'm glad I ran across this video. I support you in this. I just want to sell policies with great leads with no charge backs. On your application you ask for prior sales proof. I been out of the game for years and don't have anything to show proof of past successes. Can I still join your team?"

— YouTube · Why I Left The Life Insurance Business (My Old MLM) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nguUnK7fjDk&lc=UgzJaldo-PZu7wQUnsB4AaABAq>

Leads that never answer or are fake

"Sick of lead companies It's amazing.... agency owners buy "premium" leads and no matter where you go there's trash mixed in. The excuses are incredible like "you aren't dialing them enough" "the prospect keyed in that fake address and number" ect. ect. The agency I work for literally has people dialing alllllll day constantly (over 1000 dials). The sales agents are also calling, emailing, and texting. None of that matters when I get someone on the phone that's already been called 15 times. How the hell do these leads get sold to 20+ agents? I even had a lead in which the guy was DEAD for two years. Where are they even getting this crap from? Any industry insiders that want to give me the 411?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/

"BadA\$\$leads scam I purchased some leads from badassleads.. those leads are a penny worth. Wrong numbers, disconnected numbers, bad emails. Just don't waste your money and generate your own. Seriously lead generation companies are ripping off Agents"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/

"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1r86i3q/whats_the_hardest_part_of_being_an_insurance/o62tbgm/

"> What is your plan for when the incoming calls stop? As cynical as this sounds - there is no plan. If you have a phone, the calls will never stop coming. The numbers are spoofed, the names are fake, and there is nothing you can do. Even if you're on every blacklist alliance list, DNC, TCPA litigator scrub, etc etc - they all disconnect the calls AFTER they happen. It's annoying and won't end. I can get 100 illegal calls in a day and get zero justice or I can get 100 illegal calls a day, sue on 3-4 of them and get \$10-20 grand worth of justice. This is the world we're living in. The calls will never stop. If they did, I'd have a much higher serenity around here and I could enjoy some of the money I've made over the years. > Can you say with absolute sincerity that you're not taking any action to receive these illegal calls? 100%. I do not sign up for ANYTHING. I sit at home watching TV or scratching myself and the calls come in. I'm too young for medicare, but I get 20+ calls a day for medicare advantage. I'm too young for final expense insurance, I get 30+ a day for final expense. It's insanity. > You sure you're not intentionally putting yourself in a position for opportunities to sue these companies/agents? Am I intentionally putting myself in a position to sue these people, absolutely. The same way a cop running radar that has a really good spot that nobody can see / knows about..... I have a charged gopro handy and I record the incoming calls. Yes, I intentionally prepare myself to get the most leverage and the best evidence capture of illegal telemarketing practices. > I can't tell if you're posting this to be a genuine warning or maybe even bragging... but it actually reads like "Careful about your lead source, or else people without real jobs like me are going to sue you." I've done several settlements with small brokers that have said "we can't pay you what you're asking" and I said that's fine, I'll hold your upline joint and severally liable. Next thing I know, a decent settlement offer comes my way. OR I hire an attorney, they file a class action against the upline, the brokerage, the broker and the agent PERSONALLY and everyone goes to court, the upline spends \$150-200k in defense costs that they subrogate back to the downline via payment plan/docked commissions/what have you and my attorneys add another win to their CV. The message here is that YOU MAY THINK this new lead vendor of yours is all great but if you get burned, you can potentially be involved in bet the company litigation. And this is the WORST kind of litigation to be in because you don't realize you're in bet the company litigation until you've wound up betting the company. > Do what everyone else does and block the numbers that call Not that easy. All the numbers are spoofed. I get calls from the hospital, chevy dealership, etc etc - all displayed on the caller ID that are overseas call centers. Your outlook is 100% flawed. > No I have never been sued by a serial litigator because I only receive direct inbound calls, but I can still cringe at you for bottom feeding You know what's funny? Every single broker I've sued says "we only receive direct inbound calls" - you know why? THE LEAD GEN SPOOFS MY NUMBER, CALLS YOUR BROKERAGE SO YOU CAN CLAIM IT IS AN INBOUND CALL. The only counterbattery is my gopro video."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1mrhyn2/i_sue_insurance_brokers_and_insurance_companies/n8y9gic/

"Some lead vendors are honest stating their leads are sold to multiple agents, others however claim their leads are exclusive while recycling and selling the same lead multiple times over. You can definitely still find prospects that have yet to purchase a policy or even some that you may be able to offer a better rate to, but for the most part this type of lead is garbage and a headache to deal with. My agency has been using Speakeasy Leads for almost a year now for final expense and general life insurance leads. Agent Advantage has also been great for IUL leads. Both seem to be the few that offer legitimately exclusive leads and I rarely get the "I've already spoken to 10 agents" bs lol. A few vendors I would avoid from previous personal experience: Integrity Lead Center - these leads are definitely resold to multiple agents Leadrilla - Garbage TTC Leads - They were great, but since their original owner passed away the lead quality suffered Caboom Leads - Overpriced + prospects seem to be just shoppers MediaAlpha - I've received numerous leads in the past that had disconnected #'s paired with many prospects who have been deceased for years, overall just seems like fake data. Overall, the best method is to learn how to generate your own leads or hire an expert to setup your campaigns/lead capture funnels. This however is much easier said than done as it does take some time, effort and money to effectively learn paid ads, and if you do hire an individual or agency to manage this for you their fees are steep with no results guaranteed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merel99/

"Normal for farmers? Hi all, I started at farmers a month ago. Was working in a Medicare agency before this. The issue I'm having is I'm my managers only employee and she is an agency owner and I'm basically completely on my own. I don't fully know what's expected of me and I've been struggling to get sales. Has anyone else dealt with this? I wanted to go to State Farm but I don't have my life license yet. I still feel like I don't know what I'm talking about and she gives me 5 leads a day, I'm calling out to current clients and old leads but like 90% of the old leads are disconnected or don't qualify for Farmers. I kinda hate it and idk if this is normal"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wocjrp/normal_for_farmers/

"Im licensed, now what? Part time life ins sales ideas Im new to posting but I will try to keep it short but a little background for context is necessary. I have been in P&C insurance sales for 4 years for a small but successful independent agency. I got my License to sell Life to round out my P&C accounts and got my health&accident license with it. With no real future career opportunity at our 3 man agency and the principal agent screwing my commission and treating me like trash, I took a job selling medicare health insurance for a major provider in my area for open enrollment. This new healthcare job is WFH and so much slower paced than what i am used to, until things get busier in Sept i have nothing but spare time and a life insurance license that i dont know how to use to sell independently part time. Does anyone have any ideas on companies or carriers or aggregators that would help me sell some life insurance in my spare time? I have the ins sales experience so the real challenge is leads i suppose. I know there are plenty of carriers that will appoint me to sell their products. But how does one drum up business/contacts/leads that arent the total junk recycled crap, because I have been down that road. I have an LLC and insurance company already registered and ready to go from back when i almost went out on my own in P&C. The best idea i can think of is to use some of my marketing from that and invest some \$\$ into google ads and FB marketing and go the digital advertising route. Try to funnel in some leads from there? Short of that im not really sure. I am open to any and all ideas. Thanks all."

— r/LifeInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/LifeInsurance/comments/1eepurt/im_licensed_now_what_part_time_life_ins_sales/

"Medicare I am a P&C guy who owns an agency. I have two people working personal lines and I was doing commercial, which is slow at times. I wanted to get into Medicare Insurance so I went with the FMO Ritter and they have been great but...outside of my own prospect in house I am unsure how to jumpstart my book. My goal is 4 a month to start out since I do already have an income and have other daily responsibilities as an agency owner. I feel like everyone is buying leads and no one is happy with those leads so its hard to trust any lead source. Then the cost seems crazy to me for those leads. I would love live transfers but at \$45-\$60...I am not even sure I could afford enough to even try. I do have a sign coming for outside my office that basically says "We Offer Medicare Supplements!". I am hoping passing traffic will bring in some organic business. I guess what I am asking is how did some of you guys really start from scratch? Are leads pointless? For every "I like so and so leads" there's a "Really they sent me trash!". Do you really need to expand into other states? Do you need to forego the data leads and do transfers? Do your FMOs help you with leads (Ritter doesn't offer leads)?"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/15ksxo7/medicare/>

"Lead Stuffing" so that's the term..... i noticed like a certain percent of leads are fake addresses and they come in batches"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/mercnj/

"Figured I would post my thought to save everyone reading some money... CABOOM leads provides below average leads with a 20% answer rate when called 10-15 times in the first 3 days. Most of the IUL leads who answered were dead broke and unqualified. They were VERY FAR from high intent leads that were ready to buy. I should have known based on their advertising that it was sketchy, but I thought spending more would lead to higher quality leads. I was wrong. I started to focus more on buying annuity leads since this is my primary niche after a few weeks of failed IUL leads (that I thought were a fluke at the time - 60 leads total). I made the mistake of signing up for an annuity lead subscription after seeing high praise from an annuity producer I respect. I was even more disappointed with these leads. I ordered 20 leads per month for \$5000 and was told by my representative that I could cancel if I was very disappointed, but he assured me that I would have at least a 3x return on investment... Keep in mind that I actually have wealth management experience selling \$4M of annuities and mutual funds last year.... I ordered in mid-February and it's now early April and I STILL haven't received my first 20 leads. In late February, I ordered another 10 leads hoping that my lead flow would come in faster, and none have been delivered from this order. Most leads were not serious anyway and had no clue that the ad was talking about annuities... I had a similar experience on the IUL leads. I believe their ads are misleading and trick people into thinking they are getting some kind of free benefit that does not exist... I thought Cody was one of the good guys in the industry, but I'm not sure I trust him or his team. Quite frankly, their advertising is extremely misleading - "ready to buy" is garbage, but I blame this on myself for falling for the trap... Also, lots of other shady practices like offering discounts for POSITIVE reviews only, sending out a FAKE April fools message that they are no longer accepting new clients to trick people into buying with urgency, advertising that leads are vetted and ready to buy (all they do is respond to a text code - I'm not sure if I even believe this), and worst of all, not following through on promises. I have been unable to cancel my subscription order even though I am highly displeased and I have not even received 20 leads although I've ordered 30+ more than a month ago"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ibqa54/caboom_leads_review/mkvaioj/

"The problem is not putting hard work, if you went through the process you know that if you don't work hard you won't get any leads in r call people... The problems is that in the beginning they don't tell you but you will be getting old ass leads... and that's is frustrating... still not a cold call but some people don't even remember they signed up for... not to mention other agents that don't resolve their bad leads so it goes back to the pile as a no answer... and guess what? You will eventually call a bunch of people who already said are not interested many times... so I've seen some new agents taking many weeks just to book something remotely good... People who jump into this desperate for money and with no much time to climb up until get fresh leads will not last long, it's a fact, and they should be open about that from the get go... instead they hype you up, push you to learn all scripts and so on, and when you are finally ready you will spend 80 of you time going through a list of leads and calling people that never pickup the phone."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cy9b7k/im_stuck_at_globe_life_american_income_life_and_i/ms4ol22/

"The culture is definitely going to depend on who you're uplines are and what agency you joined. Of course that's obviously going to be true for every IMO that exists personally I didn't have any issue with culture or any of the things op mentioned although I will say that there was a lot of focus on recruitment and I feel like that will probably be the same no matter what as symmetry has a heavy focus on recruiting. The leads are definitely junk. In my opinion that alone is the biggest reason not to join symmetry. Symmetry is not even an insurance agency they're a lead company that has a side hustle selling insurance. Even the \$50 fresh leads are a pile of junk that will give you no return on investment unless you're incredibly lucky."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kjtqo3/warning_my_experience_with_symmetry_financial/ms6l3wz/

"NextGenLeads is a SCAM. NextGenLeads is a SCAM. They sell fraudulent data leads of Medicare which doesn't exist. Every lead I received was fake, disconnected, or for a person who never existed. Their refund algorithm claims are lies and support refuses to take responsibility. This is stolen money — don't sign up. Stay far away. They are a complete fraud"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6914a10a157e1b9986febe4b>

"Find another Leads provider!. I worked with Nick E. He was very helpful in setting up my campaign for their discounted weekend leads. I ended up spending Three hundred dollars on about 60 health leads. About 20% of the leads had disconnected or bad numbers. All of these Nick told me I would get reimbursed - but that did not happen. The other 80% of these leads, 90% did not answer the phone with about 1/2 going to voice mail, and the other half having no voice mail set up. The final 10% that I did speak to (briefly) either hung up immediately or claimed that they never requested information. This appears to be a scam - \$300 for no real leads. Giving Money to Nextgen Leads is unprofitable and a waste of your time!"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6046708ff85d75064c3b712f>

"majority of leads are disconnected.... majority of leads are disconnected numbers, wrong numbers, or don't fall within the filters that are set - very frustrating!!!"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d66efbaf0186907ac964388>

"I have the leads to be over sold and.... I have the leads to be over sold and not qualified. They also have a very strict returns program so you can return leads that are garbage. Your better off taking your money to Las Vegas!"

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d66e6b1f0186907ac963f50>

"The leads are rarely qualified, or in service.. The leads are only qualified and in service 15-20% of the time. There are numbers that are completely out of service but the returns get rejected. The only people that seem to answer (MAYBE 1 out of 10 leads that I get) don't qualify and don't match the health filters. I don't even see how it's legal to only return 10-15% of leads that are blatantly bad or not in service. Also, I'd say half the individuals I speak to are getting blown up with calls... making those leads, in fact, NOT exclusive. For \$30/lead on tier 1, I can go to another lead system and pay literally half for the exact same lead. I figured only bidding on tier 1 would give a better contact, but the leads are just as garbage at the tier 3. I've taken 2 separate webinars with nextgen hoping to learn how to better setup my campaigns and even after doing it exactly as you suggest, I still get contact on maybe 1 out of 10 leads that I get... that's 1/10 I even get to say hey to. So far, definitely hasn't been work the investments."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 2 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d683ffef0186907108933e4>

"RUN FROM THIS COMPANY. Absolutely furious and beyond disappointed with Smart Financial. If I could give them -20 stars, I would!! Their service is an absolute nightmare, and as others have mentioned, dealing with Jairus Garcia is a disaster. They refuse to address your concerns properly and go as far as blame you for their garbage leads. My husband and I purchased some leads, and every single one was trash. Most were disconnected numbers or had numbers that were restricted- yet they claim these are "hot leads." When we confronted Jairus about this, he has the audacity to say it was our fault for not working the leads correctly. To make matters worse, we asked 3 separate times to have our account closed and when that didn't work, I had to call them. Even calling them didn't help. Jairus would dodge my calls and call me days later telling my coworkers that I kept giving him the run around. As you can tell by reading this far, it was always my fault for everything. No accountability on their behalf. Anyway I ended up disputing charges and they went back around and disputed my claim and I ended up having to pay for their crappy leads anyway. It doesn't end there. They have different agents calling us from different numbers trying to rope us back in, even though I have insisently told them we are not interested in their services. It's beyond ridiculous. Save yourself the headache and run from this company. They don't care about you or your business, they just want the money and will stoop to any level to make sure they get it. This is by far the worst experience I've ever had!"

— TrustPilot · SmartFinancial · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/678581ea14d36aed0c9a3a43>

"Waste of money. The sales people don't do anything to help or respond to emails unless its in regards to an agent wanting to put more money in. Trying to communicate with the company is impossible. Most leads were either at a disconnected number or they had already gotten a quote and a policy from somewhere else."

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a29772b56d8c4ad541b990a>

"Terrible leads. Terrible leads. Half the numbers are disconnected. The ones that do answer already have insurance. Save your \$\$. And they only give you credit a quarter of the disc. numbers and that's not enough."

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/690bdabc9fe15b15007b8b03>

Commission cuts and carriers pulling commissions

"Why aren't we talking about commission cuts? I've been lurking here for a while, and like many others, I've been considering getting licensed to sell health insurance. I've noticed there are "a ton" of weekly posts asking "Should I get into insurance?" and most of the responses are really positive and encouraging. But what surprises me is what's **NOT** being discussed much: **#1 Major carriers are cutting commissions or removing them entirely.** Here are some examples: * **United Health Care** will stop paying commissions on 100+ Medicare Advantage plans and all PDPs in over 20 states starting July 1, 2025. The NAIFA denounced UHC's decision to cut agent commissions. * **Aetna** is withdrawing from the ACA marketplace and slashing commissions after 2025. * **Cigna, Centene, Elevance (Anthem)** are all making similar moves. **#2 The recent passing of the new "Big Beautiful Bill"**. From what I can tell, these are pretty major shifts and could seriously impact how agents make a living going forward. Yet almost none of this shows up in the "how do I start" threads. Why? So, I wanted to ask more directly: * Why isn't there more discussion about these changes here? Is the impact overstated, or are we just not seeing the effects "yet"? * Do veteran agents think ACA/Medicare will still be viable long-term? * Should newcomers treat this as a full-time career or more of a side hustle moving forward? * How are current agents planning to adapt in the next 5-10 years? Genuinely curious. I'm not trying to be negative. I'm just surprised there isn't more open talk about what seems like some pretty big red flags for the industry. Would love to hear what those of you already in the trenches think. Thanks!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/

"United is simply restructuring and will release new plans for AEP. Obviously they were hit hard, notice they only decommissioned the extremely affordable PPOs going forward... thats because they don't want you to sell any more of them and they cant just release plan changes mid year. And you are talking about commission cuts when we were just announced a 10% increase in MAPD renewals and Initials for 2026. There are lots of carriers dying to throw agents money.... And new carriers are still getting in the game and expanding every year, which is a good sign. I agree it is a little unstable right now, but for agents that is a good thing. Medicare and ACA aren't going anywhere. And if they do, you have an entire book to convert to the new thing."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n56ide4/

"For MAPD brokers, who is still writing UHC and Humana non-commissionable plans? Across most of the country over the past few years, UnitedHealthcare and Humana have made many of their MAPD plans non-commissionable. I refuse to work for free and represent these plans going forward. Are there any MAPD-certified brokers who are still willingly selling these plans? Just curious as to why you would put a client on a plan you receive no commissions on."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1woc7yr/for_mapd_brokers_who_is_still_writing_uhc_and/

"Medicare Agent Commissions I have a question for fellow Medicare agents. With carriers pulling commissions what are your plans to pivot to keep business alive? My clients and new individuals turning 65 still are in such need for help navigating through the weeds of the whole system along with their plan choices but working for free just can't go on. We have a higher MS clientele rate but now with those rates skyrocketing I'm concerned there will be a shift towards MAPD which a lot are going non-commissionable. Also in our small area we don't have a thriving market for DVH so that's out. What are you all doing to stay alive?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/

"I'm an ACA broker in about 15 states and the commissions are always \$15-\$30 per month per member, depending on the carrier. It's never a % of the monthly premium in my experience. There's no commission if you canceled before it started. That guy deffo gave you bad info on filing status. Glad you got the right I fo here!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/pbqZyor/

"I've been predicting that (the 2nd wave of commission cuts) for several years. Fortunately I've been wrong so far. I think it will come but no reason agents shouldn't sell all of them they can sell currently. Just don't put ALL your eggs in that basket."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Senior Insurance Forum · 4 reactions · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/mapd-commissions-first-to-get-the-axe.110822/#post-1457732>

"I am a Medicare Insurance Broker in California with over 20 years experience. We were just notified yesterday of commission cuts with 68 pages of information. For new plans starting January 2026 we have received the usual commission increase, however, for renewals it appears that we will only receive renewal commissions based on 2025 residuals instead of 2026 rates. It's disappointing, but it won't kill us. In my area, the only plans that are being discontinued are the unpopular plans. Would I say, go ahead and get licensed and certified to sell Medicare? I would not, knowing what I know now. It's alot of work annually getting certified to sell Medicare with hundreds, if not thousands of regulations. Not to mention all the competition from other agents. I can tell anyone who wants to know, I'm looking for another way to supplement my income in the future because I think what will happen to non-Medicare plans will eventually happen to us, that being up to 4% commission instead of 20% like it used to be."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/ndjpk27/

"New Agent Advice I got my life insurance license back in February (at the same time I was let go from my previous W2 position). I have really struggled to find my footing with IMOs and FMOs. A lot of these companies just throw trash leads at new agents and expect you to find gold. To make matters worse, my current company's inbound transfer leads completely dried up because another agent didn't pay their invoice. The system was supposed to be you receive inbound transfers, get paid from your commission Thursday and pay the invoice Friday. Since I'm currently unemployed and don't have any savings, I can't afford to buy expensive leads or wait out cash-flow gaps. I recently interviewed with State Farm but didn't hear back. At this point, I really need a W2 captive agent role or an independent position that offers exclusive, provided leads for a lower commission cut so I can build a stable bankroll are my thoughts. Does anyone have any help or suggestions?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1wgdt5/new_agent_advice/

"Appreciate the context! That helps me understand it better. Sounds like you're saying this is might be more of a market correction or rough patch than a permanent decline for agents. I've heard some of the chatter around UHC's situation but didn't realize it was that bad. Curious, do you think the carriers pulling commissions now might bring them back *if* the plans become profitable again? Or is that just wishful thinking and the trend toward no commissions is here to stay? And yeah, I agree...it feels like ACA/Medicaid are way more vulnerable, but hard to predict where this all ends up."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m9awgu/why_arent_we_talking_about_commission_cuts/n563vtn/

"W2 jobs I have found out there now are low commission to no commission meaning they don't really pay you what your time and effort are worth. However, there are some places that do 1099 and high commission AND they provide leads. That's where I am now and it's been working for all the agents. One of the issues I always had with people on W2 is that they just come for the paycheck and never seemed to be working to get sales. I hated that. I always felt like they were wasting good leads that I could have worked. 1099, no one does that as much lol. Because they know they get paid if they make sales."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1su3zm9/i_am_stuck_frustrated_and_ready_to_give_up_on_my/oi32vrz/

"An agent helped me evaluate some Medigap policies but I finally decided to take my employer's highly-subsidized, retiree-only Medicare Advantage plan. I respect the time and value agents bring to the table, and feel badly that this person earned no commission. I want to send him a payment for his help. Help me benchmark what would be appropriate. Or do agents just think this sort of thing just comes with the territory?"

— YouTube · How Much Money Can Medicare Sales Agents Make? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vs4gz6CkKl&lc=UgyLEcrLhNG9vJCKcRZ4AaABAq>

"We still help them choose the appropriate drug plan for them and enroll them. Commissioned or not. That's what we're there for. It was just a hit for our company when a lot of the carriers pulled commissions and were still trying to gain back what we lost last AEP and grow. Also concerned about the future of the market as a whole."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1kotgtz/medicare_agent_commissions/msym76d/

Shared leads sold to many agents

"Hahaha. Looks like a lead that has been tormented by countless calls from agents. I blame the lead vendors that resell the same leads to 5 different offices"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1rsznnr/text_exchange_from_a_prospect_who_reached_out_to/oaag95t/

"Former MGA here. I worked the TMK system (AIL Globe NILICO) for about 5 years and was VERY successful. So it is possible however I left and went independent for several reasons. 1. Everyone and anyone at AIL that talks about free leads vs paying for leads doesn't quite understand that they aren't comparing apples to apples here. Most leads at AIL aren't people who are looking FOR or interested in life insurance, the union leads are sort of close but they all think you're just coming to endorse the free AD&D. Most agencies these days aren't even running union leads anymore but running Will Kits Child Safe/mcgruff veterans etc. (my agency tested several other "kits" too like Cancer kits) Another thing is they recycle leads just as much as everyone else but they limit the amount you get and control when you get them. So yes they are free but imagine getting 60-100 leads and being told that's all you get for 60-90 days so you better collect referrals. (Heck you're trained NOT to say "insurance" on the phones 😂) 2. Starting at 50% comp these days is just silly when everyone else except WFG Primerica and PHP are starting new agents between 75-110% 3. The leaderboard is a liar, most (not all) of the people in the spotlight or whatever that magazine was called are not running the same leads that regular new agents are, they're running POS aka calling clients that purchased policies from different agents and then upselling them. Those that aren't are sometimes just chasing advance and doing shady things. 4. The rates for policies ESPECIALLY for people over 60 are laughable... example: I can get a 60 year old Male non tobacco user can get straight whole life NONE GRADED day 1 coverage (meaning the policy is issued and in force when you write it bc it's UW is electronic... no extra phone calls) 20,000 for 68.50 but since I don't like that specific carrier I'd get them a better policy or carrier with Mutual of Omaha for 84.32. Check the price on eapp for the difference and keep in mind... those prices aren't graded. Which brings me to number 5. It's hard to have residuals and renewals when your policies are being replaced. TLDR: It's a decent starter company and yes you CAN make good money but to all of us outside of it we look at AIL Prime WFG and PHP like middle schoolers trying to look cool wearing mom and dad's clothes."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 8 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/15wc7r0/recently_accepted_a_job_with_globe_life/jx47s9rl/

"Some lead vendors are honest stating their leads are sold to multiple agents, others however claim their leads are exclusive while recycling and selling the same lead multiple times over. You can definitely still find prospects that have yet to purchase a policy or even some that you may be able to offer a better rate to, but for the most part this type of lead is garbage and a headache to deal with. My agency has been using Speakeasy Leads for almost a year now for final expense and general life insurance leads. Agent Advantage has also been great for IUL leads. Both seem to be the few that offer legitimately exclusive leads and I rarely get the "I've already spoken to 10 agents" bs lol. A few vendors I would avoid from previous personal experience: Integrity Lead Center - these leads are definitely resold to multiple agents Leadrilla - Garbage TTC Leads - They were great, but since their original owner past away the lead quality suffered Caboom Leads - Overpriced + prospects seem to be just shoppers MediaAlpha - I've received numerous leads in the past that had disconnected #'s paired with many prospects who have been deceased for years, overall just seems like fake data. Overall, the best method is to learn how to generate your own leads or hire an expert to setup your campaigns/lead capture funnels. This however is much easier said than done as it does take some time, effort and money to effectively learn paid ads, and if you do hire an individual or agency to manage this for you their fees are steep with no results guaranteed."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 6 upvotes · life / final-expense agent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1iy32o6/sick_of_lead_companies/merel99/

"Back to school? I'm a Medicare Telesales (captive) agent for a large health insurance company. I'm doing fairly well, not the best on my team but not the worst, but I DO know that I hold leadership qualities that some do, and some do not possess. I really love my job, I love the my colleagues, and I really want to move up in my career. I have not been in school for 10+ years... I am honestly not even sure how going back to college would even work, entirely. I am a single mom of a four year old boy who's in preschool full time. (just to give a little background and knowledge of my very limited schedule) What classes should I take in order to make myself stand out ahead of anyone else who may be aiming for the same leadership roles, such as supervisor or lead? Bachelors in Health Sciences? Any helpful advice/insight would be IMMENSELY appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/InsuranceProfessional · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceProfessional/comments/1cqssyh/back_to_school/

"Pretty typical of any vendor, can run hot and cold. I'm not sure if you see the same leads that I do, but if there is a "questionnaire" lead, stay away from that one. It is full of people who are just filling out surveys. To be honest, I buy a mix of leads from them. That being said, every internet lead has to be worked. You are going to get plenty who say "wasn't me", or some other lame excuse or they just hang up on you. I'll simply put those leads to the side for a couple days, even a week and then call them again as if we've never spoken. It doesn't always work out, but the number of people who all but cussed me out a few days ago, now act like they've been waiting on my call is just weird. I like that Integrity doesn't force a specific number for a purchase. I work this business part time so it's nice to be able to control how many I get. I work with a team, and we have plenty of new agents come and go. I'll see them buy 5,10,20 leads, dial them a few times, not make a sale, then blame wherever the lead came from, say the whole thing is a scam and bounce. Working internet leads is not always an easy task."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1k1p919/badaleads_scam/mnsacz5/

"@michellejones9265 Wrong! They respond to one ad, and the lead is sold to 100 agents who then blow their phone up non-stop. Then their information is loaded into databases and put of call rotations and this data is out there for anyone to purchase. I am an insurance telesales agent, and I pay for EXCLUSIVE INBOUND RAW LEADS so that the person responding to the ad gets only me. And I convert 73% of the time because I am not selling them, I am helping them."

— YouTube · Insurance Agent Calls An Angry Lead - Rate This Call! #insurance #insuranceagent #lifeinsu · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yc0XJA-IF5I&lc=Ugw49oUdeZR-fn3Bn0R4AaABAg_Alg9l0V7W9YAUH4bNyS2V1

"My question is do they sell the same leads to more than one agent. A lot of the lead companies out there are selling the same lead to up to 8 agents. I hate to be the client that responded to a card in the mail, or ask for an agent to call them and then have 8 agents calling me, and each one would tell me the other 7 agents are out to screw me."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Health Insurance and Ancillary Benefits · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/asap-quotes.1599/#post-108183>

"Horrible company with bad customer.... Horrible company with bad customer service. You have to constantly contact them to ask questions and no one ever gives you the same answer. They also resell leads. My colleague and I would get the same leads and found out we were quoting the same people and competing with each other using the same service."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/68fa6ecffc19918761585390>

"The leads are rarely qualified, or in service.. The leads are only qualified and in service 15-20% of the time. There are numbers that are completely out of service but the returns get rejected. The only people that seem to answer (MAYBE 1 out of 10 leads that I get) don't qualify and don't match the health filters. I don't even see how it's legal to only return 10-15% of leads that are blatantly bad or not in service. Also, I'd say half the individuals I speak to are getting blown up with calls... making those leads, in fact, NOT exclusive. For \$30/lead on tier 1, I can go to another lead system and pay literally half for the exact same lead. I figured only bidding on tier 1 would give a better contact, but the leads are just as garbage at the tier 3. I've taken 2 separate webinars with nextgen hoping to learn how to better setup my campaigns and even after doing it exactly as you suggest, I still get contact on maybe 1 out of 10 leads that I get... that's 1/10 I even get to say hey to. So far, definitely hasn't been work the investments."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 2 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d683fef0186907108933e4>

"Their leads are aged. Their leads are aged, not valid phone # and shared with multiple agents within the same company. Never waste your time with a phony lead company!"

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6862dd5f5e2b91e0fa8ea1f8>

"Because GoHealth flagged this. Because GoHealth flagged this, I am posting it again. If you don't like it, gohealth, then it's time to make changes within the company instead of supressing voices. This company engages in shady practices to inflate their numbers. I am a current top performing employee and can assure you that we are pressured to sell anything to anyone as long as we can get it to pass with Medicare and as long as we can get you to say yes on a recording. We are incentivized with large amounts of cash to worry about sales per day and not how many people actually stayed enrolled for longer than 3 months. We are reprimanded if we are not converting our leads, that means I lose my job and can't feed my family if I don't do everything in my power to enroll you, whether or not it's of any benefit to you or even if you're the client of another agent, I'm required to attempt to enroll you and take credit for that. I can assure you that we will call you several times a day with 5+ agents working the same lead, calling up to three times a day and no, the company does not acknowledge your Do Not Call request even if we say we do, someone else will call you within the day I promise. I can assure you that the company will do whatever it takes to make that bottom line and show growth in each department, in each quarter, no matter what we have to do or who we have to do it to, agent or client. Business is business. I can't share every detail in one go but I post this because I'm deeply concerned with the things we as a society accept as a normality, and I wonder how much corporate abuse will we normalize before we give up our rights entirely."

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/672c105acdab77a125b4bfed>

"This company engages in shady practices.... This company engages in shady practices to inflate their numbers. I am a current top performing employee and can assure you that we are pressured to sell anything to anyone as long as we can get it to pass with Medicare and as long as we can get you to say yes on a recording. We are incentivized with large amounts of cash to worry about sales per day and not how many people actually stayed enrolled for longer than 3 months. We are reprimanded if we are not converting our leads, that means I lose my job and can't feed my family if I don't do everything in my power to enroll you, whether or not it's of any benefit to you or even if you're the client of another agent, I'm required to attempt to enroll you and take credit for that. I can assure you that we will call you several times a day with 5+ agents working the same lead, calling up to three times a day and no, the company does not acknowledge your Do Not Call request even if we say we do, someone else will call you within the day I promise. I can assure you that the company will do whatever it takes to make that bottom line and show growth in each department, in each quarter, no matter what we have to do or who we have to do it to, agent or client. Business is business. I can't share every detail in one go but I post this because I'm deeply concerned with the things we as a society accept as a normality, and I wonder how much corporate abuse will we normalize before we give up our rights entirely."

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67296e0cbbcd446c179ddeb1>

FMOs and uplines that don't deliver or won't release

"I didn't even make it to my first training with them. They had me sit in on a "mandatory" Zoom meeting (seriously? For 1099's?), which was an absolute shit-show of some agents making calls, others talking to one-another, and still others dicking around on video games--all at the same time, and with nothing muted. I couldn't take it. It also told me that nearly everything the recruiter had told me had been lies (a 30-hour week? Only 30 leads to call each week, and all of them union members who are sitting around twiddling their thumbs waiting for your call to complete their enrollment in benefits they're already signed up for? Cool! Easy money), which is why I opted out right then-and-there. Another thing about AIL I found to be VERY fishy was their requiring me to find a friend or associate to fill out an application and include all their personal information so that I could be appointed. When I asked what would then happen with the information, I was told not to worry, that it was just something necessary to be appointed and my friend, etc. wouldn't be liable for anything or be purchasing a policy. To this I asked why we can't just fudge things with made up info, but was told that "the system" wouldn't recognize it as a real person if we did. I also asked what happened to the information, and was told that it "...just goes to the company!" "And then what?" "Oh, I don't know, don't worry though!" Uh, when it comes to either mine or other people's personal information, yes, I worry. You may also want to take a look at all the BBB complaints against the company, of which there are shitloads. Though I realize that yes, AIL may be as legit as they come, I still don't like that they continuously speak of "uplines and downlines" since I'm leery of MLMs, and I sure as HELL ain't interested in having to lie to others to recruit them!"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/164ik21/are_there_any_truly_good_life_insurance_companies/koigwvj/

"So here's a funny twist in my insurance journey. I've been grinding, trying to build my agency, and for months I've been researching CRMs and dialers. I finally pulled the trigger and bought Ringy because everyone kept recommending it. Fast forward to this week... and I randomly discover I actually had access to Integrity's CRM, dialer, and lead marketplace the whole time for free through one of the agencies I'm contracted with. No one ever mentioned it. I literally stumbled into the dashboard by accident while looking for something else. Wild. I paid for a CRM meanwhile I already had access to one but my upline never brought it up. Smh Not mad about it though, just sharing in case any newer agents don't realize some FMOs/IMO's automatically give you tools like CRMs, dialers, quoting platforms, or lead systems that they never bother to highlight. Definitely worth double-checking what's included with your contracts before you go spending on extra software. If anyone else has had this happen or knows hidden features inside Integrity's system, drop some tips. I'm already finding stuff I didn't even know existed. However, I am going to keep the ringy platform. I really like the drip system they have for text and email and other features"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1odlyvg/solo_insurance_agent_looking_for_a_crm_dialer/no7I9a4/

"I would need to know what line of insurance you are talking about to get more specific. But basically its a standard wait of 6 months after a documented request of release from the contract for most carriers. Mutual of Omaha is pretty strict on that stuff. As far as what you do going forward is find an IMO that can fill the gaps with something competitive in the meantime while you process the releases and wait it out."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1gv923a/what_uplines_dont_want_you_to_know_carrier/nktnyr6/

"I read all of your comments. I do Medicare, as well. Just curious if you have anything in your former contract preventing you from just quickly moving under another FMO. As in, do you need a release from your former upline in order to get under anyone else?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1ofi9mo/i_was_a_1099_agent_and_got_terminated_today/nld6ghk/

"ya, I worked for them for a short stint. wasn't a fan of the structure and now ik with an IMO that is the opposite of an MLM, they help me as much as I need it and tell me where to privately purchase leads as opposed to purchasing it through them."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1f816tw/legit_life_insurance_wfh_job/lcsa40/

"I decided to get into this business after a friend of mine died with no life insurance, leaving his wife and two daughters destitute. My main focus, eventually, will be selling term insurance to families to protect them from a similar fate. I do write term cases now, but it is not my primary focus just yet. I decided to focus on final expense life insurance because it pays well and quickly and I am changing careers, so I do need to replace my income. Also, insurance is a complicated product, at least it is to me. Final expense gives me a nice, simple, narrow focus by which to build my foundation of knowledge of and experience in the insurance industry. In either case, I believe folks need life insurance. I have a wife and three kids. Every time my wife and I had a new child, I increased my life insurance. I'm a believer in the real risk of death and dying without leaving financial protection in place for those I love, and I believe each of us has a moral obligation to protect those who depend upon us from the potential loss of our income through death, and likewise to make sure we do not leave behind a financial burden for our children in the event we die without sufficient savings to pay our final expenses. When I talk to a prospect about life insurance, whether it is a family with children who need a large term policy or a senior who needs a small whole life policy, they know without a doubt how important I feel it is that they do something to protect themselves and their family. I always say to them at some point during the presentation, "This isn't about me or the insurance company or whatever commission I may hope to be paid for selling you this policy. This is about the obligation you and I have to our families. I believe having life insurance, and just having it, but having enough it, and the right kind of it, is simply the right thing to do." And they always nod their heads in agreement, and say "I know you do. I can tell you really believe in what you're doing." If you believe as I do, then you should have no qualms about the moral basis of this business you are contemplating entering. Protect yourself from the IMO's who are focused on recruiting and the MLM aspect of this business, and find an IMO that is focused on service to the agent. As far as the product goes, as long as you are helping folks get policies with highly rated carriers that they can comfortably afford so that they are not wasting money on a policy that they will have to let lapse, a policy that will provide them with a real benefit that they themselves, through your efforts, recognize as solving a problem that they have, then you are on the firmest of moral footings."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/fe-shady-niche-advice.86106/#post-1152180>

"crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- crabtrap said: Is it advisable to sell for more than one IMO/FMO? There are a few products not offered by my IMO and I would like to have them as an option to better serve the customer. Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929096>

"jdeasy said: Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. ----- Personal preference. Some say to not have all your contracts with one IMO but I prefer to have all of mine with one. But if they didn't carry a company I wanted I would pick it up elsewhere. I happen to be with an IMO, {FEX}, that will grant releases if I wanted to leave. If you are not with one that will release then it's a whole different ballgame. I certainly would not put all my contracts with an IMO that won't release. Click to expand... Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929350>

"John Galt said: Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets. I got it this morning. I thought you and Travis were communications on it. I'll call you today. Just need to verify that you are transferring all contracts that have any risk of debt roll up. Then all is good."

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929396>

"Diversified is offering this right now and hiring over 40 agents before July 1st but absolutely require atleast a year of experience and a release letter, but at least I know it's an option down the road. Can anyone recommend anywhere else in the meantime?"

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1shv3xs/best_company_to_join_for_agents_new_to_medicare/ofgofhm/

"John Galt said: Hmmm, I've sent two emails over the past few days requesting a release from just one carrier, all I've heard is crickets. Don't beat around the bush...what are you trying to say?"

— Insurance-Forums.com · Final Expense Forum · <https://www.insurance-forums.com/community/threads/selling-for-multiple-imo-fmos.70645/#post-929356>

Captive and call-center jobs: quotas, pay, pressure

"Do you know of any health insurance companies who pays their captive agent on an per hourly basis plus commissions? I just started with mine and its only 100% commission based, so for starters who dont have yet their clientele, money is a struggle. Do you have any advices?"

— YouTube · How Much Does A Health Insurance Agent Make/beingbougie · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrGUFRdgtZY&lc=UgzzDyeN1Egpbx-37nx4AaABAg>

"I can relate. As a captive agent I get lots of pressure to meet unrealistic sales quotas without any consideration for the quality of calls we are receiving etc. Hostile /cluelessly ignorant management just push harder for the dollar on the ones trying the most instead of boost the team and skill build. Top performing agents are the ones getting quality sale inbound directed to them on the backend through que assignment which I think is sus because it's clear those couple agents will continue doing big numbers while management whips us and acts like we should be able to do the same slam dunk on an outbound quote that was a no sale from the jump. There's some benefits working from home but yeah if the stress and money doesn't make sense it's confusing at times. But aye I worked hard to get where I'm at, ill continue to give my best - just not burn myself out because I've seen my enthusiasm and efforts be taken advantage of or unappreciated. Sometimes I wonder if I'm actually a licensed health insurance broker with a fiduciary responsibility or just a fkn used car salesman 🤔 cause God damn lol Hoping this week is much better tho for everyone here ❤️"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1bqj6l/how_is_everyone_handling_burnout_during_these/kxeuukb/

"If you're building your own P&C book, why not go out and get appointed directly from the carrier? I'm a young P&C agency owner as well, and I've had my life license for about a year now (when I was with State Farm.) I never really liked life, but I know it builds solid retention within your book. So here in the next couple months I'll be looking out for life insurance company appointments. I'd rather sell life occasionally than be stuck working for an upline that mandates sales quotas and gives you crappy leads + takes a large chunk of your commission."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1vtziac/my_experience_with_these_instagram_life_insurance/p54kywp/

"I agree with you about the leads determining how you succeed. Where I work we get gaslighted about 'You all get the same phone calls'. LOL, yeah sure. We know the top reps are in a queue where they get 3 deals by noon and us newbies don't get 3 quotable leads by noon ever. By quotable I mean, the lead is either on a DSNP and the next closest Plan has 100 less OTC and both plans have 0 co-pays for everything, like for like or calls where there is no SEP to use or the only SEP is Chronic and there are no CSNP plans in the area."

— YouTube · How To Sell 1 Medicare Policy Daily! [The Complete Blueprint] · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TVurscsiJKY&lc=Ugx9YbTFp6404-rkkAp4AaABAg.A1laVXaQaiuA7qYB8lYOkD>

"Off-Market plans are OFTEN (though not always) NOT ACA compliant- meaning they don't necessarily cover every one of the 10 Essential Health Benefits (may not cover hospital stays, may not cover pharmacy, may limit the number of visits to a PCP they'll cover, may not cover maternity, may not cover mental health, may not cover preventive 100%-- All things that ACA compliant plans MUST cover to some degree). In general, you may find some comparable plans by going to a carrier directly or hiring a broker to help you research off-market plans. I would urge you not to just "google" and select a random google website and start entering your information- that's how you end up in an ENDLESS cycle of "agents" (and I use this in quotations, because I question their credentials) spam calling you because that website just sold your information to 10,000 "agents". Research reputable brokerage firms in your area- the big names in the game are Lockton, Gallagher, AON, USI, Hub International, Willis Towers Watson, Brown & Brown, etc. and they should all have a department that handles individual coverages. These big firms have LICENSED brokers. \Ask for an ACA compliant plan if you're needing everything I've listed above to be covered and/or if you have pre-existing conditions (non ACA compliant plans can deny a claim just for being pre-existing). If you're asked to fill out any personal health information besides if you're a smoker (they ask for past diagnosis, past surgeries, family history of certain things, etc. in your application) it's a Medically Underwritten plan and not an ACA compliant plan. A reputable licensed broker is connected with several carriers vs. potentially just pushing one carrier or one type of plan (for instance a MEC plan or an indemnity plan-- which are not necessarily ACA compliant but the majority of what I see these scammy agents selling), should be patient enough to walk you through your options, take your concerns into consideration (providers you really need/want to have in network, medications you're currently taking, etc.) when finding you a policy. If you feel rushed or don't like the policies they are presenting, don't be afraid to go to the next broker. However, saying this AS a broker--- the ACA Marketplace is where I instruct my friends to look first as every single one of those plans is a legitimate ACA compliant, comprehensive coverage plan, no matter what you choose. We have a pinned post on walking you through how to pick a plan here: [https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1fvniop/questions_answered_which_plan_should_i_choose/](https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1fvniop/questions_answered_which_plan_should_i_choose/) I don't know that you can pre-pay the ENTIRE year, that's a question you'll have to ask the carrier. We typically see it billed by month-- though if you're not getting a subsidy, I supposed it's possible- in theory."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qwmyum/paying_for_aca_obamacare/o3qdal4/

"Don't trust e-health with your bank information!. When filling out the information it asks me my birth date and my age and I filled it out correctly. It gave me a quote that was affordable for me so I gave them my bank information for it to be withdrawn. Then they claimed that the year of birth for me was 2026. Asked them to change it to the correct one. Then they told me the rate would be three times more and tried to take it out of my bank account immediately. I had to stop check on my bank account which caused me a fee. It was obvious that they are trying to meet quotas. Even after filling out a request to cancel the application, they tried to take it out of my bank account. They should ask if I can afford the new quote before taking it out of my bank account. It's obvious that this is some sort of a scam. I will report this to some sort of authority."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa416f26f632c34dfa7e4f>

"Disappointing process and premium results. Extremely long process. Poor planning for health evaluation. Misleading premium quotation."

— TrustPilot · SelectQuote · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/699b1e3582b26675fbf5900d>

Lead debt and money burned

"Life Insurance is NOT what it seems... Alright this one is for all current and future life insurance agents. A few months ago I left a stable 9-5 with great benefits and decently high income to pursue life insurance sales. I kept seeing posts and ad's on social media making it seem like the next gold rush. I saw kids in their teens and 20s "selling" \$20k+ per week. And thought to myself, it's a no brainer. So I saved up some money for the transition, made the jump with both feet full time with the expectation that even if I make half of what they're showing, it would still be a game changer and life changer for me and my family. Fast forward 2 months, I feel as though I was sold a bill of goods and am now \$30k+ in debt on credit cards (due to licensing costs, lead spend, living expenses) and am now forced to look at alternative career options. I sold over 30 policies in my first 2 months but only deposited about \$10k and spent about \$13k in lead spend alone. A few things I learned that may help others thinking of making the switch: Agents on social media will advertise Annual Premium (AP) and make it seem like that's what's getting deposited in their account, in reality, that's not the case. What you get paid depends entirely on what product you sell (simplified or guaranteed issue), what carrier you sell it through(carrier split), what your compensation percentage is with your team and company (70-100%+ IMO comp), and you typically only get 75% of it upfront. Also, every policy you sell doesn't necessarily issue. Some of them cancel ahead of time, or have insufficient funds, or your policy gets replaced, etc. THEN you have to factor in any potential chargebacks (industry average is between 20-30%). And after all that is said and done, you need to subtract out the amount you spent on leads for the week/month. That will give you your actual ROI. For example, let's say I sold \$50k in AP for the month. \$50,000 85% carrier product split (average assumption some products are much less) 90% IMO split (some imo's start you at only 70%) 75% upfront commission (9 months worth) 25% charge back/fall off assumption (can be reduced based on your systems, processes, and practices in place) \$21,500 = gross deposits into your bank account Minus your lead spend (assume a 5x- 10x Return on Lead Spend) let's call it \$7,000 on lead spend to sell 50k in AP. That means your NET profit would be around \$14,500. Not saying that's chump change or anything, but then you take into account the fact that you usually are working 10-12 hour days 5-6 days a week and if you're selling anything less than \$40k a month, you're practically going negative or breaking even. That's why the industry has such a high churn rate of 98% in the first year. The problem is, the life insurance industry is heavily dependent on recruiting and a lot of these people that actually make it to the big leagues spend years recruiting and reinvesting their commissions into the business. So I'm not saying it's not possible, but I am saying that the illusion you get sold upfront is distorted and not 100% the truth that you will start selling and "making" \$20k+ months easily. It's the equivalent of me "selling" a \$100k car and saying that's what I "earned", but it's not, you usually only get a fraction of the volume. Now I'm sure there are going to be outliers and people that say "well I made it", I'm not here to tell anyone to do or not to do something they want to try, I'm just here to share what I wish someone had told me upfront when I was getting started so that I knew better and could make a more informed decision. Hindsight is 20/20 of course but either way I'm glad I took the leap and bet on myself. So if you're just getting started or are thinking about it, make sure to ask your upline all the questions and calculate exactly how much you need to sell and how much you need to spend to NET the amount of money you want. Then compare that to the time you need to invest to achieve it and make an informed decision on whether this industry is for you or not. Stay blessed."

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"It really just depends on the leads i buy, the most expensive ones right now for me are \$13.00 a lead.. Typically you want to reinvest 10-15% of what you're wanting to make back into your business. So if you want to make 10,000 a month you need to invest at LEAST 1,000 back into leads and stuff like that. It's all about your numbers too. Warm market leads are better than cold market in my opinion. I've spent about \$400 in leads and i've made 2 sales off of those that have covered the \$400 and then some. Life insurance is a little different than other insurance i feel like, you REALLYYYYY have to grind. It's hard but once you figure out your numbers it's like a challenge against yourself every month haha."

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"This right here! So many unethical companies too that's exploit their agents and charge for bonk ass leads. My first experience was with HealthMarkets, horrible company, leads are \$36 each all of which are trash. I spent thousands of dollars on leads the first year. I also got taken by FFL, there I only burned \$3,000 in leads, I sold 5 policies, 4 charged back. I'm so happy now that I'm focused on the ACA market only. I don't care about selling life or any other supplemental. People are broke and they care barely afford health insurance as it is."

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"I've only done a little over a week of actual calls myself. Never regretted any choice so much as the one to go into selling life insurance. Though it's not the angry customers and hang ups that have me burnt out. I had no idea the costs involved in buying leads (on top of licenses), and started this job while already in debt in several areas of life. I'm looking at a foreclosure on my house while barely being able to afford 20 leads a week. Which is too few and only half of what my company expects me to get, and I'm constantly aware of what little money I have left for more leads. I've had very few people even answer the phone (and I call often and have left voicemails), and have yet to get through the first 10 seconds with those few that did, so my confidence has taken a dive. I've made changes to the way respond to those initial objections, I feel I'm better prepared to keep the call going, but I just can't afford to buy more leads to test them out. I'm about to try out a burner in the hopes I can breathe some life into one or two of my old leads and get them to pick up, as well as get the next leads to answer. With all that I might still be able to push through, but having my boss make comments about taking responsibility for ourselves and our destiny, and telling me he took out credit cards when he got started (which I wouldn't be approved for anyway, and already took out my 401k), pretty much led to a meltdown the other day. I'm aware of my shortcomings, and usually good with constructive criticism, but with those I can't control like finances, being told indirectly I'm making excuses has about done me in. Being in on our morning meetings usually gets me pumped and feeling confident but all of a sudden.. it's just gone, and I'm deflated like a balloon. I'm struggling to get back into the mindset I need to be in. Just 20 or so leads a week is costing me \$400, and I'll be almost broke after the next batch I get on Monday, and I just can't escape that thought of what do I do if I don't make a sale. And the live transfers go too fast for me to grab them. They're expensive but at least I would be able to do a presentation and not feel like such a failure so soon after starting. Sorry OP, I'm not very helpful lol. But I feel you. It's not an easy career by any means. I haven't given up but I'm not sure what else I can do when the money runs out. I feel like motivational books might be helpful for you though. Before the meltdown (as I already have issues being naturally confident) I was reading "The magic of thinking big" by David Schwartz. It really was helping with motivation and my frame of mind before now. You might give it a go, it can't hurt."

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"After spending 7 years with Primerica, from 2004 to 2011, I came to one conclusion. In a lot of Life insurance commission sales jobs, you're either in debt from chargebacks or you're in debt from buying leads. I believe if the opportunity is truly solid, the company should generate the leads, vet the salespeople, and assign qualified opportunities. Pay a little less commission if you have to, but build a higher-quality sales force instead of recruiting everyone with a pulse. The client loses too when a salesperson is struggling financially. When you're desperate for a commission, it's easy to develop "commission breath" and recommend what pays the most instead of what's best for the customer. For the last 14 years I've been in home improvement sales, and I honestly wish I had found this industry when I was 20. The company provides the leads. We sell large-ticket projects that are installed in a few weeks. Customers pay upfront. No chargebacks. No chasing renewals. No worrying about policies lapsing years later. Every sales job has its challenges, but if you're looking for a long-term sales career, don't overlook home services. I wish I had found it sooner."

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"Thought I'd add my 2 cents...I joined in July of this year and I still believe there is a lot of potential. I'm tracking everything right now. My costs, my earnings, my hours and I've decided to give it 1 year before redirecting because it is a steep, rough learning curve and people say it can take a year to acclimate. But if you are average and you acclimate, you can be quite successful. Don't compare SFG to an hourly job somewhere else, this is much closer to entrepreneurship and with that in mind you're spending more than you are making at the beginning. Here is my opinion on OP's red flags: 1. Aged leads. Yes, if you buy those ones. Which are great for new agents because they offer practice (and possible sales) for a fraction of the cost. For example, my first sale was with an H lead...that's the cheapest .40 cent lead. I spent \$10 in leads and turned that into \$1000. But I've recently been buying A leads (fresh new leads) and it's much more disappointing not to convert those to sales. I estimate that I've spent \$800 on fresh leads this month and have converted that to about \$4000 income. 2. Culture. I love the group/agency I am a part of. A lot of support. A lot of resources. A lot of community and communication. We just got done doing a 60 day health challenge for anyone who wanted to join. The agency has several leaders and I can validate that some leaders ego's and shame responses are too much for me. I don't like how they talk and I don't respond well to that. They are not my direct upline and I'm glad, but my direct upline is fantastic. 3. Permission for licensing. I've never heard of this. I licensed when and where I wanted to. My upline didn't mention anything other than it will help me succeed if I license in more than one state. They helped me find states that have a lot of leads. 4. Shaming over conferences. Yes. I joined a couple months before their conference and the amount of "if you're not signed up for conference, it shows that you are not committed" type of comments were totally off putting. Again my uplines were not a part of that type of verbiage and in fact some of the leaders were encouraging with, "don't worry if you can't make it, those of us that can make it will share what we learn and use it to bring everyone up" type of conversations. I think conference must feel like some kind of club or like even religion and some people believe in it so much that they think it's the truth and way for everyone. I don't subscribe to that type of hype, but I do hope I can go next year because it not only looked educational, but fun...karaoke and costume party and dinners so if I make it past my 1 year mark I plan to attend. 5. The training. This is my first experience in this training so I can't say it's the worst. Probably again depends on the help you get from your agency. I will say, even though I had a very supportive group it felt very self-taught. But they have the resources for it and there are a lot of different trainings to participate in so it is possible to be self taught. It's hard though. Doable for sure! 6. Mental health. I can absolutely understand the toll an unsupported position could and would have on someone...ESPECIALLY in sales. Sales is a beast. You learn a lot about yourself. It's painful at times and I wish it was a nice cut and dry training and 1 month later you feel great. I'm 3 months in with high highs and low lows. A lot of days I want to give up. But ultimately, I want to give it a full chance. I'm making more than I'm spending (including costs for licensing in other states, dialing subscriptions, and the more expensive A leads) and I think that's pretty good for a new agent. These are just my new agent opinions. I haven't had any experiences with other IMOs or insurance jobs or anything like that. My background is stay at home mom, into mental health practice ownership with my husband, back to stay at home mom, and now SFG."

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